



**GREEN
CLIMATE
FUND**

Meeting of the Board
16 – 19 May 2022
Antigua and Barbuda
Provisional agenda item 5

GCF/B.32/02/Add.01

25 April 2022

Consideration of funding proposals - Addendum I

Funding proposal package for FP184

Summary

This addendum contains the following six parts:

- a) A funding proposal titled " Vanuatu community-based climate resilience project (VCCRP)";
- b) No-objection letter issued by the national designated authority(ies) or focal point(s);
- c) Secretariat's assessment;
- d) Independent Technical Advisory Panel's assessment;
- e) Response from the accredited entity to the independent Technical Advisory Panel's assessment; and
- f) Gender documentation.

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Funding Proposal

Project/Programme title:	Vanuatu community-based climate resilience project (VCCRP)
Country(ies):	Vanuatu
Accredited Entity:	Save the Children Australia
Date of first submission:	2021-08-13 V.1
Date of current submission	2022/03/31
Version number	v7 (B.32)



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Note to Accredited Entities on the use of the funding proposal template

- Accredited Entities should provide summary information in the proposal with cross-reference to annexes such as feasibility studies, gender action plan, term sheet, etc.
- Accredited Entities should ensure that annexes provided are consistent with the details provided in the funding proposal. Updates to the funding proposal and/or annexes must be reflected in all relevant documents.
- The total number of pages for the funding proposal (excluding annexes) **should not exceed 60**. Proposals exceeding the prescribed length will not be assessed within the usual service standard time.
- The recommended font is Arial, size 11.
- Under the [GCF Information Disclosure Policy](#), project and programme funding proposals will be disclosed on the GCF website, simultaneous with the submission to the Board, subject to the redaction of any information that may not be disclosed pursuant to the IDP. Accredited Entities are asked to fill out information on disclosure in section G.4.

Please submit the completed proposal to:

fundingproposal@gcfund.org

Please use the following name convention for the file name:

"FP-[Accredited Entity Short Name]-[Country/Region]-[YYYY/MM/DD]"

A. PROJECT/PROGRAMME SUMMARY				
A.1. Project or programme	Project	A.2. Public or private sector	Public	
A.3. Request for Proposals (RFP)	If the funding proposal is being submitted in response to a specific GCF Request for Proposals, indicate which RFP it is targeted for. Please note that there is a separate template for the Simplified Approval Process and REDD+. <u>Not applicable</u>			
A.4. Result area(s)	Check the applicable GCF result area(s) that the <u>overall</u> proposed project/programme targets below. For each checked result area(s), indicate the estimated percentage of GCF and Co-financers' contribution devoted to it. The total of the percentages when summed should be 100% for GCF and Co-financers' contribution respectively.			
		GCF contribution	Co-financers' contribution¹	
	Mitigation total	<u>Enter number</u> %	<u>Enter number</u> %	
	☐ Energy generation and access	<u>Enter number</u> %	<u>Enter number</u> %	
	☐ Low-emission transport	<u>Enter number</u> %	<u>Enter number</u> %	
	☐ Buildings, cities, industries and appliances	<u>Enter number</u> %	<u>Enter number</u> %	
	☐ Forestry and land use	<u>Enter number</u> %	<u>Enter number</u> %	
	Adaptation total	<u>Enter number</u> %	<u>Enter number</u> %	
	☒ Most vulnerable people and communities	45 %	48 %	
	☒ Health and well-being, and food and water security	45 %	48 %	
	☐ Infrastructure and built environment	<u>Enter number</u> %	<u>Enter number</u> %	
☒ Ecosystems and ecosystem services	10 %	4 %		
A.5. Expected mitigation outcome	Indicate greenhouse gas (GHG) emission reductions or removals in tCO₂eq over total lifespan of the project/programme²	A.6. Expected adaptation outcome	200,157 total direct and indirect beneficiaries	
(Core indicator 1: GHG emissions reduced, avoided or removed / sequestered)			90,157 direct beneficiaries	110,000 indirect beneficiaries
			33% of direct beneficiaries vis-à-vis total population	40% of indirect beneficiaries vis-à-vis total population
A.7. Total financing (GCF + co-finance³)	32,650,440 USD	A.9. Project size	Small (Upto USD 50 million)	
A.8. Total GCF funding requested	<u>26,182,878</u> USD For multi-country proposals, please fill out annex 17.			

¹ Co-financer's contribution means the financial resources required, whether Public Finance or Private Finance, in addition to the GCF contribution (i.e. GCF financial resources requested by the Accredited Entity) to implement the project or programme described in the funding proposal.

² The total lifespan of the project/programme is defined as the maximum number of years over which the outcomes of the investment are expected to be effective. This is different from the project/programme implementation period.

³ Refer to the Policy of Co-financing of the GCF.

A.10. Financial instrument(s) requested for the GCF funding	Mark all that apply and provide total amounts. The sum of all total amounts should be consistent with A.8. ☒ Grant <u>26,182,878</u> ☐ Equity <u>Enter number</u> ☐ Loan <u>Enter number</u> ☐ Results-based payment <u>Enter number</u> ☐ Guarantee <u>Enter number</u>		
A.11. Implementation period	6 years	A.12. Total lifespan	12 years
A.13. Expected date of AE internal approval	This is the date that the Accredited Entity obtained/will obtain its own approval to implement the project/programme, if available. 9/7/2021		
A.15. Has this FP been submitted as a CN before?	Yes ☒ No ☐	A.16. Has Readiness or PPF support been used to prepare this FP?	Yes ☐ No ☒
A.17. Is this FP included in the entity work programme?	Yes ☒ No ☐	A.18. Is this FP included in the country programme?	Yes ☒ No ☐
A.19. Complementarity and coherence	Does the project/programme complement other climate finance funding (e.g. GEF, AF, CIF, etc.)? If yes, please elaborate in section B.1. Yes ☒ No ☐		
A.20. Executing Entity information	Entity: Government of Vanuatu acting through its Ministry of Climate Change (MoCC) Country of registration: Vanuatu Ownership type: Government Entity: Save the Children Vanuatu (SCV) Country of registration: Vanuatu Ownership type: non-profit organisation The MoCC & SCV will co-Execute the project		
A.21. Executive summary (max. 750 words, approximately 1.5 pages)			
1. Vanuatu leads the world disaster risk index as the country with the highest disaster risk score of 49.74, indicating it is the most highly exposed to natural hazards⁴. A global analysis of countries affected by the impacts of climate-related events (e.g. tropical cyclones, floods, heat waves) ranked Vanuatu 8th globally, based on losses per GDP percentage between 1999 and 2018⁵. These risks are evident in the recent and repeated hazards that Vanuatu has experienced, including TC Pam (2015), El Niño drought (2016), marine heatwave (2016), TC Hola (2018), TC Harold (2020) and regular flooding during heavy rainfall and tropical cyclones. These events have resulted in significant damage to infrastructure and livelihoods (with TCs Harold and Pam causing loss equivalent to 61% and 64% GDP, respectively).			

2. The current available evidence indicates that the most significant climate change challenges facing communities in Vanuatu are due to increasing frequency and/or intensity of extreme events:
 1. Temperature: air and sea (minimum, mean and maximum daily temperatures and events such as heatwaves).
 2. Rainfall patterns (increased duration of dry periods, changing frequency and intensity of extreme rainfall and ENSO-associated rainfall).
 3. Tropical cyclones (increased intensity including severe wind and waves, and intense rainfall and flooding).
3. The vulnerability of communities in Vanuatu to these climate hazards is driven by the country's geography and heavy dependence on natural resources for subsistence and income. Other factors that contribute to the country's vulnerability are a narrow economic base, a weak developing economy (recently graduated from LDC status, but likely to be pushed back to it by the economic impacts of COVID-19), poor inter- and intra-island communication and transport networks, and a decentralized and dispersed population often isolated during disaster events (due to the country's vast ocean territory, with widely spread and sparsely populated islands).
4. The Vanuatu Community-based Climate Resilience Project (VCCRP) will support highly vulnerable rural communities across 29 Area Councils in Vanuatu to increase their resilience to climate variability and change by implementing targeted adaptation actions and facilitating decentralized governance structures that enable rural populations to adapt to changing climate trends and reduce disaster risk. The project's adaptation package provides a menu of actions to support households and communities to address key drivers of climate change vulnerability, minimize exposure and sensitivity and build resilience to unavoidable impacts. The adaptation package includes community-based, locally-led actions focused on minimizing sensitivity of food systems (agriculture and fisheries), reducing dependence on vulnerable income-generating resources through alternative livelihood options, improving access to critical services and addressing social inequities that exacerbate climate vulnerability. The adaptation package will also support communities to maintain healthy ecosystems and restore degraded habitats, to fortify food and livelihood security and reduce vulnerability to climate change-driven disasters, to enhance resource management and build adaptive governance systems.
5. The project's goal statement is that **IF** vulnerable remote and rural communities in Vanuatu access and utilize locally-relevant climate information, integrate climate risks into community planning processes, and are supported to implement priority adaptation actions; **THEN** they will be more resilient to the impacts of increasing climate variability, extremes and change on their food security and livelihoods; **BECAUSE** their exposure and vulnerability to hazards will be reduced and their adaptive capacity increased.
6. The project will work to achieve this goal via activities under three interlinked components:
 1. Government, civil society and communities are strengthened to support local resilience to climate change impacts, including by providing access to climate information and early warnings
 2. Scalable, locally appropriate actions are implemented to meet community adaptation needs to create climate-resilient, sustainable development pathways (adaptation package)
 3. Institutional adaptive capacity is enhanced by building adaptive governance systems at the local level and enhancing local-provincial-national linkages
7. The project will directly reach 90,157 people in 19,556 households and 282 communities across all six provinces (33% of the total population or 43% of the rural population) and a further 110,000 people indirectly (a further 40% of total population or 52% of the rural population). By working directly with communities and indirectly via building governance capacity, the project will reach almost all rural communities. Further, the adaptation package approach gives communities options to select the most appropriate and effective adaptation actions and provides ownership of the solutions that minimize vulnerability and build on local knowledge, skills and innovation.

⁴ Behlert et al (2020) *World Risk Report (2020)* Available [here](#)

⁵ Eckstein et al. (2020) *Global Climate Risk Index 2020: Who Suffers Most from Extreme Weather Events? Weather-related loss events in 2018 and 1999 to 2018*. Available [here](#)

B. PROJECT/PROGRAMME INFORMATION

B.1. Climate context (max. 1000 words, approximately 2 pages)

Baseline conditions

8. The Vanuatu Climate Change and Disaster Risk Reduction Policy (2016-2030)⁶ states that the country is “one of the most vulnerable countries in the world to climate change and disaster risks”, while the 2020 World Risk Report ranked Vanuatu as the most at-risk country to disasters⁷.
9. Vanuatu is characterized by mostly mountainous volcanic islands with steep catchments leading to narrow coastal plains vulnerable to flooding, storm inundation and sea-level rise. The country’s tropical climate can vary considerably each year due to the El Niño Southern Oscillation (ENSO) cycle and other drivers, with extreme weather and climate variability within and between years. In the last five years, Vanuatu has experienced at least one cyclone every year and substantial impacts, with two category 5 intensity cyclones causing catastrophic damage (TC Pam 2015 and TC Harold 2020). The estimated economic loss and damages from TC Pam in 2015 were 64% of Gross Domestic Product (GDP) (approximately USD 450 million)⁸. Vanuatu is also exposed to geological hazards – earthquakes, tsunamis and landslides.
10. The country’s population of approximately 272,000 (2016 mini census) is spread over 68 islands and 75% of people live in rural and often remote communities. With 94% of the population living within 5 km of the coast and 60% living within 1 km of the coast⁹, coastal environments and natural resources play a vital role in the subsistence and commercial life of ni-Vanuatu. This long traditional connection and dependence on natural resources stems from the fact that 65 of the 83 islands that make up the Vanuatu archipelago have been inhabited for thousands of years. This has enabled the country’s people to acquire a profound understanding of their land, sea and climate. Generational knowledge, combined with the expertise that results from being primary managers and beneficiaries of natural resources, is a keystone to local livelihoods, cultural identity, and the ability of dispersed rural populations to cope with disasters¹⁰. However, an increasingly unpredictable climate is challenging the limits of local and traditional experience, while threatening significant national and community level impacts into the future. This is further compounded by a likely future in which extremes (like tropical cyclones) are more intense, resulting in more damage to local farming systems. More diversified and climate-resilient food security and livelihood strategies will help offset the impacts of these extremes.
11. The national government in Vanuatu is democratically elected and has oversight of all climate change matters through the Ministry of Climate Change. Sub-national governance in Vanuatu consists of six Provincial Government Councils which is sub-divided into Area Councils. As of 2020, there are 71 Area Councils present throughout Vanuatu however all national statistics are based on the previous 66 Area Councils. Area Councils have a varying number of communities (averaging around 9), and each community should have a Community Disaster and Climate Change Committee (CDCCC) to guide both adaptation and disaster preparedness and response. In practice, many communities do not have a CDCCC in place, or if they do, they are often not fully functional. More broadly, Vanuatu has responded positively to climate change challenges from a governance perspective and has established the National Advisory Board (NAB) on Climate Change and Disaster Risk Reduction (CCDRR) with primary responsibility for coordinating and mainstreaming climate change policies, programs and projects and linking to a whole-of-government approach.
12. While CDCCCs are the primary mechanism for adaptation planning at the local level, they have no independent legal status. They are established by mandate from the MoCC’s National Disaster Management Office (NDMO). Their structure, roles and responsibilities and ways of working outlined in the MoCC publication ‘CBDRR Handbook’, NDMO (2017). Members of CDCCCs are appointed in line with requirements outlined in the Handbook. Membership should conform to the Handbook’s composition and is based on voluntary self-nomination followed by a community vote. Under the Handbook guidelines, each CDCCC must include the following representatives: a community leader; a

⁶ Government of Vanuatu (2015) *Vanuatu Climate Change and Disaster Risk Reduction Policy 2016-2030*. Available [here](#)

⁷ Behlert et al (2020) *World Risk Report (2020)*. Available [here](#)

⁸ Government of Vanuatu (2015) *Post-disaster needs assessment: Tropical Cyclone Pam, March 2015*. Available [here](#)

⁹ Andrew et al. (2019) *Coastal proximity of populations in 22 Pacific Island Countries and Territories*. Available [here](#)

¹⁰ Johnson et al. (2020) *Chapter 10: Impacts of climate change on marine resources in Pacific Island region*. Available [here](#)

youth representative; a representative of people with disabilities; and a local government representative (from a local health clinic or school). There is no requirement for gender balance, but this will be required under VCCRP processes.

Vanuatu's climate and recent trends

13. Vanuatu has a predominantly hot, humid, tropical climate, with year-round rainfall. There are two main seasons: a warm wet season, influenced by the northwest monsoon, between November and April; and a cool drier season, influenced by southeast trade winds, from May to October. Vanuatu's climate varies considerably from year to year due to El Niño–Southern Oscillation (ENSO) and other drivers; with extreme weather and climate variability within and between years, including tropical cyclones, floods and storm surges (often associated with tropical cyclones), and droughts.
14. Meteorological records for Vanuatu are maintained by the Vanuatu Meteorology and Geo-Hazards Department. There are, however, gaps in the historical data record as a result of ongoing challenges with digitizing the paper record, the dearth of monitoring stations to capture current trends, and the general paucity of research into Vanuatu's climate. Despite this, there are clear observed trends in the data, including:
 - The observed warming trend is clear and ongoing, and, relative to an early baseline of 1850-1900, Vanuatu has experienced around +0.3 °C warming compared to the 1986-2005 period;
 - Sea surface temperature (SST) varies seasonally and has been observed to be increasing over recent decades, with a strong link between SST and air temperature trends on the small islands. SST is an important factor that can influence the location of primary productivity zones and availability of food, composition of species, the migration of species, the severity of storms and cyclones, ocean salinity, and the overall health of marine ecosystems. Increase in SST has also been observed around Vanuatu with the rate of change in annual average SST between 0.3 and 0.4 °C per decade¹¹. There is little spatial variation in Vanuatu in the annual trend. This annual trend is consistent with the global average of 0.33 °C per decade;
 - There are no clear trends in seasonal or annual rainfall over Vanuatu since 1907. Over this period, there has been substantial variations in rainfall from year to year but little change in extreme daily rainfall or total rainfall;
 - Tropical cyclones (TC) most commonly affect Vanuatu during the warm wet season, between November and April. Over the 42-year period to 2010, 101 tropical cyclones developed or crossed into the Vanuatu Exclusive Economic Zone, or an average of 24 cyclones per decade. The number of cyclones varies from year to year, with none in some seasons but up to six in others. Over this period, cyclones occurred in El Niño, La Niña and neutral years. In the recent past, Vanuatu has experienced two category 5 cyclones (TC Pam in 2015 and TC Harold in 2020) with estimated economic loss and damage of approximately 64% of GDP for TC Pam and 61% GDP for TC Harold;
 - Wind and waves around Vanuatu do not vary significantly throughout the year, having constant wave heights and periods. Waves are influenced by the southern trade winds and movement of the South Pacific Convergence Zone. They display some variability from year to year with ENSO and the Southern Annual Mode. Waves come mainly from the south-east, consisting of trade wind generated waves and a component of swell propagated from storm events in the Southern Ocean. Wave heights are typically greater in the south at Aneityum than at Port Vila or in the north.
15. A more detailed overview of Vanuatu's climate and observed trends is in **Section 4 of Annex 2**.

Climate change projections

16. The Vanuatu National Adaptation Programme of Action (NAPA)¹² states that the country is exposed to, and highly vulnerable to, nearly all conceivable impacts of climate change. These risks were re-

¹¹ Maynard, J., Heron, S., van Hooijdonk, R., Tracey, D. (2018) *Past and projected future impacts of coral bleaching on the reefs of Vanuatu*. Report to the Secretariat of the Pacific Regional Environment Programme (SPREP), Apia, Samoa (19 pp). Available [here](#).

¹² Government of Vanuatu (2007) *National Adaptation Programme of Action*. Available [here](#).

confirmed in the analysis undertaken to develop Vanuatu's Climate Change and Disaster Risk Reduction Policy¹³.

17. Climate change projections for Vanuatu have been delivered by the Pacific Climate Change Science Program (PCCSP) and the Pacific-Australia Climate Change Science and Adaptation Planning program (PACCSAP)¹⁴. The PCCSP and PACCSAP modelling is based on climate model simulations following a set of emissions scenarios that are consistent with certain socio-economic assumptions of how the future may evolve. There are many different global climate models and they each represent the climate slightly differently. An evaluation of 26 global models found that 24 best represent the climate in the Vanuatu region of the western tropical Pacific. These 24 models have been used to develop climate projections for Vanuatu.
18. In 2019, CSIRO commenced the process of updating the PCCSP and PACCSAP projections (under the NextGen project), utilizing the same underlying data¹⁵. The updated projections confirm the findings of the PCCSP and PACCSAP projections on most indicators and introduce new developments and understanding of three key climate drivers in Vanuatu: extreme rainfall, tropical cyclones and sea level rise. The NextGen findings are fully coincident with the headline findings of IPCC Working Group I for the Sixth Assessment Report (AR6)¹⁶. In particular, trends in temperature, rainfall, ocean chemistry, sea level rise and extreme weather events are coincident between both publications, allowing for regional specificities (such as lower air temperature increase due to the weather systems being driven by the ocean environment).
19. The two lowest emissions scenarios, RCP2.6 and RCP4.5, are below the current global emissions trajectory. According to AR5, in 2011 the total radiative forcing relative to 1750 reached 2.29 Wm⁻² with *high* confidence. In AR6, by 2019 the radiative forcing had risen to 2.72 Wm⁻², of which 0.34 Wm⁻² was due to the increase in GHG concentrations in the atmosphere. Given this trend, RCP2.6 is unlikely to be achieved¹⁷, particularly when considering the pledges made to date on the 2021 update of the NDCs under the Paris Agreement. RCP4.5 is achievable if all current pledges are met and the remaining NDCs to be updated commensurately increase ambition – and that ambition continues to increase over time.
20. As a nation highly vulnerable to climate change impacts, Vanuatu needs to protect its population from the hazards presented by the most plausible future climate using the precautionary principle (represented by RCP6.0), rather than an aspirational one (represented by RCP2.6) or even that which is possible if all current pledges are implemented (represented by RCP4.5).
21. This is particularly the case as there remain significant uncertainties at the level of policy response and implementation globally (exemplified by the number of net-zero pledges made that lack a clear implementation framework or pathway to achievement). Therefore, the impact assessment for this project is based on the medium emissions scenario (RCP6.0) as an intermediary between the low emissions scenario (RCP4.5), which is recommended for the planet to avoid significant ecological tipping points¹⁸, and the very high emissions scenario (RCP8.5). There are two further considerations that make selection of any *specific* RCP a moot point in the context of this project:
 - **The projected changes do not diverge in a significant way between the RCPs until around 2040**, so the shorter-term projections remain valid regardless of the RCP utilized.
 - **The direction of change for all emissions scenarios is the same** (e.g., higher temperatures, more concentrated rainfall), with increasing intensity depending on longer term trajectories. Application of the precautionary principle, as a matter of good governance, would then point to the use of a higher-rated RCP.

¹³ Government of Vanuatu (2015) *Vanuatu Climate Change and Disaster Risk Reduction Policy 2016-2030*. Available [here](#).

¹⁴ CSIRO and BoM (2014) *Climate Variability, Extremes and Change in the Western Tropical Pacific: New Science and Updated Country Reports, Vanuatu Chapter*. Australian Bureau of Meteorology and Commonwealth Scientific and Industrial Research Organisation. Available [here](#).

¹⁵ CSIRO and SPREP (2021) *Current and future climate for Vanuatu: enhanced 'NextGen' projections*: Technical Report. Available [here](#).

¹⁶ IPCC (2021) Summary for Policymakers. In: *Climate Change 2021: The Physical Science Basis. Contribution of Working Group I to the Sixth Assessment Report of the Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change* [Masson-Delmotte, V., P. Zhai, A. Pirani, S. L. Connors, C. Péan, S. Berger, N. Caud, Y. Chen, L. Goldfarb, M. I. Gomis, M. Huang, K. Leitzell, E. Lonnoy, J.B.R. Matthews, T. K. Maycock, T. Waterfield, O. Yelekçi, R. Yu and B. Zhou (eds.)]. Cambridge University Press. In Press.

¹⁷ In the RCP2.6 pathway, radiative forcing peaks at 3.0 Wm⁻² before 2050 to then fall back to 2.6 Wm⁻² by the year 2100.

¹⁸ IPCC (2018) Impacts of 1.5°C Global Warming on Natural and Human Systems. In: *Global Warming of 1.5°C. An IPCC Special Report on the impacts of global warming of 1.5°C above pre-industrial levels and related global greenhouse gas emission pathways, in the context of strengthening the global response to the threat of climate change, sustainable development, and efforts to eradicate poverty*. Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change.

22. Considering the above and the availability of scientific data on climate change forecasts and impacts specific to Vanuatu, the project design is informed principally by the medium emissions scenario (RCP6.0). Where available, impacts based on RCP4.5 are included. The project activities are also designed to be no-regrets adaptation actions – they will help increase resilience in the face of significant impacts, while still making sense in lower emissions scenarios, and even in a world without climate change impacts due to the target communities' existing exposure and vulnerability to climate extremes.
23. Under a medium greenhouse gas emissions scenario (RCP6.0), future climate conditions can be summarized as follows:
- Increases in daily **air temperatures** are projected across all of Vanuatu for minimum, mean and maximum daily temperatures. Compared to 1995, temperature will be higher by 0.9-1.3°C by 2050, and 1.3-2.7°C by 2090 (high confidence);
 - Extreme air temperatures** will reach higher levels and become more frequent. By 2040, the current 1-day maximum occurring once every 20 years will occur every 2 years (high confidence);
 - Increases in **sea surface temperatures** will mean reefs around Vanuatu will experience conditions that exceed thermal thresholds known to cause coral bleaching (above 29.5°C) more often, but impacts will be spatially and temporally variable (high confidence)¹⁹;
 - Extreme sea surface temperatures** (marine heatwaves) will occur more often, increasing from 10% of the time currently to 25% of the time by 2040 (high confidence);
 - Projections of changes in **rainfall amounts** have low confidence, and trends are unclear given the very high climate variability in Vanuatu. There are a range of possible future trajectories, from wetter to drier, largely determined by future changes in the South Pacific Convergence Zone. This will pose challenges to planning and policy development, and therefore planning should consider both a wetter and a drier future;
 - Extreme rainfall** will become more frequent and intense (high confidence). By 2040, the 1 in 100-year event intensity will increase to 10-11%. This change is the same across all islands. Frequencies of current extreme events will increase by 1.2-2.5%;
 - The duration of **dry periods (droughts)** will become longer (low confidence). The 1 in 5-year event will likely lengthen from 19 days to 28 days;
 - Tropical cyclones** are projected to be less frequent (decrease in cyclone formation) but more intense (medium confidence);
 - Sea level** is estimated to be currently increasing by 6 mm/year since 1960. Models simulate an increase of up to 35 cm (15-35 cm) by 2050, with increases of up to 89 cm (30-89 cm) indicated by 2090 (high confidence);
 - In 20 years' time, it is projected that continued **ocean acidification** will result in seawater chemistry that is only marginally suitable for calcification, affecting reef accretion and structure on 80% of coral reefs around the world, including those in Vanuatu²⁰.
24. The current evidence indicates that the greatest climatic challenges facing communities in Vanuatu are due to increasing frequency and/or intensity of extreme events:
- Temperature: air and sea (minimum, mean and maximum daily temperatures and events such as heatwaves);
 - Rainfall patterns (increased duration of dry periods, changing frequency and intensity of extreme rainfall and ENSO-associated rainfall);
 - Tropical cyclones (increased intensity, not frequency, predicted including severe wind and waves, and intense rainfall and flooding).

¹⁹ Maynard et al. (2018). See footnote 11.

²⁰ Lenton, A., McInnes, K.L., O'Grady, J.G. (2015). Marine projections of warming and ocean acidification in the Australasian region. *Australian Meteorological and Oceanographic Journal*, 65(1), pp.1-28.

Temperature

25. Projections for all emissions pathways indicate that the annual average air temperature and SST will increase in the future in Vanuatu, and the magnitude of projected change is similar for the next 20 years under any plausible emissions pathway, but after 2040 there is growing and notable differences between low and high emissions pathways (*Figure 1*, below). By 2050, under a medium emissions scenario (RCP6.0), this increase in temperature is projected to be in the range of 0.6-1.3°C, while under a Paris Agreement compatible scenario (RCP4.5) anticipated warming is 0.6-1.5°C.
26. In Vanuatu, warming has occurred and is projected to continue occurring at a lower rate than the global average (+2°C of global warming results in +1.3 to +1.9°C in Vanuatu) due to the influence of the ocean. Step-like changes in air temperature have occurred in the past and are likely to happen in the future, and therefore planned adaptation actions should consider non-linear and unpredictable warming in the future. The warming trend in Vanuatu is clear (with at least 0.7°C average temperature increase to date) and very high confidence that this trend will continue for the foreseeable future regardless of the emissions scenario.

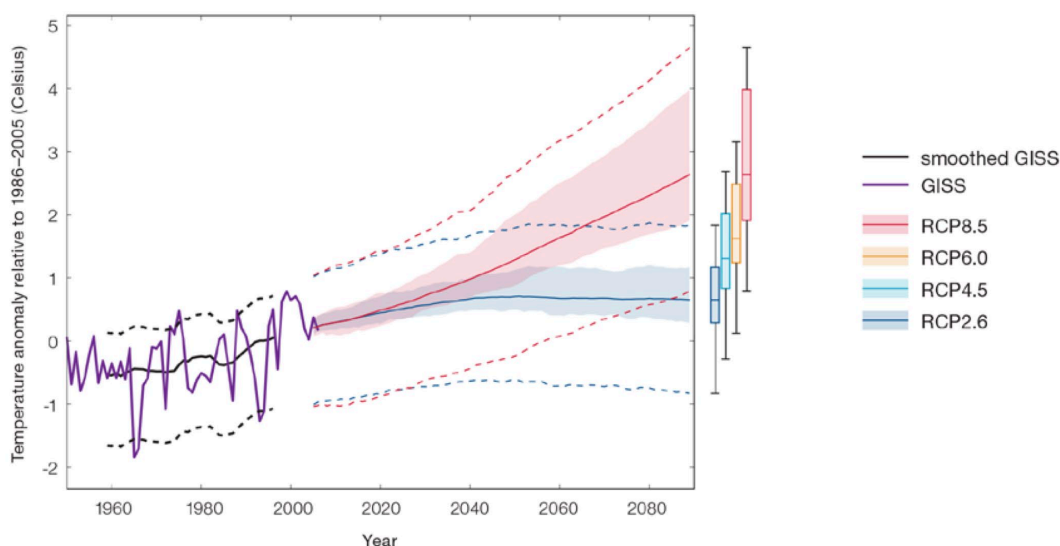


Figure 1. Historical and simulated surface air temperature time series for the region surrounding Vanuatu. The graph shows the anomaly (from the base period 1986-2005) in surface air temperature from observations (the GISS dataset, in purple), and for the CMIP5 models under the very high (RCP8.5, in red) and very low (RCP2.6, in blue) emissions scenarios. The solid red and blue lines show the smoothed (20-year running average) multi-model mean anomaly in surface air temperature, while shading represents the spread of model values (5-95th percentile). The dashed lines show the 5-95th percentile of the observed interannual variability for the observed period (in black) and added to the projections as a visual guide (in red and blue). This indicates that future surface air temperature could be above or below the projected long-term averages due to interannual variability. The ranges of projections for a 20-year period centred on 2090 are shown by the bars on the right for RCP8.5, 6.0, 4.5 and 2.6 (CSIRO and BoM 2014, see footnote 14).

Rainfall

27. There is uncertainty around rainfall projections for Vanuatu as model outputs are not consistent. Some models suggest a slight increase in wet season rainfall and a decrease in dry season rainfall, however the overall projection is for little change. Wet and dry years will still occur in response to natural variability and regional drivers, e.g. ENSO. Projections show extreme rainfall days are likely to occur more often. Drought frequency is expected to decrease slightly by the end of the century.
28. Preliminary results from the NextGen projections show that rainfall change is more uncertain than temperature change, and trends are less obvious given the very high climate variability. The average result from climate models is for a small change in the average rainfall annually. But there are a range of possible future trajectories, from wetter through to drier, largely determined by future change in the South Pacific Convergence Zone. Therefore, planned adaptation actions should consider the impacts of both increased incidence of extreme rainfall events and changes expected in seasonal rainfall (with implications for rain-fed agriculture).

29. While the total annual quantum of rainfall may not change dramatically – or at least it isn't currently possible to reliably project the direction of any change, people in Vanuatu will continue to live with significant rainfall variability and escalating extremes. Of particular concern is the likelihood that climate change will increase the variability of the country's rainfall. This is especially true for the remote and rural populations the VCCRP will target, given their reliance on subsistence rain-fed agriculture, which is particularly susceptible to climate change induced changes in rainfall patterns, extreme rainfall leading to flooding, droughts, heatwaves, salinization, increases in evapotranspiration, seasonal variations, and reduction in freshwater availability. Under an RCP4.5 scenario, soil moisture is expected to decrease significantly, and potential evapotranspiration is increased, indicating significant stress on non-irrigated crops (see *Figure 2*, below). These climate impacts are exacerbated by soil erosion and loss of soil fertility due to deforestation and environmental degradation. In order to ensure vulnerable remote and rural communities have increased resilience to climate change, it is important to develop and deliver adaptation actions in the agriculture sector that will help increase food security across a range of climate futures – from wetter to drier. The VCCRP activities will seek to do this.

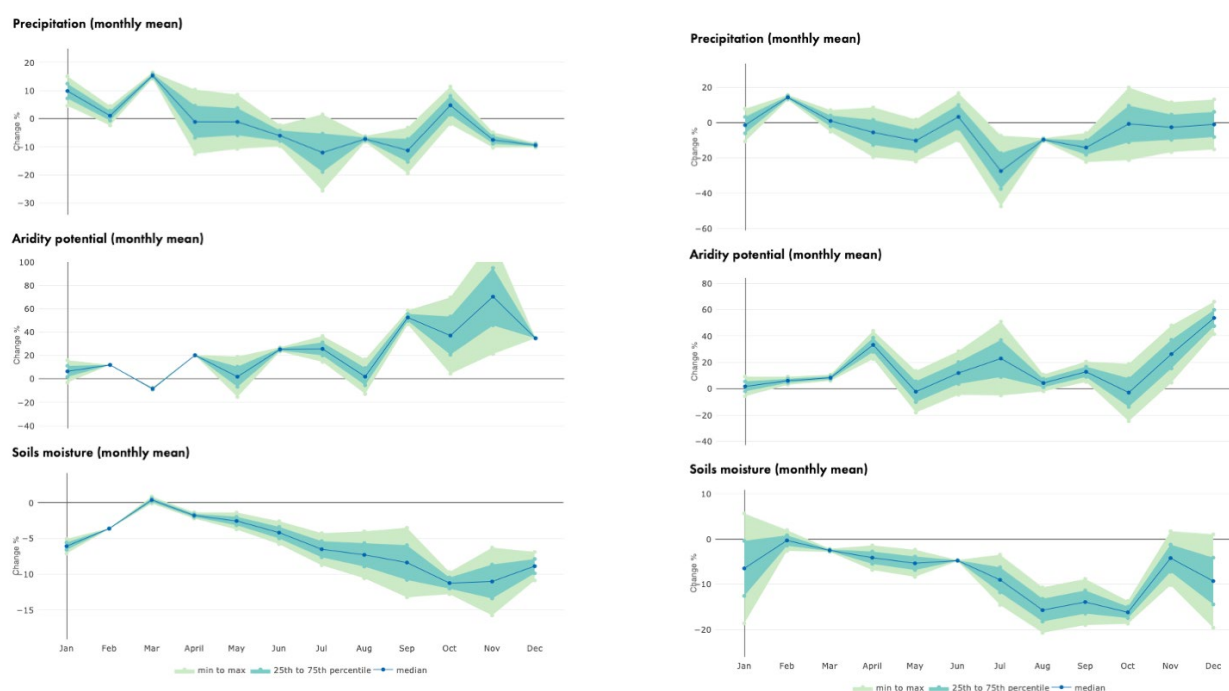


Figure 2. Espiritu Santo (left – west coast; 14.96 S - 166.65 E) and Tanna (right – 19.47 S - 169.34 E), monthly average precipitation, aridity potential and soil moisture, for the time period 2041-2070 relative to the period 1981-2010. Model CORDEX Australia - WWHYPE Ensemble Mean, RCP4.5 (SMHI, Climate Information, <https://climateinformation.org/>, accessed on 2021-07-20)

Tropical cyclones

30. On a global scale, climate projections indicate there is likely to be a decrease in the number of tropical cyclones by the end of the 21st century. However, for cyclones that do occur, there is likely to be an increase in the average maximum wind speed by about 5%, an increase in rainfall intensity of about 14% within 100 km of the cyclone centre, and a likely (around 13%) increase in the proportion of cyclones that reach very intense levels (category 4-5)²¹. This is coincident with the projected change in TC activity reported in AR5: “Negligible change in overall frequency. Significant (~15%) increase in number of Category 4–5 TCs”²². AR6 reports for “Projected changes at +2°C global warming”, compared to pre-industrial conditions, that there is “high confidence in a projected increase of TC rain rates at the global scale; the median projected rate of increase due to human emissions is about 14%”, and that there is “high confidence for an increase in the proportion of TCs that reach the strongest (Category 4-5) levels. The median projected increase in this proportion is about 13%”²³.

²¹ See Knutson et al (2020). Tropical cyclones and climate change assessment: Part II. Projected response to anthropogenic warming. *Bulletin of the American Meteorological Society*, 101 (3). Available [here](https://doi.org/10.1175/BAMS-2019-0192).

²² IPCC 2013, section 11.3.2.5.3

²³ IPCC 2021, section 11.1.7

31. With regard to the implications of future projected climate change on tropical cyclones, the NextGen projections conclude that the “evidence suggests that for the southwestern Pacific as a whole, the total number of tropical cyclones may decrease over the century, but with an increase in the average intensity and an increase in the impacts of tropical cyclones through more intense rainfall and greater coastal inundation due to sea level rise.”²⁴
32. Annually, Vanuatu is affected by an average of 2.6 cyclones (ranging from 0-6 per year in recent decades). 29 of 71 tropical cyclones (41%) that have affected Vanuatu since 1981 have been severe (Category 3 or above)²⁵. Even with a reduction in the total number, an increase in the average severity could prove catastrophic to the lives and livelihoods of people, particularly in remote and rural coastal location.

Additional burden from climate change: food systems and livelihoods

33. Due to about 80% of the population being dependent on subsistence agriculture, climate change poses a significant risk to Vanuatu’s agriculture sector and food security. Agricultural activities in Vanuatu are particularly susceptible to climate change induced changes in rainfall patterns, extreme rainfall leading to flooding, droughts, heatwaves, salinization processes, increases in evapotranspiration, seasonal variations, and reduction in freshwater availability. Under an RCP4.5 scenario, soil moisture is expected to decrease significantly, and potential evapotranspiration is increased, indicating significant stress on non-irrigated crops (see *Figure 2*, above, and *Figures 3a* and *3b*, below)²⁶. These climate impacts are exacerbated by soil erosion and loss of soil fertility due to deforestation and environmental degradation.
34. Prolonged and intense rainfall, for example, damages seedlings and encourages conditions that promote diseases and pests. Droughts create additional thermal stress on plants. Projected air temperature increases are likely to reach the maximum heat tolerance thresholds of some staple crops and induce heat stress and crop failure, especially in traditional crops such as cassava, taro and yam. Communities on Torres islands, South Santo, South Malekula, Central Pentecost, Epi, Erromango, Aniwa and Aneityum, in particular, have reported impacts from increased temperatures and droughts on declining crop yields and lowered livestock productivity during the 2015-2016 El Niño period.
35. Coastal fisheries also contribute significantly to food security, with the latest mini-census (2016) reporting that 60% of rural households engage in coastal fisheries activities. Climate change is expected to impact coral reef fish and invertebrate species in Vanuatu by altering their metabolic rates, growth, reproduction and survival²⁷, resulting in changes to species abundance, distribution and sizes²⁸. These changes will also have consequences for livelihoods, as they threaten the viability of fisheries in Vanuatu by 2050²⁹ and they may cause food insecurity.
36. In the short-medium term, coastal fisheries in Vanuatu are also at critical risk from non-climatic pressures such as overfishing, and habitat degradation due to increasing populations, land use change and pollution.³⁰ Climate change impacts further exacerbate these environmental and development issues.

²⁴ CSIRO and SPREP (2021). See footnote 15

²⁵ CSIRO and Bom (2014). See footnote 14

²⁶ SMHI, Climate Information, <https://climateinformation.org/>, last accessed: 2021-06-23

²⁷ Johnson et al. (2020). Chapter 10: Impacts of climate change on marine resources in the Pacific Island region. In: *Climate Change Impacts in the Pacific*, Lalit Kumar (Editor), Springer; Johnson et al. (2017) Chapter 11 – The Pacific Islands: Fisheries and Aquaculture and Climate Change. In: Philips B, Ramirez M (Editors) *Climate Change Impacts on Fisheries & Aquaculture: a global analysis*. Wiley Publications, New York, USA.

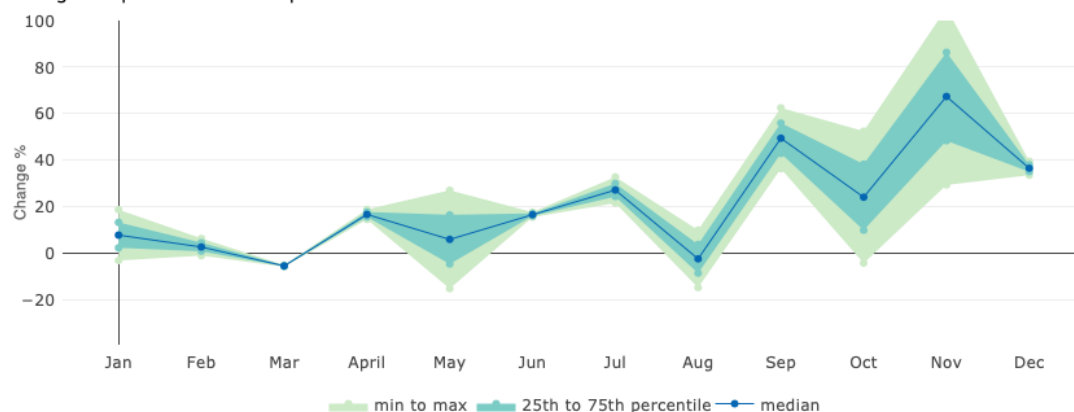
²⁸ Asch, R.G. et al. (2017) Future marine ecosystem drivers, biodiversity, and fisheries maximum catch potential in Pacific Island countries and territories under climate change. *Marine Policy*, 88: 285–294; Munday, P.L. et al. (2008) Climate change and the future for coral reef fishes. *Fish and Fisheries*, 9(3), 261-285.

²⁹ Bell et al. (2018) Adaptations to maintain the contributions of small-scale fisheries to food security in the Pacific Islands. *Marine Policy*, 88, 303-314. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.marpol.2017.05.019>.

³⁰ Gillett, R. and Cartwright, I. (2010) *The Future of Pacific Island Fisheries*. Secretariat of the Pacific Community (SPC), Noumea and the Forum Fisheries Agency, Honiara, 110 pp.

Aridity potential (monthly mean)

Change compared to historical period.

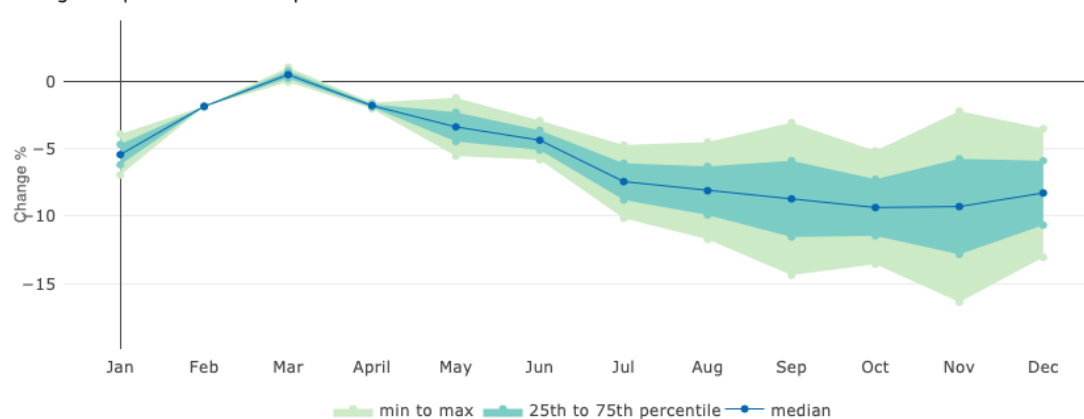


Indicator: Aridity potential (annual mean), Time period: 2041–2070, Historical period: 1981–2010, RCP 4.5, Model: CORDEX Australia - WWHYPE Ensemble Mean, Model results for an area covering the location: -15.37, 167.10

Reference: <https://climateinformation.org> (date: 2021-06-23)

Soils moisture (monthly mean)

Change compared to historical period.



Indicator: Soils moisture (annual mean), Time period: 2041–2070, Historical period: 1981–2010, RCP 4.5, Model: CORDEX Australia - WWHYPE Ensemble Mean, Model results for an area covering the location: -15.37, 167.10

Reference: <https://climateinformation.org> (date: 2021-06-23)

Figure 3a and b. Aridity potential (monthly mean) and soil moisture (monthly mean) showing change compared to historical period

Additional burden from climate change: disaster risk reduction

37. Climate change adaptation (CCA) and disaster risk reduction (DRR) efforts share the aim of building the resilience of people, economies and natural resources to the impacts of climate change. Access to Climate Information Services (CIS) for local planning remains very limited. Early Warning Systems (EWS) for disaster risk are more widespread, but still sporadic. Key opportunities to enhance DRR at the community level in Vanuatu include supporting the integration of climate-related disaster risks and potential future climate change impacts into local planning and budgeting decisions, strengthening local level CIS and EWS to inform local decision making, developing educational and awareness materials in local language and supporting socially-inclusive community groups focused on local DRR and CCA.

Research has shown³¹ that reduced food security is a key factor in driving increased rural and agrarian poverty. This in turn can trigger an increased dependence on global supply chains and aid, initially in rural areas where primary production occurs but also flowing through to urban markets. Lack of food security from climate impacts on the key subsistence agricultural and fishery sectors in rural Vanuatu, in the short-term, will reduce the resilience of the population following climate-related disasters and increase the ongoing risk from climate change. Longer-term, unaddressed, it may also trigger broader societal changes, such as forced migration, crime and disease.

Related projects/interventions

38. There are several complementary projects in Vanuatu that are currently being implemented or in the design phase and due to commence in 2021/22. A full list of projects and their status is provided in **Annex 2**, and most relevant among those are:

- Climate Information Service for Resilient Development in Vanuatu project, known as 'Vanuatu Klaemet Infomesen blong Redy, Adapt mo Protekt' (Van-KIRAP) – SPREP/GCF (FP035)
- Vanuatu Coastal Adaptation Project (VCAP) – Phase 2 – UNDP/GEF
- Melanesia Coastal and Marine Ecosystem Resilience to Climate Change Programme – IUCN/GCF (in development)
- Expanding Conservation Areas Reach and Effectiveness (ECARE) in Vanuatu – IUCN/GEF
- Pacific Ecosystem-based Adaptation to Climate Change (PEBACC) – Phase 2 – SPREP
- Restoration of Ecosystem Services and Adaptation to Climate Change (RESCCUE) – SPC (completed)
- Building Resilient Communities in Vanuatu Program – Vanuatu Red Cross
- Institutional Strengthening for Pacific Island Countries to Adapt to Climate Change (ISAAC) Project – SPC/SPREP
- Pacific nature-based solutions in the Pacific (Vanuatu) – New Zealand MFAT
- Strengthening and scaling community-based approaches to Pacific coastal fisheries management in support of the New Song, known as the Vanuatu Pathways Project – Phase 2 – SPC/ACIAR/DFAT

39. The VCCRP will complement these existing and emerging projects by building on the networks and capacity developed, implementing consistent approaches where relevant and extending the activities relevant to climate change adaptation of food systems and livelihoods to reach a greater number of vulnerable rural communities, including children, youth and women, in Vanuatu.

40. Particularly close cooperation will be achieved with the GCF-supported Van-KIRAP (FP035) (particularly under **Output 1.3**) and the GEF-supported VCAP 2 (which will provide parallel finance via implementing aligned activities in other vulnerable Area Councils). The VCCRP will work closely with the Van-KIRAP team based at the Vanuatu Meteorology and Geo-Hazards Department (VMGD) as well as those in-country and abroad with the Secretariat of the Pacific Environment Programme (SPREP) project team. Consultations with SPREP and the Government of Vanuatu have been undertaken to ensure the two projects are closely linked and mutually reinforcing. There are several key points of synergy between VCCRP and Van-KIRAP that will help enhance the impact of both projects. This is particularly related to VCCRP activities involving EWS (**Output 1.2**) and CIS (**Output 2.2**), which will compliment those of Van-KIRAP by supporting and scaling-up community-level activities where appropriate, such as those in Van-KIRAP Outcome 2 (sector-specific CIS development case studies) and **Outcome 3** (customized communication, capacity development and outreach resource materials). See *Table 2* in **Annex 2** for more detail on specific points of alignment between the projects. Once Van-KIRAP concludes, VCCRP will continue to work with VMGD to scale out updated CIS products to remote and rural communities.

41. The Pacific Community (SPC) and the Vanuatu Department of Energy are in the process of developing a proposal to scale up the National Green Energy Fund (NGEF), building from a GCF Readiness

³¹ ADB (2017) *Food Security in Asia: Why Institutions Matter*. Edited by Zhang-Yue Zhou and Guanghua Wan. Asian Development Bank Institute

project. The VCCRP will work with the newly established NGEF Unit that was created through this Readiness proposal, in addition to the Department of Energy and DoCC, with regard to deploying appropriate renewable energy technologies under **Output 1.2** (Climate-resilient agriculture for food security and livelihood development) and **Output 1.4** (Climate-resilient food value chains established to support food security and livelihoods). A key point of coordination and collaboration between the projects will be VCCRP helping to develop a pipeline of demand for NGEF products through the provision of solar appliances to producer groups at community level and support to develop into MSMEs where possible. NGEF will be able to build from this base to provide further equipment as producer groups scale up to more formal enterprises.

B.2 (a). Theory of change narrative and diagram (max. 1500 words, approximately 3 pages plus diagram)

42. The VCCRP follows the Vanuatu Community Resilience Framework³². The Framework provides an overarching structure that focuses on meeting eight pre-conditions for climate-resilience and supports the closing of existing adaptation deficits³³:
1. All community members have their basic needs met,
 2. Access to a diverse, climate-resilient, set of livelihoods strategies,
 3. Ability to engage in fair, inclusive and forward-looking decision-making processes,
 4. Access to, and ability to utilize, traditional and scientific climate information,
 5. Ability to innovate and take risks, particularly with regard to livelihoods,
 6. Increased understanding of the changing context of shocks and stresses, and ability to take action to reduce risks,
 7. Strong in-community and external networks to share and draw on knowledge, resources and ideas, and
 8. Connected government at all levels that listens and is responsive to community needs, is innovative, and has strong leadership that is transparent and accountable.
43. The Vanuatu Community Resilience Framework is a modified version of the Vanuatu Resilience Framework, developed under a previous community-based adaptation project³⁴. This in turn was a modified version of the Local Adaptive Capacity Framework developed by government, NGOs and academic partners under the Africa Climate Change Resilience Alliance program³⁵. The components of the framework are the base pre-conditions for climate-resilient communities in Vanuatu. The pre-conditions are all inextricably interlinked and mutually reinforcing. The VCCRP will work to help ensure these pre-conditions are met as part of its approach to building community resilience via the adaptation packages approach (**Component 2**), along with increasing access to information, building understanding and supporting local level adaptation planning (**Component 1**), and ensuring a strong local-provincial-national connection and two-way flow of climate-relevant information and knowledge (**Component 3**).
44. The project's goal statement is that **IF** vulnerable remote and rural communities in Vanuatu access and utilize locally-relevant climate information, integrate climate risks into community planning processes, and are supported to implement priority adaptation actions; **THEN** they will be more resilient to the impacts of increasing climate variability, extremes and change on their food security and livelihoods; **BECAUSE** their exposure and vulnerability to hazards will be reduced and their adaptive capacity increased.
45. The core climate problem the project seeks to address is that remote and rural communities in Vanuatu suffer an existing (and increasing) 'adaptation deficit' (high levels of exposure to frequent hazards and insecure access to key services undermines resilience). To address these deficits, the project will work to build local level adaptive capacity related to food security and livelihoods, based on a foundation of increased knowledge and understanding of climate change impacts, improved community-level

³² Pritchard, M. (2018) *Yumi Stap Redi Long Klaemet Jenis: Ex-Post Evaluation Report of the Vanuatu NGO Climate Change Adaptation Program*. Oxfam Australia. Available [here](#).

³³ Burton (2004) Climate change and the adaptation deficit. In *Environmental Monitoring and Assessment*, paper 3, pp.25-33; and Frankhauser (2014) Understanding the adaptation deficit. In *Global Environmental Change* vol.27, pp.9-18.

³⁴ Pritchard, M. (2018) *Yumi Stap Redi Long Klaemet Jenis: Ex-Post Evaluation Report of the Vanuatu NGO Climate Change Adaptation Program*. Oxfam Australia. Available [here](#).

³⁵ ACCRA (2011) *Consultation document: The ACCRA Local Adaptive Capacity Framework*. Available [here](#). See also, Jones et al (2010) *Towards a characterisation of adaptive capacity: a framework for analysing adaptive capacity at the local level*, Overseas Development Institute. Available [here](#).

adaptation planning, and enhanced national and sub-national government capacity to support priority adaptation actions.

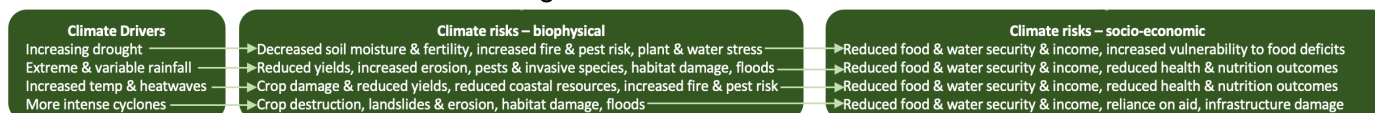
46. The project utilizes the IPCC's definition of adaptive capacity, as articulated in the Third Assessment Report: "Adaptive capacity is the potential or ability of a system, region, or community to adapt to the effects or impacts of climate change. Enhancement of adaptive capacity represents a practical means of coping with changes and uncertainties in climate, including variability and extremes. In this way, enhancement of adaptive capacity reduces vulnerabilities and promotes sustainable development."³⁶ The project's understanding of adaptive capacity, and its measurement, is further elaborated in **Annex 23**.
47. The core of the project is focused on the adaptation packages under **Component 2**. The package is a suite of adaptation activities that address the main drivers of community vulnerability. These activities were identified through a national vulnerability assessment and stakeholder engagement process, and are aligned with the resilience framework (see **Section B.3** and **Annex 23**). They form the basis of action for communities. The development of an adaptation package (or menu) gives communities options to select the most appropriate and effective adaptation actions and provides certainty that GCF investments are addressing the main drivers of climate vulnerability specific to the needs in each individual community.
48. Participatory stakeholder involvement during implementation will allow for a tailored set of adaptation actions to be selected from the adaptation package, enhancing local ownership and promoting long-term sustainability of the adaptation actions in each community. The focus on empowering communities to participate in, and lead, all stages of adaptation action, from selection to implementation, along with capacity building for government, will build strong ownership and buy-in to the project by all beneficiaries and help increase sustainability.
49. The adaptation actions are designed to be implemented over the life of the six-year project and have flexibility to accommodate the specific climate change challenges and existing capacities within each community. Components of climate resilient agriculture and fisheries for food security outputs can be scaled up as needed to suit the local context.
50. Adaptation activities have been developed considering structural disadvantages experienced by women, children and people living with a disability. This will ensure that sustainable climate resilient development pathways also promote social justice and equality in decision-making. The project will work through established local governance structures and will partner with local-level civil society organizations where available to maximize the appropriateness, ownership and sustainability of adaptation actions.
51. This approach will ensure Vanuatu can shift from a fragmented (non-standard) approach in some locations, to a coordinated spatially inclusive and decentralized approach at all levels (government and community), with a focus on the most climate vulnerable communities. To assist this approach, the project will target Area Councils and apply an uptake scorecard to measure the level of effectiveness of adopted coordination mechanisms.
52. Vanuatu faces many barriers that prevent the country from adequately addressing climate impacts without additional intervention. Vulnerability studies conducted for small island states, such as Vanuatu³⁷ show that the costs of overall infrastructure and adaptation activities is a significant proportion of GDP, and well beyond the financial means of a developing economy (especially a SIDS and recently graduated LDC economy). In addition, baseline adaptive capacity is limited and is being further eroded by external factors such as fluctuating labour markets and population growth.
53. Key barriers to effective and sustainable locally-led adaptation in Vanuatu identified during the project's design process include:
 - Institutional capacity gaps at local, sub-national and national levels which hamper effective adaptation planning processes and implementation of adaptation actions;

³⁶ Smit et al (2001) Adaptation to climate change in the context of sustainable development and equity. In McCarthy et al (2001) *Climate Change 2001: Impacts, Adaptation, and Vulnerability. Contribution of Working Group II to the IPCC's Third Assessment Report*, p.881. Available [here](#).

³⁷ Nurse et al (2014) Small islands, in Barros et al (Eds.) *Climate Change 2014: Impacts, Adaptation, and Vulnerability. Part B: Regional Aspects. Contribution of Working Group II to the Fifth Assessment Report of the Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change*, 1613-1654.

- Existing adaptation deficits (high exposure to frequent hazards and insecure access to services) impedes communities' ability to engage in activities and reduces project impact; and
- Low incentives for private sector entities to engage with remote rural communities to support increased market access and help diversify livelihoods.

54. These socio-cultural-institutional barriers interact with the key climate change risks identified for targeted communities, which include direct biophysical impacts associated with climate drivers *and* flow-on socio-economic risks, including:



55. Combined, these risks and barriers are undermining the viability of traditional livelihoods and food security in highly climate vulnerable communities. This is particularly the case for the ecosystems and ecosystem services these communities are highly reliant on, and why building the resilience of natural systems (GCF Outcome ARA4) is a critical component of the project. For the targeted communities, their livelihoods resilience (GCF Outcome ARA1) and food security (GCF Outcome ARA2) is inextricably interlinked with resilient and functioning ecosystems.
56. Ni-Vanuatu have historically adapted to variability in climate and ocean conditions and hold strong traditional knowledge. While traditional knowledge will be valuable in dealing with the longer-term changes projected in climate, it is not sufficient alone and will need to be supplemented by contemporary science and knowledge. While there is credible scientific information available about climate change in Vanuatu, applying the information to decision-making for sectors is not straightforward. There are barriers to application both in terms of the provision of information, such as technological limitations and isolation, and also in terms of education to enable this information to be appropriately incorporated into management. As a result, climate information services are potentially misinterpreted by the public during decision making, if they are used at all.
57. Villages currently experience food-security for 5-12 months of the year. The Government of Vanuatu's 2019-2020 NSDP Baseline Survey on food security found 30% of the rural population (65,330 people) are moderately or severely food insecure.³⁸ Community members attribute current food insecurity to repeated use of agricultural plots (shortened fallow times), droughts and pests. Communities report that 4-12 months are typically required to recover subsistence-agriculture after a tropical cyclone. The risks of food insecurity are further exacerbated by the increased demand for food resulting from the same rapid increase in population and increased reliance on imported and purchased (rather than locally produced) foodstuffs, which further poses a challenge for the traditionally subsistence-based (versus cash) economies of rural Vanuatu. Project activities will help reduce communities' experience of hungry months and reduce the time required to regain food security post-disaster by increasing access to food preservation and processing for storage (reducing food losses) and markets. Household incomes in rural and remote areas are also highly reliant on food production, with income mainly sourced from the sale of primary produce.³⁹
58. The project will help to shift communities from a purely traditional knowledge-based approach to resource management to one which incorporates climate science into traditional community-based decision-making. The project offers adaptation solutions building on local knowledge, skills and innovation in the use of local resources, with a particular focus on the key sectors that underpin food security and livelihoods in Vanuatu – fisheries and agriculture. Vulnerable communities and ecosystems will be more resilient to the impacts of climate change if science-based information can be coupled with traditional knowledge and relationships. Importantly, the project will focus on a bottom-up approach that empowers communities to drive the solutions and build on their existing capacity to ensure long-term sustainability in the project's approach to protecting the marine and agro-ecosystems. Project activities will promote behaviour changes among beneficiaries to help build resilient approaches to food security and livelihoods. Ongoing support from government and an increased local ability to

³⁸ Vanuatu National Statistics Office (2021) *Food Security in Vanuatu: 2019-2020 NSDP Baseline Survey*. Available [here](#).

³⁹ Vanuatu National Statistics Office (2021) *Household Income and Expenditure: 2019-2020 NSDP Baseline Survey*. Available [here](#).

access and effectively utilize future flows of climate finance will help ensure these changes are sustainable, as will supporting producers to access alternative livelihoods and income streams derived from more resilient agriculture and fisheries processes.

59. Immediate benefits will be achieved through community-level actions that address priority adaptation needs (including via increasing food security and diversifying livelihoods options), with a focus on addressing structural constraints to sustainable adaptation (specifically gender, age, disability, social inclusion and geography), increasing access to relevant and useable climate information and building adaptive governance systems. The actions will seek to reduce community vulnerability to current climate impacts. Medium-term benefits will be achieved through the participation and empowerment of communities and government by increasing knowledge and awareness of climate change and its effects, improving access to, and ability to use, climate information and manage knowledge, and strengthening local governance systems and processes to increase individual and community resilience to anticipated near-term climate change impacts. Long-term benefits will be achieved by working at local, sub-national and national levels to increase adaptive capacity and the ability to make forward-looking decisions in the face of a range of climate futures. For communities to have sufficient adaptive capacity, local planning processes need to be climate-resilient, adaptation actions need to be costed and included in budgets, local-national linkages need to be strengthened and gender and social relations need to be transformed. The project's theory of change is summarized in *Figure 4*, below. Impact and response chains for each climate driver and project output are provided in *Figure 8.1*, at the end of **Section B.3**, below.
60. As noted above, the VCCRP will build on a range of previous adaptation projects implemented in Vanuatu, scaling up proven approaches to building climate resilient food security in remote and rural community and implementing innovative (for the context) approaches to food preservation and processing to minimize food losses and expand livelihoods options. The VCCRP will particularly build on the achievements of GCF FP035 – scaling out sector-relevant climate information services developed under FP035 to an additional 282 communities, creating a paradigm shift in climate-informed decision-making at the local level.
61. The project will also result in increases across a range of economic, social, environmental and gender co-benefits, including:
 - Increasing the household incomes of rural communities through livelihoods diversification and increasing access to markets (co-benefit 1);
 - Increasing broad community health outcomes by ensuring communities have more secure access to locally-available nutritious foods (co-benefit 2);
 - Increasing access to education by ensuring fewer school days lost in the aftermath of extreme weather events through adaptation planning and enhanced DRR action (co-benefit 3);
 - Increasing the sustainability of ecosystem services by reducing reliance on vulnerable resources (e.g. reef fish) as a primary food source in rural coastal communities (co-benefit 4);
 - Increasing gender equality across all areas of community life – with a specific focus on ensuring women's voices are heard in climate-related decision-making forums and that the gendered nature of climate change impacts is a key component of all climate and development planning at community and province levels (co-benefit 5); and
 - Increasing social inclusion across all areas of community life – with a specific focus on ensuring voices of traditionally underrepresented groups (e.g. youth, people with a disability) are heard in climate-related decision-making forums (co-benefit 6).
62. For the project's theory of change to be realized, a number of assumptions need to hold. These include:
 - Multiple project areas will not be affected simultaneously by significant climate-related disasters (category 5 cyclone, wave action, flood, drought, heatwave, etc.) during implementation and prior to key project activities being implemented;

- Relevant government departments will facilitate project access to national CIS and EWS systems (including FP035);
- Provincial and local government staff will engage in strengthened climate responsive planning, budgeting and shock responsive social protection systems and formalize support for local level adaptation action;
- Targeted communities demonstrate uptake of improved practices and see immediate and longer-term benefits from project participation;
- Locally-driven action will support management, rehabilitation and restoration of land use and fisheries measures considering climate risk to reduce exposure of farms and fisheries and increase the resilience of coastal and upland areas.

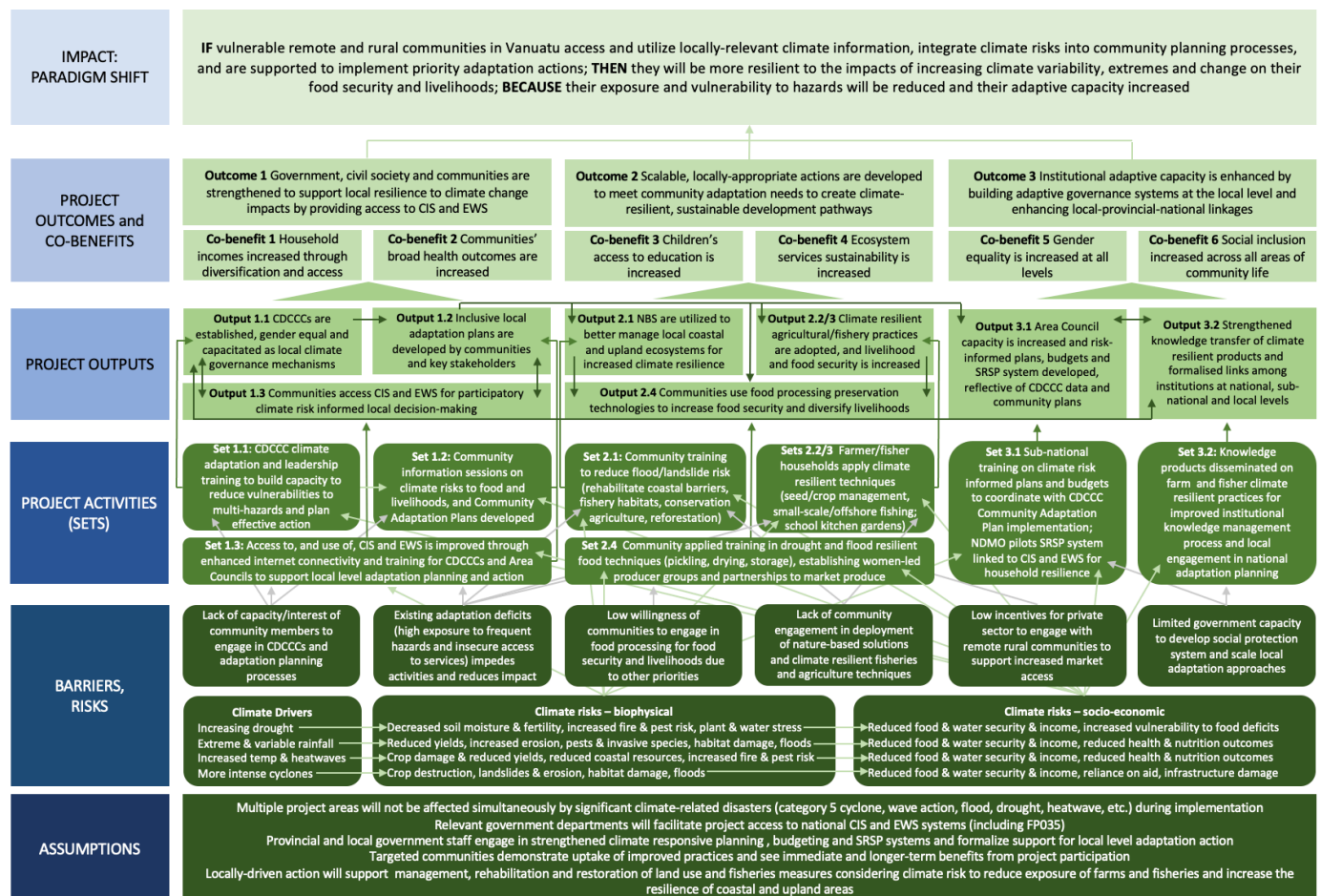


Figure 4. Vanuatu community-based climate resilience project theory of change

B.2 (b). Outcome mapping to GCF results areas and co-benefit categorization

Fill in the GCF results area table below to map each project/programme outcome identified in section B.2(a) to the contributing GCF results area(s) by referring to the description of eight results areas provided in the guidance note.

Outcome number	GCF Mitigation Results Area (MRA 1-4)				GCF Adaptation Results Area (ARA 1-4)			
	MRA 1 Energy generation and access	MRA 2 Low-emission transport	MRA 3 Building, cities, industries, appliances	MRA 4 Forestry and land use	ARA 1 Most vulnerable people and communities	ARA 2 Health, well-being, food and water security	ARA 3 Infrastructure and built environment	ARA 4 Ecosystems and ecosystem services
Outcome 1	☐	☐	☐	☐	☒	☐	☐	☐
Outcome 2	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☒	☐	☒
Outcome 3	☐	☐	☐	☐	☒	☐	☐	☐

If any co-benefits have been identified in section B.2(a), fill in the Co-benefit table below to map each co-benefit to the corresponding category as defined in the FP guidance note.

Co-benefit number	Co-benefit					
	Environmental	Social	Economic	Gender	Adaptation	Mitigation
Co-benefit 1	☐	☐	☒	☐	☐	☐
Co-benefit 2	☐	☒	☐	☐	☐	☐
Co-benefit 3	☐	☒	☐	☐	☐	☐
Co-benefit 4	☒	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Co-benefit 5	☐	☐	☐	☒	☐	☐
Co-benefit 6	☐	☒	☐	☐	☐	☐

B.3. Project/programme description (max. 2500 words, approximately 5 pages)

63. The project is designed to minimize climate change vulnerability and maximize resilience among targeted rural and remote communities in Vanuatu. The activities are based on a solid understanding of community vulnerability to climate change and existing adaptive capacity derived from existing knowledge and research, and the results of a systematic approach to assessing and ranking the relative climate vulnerability of all Area Councils nation-wide. The national vulnerability assessment was conducted as part of the feasibility study which drew on available socio-ecological data for exposure to hazards, food and livelihood systems and knowledge on which community-level factors increase sensitivity and/or undermine adaptive capacity. Stakeholder consultation and field missions validated the results. The assessment used indicators for hazard, exposure, vulnerability and adaptive capacity (method details available in **Annex 2**) consistent with the National Vulnerability Assessment Framework⁴⁰.
64. The results provide a relative ranking of all Area Councils in Vanuatu from highest to lowest vulnerability to climate change, noting that all communities in Vanuatu are vulnerable to climate change. The results were used to identify suitable adaptation options and strategically target beneficiaries (i.e. those that are most vulnerable and marginalized). The results identified the main drivers (or sources) of vulnerability, which were used to identify a suite of adaptation actions that specifically address the main sources of vulnerability and provide a 'menu' or package of adaptations for implementation (outlined under **Component 2**, below). Suitable adaptation actions will be selected

⁴⁰ Government of Vanuatu (2020) *The Vanuatu vulnerability assessment framework: A guide to sustainable and transparent climate resilience investment decisions*. Available [here](#).

from this 'menu' (adaptation package) and implemented by beneficiary communities with support from government ministries and other procured parties to minimize vulnerability and build resilience to climate change. The national vulnerability assessment results are spatially variable and show both high and low vulnerable Area Councils exist on the same island and in each Province (see *Figure 5* – a larger version of this map is at *Annex 16*), demonstrating the influence of local conditions (biophysical and socio-economic) and the need to tailor adaptation actions to the local context.

65. The relationship of the components to each other and the overall approach for implementing them is summarized in *Figure 6* below. Further detail on the vulnerability assessment process and resulting community targeting is provided in **Annex 2 (Section 5.3)** and **Annex 23**.
66. The vulnerability assessment process drew on available data for climate and non-climate hazards, and knowledge on which community-level factors increase sensitivities or undermine adaptive capacity. Stakeholder consultations provided important data for this process. Using this knowledge, the assessment used indicators for:
 - hazard (climate and non-climate hazards);
 - exposure (shoreline geomorphology, topography/elevation);
 - sensitivity (population density and growth, dependence on fishing for food, dependence of crops for food, dependence on natural resources for income, condition of habitats, remoteness / accessibility); and
 - adaptive capacity (access to services, education levels, health index).
67. Notably, indicators of climate change vulnerability are not all related to climate but are socio-ecological factors that influence the sensitivity of communities to climate change and their ability to adapt to future risks and change. Scoring criteria (low, medium or high) were developed for each indicator and data were reviewed by specialists who assigned scores for each indicator.
68. The findings of the vulnerability assessment were then tested in a sample of communities across three provinces to ensure they reflected the reality of the challenges facing remote and rural communities in Vanuatu.
69. The raw vulnerability rankings for each Area Council were then put through a prioritization process, accounting for recent, current and planned adaptation projects, government priorities, and cost of accessing / delivering activities in each Area Council.
70. This process resulted in a list of 29 Area Councils across all six provinces in which the project will work, reaching 282 communities and directly benefitting 90,157 people. All members of targeted communities are considered direct beneficiaries because the scale of activities will increase the climate resilience of all women, men, girls and boys in each targeted community (see *Table 1*, below). The full analysis and all data are available in **Annex 23**.

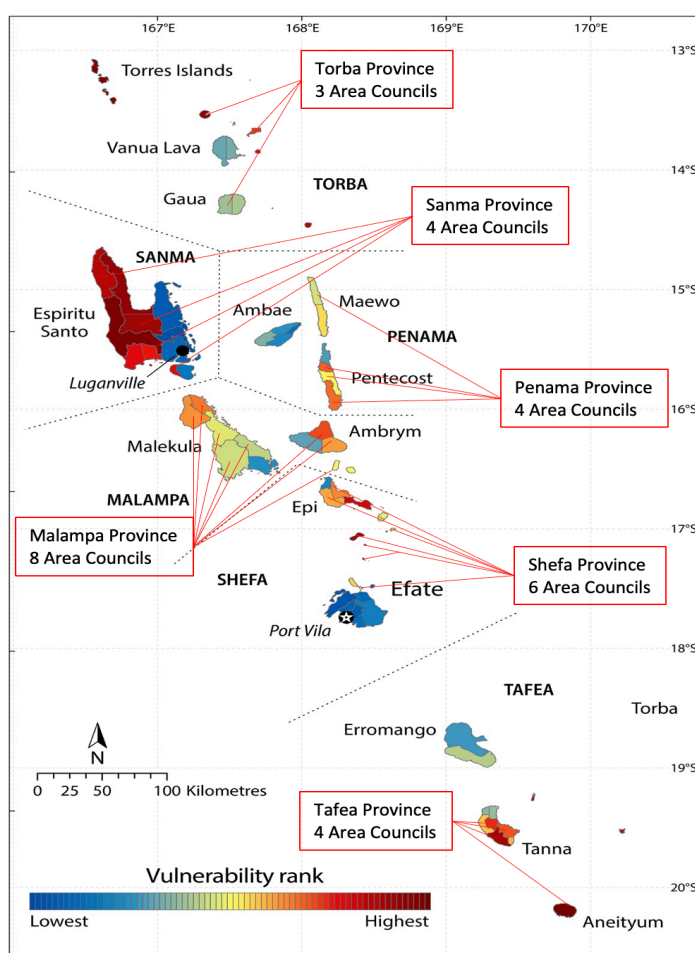


Figure 5. National vulnerability assessment results for all Area Councils in Vanuatu, with targeted Area Councils identified. A larger version is at Annex 16.

71. Implementation of the project, including the adaptations for communities to select and then apply locally, has been grouped into three main components:

- Reducing exposure (to climate-related hazards);
- Minimizing sensitivity (to climate change impacts); and
- Building adaptive capacity (to current and projected climate change impacts).

Table 1. Target beneficiary numbers by Province and population and household numbers

Province	Area Councils (#)	Population	Communities (#)*	Households (#)
Tafea	4	21,534	51	3,868
Sanma	4	10,618	37	2,325
Torba	3	3,361	15	924
Shefa	6	7,912	35	2,035
Malampa	8	33,301	99	7,397
Penama	4	13,431	45	3,007
TOTAL	29	90,157	282	19,556

*Community numbers are estimated from Vanuatu National Statistics Office data as they are not reported in the census. A range of very small villages have been combined with neighbouring villages to form communities for the purposes of effective project implementation and service delivery.

72. Project activities are designed to respond to the needs and gaps identified through the vulnerability assessment and stakeholder engagement process, including: increasing local capacity to understand the implications climate change holds, generate locally-appropriate adaptation plans, and access and utilize up-to-date climate information and actionable early warnings; building a flexible, scalable package of adaptation actions to build environmental resilience (via nature-based solutions), increase food security and diversify livelihood structures; and support enhanced system capacity at all levels to support local adaptation sustainably.

73. These three components and outputs and activities are outlined below. The relationships between outputs are shown in *Figure 8*, below.

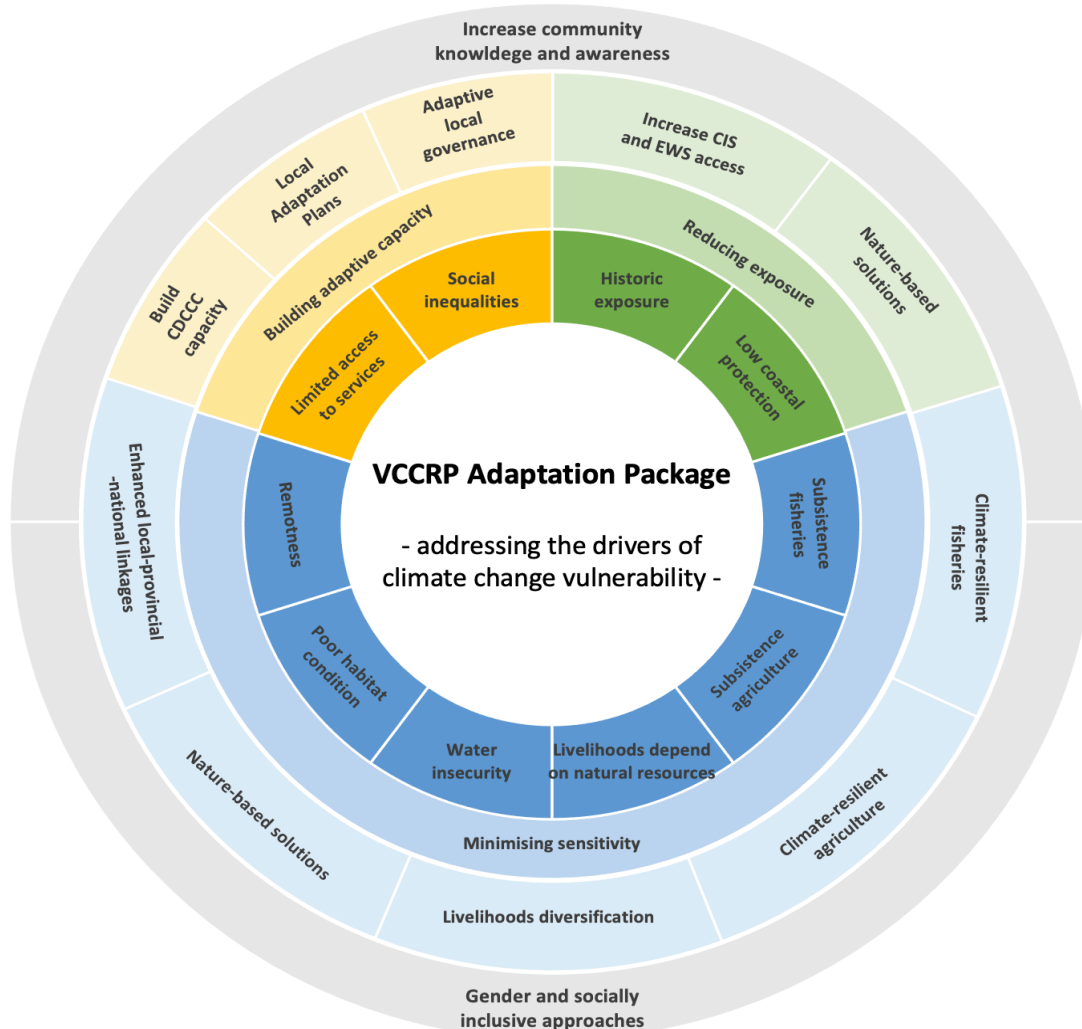


Figure 6. Relationships between drivers of vulnerability and project activities. The inner-most ring characterizes the existing extreme weather and climate change challenges facing targeted communities. The second ring categorizes these challenges and their associated adaptation actions, represented in the third ring. The outer-most ring highlights cross-cutting issues that affect all categories of vulnerability and action.

Adaptation packages – approach and content

74. The core intervention strategy of the project is delivery of the adaptation packages under **Component 2**. Each package is a suite of adaptation activities that address the main drivers of community vulnerability (globally identified through a national vulnerability assessment and aligned with the resilience framework, finetuned through community consultations; see **Annex 23**). The development of a specific adaptation package gives communities options to select the most appropriate and effective adaptations and provides certainty that GCF investments are addressing the main drivers of climate vulnerability specific to the needs of each individual community. Activities in the adaptation package are designed to be modular and scalable. Specific activities can be increased, decreased or removed, depending on community circumstances. This makes the package approach tailored and highly transferable to the remaining communities in Vanuatu as well as to other contexts.
75. Participatory stakeholder involvement during implementation will allow for a tailored set of adaptation actions to be selected from the adaptation package and increased local ownership, promoting long-term sustainability of the adaptation actions in each community. The focus on empowering communities to participate in and lead all stages of adaptation, from selection to implementation to operation and maintenance, and capacity building for government, will build strong ownership and buy-in to the project by all beneficiaries and help the sustainability of the implemented actions. Final approval of

Community Adaptation Plans, which include the community's specific adaptation package, will sit with the MoCC, as co-Executing Entity and link to national climate change policy processes.

76. The adaptation actions are designed to be implemented over the six-year project and have flexibility to accommodate the specific climate change challenges and existing capacities within each community. Components of natural resource management and climate resilient agriculture and fisheries for food security and livelihoods can be scaled up as needed to suit the local context. Each targeted community's adaptation package will form part of their broader Community Adaptation Plan (the development of which the project will support under Component 1 activities). Each community will select a number of actions from the adaptation package menu that respond to the needs identified in their Community Adaptation Plan; these actions will be collated for implementation and will make up each community's adaptation package. The Community Adaptation Plan may contain activities that go beyond the remit of the VCCRP. In these cases, the project will support communities to seek other sources of climate finance for implementation via an 'investment plan' component of the Community Adaptation Plan. The project-supported adaptation packages and the investment plan will both form part of the endorsed Community Adaptation Plan in each targeted community.
77. Adaptation activities have been developed considering structural disadvantages experienced by women, children and people living with a disability. This will ensure that sustainable climate resilient development pathways also promote social justice and equality in decision-making. The project will work through established local governance structures and will partner with local-level civil society organizations where available to maximize the appropriateness, ownership and sustainability of adaptation actions.
78. The Adaptation Package is made up of a menu of actions that fall under four broad community sectors:
 - Increasing the resilience of local natural resources upon which the local communities depend to climate change impacts using nature-based solutions (Output 2.1);
 - Climate-resilient small-scale agriculture for food security and livelihoods (Output 2.2);
 - Climate-resilient artisanal fisheries for food security and livelihoods (Output 2.3);
 - Climate-resilient food processing and preservation to support food security and diversification of livelihoods options (Output 2.4).
79. The overarching package is outlined below in *Figure 7*, including the linkages between actions. Specific activities for each component of the package are provided in the section below.

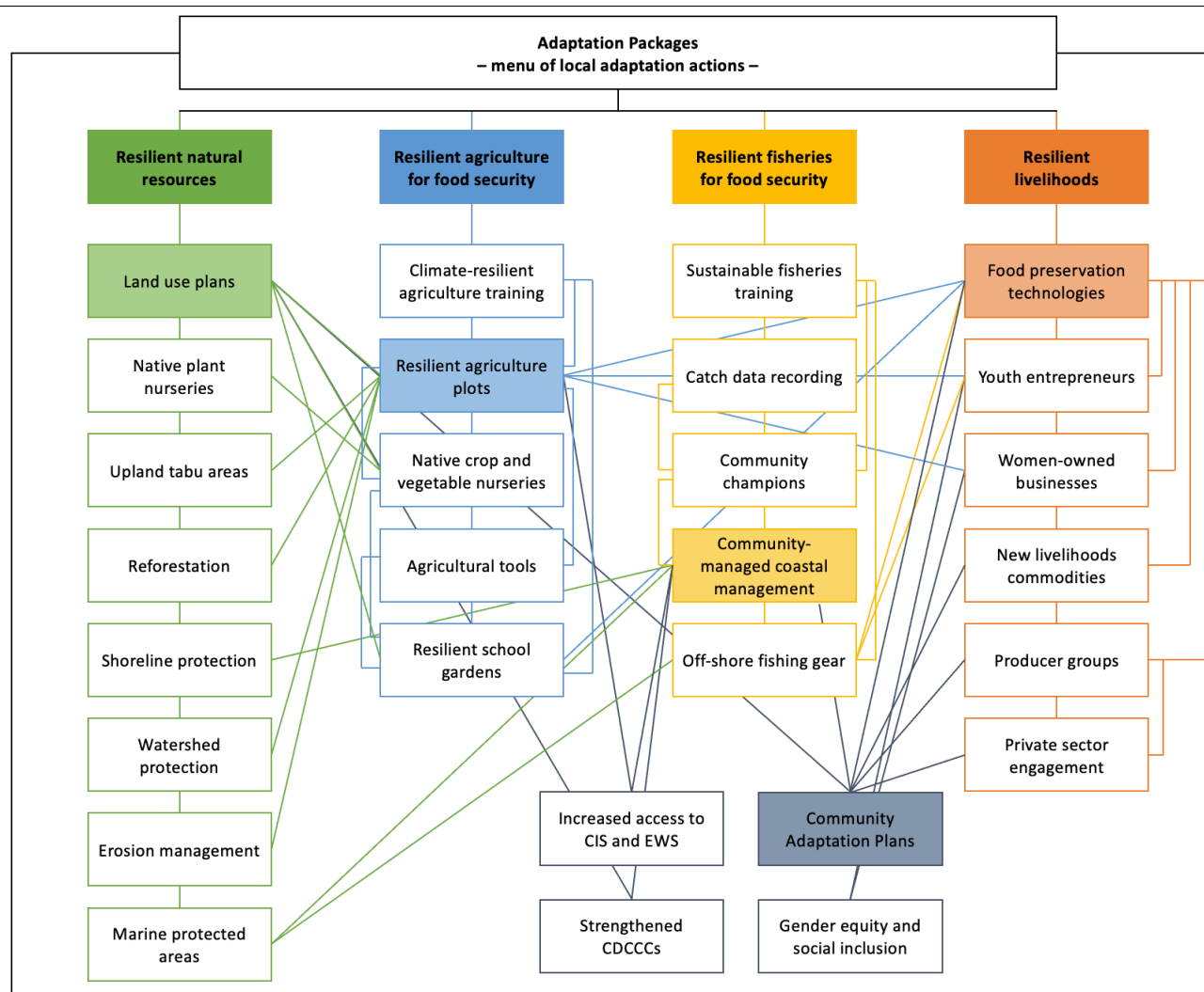


Figure 7. The VCCRP Adaptation Package menu showing interlinkages between actions.

Components, outputs and activities

Component 1: Government, civil society and communities are strengthened to support local resilience to climate change impacts, including by providing access to climate information and early warnings

80. The resilience of rural communities hinges in large part on: their awareness of climate change impacts; preparedness to proactively act when extreme weather events (e.g. cyclones or drought) occur, based on reliable early warning systems; and to make long term development decisions based on participatory local adaptation plans that incorporate up-to-date climate information. This component builds community and institutional capacity at the local level, integrated into a provincial structure, to plan for and respond to the current and anticipated impacts of climate change.

Output 1.1: Community-based climate change adaptation and disaster risk reduction mechanisms are strengthened

81. Climate change impacts will result in an increase of disaster events which will have significant and ongoing impacts on communities. Strengthening local-level DRR mechanisms (the CDCCCs) is a critical component of reducing risk.

Activities under this output will result in:

- CDCCCs established and strengthened in at least 254 communities (assumed at 90% of targeted communities)

- Gender balance achieved in 254 CDCCCs
- Members of at least 254 CDCCCs have increased understanding of climate change, enhanced community leadership skills and ability to deliver climate change awareness training to community members
- New communications channels (through SMS or social media) established for CDCCCs to request information/support from NDMO/Provincial Disaster Officers

Activity descriptions

- 1.1.1 Establish Community Disaster and Climate Change Committees (CDCCCs) (if necessary) and build their capacity, including strengthening social inclusion and gender-balance
82. Activity 1.1.1 will establish new, or strengthen existing, CDCCCs and build their capacity, including strengthening social inclusion and gender-balance. Support will be provided to the national government (including the NDMO and Department of Local Authorities (DLA)) in developing and field-testing of a CDCCC assessment instrument. CDCCC assessment indicators and methodology will be developed through an inclusive and participatory manner with key stakeholders and will include desktop and ground-truthed analysis of local contexts of where CDCCCs have been established, which are currently operational, and their inclusion of vulnerable groups. Field testing of the CDCCC assessment tool will take place to evaluate and improve the instrument prior to full implementation with all target sites. Consultations during field-testing will capture the perspectives of community members, including children/youth and people with disability, on how to strengthen their CDCCC (such as improving gender-balance). Based on CDCCC assessment instrument findings, tailored support will be provided to subnational government (including Area Councils and DLA) for the establishment and/or ongoing development of CDCCCs, including, where needed, CDCCC kits (containing two smart phones, one tablet, stationary supplies, a printer, a mini projector and five high-vis vests) and community workspace.
- 1.1.2: Increase CDCCC member capacity to identify climate change and disaster risks at the local level, including providing leadership training (targeted at women) and establishing communication channels for CDCCCs to request information/support from the National Disaster Management Office (NDMO)
83. Activity 1.1.2 will increase the capacity of CDCCC members in effectively identifying climate and disaster risk within their respective geographic boundaries. Based on CDCCC assessment findings, CDCCC members will be engaged in leadership and technical training (including climate change adaptation and disaster risk reduction) sessions aligned to their respective needs and strengths. Traditionally vulnerable groups, including women and children/youth, will be engaged to participate in leadership-oriented training to enable greater participation in local adaptation planning processes. Follow-up refresher trainings will be conducted annually, with additional monitoring and support visits as needs arise. CDCCCs will be supported in establishing new, or strengthening existing, communication lines (including telephone, SMS/MMS/RCS, and social media) with the NDMO to enable requests for information and support in leading community education sessions on climate and disaster risk.

Output 1.2: Communities have increased understanding of climate change impacts and are supported to develop inclusive local adaptation plans

84. In order to take effective adaptation action, communities require an increased understanding of the implications of climate change for their impacts for their lives and livelihoods and the ability to effectively plan for current and future adaptation needs.
85. Activities under this output will result in:
- 90,157 people have increased understanding of climate change and its implications via participation in community education sessions
 - 145 local government staff (Area Council) with the capacity to deliver awareness raising materials on climate change and disaster risks to food systems, livelihoods and disaster risk
 - 144 community awareness media broadcasts/posts on climate change risks and impacts delivered to public via media/social media

- Baseline reports on biophysical and ecological conditions developed with at least 254 communities (assumed at 90% of targeted communities)
- Baseline reports on household-level socioeconomic status and resource dependence developed with at least 254 communities (assumed at 90% of targeted communities)
- Community Adaptation Plans developed with CDCCCs and households in at least 254 communities (assumed at 90% of targeted communities), developed by communities through a participatory process and approved by MoCC under national climate change policy processes
- Prioritization of VCCRP adaptation package activities for delivery in at least 254 communities (assumed at 90% of targeted communities)

Activity descriptions

1.2.1: Community awareness raising on climate change risks to food systems, livelihoods and disaster risk via targeted information, education and communications (IEC) materials and information sessions managed by Area Council Climate Change Officers and CDCCCs

86. Activity 1.2.1 will contribute towards building awareness in target communities on climate change and disaster risks to food systems and livelihoods by supporting Area Councils and CDCCCs with tailored IEC materials and training resources to facilitate community information sessions. A desktop review of existing climate change education materials (including those developed by other projects including GIZ CCPIR, RESCCUE, PEBACC, see Annex 2) aimed at community-level audiences will be reviewed to identify gaps and opportunities for improvement in partnership with sector stakeholders. Support will be provided to MoET and MoCC to incorporate project level information on climate change risks to food systems, role of habitats in supporting fisheries, livelihoods, disaster risk and adaptations options into existing material being developed for teaching and capacity building purposes. Digitized train-the-trainer sessions with Area Councils and CDCCCs will be facilitated to ensure effective utilization of newly developed digital and paper-based IEC materials and key messages. Following dissemination of IEC materials, training opportunities will be scaled-up for interested community members, civil society organizations, and other local stakeholders. In conjunction with Activity 3.2.2, in-person knowledge exchange events will be held with local (including Area Council and CDCCC members), subnational, and national stakeholders to facilitate an additional entry point to champion consideration of local issues in subnational / national climate change adaptation planning processes.

1.2.2: Identify key local issues that drive climate vulnerability and use this to develop local adaptation plans and measure program impact, including baseline biophysical and ecological surveys of key natural resources (habitats and species) that support food security and livelihoods as well as household socioeconomic surveys to document resource dependence and important natural resources to inform local adaptation actions

87. Activity 1.2.2 will support identification of key challenges and barriers that drive climate vulnerability as well as existing local resources and adaptive capacities to inform development of local adaptation plans. The DLA will be provided with technical support toward capacity building of Area Council members in facilitating community profiling and assessing / documenting local climate vulnerabilities in alignment with the National Vulnerability Assessment Framework (NVAF) and other national sector guidance. Following digitized train-the-trainers sessions with DLA officers and Area Council members, participatory community profiling and local vulnerability assessments will be undertaken by local Area Council members. Rapid baseline surveys of key biophysical and ecological natural resources that support local food systems and livelihoods will be carried out, including assessment of threats to watersheds, erosion hotspots, mangrove and reef health, fish catch surveys, invasive species, and agricultural pests and diseases. In addition to collecting biophysical and ecological baseline data for assess project impact, household socioeconomic surveys will be conducted with national stakeholders (such as VNSO) to assess local natural resource dependence to inform adaptation interventions.

1.2.3: Development of inclusive Community Adaptation Plans and identification of key resilience building actions (selected from adaptation package menu) through participatory processes facilitated by sub-national government and CDCCCs

88. Activity 1.2.3 will facilitate development of Community Adaptation Plans and identification of key climate resilience building actions from the VCCRP adaptation package menu of interventions. Building on findings from Activity 1.2.2 and in partnership with the DLA, a participatory and inclusive stakeholder engagement processes will be undertaken to develop Community Adaptation Plans, helping prioritize immediate to mid-term adaptation actions to address current and projected climate change risks, as well as identifying key areas for adaptation investment. Community Adaptation Plans will provide the foundation from which communities identify their local preference and priorities for VCCRP adaptation interventions, ensuring actions taken align to local needs, are socially acceptable, avoid adverse environmental and social impacts, and address the underlying local drivers of climate change vulnerability. The Plans will target both immediate adaptation priorities (some of which can be met via the VCCRP adaptation packages) and longer-term priorities, as well as identifying specific adaptation investment opportunities (including value chain and market opportunities) via an 'investment plan' component of the Community Adaptation Plan. Validation by community members (including Area Councils and CDCCCs) will enable finalization of Community Adaptation Plans and prioritization of VCCRP adaptation interventions to be undertaken. Community Adaptation Plans will then be updated on a three year cycle.

Output 1.3: Communities have increased access to climate information services and early warning systems and the skills to utilise them as adaptation tools

89. Output 1.3 will build on GCF FP035 (Van-KIRAP) to disseminate useable, accessible climate information to the community level, helping ensure that the climate information generated under Van-KIRAP reaches the most vulnerable communities.

90. Activities under this output will result in:

- Baseline assessment of existing access to EWS and CIS in 282 communities (assumed at 100% of targeted communities)
- Increased access to CIS and EWS via telecommunications connectivity for at least 261 CDCCCs via installation of solar PV systems and internet connectivity with systems for on-selling data for financial sustainability
- 144 CIS communications delivered to communities via social media, text messages and radio
- Technical competency in utilization of CIS and EWS increased in at least 254 communities

Activity descriptions

1.3.1: Develop and distribute CIS IEC products to support community adaptation awareness raising and adaptation planning processes building on products developed under FP035 (Van-KIRAP) and adapting them to the wider local context

91. Activity 1.3.1 will support development and distribution of CIS IEC products to inform community-level climate change adaptation planning processes. In conjunction with Activity 1.2.2, a baseline assessment of existing access to EWS and CIS in target communities will be undertaken, including traditional indicators and knowledge as well as accessibility for people with disabilities and vulnerable groups. This assessment will be informed by a review of best practice on EWS. Based on demonstrated baseline assessment findings, support will be provided to enhance CDCCC infrastructure through the procurement and installation of solar PV systems (including batteries, lights, and wiring) and internet connectivity. Technical support will be provided to CDCCCs to establish a system of on-selling data capacity to cover operational / maintenance costs and address long-term sustainability. Elderly members of target communities will be encouraged during community meetings to help identify and capture traditional knowledge (including knowledge and memories of cropping calendars and their changes over time due to climate impacts and cyclones) for early warnings of disasters or extreme weather events related to agriculture or fisheries, with an emphasis on highlighted local/community-level expertise. CIS products and knowledge management materials will be developed (including print, digital, audio, and mixed media) for use in target communities in partnership with national authorities (including NDMO and VMGD). Opportunities to extend or scale-up CIS materials from other relevant projects (particularly Van-KIRAP / FP035) for community-level use will be preferred to ensure efficiency

and to avoid duplication of efforts. See **Annex 2 Section 3.4.1** for more detail on VCCRP-Van-KIRAP collaboration.

1.3.2: Build capacity of Area Council Climate Change Officers and CDCCCs to effectively utilize CIS in community planning processes, including scaling out FP035 community-level CIS training utilizing participatory processes

92. Activity 1.3.2 will strengthen the capacity of Area Councils and CDCCCs in the use of CIS resources and information to inform community-level planning processes. Technical training materials will be prepared that address community needs and are tailored for community-level understanding (layperson) of climate and disaster risk. Tailored technical trainings will be facilitated with CDCCCs and community members (using digitized train-the-trainer model) on use of CIS products and resources, including integration of GESI considerations and youth-inclusive approaches. Collaboration on delivery of CIS technical training with Van-KIRAP (FP035) and national authorities (VMGD and NDMO) will avoid duplication of efforts. Building on Activity 1.2.1, community trainings will be delivered by CDCCC members on using CIS related to agriculture, fisheries, and disaster risk reduction, thereby increasing local knowledge base on understanding climate change.

Component 2: Scalable, locally appropriate actions are implemented to meet community adaptation needs to create climate-resilient, sustainable development pathways

93. Vulnerable communities can only achieve climate-resilient food systems and livelihoods if their primary production is made resilient to climate shocks. This component focuses on strengthening agriculture and fisheries systems to achieve food security and promoting economic activities through local value-chain improvements in order to diversify livelihoods options. This component is the core of the project and is built around the adaptation package menu which is flexible and scalable to community contexts.

Output 2.1: Local natural resources are more resilient to climate change impacts through implementation of nature-based solutions

94. Climate change impacts on natural resources that support food systems and livelihoods vary by location and over time and will, therefore, affect communities differently. Actions under this sector will support communities to build the resilience of their local ecosystem to ensure it can continue to support food security and livelihoods as climate change impacts escalate.
95. Activities under this output will result in:
- At least 254 land use plans developed to guide community decision-making around the allocation of community resources
 - 29 nurseries will be established to provide communities with native tree saplings to support re-forestation
 - 500,000 tree seedlings and 500,000 culms of vetiver grass (*Chrysopogon zizanioides*) will be distributed to communities for reforestation, erosion control and shoreline protection
 - At least 254 erosion management demonstration sites will be developed to highlight climate-resilient land management, and 29 erosion hotspots (one per Area Council) will be rehabilitated as fully realized examples
 - A total of 11,600 hectares of agricultural and fisheries sites under better management, including:
 - 500 hectares of upland forest areas across 29 Area Councils will be protected via extended tabu areas
 - 200 hectares of forest area will be restored with native trees
 - 100 hectares of shoreline vegetation will be restored via replanting mangrove forests and invasive species management
 - 200 hectares of critical watershed areas protected through installation of micro-check dams and erosion control (including establishing living barriers)
 - 500 hectares of marine habitats will be protected by local conservation (tabu) areas

Activity descriptions

2.1.1: Support adaptations that strengthen or rehabilitate coastal protection barriers, reduce risk of flood/landslides and improve water-security through nature-based solutions, including establishing living barriers to storm winds, erosion or landslide zones to fortify slopes and reduce erosion, and reforestation of damaged forests and water catchments

96. Activity 2.1.1 will deliver community-based education on coastal and upland resource management (including role of mangroves in local fisheries and natural coastal barriers), working with CDCCCs and community leaders to ensure inclusive, participatory events that incorporate traditional knowledge and 'kastom.' The education components will be parlayed into planning workshops with sector stakeholders (including Department of Environment Protection and Conservation (DEPC) and Department of Agriculture and Rural Development (DARD)) for development of coastal and upland resource management plans (as a component of the Community Adaptation Plan). These community-led plans will be informed by activities under Component 1 that also address community education and identification of underlying issues that drive climate variability. Building on baseline biophysical and ecological surveys carried out under Component 1, this activity will establish living barriers (including planting mangroves and vetiver grass), support reforestation of damaged forests and water catchments (including growing saplings), manage invasive vine species impacting watersheds (identify and remove), and establish new / strengthen existing community conservation areas (including helping community leaders establish/expand 'tabu' areas).

2.1.2: Introduce/scale up improved agriculture methods to minimise erosion, including establishing field demonstrations sites for soil erosion minimisation methods and facilitate groundwater recharge and distributing preventive species to communities.

97. Activity 2.1.2 will support agriculture technical officers at DARD to develop, produce, and deliver training and education materials on climate-resilient agricultural practices, including reviewing and strengthening existing technical resources. Further support will be provided to DARD staff to undertake community participatory approaches to develop and implement site-specific strategies to combat soil erosion (including conservation methods, minimum tillage and contour planting/terracing). Based on community validation of erosion strategies developed, this activity will establish field demonstrations to showcase to local households and community members various approaches to mitigating soil erosion and facilitating groundwater recharge. Field demonstrations will be complimented by the distribution of trees and plants to prevent erosion (native tree saplings and vetiver grass) and tools to support implementation (planting at identified hot spots).

2.1.3: Support communities to protect and rehabilitate habitats that support fisheries, particularly degraded coral reefs, seagrass meadows and mangroves, including establishing or enhancing traditional tabu areas for conservation of coastal resources and freshwater resources

98. Activity 2.1.3 will support provincial fisheries officers to develop, produce, and deliver training and education materials on mangrove and reef health, sustainable fisheries practice and coastal zone management (including the role of habitats for coastal/marine resources). Further support will be provided to provincial fisheries officers to engage communities (direct beneficiaries) on identification and establishment of priority actions to address protection and rehabilitation of local coastal habitats (including reduced mangrove clearing, limited reef gleaning). Emphasis will be placed on collaborating with community leaders (including chiefly authorities and CDCCCs) on establishing new / enhancing existing 'tabu' areas for environmental conservation (including freshwater resources, reef fisheries). Degraded coastal resources (including mangroves, seagrass meadows and coral reefs) will be identified and rehabilitated as part of overall efforts to support communities to protect and rehabilitate habitats that support fisheries. Similar to Activity 2.1, invasive species (including crown of thorns starfish) in coastal habitats will also be addressed (identified and removed).

Output 2.2: Climate-resilient agriculture for food security and livelihood development

99. Climate change is affecting the success of traditional planting methods and ways of growing crops due to changes in local weather and climate, pests and disease. As climate change impacts escalate, food

insecurity will increase. Building the resilience of local agriculture practice is critical to preventing further degradation of food security and building surpluses for processing and marketing.

100. Activities under this output will result in:

- Training of 17,072 small-holder farmer households in climate-resilient agriculture techniques for application in household plots (assumed at 90% of households in the project sites)
- At least 254 demonstration sites of community-level climate-resilient agriculture
- 11,300 farmer households supported in the adoption of these more resilient agriculture methods and increasing their food security and livelihood options (assumed at 60% of households that received training)
- 29 crop and vegetable nurseries will be established to provide communities with seeds and saplings of climate resilient crop varieties
- Seeds and seedlings will be distributed to 15,175 farmer households (assumed at 80% of households that received training)
- Simple agricultural tools will be distributed to 15,175 farmer households to help increase their productivity (assumed at 80% of households that received training)
- Climate-resilient kitchen gardens will be established in schools across 29 Area Councils

Activity descriptions

2.2.1: Support adaptations to traditional farming methods to increase climate-resilience and increase food security, including establishing field demonstrations of climate-resilient agriculture techniques

101. Activity 2.2.1 will support DARD technical officers to perform a comprehensive stock take of exiting and traditional agriculture practices and seasonal crop calendars in target communities. The results of the stock take will support the DARD in development of training materials on climate-resilient agriculture and water conservation techniques (including intercropping, seed selection, grafting techniques, and planting management). Training materials produced and distributed will encompass existing DARD resources as well as new resources (such as video demonstrations on natural composting) focused on climate-resilient agriculture practices. DARD technical officers will be supported in undertaking training and education workshops at the community level. Public areas for field demonstrations will be established in partnership with community leaders to enable DARD technical officers to showcase climate-resilient agriculture methods using a participatory learning approach.

2.2.2: Introduce/scale up adoption of climate-resilient native food and cash crop varieties, including establishing new or support existing nurseries in Area Councils for raising climate-resilient seed stocks, and distributing seedlings and tools to communities.

102. Activity 2.2.2 supports the adoption (through increased supply and accessibility) of climate-resilient native food and cash crops through partnerships with nurseries and sector stakeholders (including DARD, VARTC, FSA) in target communities. Support for Area Council nurseries will include collaborating with stakeholders to supply and raise new climate resilient seeds and seedlings, and establishing multiplication plots of resilient food and cash crops. Prior to distribution, DARD technical officers will be supported to survey needs for accompanying agricultural tools and equipment for each target Area Council. Mass distribution of resilient native food and cash crops planting materials will be complimented by distribution of simple agricultural tools (including earth huger, rotavator) to increase productivity. Training will be provided to accompany distribution of new planting materials and tools.

2.2.3: Establish/scale-up community-, school- and home-based kitchen gardens for enhanced nutrition utilising climate-resilient crops, including establish demonstration training gardens in schools to raise vegetable and tree seedlings for increased climate resilient nutrition and facilitating seed exchanges and seed saving to increase local independence and resilience.

103. Activity 2.2.3 focuses on supporting adoption (through increased supply and accessibility) of kitchen gardens to promote enhanced nutrition utilizing climate-resilient crops. Delivery of family-based nutrition education on traditional diet and local food gardens with diversified climate-resilient crops will be carried out collaboratively with DARD and other sector stakeholders. Training and awareness materials will cover family-based (household, school, community) nutrition awareness and kitchen gardens to

promote nutrition and use of traditional food sources. Also covered will be agroforestry to promote healthy soils and water conservation (including using trees for shade, soil stabilization, improving soil moisture, etc.), as well as plant health and capacity building of community members to better identify and manage pests and diseases. Climate-resilient seeds, seedlings and plants will be procured and distributed in partnership with DARD. Public areas for field demonstrations will be established in partnership with community leaders to enable schools to raise vegetable and tree seedlings for enhanced nutrition.

Output 2.3: Climate-resilient fisheries for food security and livelihood development

104. Coastal and reef fisheries in Vanuatu are already impacted by current climate-related threats such as marine heatwave events, cyclones and terrestrial runoff. As climate change impacts escalate communities will see a significant reduction in the productivity of coastal resources, reducing fish populations and the catches needed to nourish households. Supporting communities to better manage the coastal zone and diversify their fish catch will help reduce pressure on coastal and reef ecosystems and supporting increased food security.

105. Activities under this output will result in:

- Training of 11,734 artisanal fishers in effective coastal resource management to help protect coastal and reef ecosystems from further damage (assumed 80% of households in the coastal project sites reached)
- Catch data recording system established in at least 202 communities to support more sustainable decision-making (assumed 90% targeted coastal communities)
- At least 404 community champions identified and trained in local monitoring and management of coastal resources (assumed one female and one male champion in each of 90% of targeted coastal communities)
- 202 coastal communities establish community-led coastal resource management systems (assumed 90% targeted coastal communities)
- Off-reef fishing equipment distributed to 112 communities (assumes 50% targeted coastal communities)

Activity descriptions

2.3.1: Build community capacity on coastal resource management and monitoring that supports sustainable fisheries, including via youth-focused skills development

106. Activity 2.3.1 will build the capacity of target communities on coastal resource management through delivery of bespoke training and education programs. In parallel with Activity 2.1, communities will be engaged to assess coastal resource conditions (including habitats), direct and indirect threats (including mangrove clearing, overfishing), and current management and governance practices (including conservation or tabu areas). Community leaders will identify 'community champions', including youth champions, who will serve as focal points for activity implementation and communication to team members. Coastal resource assessments will inform the development of culturally appropriate and scalable coastal resource management training programs in partnership with key sector stakeholders (including Vanuatu Fisheries Department (VFD) and community champions). Support will be provided to VFD fisheries specialists for development and delivery of coastal resource management training program, including pilot implementation prior to upscaling to further project sites.

2.3.2: Support communities to adopt primary community-based fisheries management to reduce climate change impacts, including supporting community-level implementation of climate-resilient fisheries management and development of locally appropriate governance mechanisms, as well as increasing diversification and sustainability of fisheries resources (alleviating pressures on inshore fisheries) by providing off-shore fishing equipment to communities

107. Activity 2.3.2 will support adoption of primary community-based fisheries management given small-scale fisheries with limited management and enforcement capacity. Training materials focused on building community-level capacity in leadership, monitoring, and effective governance will be

developed in consultation with ‘community champions,’ followed by delivery of training sessions in partnership with Area Councils and provincial government. Community champions will work in partnership with VFD fisheries specialists and community members to collect local fisheries data using community-based monitoring methods. Support will be provided to community champions in use of monitoring data to assess effectiveness of new fisheries management techniques, conduct refresher trainings for peers as needed, and establish long-term mechanisms for sharing data between communities and government. Support for implementation of climate-resilient management techniques focused on primary community-based fisheries management to reduce climate change impacts will be determined through community consultations and sector stakeholders (including VFD). Off-shore fishing equipment (including bottom fishing gear, and training on canoe making) will be distributed to target communities as a means of alleviating pressure on inshore fisheries and to support diversification and sustainability of fisheries resources.

Output 2.4: Women-led climate-resilient food processing and preservation established to support food security and diversification of livelihoods options

108. Climate change, including disaster events, impact on traditional crop and fisheries production and food-security, with reverberating impacts on local livelihoods and the availability of capital to purchase store-bought food stuffs. Food processing and preservation methods are key to climate-resilient food and livelihood systems, addressing yearly fluctuations in agricultural production and disasters such as cyclones, while facilitating commodity diversification. Food preservation and storage techniques will also extend the shelf-life of both agricultural and fisheries products, reducing food loss and improving quality, allowing for transport to markets, particularly for remote communities that are isolated from market centres. Food preparation and preservation at the household level is generally considered ‘women’s work’ in Vanuatu. Women are equally as engaged in agriculture activities as men and participate in near-shore fishing for household sustenance. Women are also engaged in selling produce at markets. This output will focus on building women’s economic empowerment through community-level food security and income diversification activities. A key outcome will be supporting the establishment of women-led producer groups. These groups will be 100% owned and managed by women from target communities and will utilize project provided food preservation and processing technologies to develop value-add products for markets.

109. Activities under this output will result in:

- 261 communities utilizing climate-resilient food preservation techniques (assumed at 90% of targeted communities)
- Solar food dryers distributed to 261 communities for use in preserving surplus produce and fish for food security and delivery to markets (assumes 90% of targeted communities)
- Solar-powered freezers distributed to 261 communities for storing excess fish catch and produce for food security (assumes 90% of targeted communities)
- Households in at least 140 communities utilizing salting and pickling for food preservation and marketing (assumed at 50% of targeted communities)
- New livelihoods commodities (dried fruits, dried nuts, smoked fish, shell crafting, copra, coffee) adopted by at least 140 communities to increase incomes and diversify livelihoods (assumed at 50% of targeted communities)
- Establishment of 90 women-led producer groups to support communities to bring agricultural and fisheries goods to market, 30 led by young women (assumed average of 3 per Area Council)
- Facilitation of at least six private sector partnerships to support access to distant markets for commodities (assumed at 1 per province)

Activity descriptions

2.4.1: Introduce or scale up women-led local solutions for food processing and preservation, including identifying foods most suitable for preservation and provision of processing equipment (solar dryers and freezers) to communities

110. Activity 2.4.1 will introduce new (or scale up existing) local solutions for food processing and preservation as a means of supporting food security, reducing food loss and diversifying women’s

livelihood options to strengthen climate resilience. Local commodities that can be harvested or grown in target communities and are suitable for preservation will be promoted for cultivation and preservation in communities. Food losses are expected to be reduced when excess produce from agriculture and fisheries can be preserved. Target communities will be provided with educational information on relevant food processing and preservation techniques. Adaptation technologies for food preservation and storage (including solar dryers and solar freezers) will be supplied to communities to facilitate food processing. Target communities will be provided with support towards long-term use, operation and maintenance of food processing and preservation systems (including replacement parts, refresher trainings, and upskilling as needed). Key stakeholders (including Area Councils, DLA) will be provided with support towards identifying and addressing barriers to support successful adoption of adaptation technologies.

2.4.2: Support women to diversify into new agricultural/food commodities and value-add products that deliver greater income generating opportunities, including identifying local value-add commodities with market potential and supporting processing

111. Activity 2.4.2 will deliver outreach and educational information on recommended value-added products. Outreach will take place at the Area Council level, with further dissemination of information and materials to individual target communities based on relevance. A sub-set of targeted communities will be provided supported to develop new agriculture/food commodities and value-added products (dried fruits, dried nuts, smoked fish, shell crafting, copra, coffee) for income generation as a means of supporting food security and diversification of livelihood options. Participatory and inclusive community consultations (workshops and meetings) will identify and prioritize opportunities, ensuring a community-led process. A market analysis will be undertaken to inform how to best support community development of value-added products as well as increase access to new (distant) markets for emerging commodities, including for tourism through local cottage industries.

2.4.3: Support women-led enterprises to access private partnership options to access new (distant) markets for value-add products

112. Activity 2.4.3 will deliver outreach and educational information on recommended value-added products. Outreach will take place at the Area Council level, with further dissemination of information and materials to individual target communities based on relevance. Assistance with production and distribution of value-added products and agriculture/fisheries commodities will be channeled through women-led producer groups established at the community and/or Area Council level. In collaboration with the Vanuatu Chamber of Commerce and Industry (VCCI) (building on the Mobilizing Vanuatu private sector towards climate change action readiness activity delivered by GGGI), private sector partnerships will be identified and established to further support community-level enterprise and enhance access to markets, and, where possible, support producer groups to transition into micro or small enterprises (including support to identify longer term sources of finance for business development).

Component 3: Institutional adaptive capacity is enhanced by building adaptive governance systems at the local level and enhancing local-provincial-national linkages

113. One of the key processes in adaptive governance is the feedback mechanism and integration of lessons learned into policies and procedures. Consideration of Gender Equality and Social Inclusion (GESI) procedures in local planning will ensure that all vulnerable local individuals, households and communities are included in creating climate-resilient livelihoods in the rural areas. This component is key to ensuring the sustainability of the adaptation packages approach, by embedding the system of community adaptation planning and prioritization of actions into national and provincial planning and budgeting cycles. The component will also build the capacity of provincial and national actors to access and effectively use future flows of climate finance.

Output 3.1: Adaptive local governance systems strengthened through sub-national planning

114. To help ensure the sustainability of government supported adaptation actions at the local level, sub-national government needs to integrate future climate risk into planning and budgeting processes and

have the institutional capacity to support the ongoing operations of CDCCCs. As disaster risk increases with the escalation of climate change impacts, ensuring government resources are able to flow quickly and efficiently to where they are needed is a critical component of building resilient communities. The development of shock-responsive social protection mechanisms is a key component of this process.

115. Activities under this output will result in:

- Development of 29 Area Council vulnerability maps
- Actionable analysis of gaps in Area Council institutional capacity to support local-level adaptation
- Increased Area Council capacity to undertake local-level climate risk analysis and integrate climate risks into planning and budgeting processes
- NDMO supported to design a climate-resilient, shock-responsive social protection system, including the development of locally appropriate targeting criteria to register the most vulnerable children and households in communities
- NDMO supported to develop the framework for a cash transfer system to operationalize the social protection system

Activity descriptions

3.1.1: Support Area Council and Province officials to incorporate climate risk analysis and financing strategies into Area Council development plans and budgets

116. Activity 3.1.1 will enable subnational officials to incorporate climate risk analysis (such as vulnerability mapping) into Area Council development planning and budgeting, and will incorporate assessment findings from Activity 1.2.2. Financing strategies will be included in the plans, identifying all relevant sources, including from the private sector through enterprise investment options and the communities through community funds, etc. Gaps and barriers to integrating climate risk into local development processes will be identified and addressed through the development of tailored technical trainings to Area Council members, provincial government officials, and other relevant stakeholders. In-person instruction with field demonstration will be coupled with ongoing technical support and resources to both operationalize training materials as well as assist with new or updated climate risk assessments when necessary. Continuity with development of Community Adaptation Plans from Activity 1.2.3 will be ensured to avoid duplication, contradictions, or inconsistent budgeting. Additional technical support and resources will be provided to Area Councils and provincial government officials to enable assessment of gender gaps (including existing gender and social deficits, best practices to reduce gaps, and recommendations moving forward) through gender-responsive climate change budgeting and planning.

3.1.2: Build the capacity of local authorities to support operations of the CDCCCs and ongoing inclusive local adaptation planning processes, including supporting systems to increase two-way communication and engagement between Area Councils and CDCCCs

117. Activity 3.1.2 will strengthen the capacity of local authorities (including Area Councils and CDCCCs) to carry out inclusive and effective adaptation planning at the local level. In partnership with the DLA, a diagnostic instrument will be developed and implemented to assess the capacity of Area Council officials and identify knowledge gaps, interests, and opportunities. Incorporating results from the assessment, as well as findings from Activity 1.2.1 and 1.2.2., a suite of technical training materials will be developed to address key competencies through a digitized train-the-trainer approach. Opportunities to bolster formal linkages between Area Councils and CDCCCs will be incorporated into capacity assessments and training materials to support increased communication and engagement. Ongoing linkages will be ensured by facilitating more frequent access to communities (including via provision of transport, i.e. quad bikes). Ongoing support will be provided to local authorities to encourage and enable the inclusion of sustainable budgeting for CDCCCs as a component of Area Council Development Plans.

3.1.3: Support NDMO to design and establish a shock-responsive social protection system designed for the needs of the most vulnerable households

118. Activity 3.1.3 will utilise co-finance from Australia's Department of Foreign Affairs and Trade to provide technical assistance to the National Disaster Management Office for the design of a government owned, shock-responsive social protection initiative. NDMO will be supported through a technically specialized procured party to develop and pilot locally appropriate targeting criteria based on needs (including inputs from Activity 1.2.2) and triggers determined by national-level indicators of shock such as drought and rainfall or local-level knowledge of community-specific shocks. The targeting criteria will be used to register the most vulnerable children and households in communities. Targeting criteria combined with trigger indicators will form the underlying framework for the system which in turn will further strengthen sub-national CIS and EWS systems (including via output 1.3). The system consists of providing primarily unconditional cash transfers for time-delimited consumption support in times of acute needs and stress. Delivery will occur through physical payment, vouchers or mobile money, to be determined during the design phase. Upon the occurrence of a shock (sudden or slow-onset), activation of immediate cash transfer to registered households, possibly even before disaster occurs based on seasonal weather forecasting will enable households to prepare for shocks (natural hazards) or climate induced stress and address immediate needs before household resilience is eroded. The activity will include the generation of evidence and learning to understand perceptions of cash transfers including acceptability and accessibility of cash transfer mechanisms and targeting criteria. Note the activity exclusively focused on designing and establishing the system and will not include cash payments as that is out of the scope of this project.

Output 3.2: Enhanced local-provincial-national linkages through knowledge management and creation of feedback loops

119. Ensuring that project-supported processes and outcomes are shared between communities, Area Councils, Provinces and the national level will help build a culture of adaptation learning in Vanuatu and promote replication and scale up of successful adaptation actions.

120. Activities under this output will result in:

- The production and distribution of 30 annual knowledge management products, including in local languages
- Engagement in 18 national, regional and/or international forums to disseminate local CBA knowledge
- Systemized capture, evaluation, and reporting of data on CCDRRR sector policy implementation by at least 23 Area Councils
- Annual dialogue meetings/forums held, increasing communication vertically across government to increase inclusion of local needs in planning decisions
- 1 national and 29 sub-national planning documents (e.g. strategic plan, business plans, etc.) reflecting long-term community needs identified by local actors

Activity descriptions

3.2.1: Capture lessons learned, emerging themes and best practices at the community level to ensure sub-national and national planning processes are informed by local needs and that local actions support national objectives

121. Activity 3.2.1 will promote national and sub-national planning processes that are informed by community level experiences (such as capturing lessons learned, emerging themes and best practices) and that community-level actions are in support of national public policy objectives. Periodic evaluations will be carried out to assess progress against key outcome/performance metrics, as well as document lessons learned on the successes and challenges of project implementation. Bespoke knowledge management products and resources will be produced to communicate the insight and knowledge gleaned from evaluations (including impact assessments) directly to national stakeholders (including NAB Secretariat, MoCC, and PMO) involved in climate change governance and planning. Participation of community champions in national and regional forums on climate change adaptation governance (such as Pacific Resilience Partnership events and national climate change adaptation planning workshops) will be supported as a means of increasing communication and linkages between community-level and national stakeholders. Dissemination of knowledge management

products will occur in all three national languages (including English, French, and Bislama) to ensure inclusivity of all stakeholders. Additionally, knowledge management resources will be produced in multiple mediums (including text, video, audio, and interactive media) to further ensure inclusivity of people with disabilities to benefit. Linkages to international adaptation knowledge bases (including the FRDP and the Nairobi Work Programme) will be assessed through a comprehensive stocktake of relevant community-based adaptation frameworks, appraised against relevant project outcomes, followed by communicated/demonstrating these linkages in knowledge management products.

3.2.2: Support local authorities in monitoring and evaluation of national CCDRR policies at the local level and increasing dialogue between stakeholders at all levels, including establishing a system to support sub-national authorities with reporting on implementation of national sector policies

122. Activity 3.2.2 will support monitoring and evaluation of the national sector policy on climate change and disaster risk reduction, further aiming to strengthen linkages and communication between local, provincial, and national stakeholders.

Subnational government (including Area Council and provincial officials) will be supported towards establishing systems to support reporting on implementation of the national CCDRR sector policy within local stakeholders' respective subnational boundaries. In partnership with civil society (including Vanuatu Climate Action Network (VCAN)), participatory events will be facilitated between national and subnational stakeholders (including government, private sector, and non-governmental organizations) to discuss actions to increase emphasis on long-term, community-level priorities within national and subnational planning and budgeting processes.

123. Activities in the adaptation package under **Component 2** are designed to be modular and scalable. Specific activities can be increased, decreased or removed, depending on community circumstances. This makes the package approach tailored and highly transferable to the remaining communities in Vanuatu as well as to other contexts. The specific contents of the package may alter based on broad country context (i.e. packages for another Pacific SIDS may look broadly similar while packages for a landlocked LDC in Asia may look significantly different) but the approach would be the same. Activities under components one and three are designed to ensure the sustainability of the adaptation package actions and help government to support and scale-up the approach over time to all rural communities in Vanuatu.
124. The project's activities are designed to directly address the specific climate drivers and vulnerabilities identified as key constraints to sustainable development in remote and rural communities in Vanuatu. The impact and response chains for each climate driver and project output are shown in *Figure 8.1*, below.

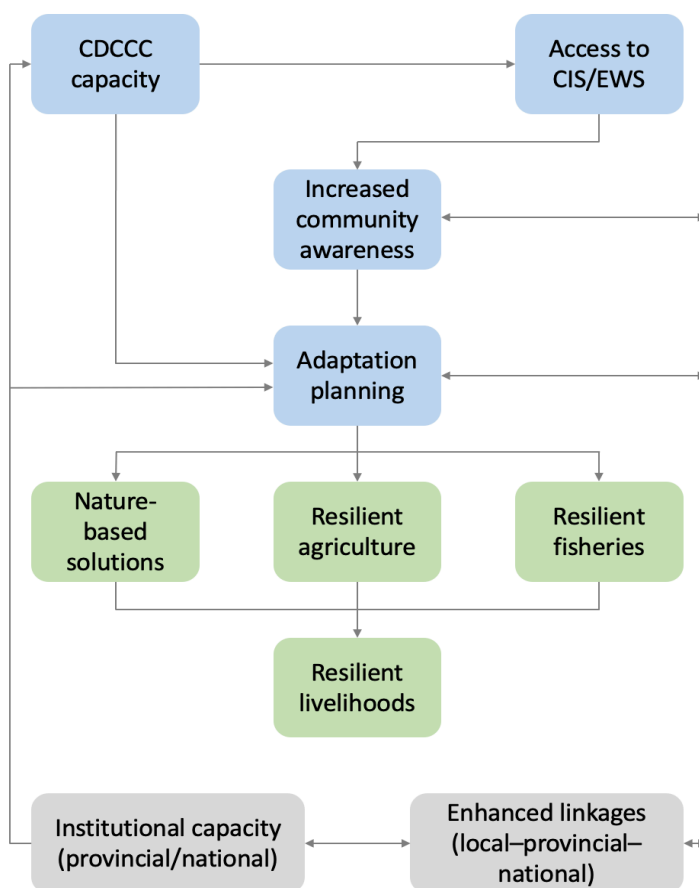


Figure 8. Components of the project and interrelationships between outputs

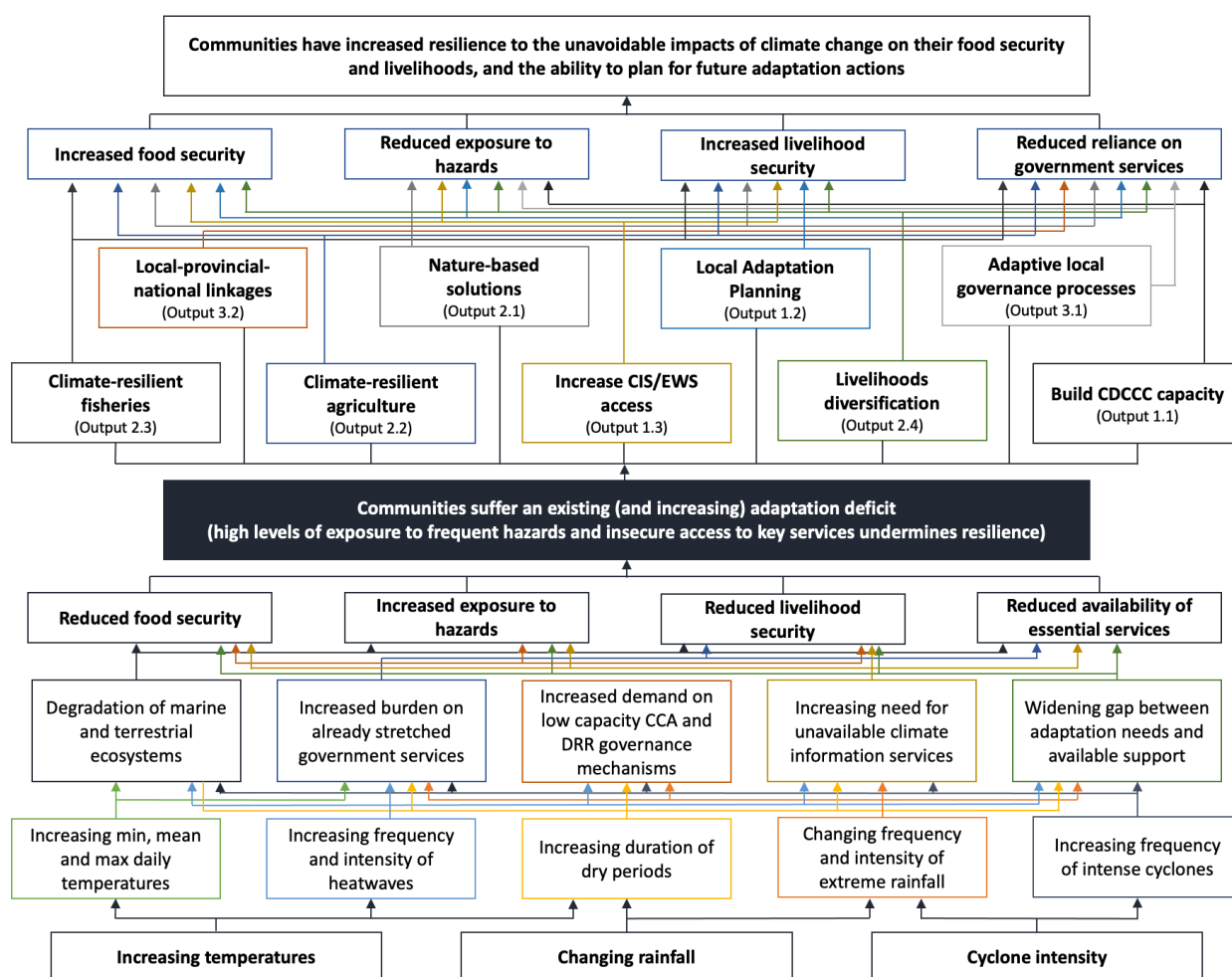


Figure 8.1. Impact and response chains for each climate driver and project output

B.4. Implementation arrangements (max. 1500 words, approximately 3 pages plus diagrams)

125. The legal agreement between the GCF and Save the Children Australia (SCA) as Accredited Entity (AE) will be a grant agreement through a FAA. SCA, as the AE, will enter into legally binding sub-grant agreements with the Co-Executing Entities – the Government of Vanuatu, acting through its Ministry of Climate Change (MoCC), and Save the Children Vanuatu (SCV) – to deliver the agreed project activities. MoCC will enter into agreements with other Government ministries including Ministry of Internal Affairs, Ministry of Agriculture, Livestock, Forestry, Fisheries and Biosecurity, Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources, and Ministry of Justice and Community Services. Formal project agreements with other ministries will be managed through both the established 'Government Investment Program' (GIP) system as well and intergovernmental MoUs between MoCC and other government ministries and departments. The GIPs outlines and formalizes: (1) the project; (2) the sources and destination of funds; (3) detailed budget; (4) specifics of project objectives and activities; (5) beneficiaries; (6) monitoring mechanisms; and (7) risk and risk management. The GIP system is integrated into the Government Financial Management Information System (FMIS) and linked to the Single Treasury Account (STA) for oversight and reporting against project expenditure. Project funded activities not delivered through Government Ministries or the EEs will be undertaken through procured parties, e.g. specialized technical constancies. The MoUs will outline the accountability of other government ministries to the MoCC in the delivery of the activities. They will include the cascading of GCF and Save the Children Australia (SCA as AE) compliance requirements and project activity implementation coordination and reporting. The GIPs will be annexes to the MoUs. No funds will be directly disbursed to community members in cash. All relevant goods and services will be

procured by the co-EEs or government partners. Note: any investment income earned on interest from the EEs GCF Bank accounts will be reflowed into the GCF project.

126. Project implementation will be facilitated by the key stakeholder departments contained within the various ministries, specifically including the Department of Climate Change (DoCC), Department of Local Authorities (DLA), Department of Agriculture and Rural Development (DARD), Vanuatu Fisheries Department (VFD), Department of Water Resources (DoWR), Department of Women's Affairs (DWA), Vanuatu Meteorology and Geo-Hazards Department (VMGD), and the National Disaster Management Office (NDMO). With sub-national government officials and extension offices to deliver agreed components of the adaptation package. Save the Children Vanuatu will also deliver several activities, such as community-level adaptation actions partnering with provincial governments, private sector and civil society partners in all six provinces. The MoCC will retain overall responsibility for the implementation of the project.
127. Agreements between the co-Executing Entities and beneficiary communities will be captured in the Community Adaptation Plans before investments are made in the communities. The plans are developed, finalized and agreed by the communities supported by the CDCCs and project staff. Once agreed they are approved by the Executing Entities. Once approved, they are implemented as outlined in the plans.
128. Save the Children Vanuatu (SCV) and the MoCC will work with other government ministries and procured parties to deliver agreed national-level activities. Where required civil society and private sector entities will be engaged by SCV as procedure parties to deliver project activities where they have a comparative advantage in consultation with the Vanuatu Chamber of Commerce and the Vanuatu Climate Action Network (VCAN), and in coordination with the NAB.
129. Co-financing from the Government of Australia will be managed through a grant agreement to SCA. A sub-grant agreement will be put in place between SCA to SCV managed through the Save the Children Award Management System (AMS). Funds will flow from SCA to SCV in the same way as all SCA to SCV projects from the SCA account in Australia to the SCV account in Port Vila. Compliance oversight and reporting is managed and documented through the AMS.
130. Co-financing from the Government of Vanuatu to the project is managed through the GIP system (outlined above in paragraph 125), integrated into the Government Financial Management Information System (FMIS), and linked to the Single Treasury Account (STA) for oversight and reporting against project expenditure.
131. The co-Executing Entities will work together through a single Project Management Unit (PMU) and technical team established in Port Vila, within the Department of Climate Change (DoCC). The PMU will maintain clear lines of communication between the project and the NDA/GoV; manage project implementation; undertake project-wide M&E; provide technical support to implementing partners on climate change impacts, adaptation and integration processes, Environmental and Social Safeguard (ESS) (including monitoring the project's environmental performance and supporting the integration of gender, disability and social inclusion); lead communication and outreach activities; and lead coordination and cooperation with other projects, donors and organizations (see *Figures 9 and 9.1*, below).

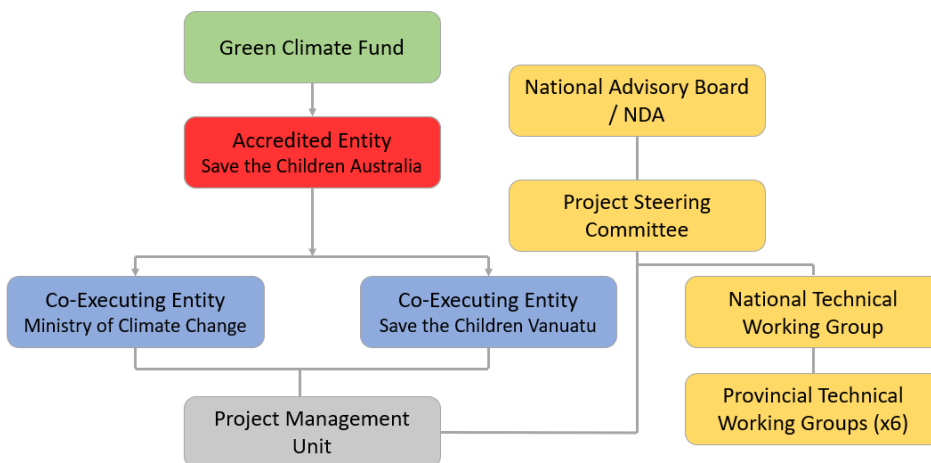


Figure 9. Diagram showing the governance arrangements for VCCR

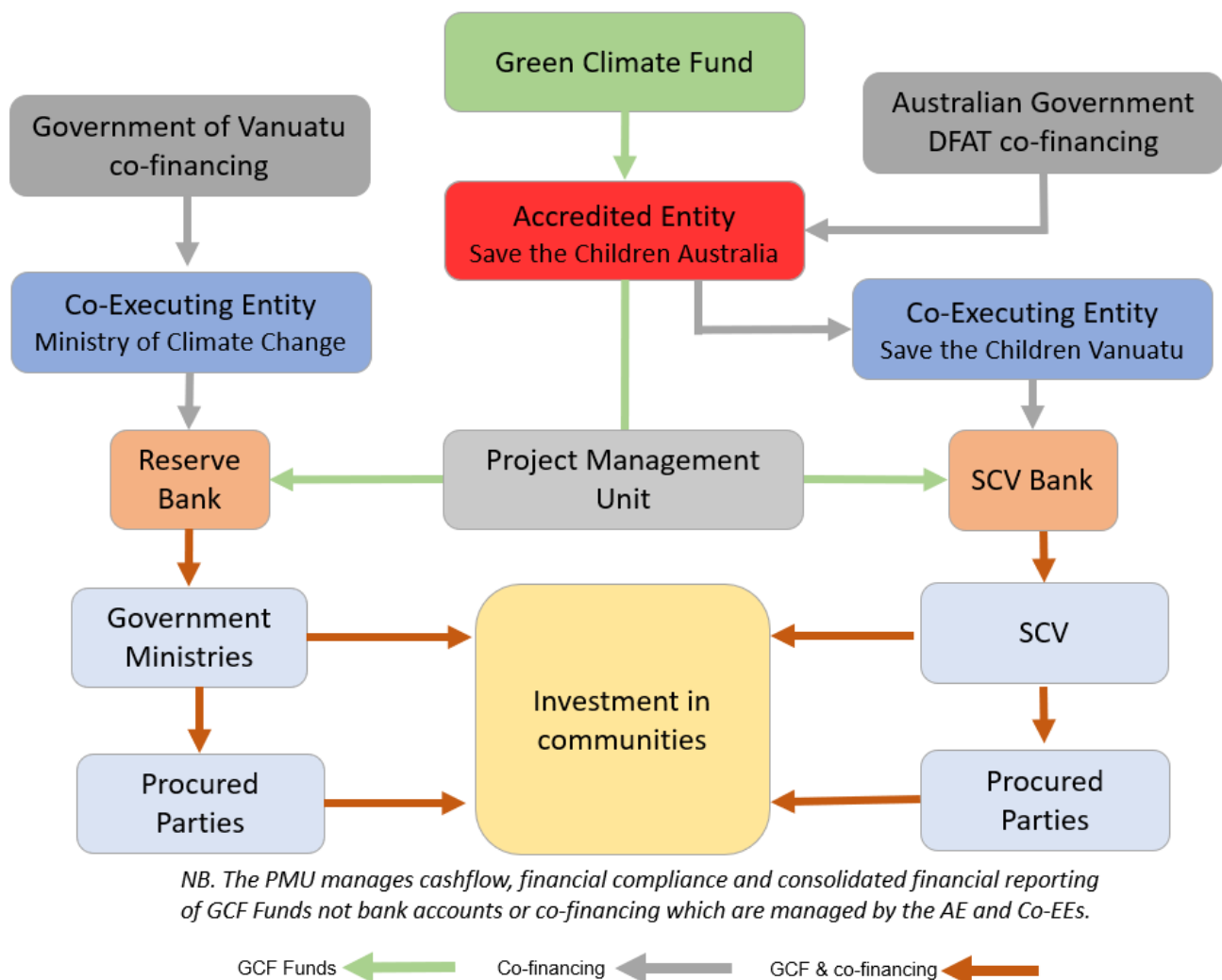


Figure 9.1. Diagram showing the flow of funds for VCCR

132. The PMU will be led by a Team Leader reporting to the SCV Country Director and Director-General (DG) for Ministry of Climate Change. The Team Leader will line manage the other PMU members including a Finance and Compliance Specialist, Procurement Specialist, MEAL Specialist, ESS/GESI Specialist, Communications Specialist, Component Coordinators and Technical Advisers.

133. A Project Steering Committee (PSC) will be formed and will be responsible for overall strategic oversight of the project. The PSC will support strategic high-level coordination and oversight and promote the interests of the project among senior country and regional level stakeholders. The PSC will also provide a high-level risk management function by reviewing and providing feedback on performance reports produced by the PMU. It will make decisions on critical project issues raised by Technical Working Groups (TWG's) including amendments, budget allocations and endorsing management improvement actions arising from audits and addressing serious project quality and implementation issues (including major complaints and feedback that pose a reputational risk to the project, such as sensitive safeguarding issues that cannot be addressed by TWG). Project performance reports and outcomes from PSC meetings will be shared with the NAB to promote strong coordination and transparency.
134. The PSC will be co-chaired by DG for Ministry of Climate Change and Country Director for SCV and will be comprised of all agency Directors involved in project implementation (DoCC, DLA, DARD, VFD, VMGD, NDMO, DoWR, DWA), Secretary Generals of provincial governments, VCCRP PMU Team Lead, and Representatives of Vanuatu Climate Action Network and Vanuatu Business Resilience Council. It is proposed that the PSC will meet twice each year (with extraordinary meetings called as required).
135. The NDA for Vanuatu is the Director General for the Ministry of Climate Change (DG MoCC). As the MoCC is also the EE the DG MoCC has both NDA and EE accountabilities. However, the work of the DG MoCC as NDA is governed by the National Advisory Board (NAB) which is the decision-making mechanism. The NAB is chaired by the DG MoCC but is a whole of government body with representative from across Ministries. The role of the DG MoCC as EE for the project is governed by the PSC with oversight for the Minister of MoCC. Conflict of interest is avoided by both mechanisms being mandated as multi-stakeholder decision making bodies.
136. The PSC shall report and provide updates to the NAB when it meets 3-4 times per year. The NAB is responsible for bringing leaders of government and non-government organizations across all sectors together to promote greater levels of coordination among the many individual climate change and disaster risk reduction projects. The NAB remains independent of the VCCRP and the project will support the functionality of the NAB through technical support to the NAB Secretariat and ensure the PSC is accountable to the NAB throughout the project duration.
137. A National Technical Working Group (NTWG) will be established to provide operational and technical oversight during implementation of the project. The NTWG will meet quarterly to provide feedback to the PMU on project performance reports, review and approve project documents prepared by the PMU and to address critical issues, discuss and provide feedback on recommendations from provincial technical working group meetings and address major operational and project quality issues impacting delivery (including significant complaints and feedback from communities and project stakeholders). The NTWG will be comprised of technical implementing officials from key government and non-government agencies (not senior management / Director level positions).
138. Provincial Technical Working Groups (PTWG) will also be formed in each province. This body will replicate the function of the NTWG at the provincial level and will provide bottom-up feedback on project quality and implementation issues to the NTWG. This group will also meet on a quarterly basis and will be co-chaired by the Provincial Secretary Generals and the Save the Children Provincial Program Manager. The PTWGs will be comprised of the members of the provincial Technical Advisory Commissions (TAC) and attended by relevant provincial authorities such as Area Administrators and Community Liaison Officers as required.
139. The proposed implementation structure for project operations is provided in *Figure 10*, below. Note The EEs will maintain final decision-making in respect of the implementation of the Project activities.

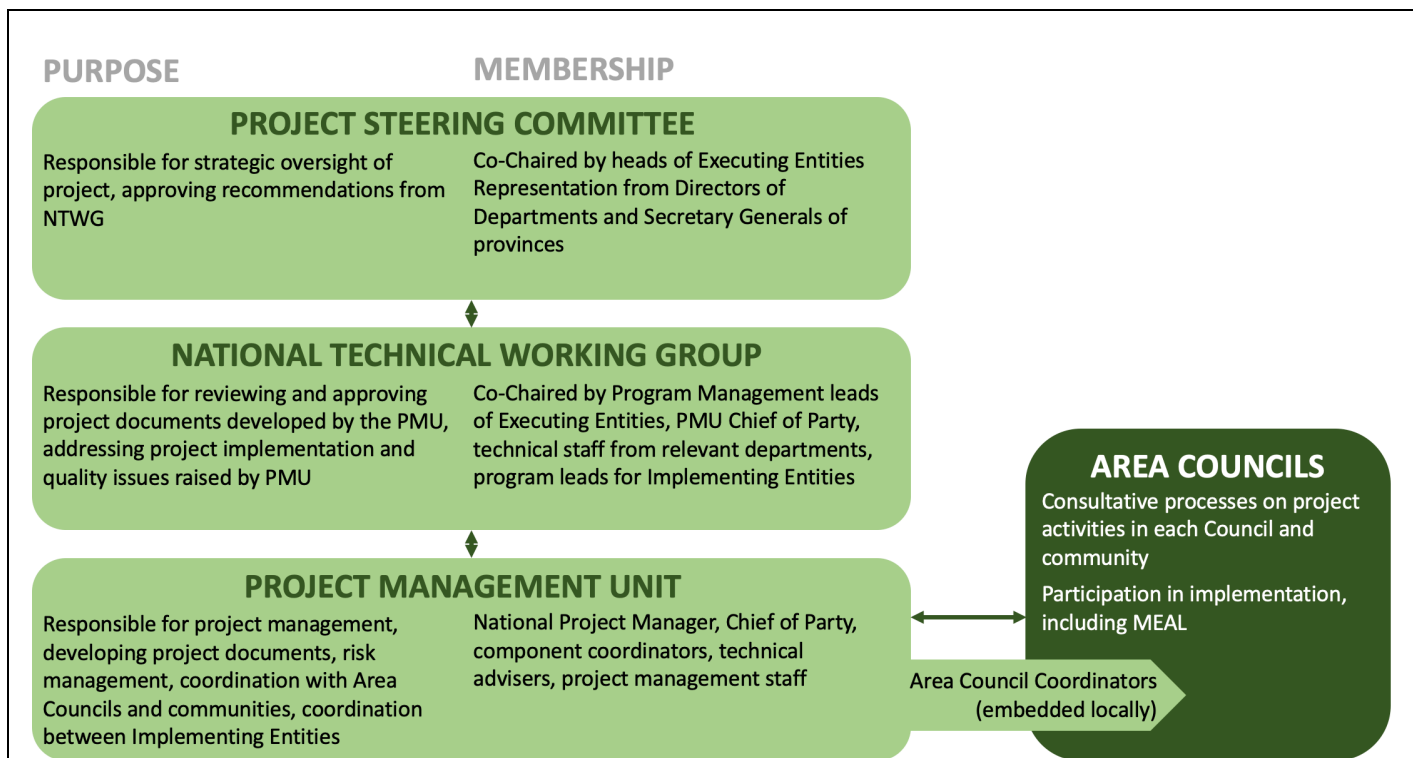


Figure 10. Proposed implementation structure for project operations

Accredited Entity Capacity: experience and track record

140. Save the Children is the world's leading independent organization for children, with 30 national organizations working together to deliver programs in more than 120 countries. In 2019, Save the Children delivered programs worth over USD 2.2 billion across 117 countries and directly reached over 38.7 million children. Our vision is a world in which every child attains the right to survival, protection, development and participation. Our mission is to inspire breakthroughs in the way the world treats children, and to achieve immediate and lasting change in their lives. Globally, Save the Children is implementing a portfolio of 100+ resilience-related projects and programmes valued at more than USD 200 million, including those with explicit objectives to reduce climate and disaster risks, as well as to increase adaptive capacity and speed recovery from shocks and stresses, as well as those which seek the social and economic empowerment of women and youth and the amplification of the voices of the most marginalized.
141. Save the Children Australia (SCA) was accredited to the GCF in November 2019 on behalf of the global Save the Children movement. SCA were chosen to lead on the GCF for Save the Children due to our longstanding leadership role in climate change and Disaster Risk Reduction. The Accreditation Master Agreement (AMA) was made effective in May 2020.
142. SCA has extensive experience of designing, delivering, evaluating and documenting approaches to community-based adaptation, including in Vanuatu, where we have worked for more than 25 years. Our approach is to support governments to deliver against their adaptation policy objectives and needs bringing a consultative approach to engaging a broad range of stakeholders, including communities, in the design of climate change interventions.

Executing Entities Capacity: experience and track record

143. The project is closely aligned to, and supportive of, key national and sector policies and strategies in Vanuatu. The project will have two Executing Entities: the Vanuatu MoCC and Save the Children Vanuatu (SCV). Both entities have extensive experience in managing and delivering climate change programs across Vanuatu at a range of scales and from a variety of funding sources (including the Global Environment Facility (GEF), the Climate Investment Funds (CIF), the Australian aid program, the World Bank and the GCF). SCV is managed by SCA and utilizes the AE's systems and processes.

The Vanuatu MoCC is the co-executing entity for GCF FP035 (via the Department of Meteorology and Geohazards) and is the executing entity for a number of donor-funded projects, including via the GEF. A review of climate public expenditure and institutional governance in 2014 identified several gaps in the delivery of climate change investment in Vanuatu, particularly as the newly established Ministry of Climate Change had not administered any climate change projects⁴¹. Since then, the government has made a concerted effort to address any capacity shortfalls, particularly focusing on the recommendations of the capacity assessment that suggested medium- and long-term actions to improve the governance of climate change and DRR funding through institutional capacity building. These actions have been supported by the dedicated M&E Unit within the Prime Minister's Office and significant progress and improvements have been made in the country's capacity to deliver large-scale climate change projects.

144. To ensure that the project can commence on time and meet agreed timelines and milestones, SCA will work closely with the co-Executing Entities to ensure that processes and approvals are in place at all levels. Save the Children has a history of delivering quality projects across a range of sectors in Vanuatu. Key government partners have staff in place within each province who can be mobilized to support project start up. Existing networks and relationships at the province level will ensure a smooth start up and on-time implementation. Further, the project has been designed to prevent over burdening any one government delivery partner to avoid straining absorptive capacity and creating capacity constraints that delay project implementation. This is a key lesson from the implementation of a range of previous projects, including FP035. Working with a range of relevant departments will ensure no one department creates funding bottlenecks as has been the experience with some previous projects. The project will also provide direct technical assistance to Government departments and other delivery partners and will be supported through Save the Children's systems and national footprint. The breadth of the project will also help ensure community capacity is not overwhelmed. Working across all six provinces will enable us to spread the investment across space and time.
145. A recent organizational review of SC-Vanuatu highlighted challenges in a few areas of capacity and procedures. These include issues with oversight of controls for child safeguarding; a lack of sufficient prioritization of humanitarian preparedness; gaps in risk identification and monitoring processes; and inadequate management oversight over key controls due to some outdated policies and procedures. Due to the relationship between Save the Children Australia and SC-Vanuatu, Save the Children Australia will work with Save the Children Vanuatu to establish a remedial action plan and tracking mechanism as well as provide on-going support in these areas at the organizational level (not just for GCF project staff) before and during GCF project implementation to support capacity development and reduce risks. Tracking the delivery of the remedial action plan will be included as a standing item on the Senior Management Team (SMT) quarterly meeting until completed. The expected completion date of the necessary action for the above-mentioned shortcomings is March 2022.
146. Save the Children Australia completed an initial partnership assessment for The Government of Vanuatu represented by the Ministry of Climate Change (MoCC) in October 2021. The data collected for the assessment included a review of related policies, a 2020 Public Finance Management Assessment by the Australian Department of Foreign Affairs and Trade for the Department of Education and Government of Vanuatu overall, and discussions with MoCC staff. The assessment found that MoCC has the experience and expertise to carry out the scope of work outlined in the project successfully. The results of the assessment highlighted that Save the Children should work together with the Government of Vanuatu and MoCC partners to better understand the strength of financial systems, including planning and budgeting, reporting, controls, and staffing. Similarly, while the team reviewed the Ministry of Finance and Economic Management (MFEM) and MoCC procurement guidelines, which were deemed to be adequate as outlined in their procumbent manuals, the team was unable to confirm how these policies and procedures are followed on a day-to-day basis. While the review identified no red flag risks, Save the Children will continue to collaborate with MoCC and plans to update the partner assessment on an ongoing basis including undertaking an additional compliance review of the consistency of the application of the guidelines prior to the commencement of this project.

⁴¹ Government of Vanuatu (2014) *Climate public expenditure and institutional review report*, Vanuatu. Available [here](#).

B.5. Justification for GCF funding request (max. 1000 words, approximately 2 pages)

147. To date, the majority of climate change adaptation projects in Vanuatu have either worked at the national level on capacity building and policy development or piloted community-based approaches in relatively small numbers of communities. The one large project that took a comprehensive approach to community-based adaptation (CBA) across the country is the GEF-supported Vanuatu Coastal Adaptation Project (VCAP, Phase 1), although CBA interventions were limited to a handful of islands. This trend holds true for the broader Pacific region and across the developing world, where the vast majority of CBA initiatives have been small scale, short term and of limited reach. Notable examples of on-going climate change adaptation (CCA) projects in Vanuatu (including those in late-design phase and closing/phasing out) are provided in **Annex 2**.
148. As outlined in **Section D.5**, adaptation, including CBA, is the key component of Vanuatu's national and sub-national response to climate change. As also noted, accessing finance to support CBA actions at the scale required to create transformational change has been difficult for governments and civil society. Communities in Vanuatu are some of the least responsible for the emissions that are causing climate change, but they are among the first to suffer the impacts and will feel these impacts more acutely than people in wealthier, less hazard-exposed countries⁴². The Government struggles to balance the broad range of adaptation priorities (from protecting critical economic infrastructure to building local climate resilience). This project will work to increase the accessibility of global climate finance to local communities. There is a clear argument for high co-finance and private sector engagement in mitigation action. The argument for poor countries to finance their own adaptation actions in response to a problem stemming from the unregulated use of the global commons, or to take out concessional loans to do so, is less clear. It is even less strong when the ultimate beneficiaries are communities on low-lying islands facing an ever-harsher climate not of their own making. Investing in CBA delivers significant benefits for communities across many development sectors, but governments struggle to find the resources to meet current development needs within communities, let alone proactively address anticipated future climate change impacts. The funding amount requested from the GCF for this project is commensurate with the scale of the problem and the Vanuatu Government's desire to take a coordinated nation-wide approach to addressing community adaptation needs.
149. Despite global climate finance continuing to increase over time the amount allocated to adaptation has remained relatively static in recent years, at around USD 20-30 billion (10-15% of public climate finance, but less than 5% of total climate finance).⁴³ While it is difficult to accurately account for the total flow of climate finance to the community level, a recent assessment estimated that less than 10% of climate finance flowing from dedicated multilateral, bilateral and regional climate funds between 2003 and 2016 was "approved for locally focused climate change projects."⁴⁴ The assessment estimated this figure was around USD 1.5 billion, of which around USD 1.3 billion was allocated to CBA activities – equating to an average of USD 93 million allocated to CBA annually since 2003. This represents a tiny proportion (around 0.02%) of total global climate flows. This rises to just under 0.4% when taken as a percentage of public climate finance flows for adaptation – still an insignificant number compared to the known needs at the community level.
150. Within these total flows, some funds and donors have attempted to prioritize CBA, but only at small scale or in competition with other priorities. For example, the GEF has a dedicated community-based mechanism – the Small Grants Programme (SGP), which channels funding direct to communities and civil society groups for a range of issues, including adaptation. The SGP is an excellent and well-regarded mechanism; however, individual grants are capped at USD 50,000, necessarily resulting in very small-scale pilot activities. In Vanuatu, for example, the SGP has supported 60 projects since 2007 with total funding of USD 2.3 million – averaging at USD 38,000 per project. Projects at this scale can have a significant impact on local lives, but they are not likely to result in transformational change.

⁴² The Government of Vanuatu has noted, including in its NDC, that significant external financing will be required if the country is to effectively manage the unavoidable impacts of climate change.

⁴³ Buchner et al. 2019. *Global landscape of climate finance 2019*, Climate Policy Initiative. Available [here](#).

⁴⁴ Soanes et al. (2017) *Delivering real change: Getting international climate finance to the local level*, IIED Working Paper. Available [here](#).

151. With the scale of need at the local level growing and the majority of donors choosing to remain focused on national level programmes, there is a significant gap in climate finance that the GCF is well positioned to fill. Investing in CBA is not likely to be a high priority for many governments with scarce resources and competing interests, particularly in the face of patchy documented evidence of the impacts of community-based approaches working at scale and driving transformative change.
152. Without substantial investment from a mechanism like the GCF, CBA is likely to remain a small scale, pilot approach that struggles to make an impact beyond individual communities. With GCF investment, the government of Vanuatu will be able scale up community-based approaches to drive transformational changes in the way adaptation is conceived, from the bottom up, and provide the donor community with the evidence they need to proactively invest in participatory approaches to building community resilience. The Government of Vanuatu is committed to CBA approaches; however, domestic resources are insufficient to take CBA to scale, and bilateral donors are spread across a wide range of sectors and are unlikely to focus sufficient resources to catalyze scale in CBA.
153. There is a strong justification for the GCF funding request. The additional burdens on communities' resilience from the increasingly evident impacts of climate change are already significant and will only grow over time. Sudden onset events, like TC Pam and TC Harold, have resulted in economic devastation across the country (with the impact of TC Pam alone estimated to be USD 450 million or 64% of Vanuatu's GDP), with remote and rural communities particularly affected. The need for these communities to have substantially increased climate resilience is clear as the global emissions profile is only slowly bending downward and is currently not on track to achieve the Paris Agreement's goal of keeping global temperatures well below 2°C. The project will work nation-wide, reaching 44% of the rural population (which is in itself 75% of the country's total population). A further 110,000 rural people will be indirectly reached – increasing the project's total reach to 95% of the rural population. Meeting the adaptation and resilience needs of these communities is critical, relatively expensive, and funding is not available via other mechanisms.
154. It is clear that the Government of Vanuatu does not currently have sufficient funding from any source (including domestic resources, donor funds and global climate finance) to meet immediate adaptation needs at the local level, particularly as the island nation has a highly decentralized and dispersed population. It is equally clear that donor funds are not an adequate source of CBA finance, as they are shorter term and smaller scale. Grant funding is the most appropriate level of concessionally for CBA activities as they are not of interest to the private sector finance and contain no direct repayment capacity. CBA activities that are not funded directly by government or cannot be self-funded by communities are not viable without external assistance. In the context of Vanuatu, the government does not have the capacity to meet adaptation needs and rural communities do not have the resources to self-support required adaptation actions.

B.6. Exit strategy (max. 500 words, approximately 1 page)

155. The VCCRP adaptation packages, under **Component 2**, are designed to be modular and scalable. Specific activities can be increased, decreased or removed, depending on community circumstances. This makes the package approach highly tailored to direct beneficiary needs and transferable to the remaining communities in Vanuatu (indirect beneficiaries). Activities under **Components 1 and 3** are designed to ensure the sustainability of the adaptation package actions and help government to support a scale out of the approach over time.
156. Consultation with DLA during the feasibility study identified opportunities during implementation to have CDCCCs captured in the Decentralization Act and formally recognized in the service delivery structure as a way of getting them sustainable resourcing and supported. This is a key outcome the project will support by strengthening and demonstrating the value of the CDCCCs.
157. The governance capacity building activities in **Component 3**, provide further potential for government and/or future climate finance to use the same menu and support further menu items in the same communities (along with scaling out to further communities).
158. Six key sustainability strategies will be employed to ensure project impact will be sustained over time:
 - **Building the evidence base to advocate for the national government to allocate future climate finance and other resources to support locally driven adaptation actions. CBA**

projects have proved highly successful. However, many have been small scale and have struggled to gain traction beyond targeted communities. This project aims to build a substantial evidence base of the impact of CBA when taken to scale across the entire country. This will increase the likelihood of future climate finance flows in Vanuatu including an allocation to support CBA activities. This will be achieved via activities in **Component 3** (i.e. 3.2.1), the project's MEAL (including an impact evaluation) and broader AE activities. The project will deliver 40 knowledge products to a range of stakeholders. The project will also work to support the Department of Local Authorities (DLA) to have at least 50% of the new staff hired for the project at the sub-national taken on as permanent staff in the DLA at the provincial and or Area Council level.

- **Allocation of national budget resources to local adaptation actions.** The project will work with provincial governments to integrate the risks of climate change as well as current and future adaptation actions into local planning and budgetary processes such that experiences in selected communities and Area Councils can be upscaled to other areas of the province, sharing lessons learned with NAB and other national stakeholders to foster scaling up of the actions on a national scale. Having adaptation actions included in formal budget submissions will increase visibility of the needs and capacities of communities and increase the likelihood of domestic resources being allocated to sustaining the impact of the project over time. A key aim of this project is to ensure communities are better positioned to access domestic resources for adaptation action. As Vanuatu's economy gets back on track and resumes projected growth trajectories post COVID-19, adaptation priorities at the community level may find domestic funding sources such that the experience of the project can be applied elsewhere in the country. Despite this, international climate finance will remain a key source of adaptation support for the foreseeable future. A further key aim of this project is to ensure communities and sub-national governments are better positioned to access future flows of climate finance for adaptation action regardless of the source. The project will deliver training to 145 government staff on integrating climate change risks and adaptation actions into local and provincial budgeting processes and support targeted officials to undertake adaptive budgeting processes during project implementation to influence future processes. The project's aim to have at least 50% of local level project staff maintained as permanent DLA staff by the project's conclusion, will also help increase local level capacity to access and utilize future flows of climate finance.
- **Promoting local ownership.** All activities implemented at the community level will be based on community stakeholder engagement combined with climate impact information. Communities will determine how to implement and sustain the adaptation actions (from the adaptation package). This ownership over project activity implementation at the community level will increase the likelihood that activity outputs and outcomes will be sustained beyond the life of the project. Stronger and more resilient food systems will reduce the impact of tropical cyclones and reduce the economic cost of rebuilding. Previous experience in developing and implementing CBA activities in Vanuatu and beyond has shown that the more engaged and in control community stakeholders are in how activities are implemented the more likely the outcomes are to be sustained and replicated. This approach is also in line with the Principles for Locally-led Adaptation⁴⁵, developed by a partnership of peers formed under the Global Commission on Adaptation. Save the Children has endorsed the principles and will endeavour to fulfil them in our climate finance projects.
- **Ensure financial sustainability of the project.** The project will aim to maximize GCF financing to address inevitable on-going operation and maintenance (O&M) related expenses associated with introduced adaptation technologies (including solar PV freezers and solar air driers) to reduce the likelihood of negative externalities such as equipment falling into disrepair or breaking down. Detailed strategies are included in the project activities that include training for target communities on installation, operation, maintenance and repair of all equipment, and budget to provide spare parts or training in using local materials for repairs and maintenance. This guidance on post-sale/installation O&M considerations will also be supplied to the DoCC on the selection and procurement of adaptation technology services for use in communities. Targeted trainings will also be provided to address long-term maintenance and operation challenges. A further key component

⁴⁵ See <https://www.iied.org/principles-for-locally-led-adaptation>

of financial sustainability is the capacity of beneficiaries to maintain/expand project-supported adaptation actions over time beyond the life of the project. In the Vanuatu context, for remote and rural communities, the reality is that government support will be needed long term to support local level adaptation action. The project will work with government at all levels to increase capacity to access and effectively utilize future flows of climate finance, while also supporting communities to develop clearly articulated and prioritized adaptation plans, which include key investment options and opportunities. Supporting local producer groups to access markets for processed and preserved food products will also help increase incomes, increasing funds available for local adaptation actions. The project will foster at least six partnerships between producer groups and private sector entities as examples that can be scaled out by industry actors with ongoing VCCI support.

- **Build capacity of government and civil society systems to enable improved service delivery of future climate adaptation initiatives.** The project will support the strengthening of existing government and civil society systems and staff, strengthening the nationally endorsed decentralized approach rather than re-organizing arrangements or introducing new structures. For example, fiduciary arrangements for the project will utilize a de-centralized financial management approach relying on pre-existing line structures located in the Corporate Service Units of each Ministry. Similarly, the project will utilize Area Council structures and processes for implementation at the community level. The utilization and strengthening of these existing government systems (which may vary in effectiveness currently amongst Ministries and Area Councils) will provide improved capacity for national service delivery in the future. The project will help build strong coordination mechanisms within the 29 targeted Area Councils and increase the effectiveness of local-provincial-national connections and feedback loops. Increased connectivity of CDCCCs (via satellite internet connectivity supported by the project) is key to this increased coordination and cooperation, as real time data and information can flow in both directions. The connectivity will be sustainably financed by a) a government commitment to enhanced CDCCC connectivity and b) the ability of CDCCCs to on-sell unused data allocations to community members for a range of purposes – including the potential for online study programs linked to other adaptation actions and market engagement. The project's aim to have at least 50% of local level project staff maintained as permanent DLA staff by the project's conclusion, will also help increase local level capacity to deliver adaptation services over the longer term.
- **Foster sustainable value chains in the local market.** Food surpluses from agriculture and fisheries will be preserved and marketed through national private sector entities. Food surpluses are expected to be generated due to improvements in agricultural and fisheries practices, including through access to improved CIS, as well as significantly reduced losses from excess production and improved handling of produce. Food preservation is essential due to the long distances and limited transportation options between the project sites and the main commercial and residential hubs of Vanuatu. Establishing the value chains ensures a small but steady supply of income to the community with which the operation and maintenance of the installed processing technologies can be supported over the long term. Once communities have realized the potential of marketing food surpluses, this may lead to autonomous growth without the need for further external financial support, especially through fostering of twinning arrangements between local producers and private enterprises in the food sector. For the private sector entities, engagement in the project and the creation of new commodity supply lines is expected to aid in the green economic recovery following the COVID-19 pandemic. Further, in collaboration with the VCCI, private sector partnerships will be identified and established to further support community-level enterprise and enhance access to markets, and, where possible, support producer groups to transition into micro or small enterprises (including support to identify longer term sources of finance for business development).

159. The project's implementation arrangements with co-execution by government and Save the Children, will promote sustainability through: 1) increasing line ministry and provincial governments' capacity to support adaptation at the community level; 2) substantially strengthening local implementation structures to ensure they are ready and able to identify local adaptation needs; and 3) the enduring links Save the Children has with communities in Vanuatu. Furthermore, the project will aim to have at

least 50% of the new staff hired for the project at the sub national level transferred to and taken on as permanent staff in the Department of Local Authorities (DLA) at the provincial and or area council levels. This will further embed the skills and project experience into government systems and structures supporting long-term sustainability by enhancing the government ability to manage future adaptation programming irrespective of the source of funding.

160. Any assets purchased for project implementation will be procured by government or handed over to key implementing agencies in the Vanuatu national government or Area Councils towards the end of implementation as will be mandated in a comprehensive Exit Strategy to be developed during the initial stages of implementation.
161. The planned VCCRP adaptation package and activities will continue to be scaled-out by implementing partners in the future after the project is completed as activities are designed to be modular and scalable. Specific activities can be increased, decreased or removed, depending on community circumstances. Thus, the package approach is tailored to meet direct beneficiary needs and is transferable to all rural communities in Vanuatu (indirect beneficiaries). Activities under **Components 2 and 3** are designed to ensure the sustainability of the adaptation package actions and help government to support a scaling-up of the approach over time.

C. FINANCING INFORMATION						
C.1. Total financing						
(a) Requested GCF funding (i + ii + iii + iv + v + vi + vii)	Total amount			Currency		
	26,182,878			million USD (\$)		
GCF financial instrument	Amount	Tenor	Grace period	Pricing		
(i) Senior loans	<u>Enter amount</u>	<u>Enter years</u>	<u>Enter years</u>	<u>Enter %</u>		
(ii) Subordinated loans	<u>Enter amount</u>	<u>Enter years</u>	<u>Enter years</u>	<u>Enter %</u>		
(iii) Equity	<u>Enter amount</u>	<u>Enter years</u>		<u>Enter %</u> equity return		
(iv) Guarantees	<u>Enter amount</u>					
(v) Reimbursable grants	<u>Enter amount</u>					
(vi) Grants	26,182,878					
(vii) Results-based payments	<u>Enter amount</u>					
(b) Co-financing information	Total amount			Currency		
	6,467,562			million USD (\$)		
Name of institution	Financial instrument	Amount	Currency	Tenor & grace	Pricing	Seniority
Australian Department of Foreign Affairs and Trade	<u>Grant</u>	<u>4,625,040</u>	<u>million USD (\$)</u>	<u>Enter years</u> <u>Enter years</u>	<u>Enter%</u>	<u>Options</u>
Government of Vanuatu	<u>In kind</u>	<u>1,541,230</u>	<u>million USD (\$)</u>	<u>Enter years</u> <u>Enter years</u>	<u>Enter%</u>	<u>Options</u>
Save the Children Australia	<u>Grant</u>	<u>301,292</u>	<u>million USD (\$)</u>	<u>Enter years</u> <u>Enter years</u>	<u>Enter%</u>	<u>Options</u>
(c) Total financing (c) = (a)+(b)	Amount			Currency		
	<u>32,650,440</u>			<u>million USD (\$)</u>		
(d) Other financing arrangements and contributions (max. 250 words, approximately 0.5 page)	Parallel financing: United Nations Development Programme / Global Environment Facility (USD 12.5 million) 162. UNDP is in the final stages of design and approval for the second phase of the GEF-funded Vanuatu Coastal Adaptation Project. Phase 1 was completed in 2019. Phase 2 (VCAP-2), which aims to improve the resilience of vulnerable areas and communities to the impacts of climate change through the conservation of biodiversity and natural ecosystems, will commence implementation in 2022. SCA and UNDP have collaborated on site selection to ensure no overlap of targeted communities. The two projects will cooperate closely during implementation to ensure complementarity of activities at the local level, sharing of lessons and outcomes, and ensuring that national and provincial level work under each project is well coordinated and mutually reinforcing.					

C.2. Financing by component

Please provide an estimate of the total cost per component and output as outlined in **Section B.3** above and disaggregate by source of financing. More than one co-financing institution can fund a single component or output. Provide the summarized cost estimates in the table below and the detailed budget plan as **Annex 4**.

Component	Output	Indicative cost Options	GCF financing		Co-financing		
			Amount million USD (\$)	Financial Instrument	Amount million USD (\$)	Financial Instrument	Name of Institutions
Component 1	Output 1.1	2,060,687	1,751,424	Grants	309,263	In Kind	Government of Vanuatu
	Output 1.2	1,401,149	1,196,775	Grants	204,374	In Kind	Government of Vanuatu
	Output 1.3	3,217,477	3,074,374	Grants	143,103	In Kind	Government of Vanuatu
Component 2	Output 2.1	4,388,046	4,176,602	Grants	211,444	In Kind	Government of Vanuatu
	Output 2.2	3,875,004	3,639,309	Grants	235,695	In Kind	Government of Vanuatu
	Output 2.3	1,450,329	1,321,402	Grants	128,927	In Kind	Government of Vanuatu
	Output 2.4	4,848,679	4,754,172	Grants	94,507	In Kind	Government of Vanuatu
Component 3	Output 3.1	6,968,283	2,227,622	Grants	4,625,040	Grants	Government of Australia
	Output 3.2	1,538,9922	1,440,696	Grants	115,621	In Kind	Government of Vanuatu
Component 4	Output 4.1	1,429,494	1,429,494	Grants			Government of Vanuatu
Project Management Component		1,472,300	1,171,008	Grants	301,292	Grants	Save the Children Australia
Indicative total cost (USD)		32,650,440	26,182,878		6,467,562		

This table should match the one presented in the term sheet and be consistent with information presented in other annexes including the detailed budget plan and implementation timetable.

In case of a multi-country/region programme, specify indicative requested GCF funding amount for each country in annex 17, if available.

C.3 Capacity building and technology development/transfer (max. 250 words, approximately 0.5 page)

C.3.1 Does GCF funding finance capacity building activities? Yes ☒ No ☐

C.3.2. Does GCF funding finance technology development/transfer? Yes ☒ No ☐

163. The project will build significant capacity among targeted beneficiaries across several key climate change related challenges. Outputs under **Component 1** will build knowledge and awareness of climate change impacts and locally-appropriate adaptation options as well as building local capacity to develop community adaptation plans. Outputs under **Component 2** include activities designed to build local capacity on climate-resilient agriculture and fisheries

techniques, as well as help communities diversify their livelihoods by building capacity around food preservation and development of value-add products. Low tech adaptation technologies (solar dryers and freezers) will be transferred to communities to facilitate the application of new capacity to local resilience building initiatives. Further capacity will be built at subnational and national levels to help ensure the integration of climate change risks and adaptation actions into Area Council and provincial planning processes, and to support the scale out of project activities to further Area Councils by government agencies.

164. The total budget allocated to capacity building activities across all project components is \$2,113,674.

165. The total budget for adaptation technology transfer under **Component 2** is \$1,632,075

Note on withholding tax. There is no withholding tax applicable to GCF funds transferred between the GCF and the AE in Australia and the EE's in Vanuatu.

D. EXPECTED PERFORMANCE AGAINST INVESTMENT CRITERIA

This section refers to the performance of the project/programme against the investment criteria as set out in the GCF's [Initial Investment Framework](#).

D.1. Impact potential (max. 500 words, approximately 1 page)

166. The project will make a contribution to the GCF's overarching adaptation impact – contributing to increased climate-resilient sustainable development – by directly increasing the climate resilience of 90,157 people in Vanuatu (33% of the total population / 44% of the rural population), focused on the most vulnerable and socially marginalized groups. Direct beneficiaries at community level will benefit from activities under **Component 2**, via implementation of the adaptation packages through the adoption of climate resilient agriculture, fisheries and diversified/enhanced livelihoods resilient to the conditions of flooding, storm surges, salinization, drought and heatwaves (marine and terrestrial); as well as from activities under **Components 1 and 3**. Direct beneficiaries at provincial and national levels will also benefit from activities under Components 1 and 3. Farmers and fishers will benefit from reduced vulnerability through the use of improved climate information services and early warning systems, adoption of resilient food production techniques, as well as income diversification. The project prioritizes measures to address the resilience needs of small farmers – who have limited access to markets, financial instruments, agricultural and climate technological advice and who suffer from poor basic infrastructure – and of vulnerable groups such as women, youth and people with disability. Beneficiary numbers were calculated via a systematic approach to beneficiary identification at Area Council level based on published statistics and data. Communities in 29 Area Councils across all six provinces will receive inputs selected from the adaptation package menu, based on their evolving needs and local context. More detailed information on beneficiary selection and targeting is in **Annexes 2 and 23**.
167. The project will contribute to several of the GCF's Fund-level adaptation and enabling environment outcomes including:
- **ARA1** Most vulnerable people and communities as it targets some of the most climate vulnerable remote and rural communities in Vanuatu with support to build adaptive capacity;
 - **ARA2** Health, well-being, food and water security as it will help significantly strengthen local-level climate resilience via increased food security, diversified livelihoods strategies and reduced disaster risk;
 - **ARA4** Ecosystems and ecosystem services as it will help protect and rehabilitate critical ecosystem services for local food security and livelihoods;
 - **Core indicator 5** (Degree to which GCF investments contribute to strengthening institutional and regulatory frameworks for low emission climate-resilient development pathways in a country-driven manner) by supporting development and implementation of sub-national level adaptation planning and implementation coordination mechanisms;
 - **Core indicator 6** (Degree to which GCF investments contribute to technology deployment, dissemination, development or transfer and innovation) by supporting introduction of climate resilient food production and processing tools, systems and technologies; and
 - **Core indicator 8** (Degree to which GCF investments contribute to effective knowledge generation and learning processes, and use of good practices, methodologies and standards)
168. The project will also increase the GCF's reach at the local level – highlighting the Fund's ability to directly impact the lives of vulnerable people with practical adaptation actions that measurably build climate resilience. The project will work nation-wide, reaching 44% of the rural population (which is in itself 75% of the country's total population). A further 110,000 rural people will be indirectly reached – increasing the project's total reach to 95% of the rural population. The entire population of Vanuatu (272,000 people) will ultimately benefit, as the project will operate nation-wide and will help improve structures and coherence for adaptation actions at all levels.

169. The project will result in substantial reductions in the risk of loss of lives and assets due to reduced exposure to extreme weather events; as well as a significant increase in the number of people adopting climate-resilient livelihoods options. It will also increase the number of households with year-round food security.
170. The project is aligned with the Updated Strategic Plan for the Green Climate Fund: 2020-2023, as contained in document GCF/B.27/21, particularly with regard to the vision (Promote the paradigm shift towards low-emission and climate-resilient development pathways in the context of sustainable development). The project directly contributes to the adaptation priorities of the Government, engages directly in design and implementation with local communities, including marginalized groups, and fosters engagement by the private sector through local value-chain development of primary food processing in the local communities.

D.2. Paradigm shift potential (max. 500 words, approximately 1 page)

171. The project will lead to a paradigm shift away from an agricultural system that is highly sensitive to climate change to climate-resilient food productive systems which ensure food and water security for farmers and fishers. Achieving reduced vulnerability and increased resilience requires a shift in agricultural and fisheries practices in Vanuatu. GCF funding will support this project to make remote communities resilient to the impacts of climate change, through a transformation in the way adaptation actions are conceived and implemented. Providing local communities with up-to-date climate information and projections; empowering them to make informed decisions about the nature, timing and type of adaptation actions they want to take; and resourcing them to follow through and feed results upward through governance structures to create a fundamental shift in the way adaptation is pursued. To date, a largely top-down approach to CBA has resulted in adaptation actions at the local level that are not community 'owned' and, therefore, not consistently maintained or sustained after project funding concludes.
172. The project will support many of the transformational success factors identified by the Government of Vanuatu in their GCF country programme⁴⁶, including: a demand-driven/bottom up approach that meets local community needs; a robust exit strategy; leveraging private sector expertise; fit-for purpose solutions (without maladaptation); transparent selection of project beneficiaries; transparent selection of delivery partners; integrated sectoral approach; capacity building; community-based small and medium enterprises (SMEs); communication and outreach; meaningful engagement with CSOs and NGOs; and integrating GCF and other climate finance into annual development programme, planning and policy.
173. The project aims to result in a step change in the scale at which CBA is conceived and implemented in Vanuatu and beyond. For CBA, the key paradigm shift is mobilizing resources at scale and with sufficient implementation time to ensure community structures are built and have the capacity to continue to operate effectively, with government support, beyond the life of the project. The project also aims for a transformation in the accessibility of climate finance at the community level. Too often climate finance hits bottlenecks at the national or provincial level. This project aims to ensure that communities are ready to access and effectively utilize future flows of climate finance from a range of sources. Lessons from this project will be applied in future CBA projects developed by Save the Children and communicated widely to the broader CBA community.
174. The project will help overcome information, technical, financial, social and institutional barriers that prevent a transition from conventional practices by delivering a package of proven and validated measures that will: improve the resilience of local production systems; increase the efficiency of agriculture and fisheries food and water management at the local level; and improve inter-institutional coordination and local governance capacity. The project is also transformative in its focus on promoting women's equitable representation in project activities and enabling greater economic empowerment and participation in decision making by women, youth and people with disability. The project will contribute to each of the GCF's assessment factors from the Investment Framework:
- **Potential for scale up and replication** – Taking CBA approaches to scale in one country will provide lessons and a platform for replication across different contexts. This model will seek to

⁴⁶ Government of Vanuatu (2018) Vanuatu's Climate Transformation with Green Climate Fund: Country Programme

prove that CBA approaches can work at scale and will set the foundations for a scale up across and between regions. The model could also be scaled to reach all remaining communities in Vanuatu via a combination of domestic resources and future climate finance.

- ***Institutional knowledge and learning*** – Part of each project component will be dedicated to knowledge sharing and learning engagement between national and sub-national government within Vanuatu. In particular, **Component 3** activities will support linkages across different levels of government within existing governance structures in Vanuatu and ultimately the knowledge generated will contribute to the broader CBA evidence base.
- ***Contribution to the creation of an enabling environment*** – In order to provide for the longer-term sustainability of any adaptation technologies provided to communities, the project will ensure adaptation package actions and implementation align with and support existing government systems and processes. Importantly, the project will ensure that government systems and processes are reflective of local needs and have the capacity to support them by strengthening the current vision of decentralization. This is a key paradigm shift in a country that has largely been governed under a centralized approach despite the dispersed and isolated population. Activities under Output 2.4 will help targeted communities diversify their livelihood options via supporting access to markets for agriculture/food commodities, creating new avenues for remote and rural communities to engage with private sector entities and increase the sustainability of project activities.
- ***Contribution to the regulatory framework and policies*** – Enhanced dialogue processes will help ‘reality check’ national policies and ensure they are targeted at effectively meeting the needs of communities as climate change impacts escalate. Working with communities and local government to integrate climate change risks and resilience building actions into development planning and budgeting processes will help catalyze a sustainable transition to locally resourced climate-responsive planning and development.
- ***Overall contribution to climate-resilient development pathways consistent with a country’s climate change adaptation strategies and plans*** – This project has a high potential for both scalability and replicability, aligned with, and designed to support achievement of the objectives of national policies. The adaptation package is designed to be scaled out over time to all rural communities, via local authorities. Provincial government officers, trained in climate focused stakeholder engagement and climate change integrated planning and budgeting, could extend the project to non-targeted communities. Within the region, the initial outcomes of this project will inform the development of the other projects addressing similar issues at the community level.

D.3. Sustainable development (max. 500 words, approximately 1 page)

175. Undertaking adaptation programming at the community level requires a holistic view of community needs and capacities. At the local level, the impacts of climate change are inextricably interconnected with broader development challenges. The evidence is clear that climate change impacts exacerbate existing development challenges and that, in the absence of significant adaptation action, sustainable development will be unachievable. CBA works directly at the local level to build community adaptive capacity by reducing vulnerability and increasing resilience to the current and projected impacts of climate change. One element of this work is to close existing adaptation deficits to ensure communities have a stable base from which to increase resilience to projected impacts and build adaptive capacity to ensure they can safeguard sustainable development outcomes.
176. The adaptation package includes actions with a range of economic, social, environmental and gender co-benefits, including:
- Increasing the household incomes of rural communities through livelihoods diversification and increasing access to markets (co-benefit 1);
 - Increasing broad community health outcomes by ensuring communities have more secure access to locally-available nutritious foods (co-benefit 2);
 - Increasing access to education by ensuring fewer school days lost in the aftermath of extreme weather events through adaptation planning and enhanced DRR action (co-benefit 3);

- Increasing the sustainability of ecosystem services by reducing reliance on vulnerable resources (e.g. reef fish) as a primary food source in rural coastal communities (co-benefit 4);
- Increasing gender equality across all areas of community life – with a specific focus on ensuring women’s voices are heard in climate-related decision-making forums and that the gendered nature of climate change impacts is a key component of all climate and development planning at community and province levels (co-benefit 5);
- Increasing social inclusion across all areas of community life – with a specific focus on ensuring voices of traditionally underrepresented groups (e.g. youth, people with a disability) are heard in climate-related decision-making forums (co-benefit 6).

177. The Monitoring and Evaluation (M&E) system of the project will ensure that the co-benefits will be monitored throughout implementation of the project and integrated with monitoring systems of the relevant Ministries and other public authorities, particularly the National Sustainability Development Plan (NSDP), and ultimately support the achievement of the NSDP. The M&E system, and the indicators to be monitored are fully described in **Annex 11**.

178. The project will make direct contributions to Vanuatu’s efforts to meet UN Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs):

- 2 (End hunger, achieve food security and improved nutrition and promote sustainable agriculture), particularly targets 2.1, 2.2, 2.3 and 2.4;
- 5 (Achieve gender equality and empower all women and girls), particularly targets 5.1, 5.5 and 5.b;
- 6 (Ensure availability and sustainable management of water and sanitation for all), particularly targets 6.3, 6.5 and 6.6;
- 11 (Make cities and human settlements inclusive, safe, resilient and sustainable), particularly target 11.5;
- 13 (Take urgent action to combat climate change and its impacts), particularly targets 13.1, 13.3 and 13.b;
- 14 (Conserve and sustainably use the oceans, seas and marine resources for sustainable development), particularly targets 14.2, 14.5 and 14.b; and
- 15 (Protect, restore and promote sustainable use of terrestrial ecosystems, sustainably manage forests, combat desertification, and halt and reverse land degradation and halt biodiversity loss), particularly targets 15.1, 15.2, 15.5, 15.8 and 15.9.

D.4. Needs of recipient (max. 500 words, approximately 1 page)

179. Vanuatu leads the world disaster risk index as the country with the highest disaster risk score of 49.74, indicating it is the most highly exposed to natural hazards. Accessing finance to address adaptation deficits and build community resilience to the current and anticipated impacts of climate change has posed a significant challenge in Vanuatu. As outlined in **Section B.5** above⁴⁷.

Absence of alternative sources of financing and need for strengthening institutions and capacity

180. While Vanuatu recently graduated from the LDC category to a lower middle-income country, it remains highly aid dependent⁴⁸. Domestic revenue remains insufficient to adequately fund essential services to a widely dispersed, largely rural population. Donor programs are generally focused on immediate development priorities (like economic growth, poverty reduction, health and education), with a relatively minor focus on climate change – and only a small number of programmes effectively integrating climate change risks and resilience building into core objectives. The capacity of line ministries to deliver services, particularly to remote islands, remains limited. While the Vanuatu Government has access to strong technical climate change capacity, the capacity to deliver

⁴⁷ Atteridge and Canales (2017) Climate finance in the Pacific: An overview of flows to the region’s Small Island Developing States. Stockholm Environment Institute, Working Paper 2017-04. Available [here](#).

⁴⁸ Vanuatu graduated from LDC status in 2020. While steadily increasing economic and social indicators are a positive sign for Vanuatu’s climate resilience, gains remain unevenly distributed and the most vulnerable people and communities will require adaptation assistance for the foreseeable future, particularly given the country’s significant exposure to extreme weather events and other hazards. Increasing domestic revenue streams will help increase the sustainability of project outcomes. The economic impact of COVID-19 and TC Harold (5 April 2020) are likely to have pushed back Vanuatu to GDP levels representative of LDCs.

adaptation assistance to the local level – in ways that meet community needs and expectations – remains restricted. Communities in Vanuatu urgently need scaled up support to address immediate adaptation priorities, as well as to support the integration of climate change into local planning processes.

181. The economic impacts of COVID-19 have been dire in Vanuatu. While the country has recorded only a handful of cases and no fatalities, the economic impacts from the collapse of the tourism sector and reduced tax receipts pushed the domestic budget into deficit in 2020/21 and is likely to result in increasing debt stress. These factors combined are likely to push Vanuatu back to LDC status⁴⁹.
182. The initial problem identification was derived from the deep experience of Save the Children and the MoCC in working at all levels across the country to understand capacities, needs and gaps – particularly the development, implementation and evaluation of previous small-scale CBA projects. During the detailed design phase, extensive consultations were undertaken at the national, provincial and community levels to identify the key drivers of climate change vulnerability to test and verify the existing understanding of the issues facing communities. These consultations revealed significant climate-related impacts to food systems (agriculture and fisheries) and the ecosystems that support them. There were also key issues associated with limited or declining community infrastructure and cultural systems (loss of traditional knowledge), and poor communication and transport networks within and between islands. This was supported by national and sub-national consultations, that confirmed these local issues and needs in relation to climate change impacts. The project, including the flexible adaptation packages, has been designed to address these critical adaptation challenges.

D.5. Country ownership (max. 500 words, approximately 1 page)

183. The project is specifically designed to support achievement of national climate-relevant objectives of key sector policies and strategies in Vanuatu. The funding proposal has been developed in cooperation with senior staff from key departments as well as the Vanuatu MoCC – the project's co-Executing Entity.
184. Adaptation is the key focus of Vanuatu's approach to addressing climate change. In its first Nationally Determined Contribution (NDC), Vanuatu highlighted adaptation as the country's overriding concern. In response to the climate threats facing Vanuatu, the National Adaptation Programme for Action (NAPA) initiated consultations and collaboration at several levels of government, identifying urgent actions to increase climate resilience. The NAPA identified five adaptation priority areas for Vanuatu, namely: i) agriculture and food security; ii) sustainable tourism development; iii) community-based marine resource management; iv) sustainable forest management; and v) integrated water resource management. This project will help address NAPA priorities (i), (iii) and (iv).
185. The National Climate Change Adaptation Strategy for Land-Based Resources (NCCAS) (2012-2022) was designed to build on the NAPA, the Priorities and Action Agenda (PPA) and the Disaster Risk Reduction and Disaster Management National Action Plan. The Vanuatu Climate Change and Disaster Risk Reduction Policy 2016-2030 (CCDRR Policy) builds on the work of the NAPA, NCCAS, and other adaptation and DRR efforts, in which these priority areas were updated to become: i) governance; ii) finance; iii) knowledge and information; iv) climate change adaptation and disaster risk reduction; v) low carbon development; and vi) response and recovery.
186. In 2018, the Government of Vanuatu prepared the GCF Country Programme for Vanuatu, complementing the NAPA and CCDRR Policy and assisting the Government with prioritization of adaptation investments. This project is highlighted as a priority in Vanuatu's GCF Country Programme, including in the 2021 update.
187. Vanuatu's NAPA, CCDRR Policy and GCF Country Programme are fully aligned with the country's National Sustainable Development Plan (NSDP). The NSDP, the highest public policy framework in Vanuatu, explicitly includes climate change adaptation as a key sustainable development priority. The policy's Environment Pillar 1: Food and Nutrition Security includes policy objective ENV 1.5: Enhance traditional agricultural practices, focusing on disaster risk reduction and climate change adaptation. More prominently, Environment Pillar 3: Climate and Disaster Resilience includes five policy objectives all related to adaptation, namely: ENV 3.1) Institutionalize climate change and disaster risk

⁴⁹ Australian Department of Foreign Affairs & Trade (2020) Partnership for COVID Recovery Strategy. Available [here](#).

governance, and build institutional capacity and awareness; ENV 3.2) improve monitoring and early warning systems; ENV 3.3) Strengthen post-disaster systems in planning, preparedness, response and recovery; ENV 3.4) Promote and ensure strengthened resilience and adaptive capacity to climate related, natural and man-made hazards; ENV 3.5) Access available financing for climate change adaptation and disaster risk management.

188. Anticipated actions by the Government of Vanuatu on national priorities for climate change adaptation in 2021-22 include efforts identified under its updated NDC (2020-2030)⁵⁰ to provide for quantifiable adaptation targets. The updated NDC includes specific targets and indicators aimed at enhancing the resilience of the agriculture sector and water sector, developed with the objectives of maintaining food security, income security and water security. The overarching goal for the agricultural sector is identified as: "Agriculture is able to support household income and food needs in a changing climate". Two targets have been established to meet this goal, focused on SMEs and private sector operators to generate sufficient income to cover essential household needs and services in normal and stressed (climate, disaster and environmentally) times (Ag1) and measures for enhancing the resilience of subsistence agriculture in a changing climate in the six provinces have been implemented (Ag2). The VCCRP aligns well with this NDC goal and targets. Additionally, the Government of Vanuatu is aiming to secure external climate financing to design, trial and operationalize a National Adaptation Plan (NAP) to build on the NAPA and expects to operationalize the National Vulnerability Assessment Framework (VAF), to which the VCCRP's national-level vulnerability assessment process (undertaken during the design) will make a strong contribution.
189. Vanuatu has had five GCF Readiness Proposals approved from 2015 to date, with which the VCCRP is well aligned. Further details on how VCCRP builds on and extends Readiness activities are provided in **Annex 2**.
190. The NDA has been engaged in the design process and will Co-Chair the Project Steering Committee (PSC), maintaining a role in oversight of for the project and direct lines of communication with the Project Management Unit (PMU) throughout implementation.
191. Country ownership has been ensured through extensive and comprehensive consultation during the design process with MoCC and line ministries via workshops and meetings, as well as wider engagement with civil society. Relevant stakeholders were identified through a mapping exercise and consultations built on many years of stakeholder engagement with key partners, government and communities to develop the Concept Note (2016-2019). Consultation was participatory and voluntary and worked closely with primary stakeholders who will have an implementing role during implementation. The continued consultation during the design phase with government at all levels, civil society and other relevant stakeholders further progressed the project development and ownership and included discussions on the project concept and details of the design process, feasibility study results, focus of the adaptation package, validation of the target beneficiaries and approval of the full funding proposal at the April 2021 NAB meeting (full details on engagement and consultation are provided in **Annex 7**).

D.6. Efficiency and effectiveness (max` . 500 words, approximately 1 page)

192. As outlined in **Section D.5**, above, CBA is a key component of Vanuatu's response to climate change. As also noted above (in **Section B.5**), accessing finance to support CBA actions at the scale required to create transformational change has been difficult for governments and civil society. Communities in Vanuatu are some of the least responsible for the emissions that are causing climate change, but they are among the first to suffer the impacts and will feel these impacts more acutely than people in wealthier, less hazard-exposed countries. The Government of Vanuatu is clear that significant external financing will be required if the country is to effectively manage the unavoidable impacts of climate change. The Government also struggles to balance the broad range of adaptation priorities (from protecting critical economic infrastructure to building local climate resilience). This project will work to increase the accessibility of global climate finance to local communities. There is a clear argument for high co-finance and private sector engagement in mitigation action. The argument for poor countries to finance their own adaptation actions in response to a problem stemming from the

⁵⁰ Government of Vanuatu (2020) Vanuatu's First Nationally Determined Contribution (NDC) (Updated Submission 2020)

unregulated use of the global commons, or to take out concessional loans to do so, is less clear. It is even less strong when the ultimate beneficiaries are communities on low-lying islands facing an ever-harsher climate not of their own making. Investing in CBA pays dividends,⁵¹ but governments struggle to find the resources to meet current development needs within communities, let alone proactively address anticipated future climate change impacts. The funding amount requested from the GCF for this project is commensurate with the scale of the problem and the Vanuatu Government's desire to take a nation-wide approach to addressing community adaptation needs.

193. It is clear that the Government of Vanuatu does not currently have sufficient funding to meet immediate adaptation needs at the local level. It is equally clear that most donor funds are not an adequate source of CBA finance, as they are shorter term and smaller scale. Grant funding is the most appropriate level of concessionality for CBA activities as they are not of interest to the private sector finance and contain no direct repayment capacity. CBA activities that are not funded directly by government or are not self-funded by communities are not viable without donor assistance. In the context of Vanuatu, the government does not have the capacity to meet adaptation needs and rural communities do not have the resources to self-support required adaptation actions. Further, as the adaptation packages approach is embedded in government systems and scaled out to the remaining communities across the country each intervention will become more cost effective as the communities remaining to be targeted are less difficult to reach and, relatively, less vulnerable to the identified climate change impacts. In effect, this project will undertake the most cost intensive component of this work – reaching some of the most vulnerable and hardest to access populations – allowing the government to scale out the approach further to help meet the needs of slightly easier to reach communities.
194. Implementing projects in Pacific SIDS entails higher costs than in many other developing countries, as the 'combination of extreme remoteness from major markets, very small size, dispersion over vast tracts of the Pacific Ocean, and environmental fragility results in very high cost of production of goods and services by both the private and public sector',⁵² leading to an assessment that the public sector is likely to remain the main source of formal sector employment and driver of economic activity in most Pacific Island countries for the foreseeable future. This project explicitly aims to reach some of the most climate vulnerable communities in Vanuatu. These communities are often in the most remote and geographically challenging parts of the country, requiring significant logistical undertakings to bring people and goods to them. These challenges are a key element of why these communities are highly vulnerable to the impacts of climate change and have limited adaptive capacity. Reaching these communities is, necessarily, high cost, but, for a community-based adaptation project with the aim of meeting the immediate adaptation needs of the most vulnerable people, the cost is justifiable.
195. While the Government does not have access to sufficient finance to meet current adaptation needs, the country has the Pacific region's only functional Government Financial Management Information System. The FMIS is linked to a Single Treasury Account (STA), a single reporting system and a single chart of accounts. This means that all Government ministries currently access all of their funds via the one system for both spending, reporting and commitment purposes. It is this total level of transparency and control that has enabled Vanuatu to be the first and, in many cases, only recipient of direct budget support from a wide range of donors including DFAT, the European Union, the US MCA, NZMFAT, UNICEF and others. The Vanuatu Government runs a fully centralized financial management system that has sufficient decentralized coverage through Government agencies in the islands (including Department of Finance). This system is functional and can handle significant flows of funding. Project resources allocated to Government IEs (including Department of Local Authorities and Provincial governments; Department of Agriculture, Department of Fisheries; Department of Climate Change; and National Disaster Management Office) will all flow through this centralized system and will be tracked and reported via MFEM.
196. The project will be designed to avoid over burdening any one government delivery partner to avoid straining absorptive capacity and creating capacity constraints that delay project implementation. This is a key lesson from the implementation of a range of previous projects implemented in Vanuatu and

⁵¹ See for example, Vardakoulis and Nicholles (2014) Managing uncertainty: An economic evaluation of community-based adaptation in Dakoro, Niger. Available [here](#).

⁵² World Bank (2017) *Pacific Possible*. Available [here](#).

the region. Working with a range of relevant departments will ensure no one department creates funding bottlenecks as has been the experience with some previous projects. The project will also provide direct technical assistance to Government departments and other delivery partners and supported through Save the Children's systems and national footprint. The breadth of the project will also help ensure community capacity is not overwhelmed. Working across all six provinces will enable us to spread the investment across space and time.

197. An economic and financial analysis (**Annex 3**) undertaken as part of the project's design phase examined four specific adaptation actions that are representative of the actions in the adaptation package menu:
 - EWS communications equipment (EIRR of 111%)
 - Nature based solutions – coastal management (EIRR of 12%)
 - Climate resilient agriculture – taro and yam as examples (EIRR of 19% for taro and 27% for yam)
 - Food processing and storage (EIRR of 81%)
198. The analysis shows that all four of the adaptation measures have solid economic internal rates of return and can be justified on economic grounds. The analysis shows that the selected measures will have a significantly positive economic impact for the targeted communities over the life of the project and beyond.
199. The report also undertook assessment of the incremental adaptation benefits of the four selected measures in the context of the overall project budget. This analysis showed the project has an economic internal rate of return of 3%, which, while positive, is below the discount rate. This is directly due to the size of the non-investment flows required to enable and support the adaptation investments, to ensure their long-term sustainability and to catalyze a paradigm shift in resilience in Vanuatu. However, the analysis found that the project still presents a strong investment for the GCF. An economic analysis cannot assess the non-economic, non-investment components of the project and, therefore, while the full project shows a just slightly positive economic return on investment, each specific investment shows a high rate of return on investment, and the non-investment costs will ensure the project leaves a substantial legacy of capacity for sustainability and more effective allocation and utilisation of future flows of climate finance. This does not imply a shortcoming of the project or its direct economic benefits, which, on a per-investment basis, are strongly positive. Rather it highlights some incompatibility of this method of assessment for projects delivering adaptation action in highly resource constrained and low-capacity contexts.
200. The analysis highlights three key reasons why the project budget includes significant non-economically assessable costs (non-investment costs). These are elaborated below as they are of fundamental importance to the project's success and ability to create transformational change in remote and rural communities that are highly vulnerable to the impacts of climate change.
201. The need to address significant capacity gaps and constraints at all levels (government at national, provincial and Area Council levels as well as at the community level) that undermine the effective development and implementation of adaptation actions – particularly in highly climate vulnerable rural and remote communities – and prevent the generation of a paradigm shift in resilience. The project's first component is focused on building institutional capacity at the local level to ensure that the project's adaptation investments (delivered via the adaptation package menu under **Component 2**) are feasible and are implemented in a strong enabling environment. Without these additional investments, the adaptation investments would be unlikely to be successful.
202. The need to ensure that the project leaves behind significantly increased institutional capacity to increase the sustainability and replicability of the project's adaptation investments and catalyze transformation. National and provincial capacity to support ongoing adaptation action in the targeted communities is vital, and investments under Component 3 of the project focus on this element, as well as helping ensure that the government has the capacity to scale up and replicate these adaptation investments in communities not targeted by the project.
203. The high cost of delivering projects in Pacific SIDS. It is important to note that implementing projects in Pacific SIDS entails higher costs than in many other developing countries, as the 'combination of

extreme remoteness from major markets, very small size, dispersion over vast tracts of the Pacific Ocean, and environmental fragility results in very high cost of production of goods and services by both the private and public sector.⁵³ This project explicitly aims to reach the most climate vulnerable communities in Vanuatu to generate a paradigm shift in their resilience. These communities are often in the most remote and geographically challenging parts of the country, requiring significant logistical undertakings to bring people and goods to them. This also explains why the technical assistance and travel cost of the project is high compared to the investment costs.

204. The economic analysis found that all four of the adaptation measures analyzed have an economic internal rate of return significantly higher than the discount rate and can be justified on economic grounds, and that the selected measures will have a significantly positive economic impact for the targeted communities over the life of the project and beyond.
205. Further, the analysis noted that the support provided by the non-investment costs is appropriate to the context of Vanuatu as a Pacific SIDS and Least Developed Country, with significant institutional capacity gaps and constraints at all levels to develop and implement adaptation actions in the most vulnerable remote and rural communities. And, importantly, that these non-investment costs are a critical component of ensuring the project generates transformational change and creates a paradigm shift in resilience for the most vulnerable communities in Vanuatu.
206. The economic analysis concluded that the project represents an excellent value for money investment for the GCF. The full analysis is at **Annex 3 (a and b)**.

⁵³ World Bank (2017) *Pacific Possible*. Available [here](#).

E. LOGICAL FRAMEWORK

This section refers to the project/programme's logical framework in accordance with the GCF's Integrated Results Management Framework to which the project/programme contributes as a whole, including in respect of any co-financing.

E.1. Project/Programme Focus

Please indicate whether this proposal is for a mitigation or adaptation project/programme. For cross-cutting proposals, select both.

☐ Reduced emissions (mitigation)

☒ Increased resilience (adaptation)

E.2. GCF Impact level: Paradigm shift potential (max 600 words, approximately 1-2 pages)

This section of the logical framework is meant to help a project/programme monitor and assess how it contributes to the paradigm shift described in section D.2 above by applying three assessment dimensions - scale, replicability, and sustainability.

Accordingly, for each assessment dimension (see the definition per assessment in the accompanying guidance note), describe the current state (baseline) and the potential scenario (target) and rate the current state (baseline) by using the three-point-scale rating (low, medium, and high) provided in the guidance note. Also describe how the project/programme will contribute to that shift/ transformation under respective assessment dimensions (scale, replicability and sustainability). In doing so, please refer to section B.2(a) (theory of change).

Assessment Dimension	Current state (baseline)		Potential target scenario (Description)	How the project/programme will contribute (Description)
	Description	Rating		
Scale	Adaptation programming at the community level in Vanuatu has, to date, been ad hoc and often driven by donor priorities (thematic and geographic). The vast majority of projects and funding have been targeted at the national level. Previous CBA projects have largely	<u>Low</u>	Once implemented, the VCCRP will be the largest investment in CBA in Vanuatu (and the wider Pacific region), in terms of both beneficiary reach and funding. The target scenario will see 90,157 people in 282 communities in 29 Area Councils across all six provinces with increased adaptive capacity and more climate resilient food security and livelihoods – directly reaching nearly half of the country's rural population. This project will have a significant impact on how all future CBA projects in Vanuatu are	Component 2 of the project will be the key driver of scale, with the adaptation packages directly reaching 90,157 people with contextually targeted adaptation assistance related to food security and livelihoods. Activities under Component 1 will support the scale out of the project approach across the targeted communities via awareness raising and adaptation planning activities.

	been pilots in a relatively small number of communities. There has been little in the way of systematic learning and knowledge generation. To date, accessing finance to support CBA actions at the scale required to create transformational change has been difficult for governments and civil society.		developed and implemented. Further, the project will indirectly reach the remaining half of the country's rural population via delivery of CIS and DRR outreach and awareness raising activities. This will help prepare these communities to positively engage with future projects utilising the VCCRP model. Activities in the adaptation package under Component 2 are designed to be modular and scalable. Specific activities can be increased, decreased or removed, depending on community circumstances. This makes the process inherently scalable to the full range of geographic and socio-economic contexts in Vanuatu. As Save the Children has a permanent presence in Vanuatu, SCA will be able to work with MoCC after implementation to capture ex-post information on the degree to which there has been a significant increase in quantifiable results within and beyond the scope of the intervention, as per the GCF definition of scale.	Component 3 activities will help embed these approaches into government systems at all levels to enhance sustainability. Activities under Components 1 and 3 will also support the scaling out of activities under Component 2 to additional, non-targeted, communities over time; further increasing the reach and scale of the project.
Replicability	There is currently no unified approach to CBA planning and implementation in Vanuatu. There are also significant institutional	<u>Low</u>	To foster and facilitate replicability of the project's outcomes, the target scenario would see the Ministry of Climate Change (MoCC) adopting the project's approach to local-level adaptation planning and implementation, including	Component 3 of the project will be the key driver for institutional replicability of the project's approach by embedding the system of community adaptation planning and prioritization of actions into national and provincial planning and budgeting

	capacity constraints at local, sub-national and national levels which hamper effective adaptation planning processes and implementation of adaptation actions at scale across the country.		maintaining the project-established Area Council Climate Change Officer positions and expanding these roles to all remaining Area Councils over time. MoCC has indicated a willingness to do this. The MoCC and government agencies implementing activities will receive support to build adaptation planning and implementation capacity at the local level. As this capacity will be embedded in government agencies, the target scenario will see these agencies maintaining their enhanced capacity post project implementation. This is a viable scenario as embedded capacity and activity implementation will be managed via the existing Government Investment Program. As Save the Children has a permanent presence in Vanuatu, SCA will be able to work with MoCC after implementation to capture ex-post information on the degree to which the project's activities are scaled out to other communities and applied to other key sectors.	cycles. The component will also build the capacity of provincial and national actors to access and effectively use future flows of climate finance. Key outputs are: - Output 3.1: Adaptive local governance systems strengthened through sub-national planning - Output 3.2: Enhanced local-provincial-national linkages through knowledge management and creation of feedback loops Implementation of the adaptation packages (Component 2) and adaptation planning processes (Component 1) in targeted communities will also provide a model for other, non-targeted communities to adopt (autonomously or via alternative sources of finance). The low-tech, locally-led approach to adaptation related to food security and livelihoods adopted by the project is highly replicable. As the model is proven effective, we anticipate it will be adopted by other projects in Vanuatu and beyond.
Sustainability	The Vanuatu Government is committed to facilitating adaptation action at all levels. Adaptation is the key focus of Vanuatu's approach to addressing climate change. In its	<u>Medium</u>	The target scenario will see the VCCRP supporting the Government to achieve NDC targets on livelihoods and food security. The VCCRP's national vulnerability assessment will also support the Government to finalize their NAP and operationalize the National Vulnerability Assessment Framework (VAF).	Six key sustainability strategies will be employed to ensure project impact will be sustained over time: - Building the evidence base to advocate for the national government to allocate future climate finance and other resources to support locally driven adaptation actions

	first NDC, Vanuatu highlighted adaptation as the country's overriding concern. The country's updated NDC includes specific targets and indicators aimed at enhancing the resilience of the agriculture and water sectors, developed with the objectives of maintaining food security, income security and water security. There is, however, the national government has no effective adaptation planning and implementation coordination mechanism in place linking community and national processes. This reduces the likelihood of systematic generation and dissemination of knowledge from successful (and less successful) actions and reduces sustainability. There are also currently low incentives for		The adaptation packages, under Component 2, are designed to be modular and scalable. Specific activities can be increased, decreased or removed, depending on community circumstances. This makes the package approach highly tailored to direct beneficiary needs and transferable to the remaining communities in Vanuatu (indirect beneficiaries). Activities under Components 1 and 3 are designed to ensure the sustainability of the adaptation package actions and help government to support a scale out of the approach over time. As the specific make up of each community's adaptation package will be locally owned and based on their own local adaptation planning process, there is a high likelihood of activity outcomes being sustainable over time. Activities under Output 2.4 (Women-led climate-resilient food processing and preservation established to support food security and diversification of livelihoods options) will help support rural communities to access markets and adopt more resilient livelihood strategies, which will help further increase the sustainability of project-supported adaptive capacity. Activities under Components 1 and 3 will help institutionalise knowledge and awareness of climate change risks and	- <i>Allocation of national budget resources to local adaptation actions</i> - <i>Promoting local ownership</i> - <i>Ensure financial sustainability of the project</i> - Build capacity of government and civil society systems to enable improved service delivery of future climate adaptation initiatives - <i>Foster sustainable value chains in the local market</i> (Further details on these strategies is provided in Section B.6, above).
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	private sector entities to engage with remote rural communities to support increased market access and help diversify livelihoods.		adaptation, facilitate enhanced access to climate information, and embed adaptation planning and implementation capacity in government institutions at all levels. The project has a high likelihood of achieving sustained impact well beyond the implementation period.			
E.3. GCF Outcome level: Reduced emissions and increased resilience (IRMF core indicators 1-4, quantitative indicators)						
Select appropriate IRMF core and supplementary indicators to monitor project/programme progress. More than one IRMF (core and or supplementary) indicators may be selected as applicable for each GCF results area and project/programme outcome (as defined in the table in section B.2(b)). If IRMF indicators are unable to measure any given project/programme outcomes, project/programme-specific indicators should be developed under section E.5 (project/programme specific indicators).						
GCF Result Area	IRMF Indicator	Means of Verification (MoV)	Baseline	Target		Assumptions / Note
				Mid-term	Final ⁵⁴	
<u>ARA1 Most vulnerable people and communities</u>	<u>Core 2: Direct and indirect beneficiaries reached</u>	Govt statistics (national census, HIES) NDMO reports Progress / completion reports Extension officers monitoring reports	Direct 0 males, 0 females Indirect 0 males, 0 females	Direct 36,000 total people (17,640 females, 18,360 males) Indirect 44,000 total people (21,560 females, 22,440 males)	Direct 90,157 total people (44,177 females, 45,980 males) Indirect 110,000 total people (53,900 females, 56,100 males)	Project is able to effectively reach and operate in all targeted communities during the implementation period Direct and indirect beneficiaries will be counted via aggregated project reporting, which will include activity and sub-activity level attendance, as well as project M&E (ie surveys of uptake, and

⁵⁴ The final target means the target at the end of project/programme implementation period. However, for core indicator 1 (GHG emission reduction), please also provide the target value at the end of the total lifespan period which is defined as the maximum number of years over which the impacts of the investment are expected to be effective.

						media/social media hit counts) Direct and indirect beneficiaries are the same for all three results areas
<u>ARA1 Most vulnerable people and communities</u>	<u>Supplementary 2.1: Beneficiaries (female/male) adopting improved and/or new climate-resilient livelihood options</u>	Govt statistics (national census, HIES) NDMO reports Progress / completion reports Extension officers monitoring reports	0 males, 0 females	36,000 total people (17,640 females, 18,360 males)	90,157 total people (44,177 females, 45,980 males)	Adequate uptake of improved practices secures buy-in from communities and long- term commitment to promoted climate resilient actions
<u>ARA2 Health, well-being, food and water security</u>	<u>Core 2: Direct and indirect beneficiaries reached</u>	Govt statistics (national census, HIES) NDMO reports Progress / completion reports Extension officers monitoring reports	Direct 0 males, 0 females Indirect 0 males, 0 females	Direct 36,000 total people (17,640 females, 18,360 males) Indirect 44,000 total people (21,560 females, 22,440 males)	Direct 90,157 total people (44,177 females, 45,980 males) Indirect 110,000 total people (53,900 females, 56,100 males)	Project is able to effectively reach and operate in all targeted communities during the implementation period Direct and indirect beneficiaries will be counted via aggregated project reporting, which will include activity and sub-activity level attendance, as well as project M&E (ie surveys of uptake, and media/social media hit counts)

						Direct and indirect beneficiaries are the same for all three results areas
<u>ARA2 Health, well-being, food and water security</u>	<u>Supplementary 2.2: Beneficiaries (female/male) with improved food security</u>	Govt statistics (national census, HIES) NDMO reports Post-disaster surveys Progress / completion reports Extension officers monitoring reports	61,600 people (30,184 females, 31,416 males) across 13,689 targeted households are food secure (30% of the rural population are moderately or severely food insecure) Baseline data is from a 2019 assessment and does not include impacts of COVID-19. The baseline will be updated during project inception Average number people per household across project sites is 4.5	66,001 people (32,341 females, 33,660 males) across 14,667 targeted households are food secure (Measured as an increase in the proportion of households reporting as food secure using FAO Food Insecurity Experience Scale) Average number people per household across project sites is 4.5	74,799 people (36,652 females, 38,147 males) across 16,622 targeted households are food secure Food insecurity in targeted communities is reduced by 50% (Measured as an increase in the proportion of households reporting as food secure using FAO Food Insecurity Experience Scale) Average number people per household	Latest estimate of prevalence of food insecurity is from 2019 and does not include the impacts of Cyclone Harold or COVID-19. With these events, food security in remote and rural areas has been impacted and likely decreased Absence of extreme climate events and economic shocks, affecting yields and household economies. that occur before the project interventions have been fully implemented

					across project sites is 4.5	
<u>ARA2 Health, well-being, food and water security</u>	<u>Supplementary 2.5: Beneficiaries (female/male) adopting innovations that strengthen climate change resilience</u>	Govt statistics (national census, HIES) Progress / completion reports Extension officers monitoring reports	<1,495 people (733 females, 762 males) <5 communities in target Area Councils are utilizing food preservation / processing technologies Average number of people per community across project sites is 299	<1,495 people (733 females, 762 males) (Distribution of food preservation / processing technologies to occur in years 4 and 5) Average number of people per community across project sites is 299	78,039 people (38,239 females, 39,800 males) across 261 communities in target Area Councils are utilizing food preservation / processing technologies Average number of people per community across project sites is 299	Project is able to effectively reach and operate in all targeted communities during the implementation period
<u>ARA4 Ecosystems and ecosystem services</u>	<u>Core 2: Direct and indirect beneficiaries reached</u>	Govt statistics (national census, HIES) NDMO reports Progress / completion reports	Direct 0 males, 0 females Indirect 0 males, 0 females	Direct 36,000 total people (17,640 females, 18,360 males) Indirect 44,000 total people (21,560	Direct 90,157 total people (44,177 females, 45,980 males) Indirect 110,000 total people (53,900	Project is able to effectively reach and operate in all targeted communities during the implementation period Direct and indirect beneficiaries will be counted via aggregated project reporting, which will

		Extension officers monitoring reports		females, 22,440 males)	females, 56,100 males)	include activity and sub-activity level attendance, as well as project M&E (ie surveys of uptake, and media/social media hit counts) Direct and indirect beneficiaries are the same for all three results areas
<u>ARA4 Ecosystems and ecosystem services</u>	<u>Core 4: Hectares of natural resources brought under improved low-emission and/or climate-resilient management practice</u>	Progress / completion reports Extension officers monitoring reports	0 hectares No ecosystems in targeted areas are currently protected or strengthened to respond to climate variability and change	5,800 hectares	11,600 hectares	No perverse incentives (policies, prices, monoculture industries that affect natural capital) are introduced in the project area The project's area is not seriously disrupted by a major extreme climate event, affecting restored areas, before resilience measures have been fully adopted
<u>ARA4 Ecosystems and ecosystem services</u>	<u>Supplementary 4.1: Hectares of terrestrial forest, terrestrial non-forest, freshwater and coastal marine areas brought under restoration and/or improved ecosystems</u>	Progress / completion reports Extension officers monitoring reports	0 hectares No ecosystems in targeted areas are currently protected or strengthened to respond to	5,800 hectares	11,600 hectares	No perverse incentives (policies, prices, monoculture industries that affect natural capital) are introduced in the project area The project's area is not seriously disrupted by a

			climate variability and change			major extreme climate event, affecting restored areas, before resilience measures have been fully adopted
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E.4. GCF Outcome level: Enabling environment (IRMF core indicators 5-8 as applicable)

Select at least two relevant IRMF core (enabling environment) indicators to monitor and elaborate the baseline context and project/programme's targeted outcome against the respective indicators. Rate the current state (baseline) vis-à-vis the target scenario and select the geographical scope of the outcome to be assessed. Describe how the project/programme will contribute towards the target scenario. Refer to a case example in the accompanying guidance to complete this section.

Core Indicator	Baseline context (description)	Rating for current state (baseline)	Target scenario (description)	How the project will contribute	Coverage
<u>Core Indicator 5: Degree to which GCF investments contribute to strengthening institutional and regulatory frameworks for low emission climate-resilient development pathways in a country-driven manner</u>	No effective adaptation planning and implementation coordination mechanism in place linking community and national processes	<u>low</u>	<i>By the end of the project, the 29 targeted Area Councils will have Level 2 strengthened adaptation planning and implementation coordination mechanisms, connected to national systems, in place and operational</i>	The project will support all targeted Area Councils to adopt relevant local-subnational-national coordination mechanisms, which will be measured by an effectiveness uptake scorecard. This scorecard will have four levels to measure the performance of effectiveness: Level 0 – no meaningful coordination mechanism in place and/or applied; Level 1 – coordination mechanism in place with clearly defined roles and responsibilities;	<u>National level (one country)</u>

				Level 2 – coordination mechanism actively applied with joint planning and implementation of activities, Level 3 – coordination mechanism regularly reviewed and refined through inclusive stakeholder consultation	
<u>Core Indicator 6: Degree to which GCF investments contribute to technology deployment, dissemination, development or transfer and innovation</u>	Minimal access to project-relevant adaptation technologies in targeted communities	<u>low</u>	<i>By the end of the project targeted communities will have increased their food security by adopting climate resilient agriculture and fisheries techniques, including via the introduction of tools, systems and technologies. Targeted communities will also have commenced food processing and preservation for direct food security and market engagement, principally via the introduction of adaptation technologies (solar dryers and freezers).</i> <i>These investments will catalyse a paradigm shift in communities' approaches to climate</i>	Activities under Component Two will directly support communities to adopt and utilize locally appropriate and sustainable adaptation technologies via the adaptation packages.	<u>Multiple sub-national areas within a country</u>

			<i>resilient food and livelihoods security and help develop a viable pipeline of demand for NGEF products and services.</i>		
<u>Core indicator 8: Degree to which GCF investments contribute to effective knowledge generation and learning processes, and use of good practices, methodologies and standards</u>	No systematic climate change communication across all targeted communities	<u>low</u>	<i>By the end of the project, 200,157 people (98,076 females, 102,080 males, all direct and indirect project beneficiaries) will have increased awareness of climate threats and related appropriate responses.</i> <i>282 targeted communities will have adaptation plans under implementation which are driving project-supported adaptation actions that reduce exposure to climate hazards and increase food security and livelihoods resilience.</i> <i>90,157 people (44,177 females, 45,980 males, all direct beneficiaries) will be reached by reliable EWS (via CDCCC connectivity)</i>	Investments under Component One will help generate and disseminate climate information. CDCCCs will have enhanced connectivity to facilitate this access and will be trained to help communities apply it to adaptation planning and action. Activities will also ensure more reliable and sustainable access to EWS (via CDCCCs). Area Council Climate Change Officers will support increased understanding of climate change at the local level and will coordinate with key stakeholders to support development of community adaptation plans and implementation of adaptation package actions (under Component Two)	<u>Multiple sub-national areas within a country</u>

			and have enhanced access to climate information.		
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E.5. Project/programme specific indicators (project outcomes and outputs)

This section should list out project/programme-specific performance indicators (outcomes and outputs) that are not covered in sections above (E.1-E.4). List down tailored indicators to monitor /track progress against relevant project/programme results (outcomes/outputs). AEs have the freedom to decide against which outcomes they would like to set project/programme specific indicators. If any co-benefits are identified in sections B.2(a)(b), and D.3, AEs are encouraged to add and monitor co-benefit indicators under the "Project/programme co-benefit indicators" section in table below. Add rows as needed.

Please number each outcome and output as shown below to indicate association of outputs to the contributing outcome. The numbering for outputs under this section should correspond to the output numbering in annex 4 (detailed budget plan).

Project/programme results (outcomes/ outputs)	Project/programme specific Indicator	Means of Verification (MoV)	Baseline	Target		Assumptions / Note
				Mid-term	Final	
Outcome 1						
Output 1.1: Community-based climate change adaptation and disaster risk reduction mechanisms are strengthened	% target communities with functioning CDCCCs	Project reports Survey/questionnaire Gov't records	Approx. 10% target communities	50% target communities	100% target communities	All targeted communities engage in CDCCC formation and formalization
	% target CDCCCs with gender balance	Project reports Survey/questionnaire Gov't records	0	30% target CDCCCs	90% target CDCCCs	CDCCCs leadership open to addressing gender issues
	% target CDCCCs with child/youth engagement	Project reports Survey/questionnaire Gov't records	0	30% target CDCCCs	90% target CDCCCs	CDCCCs leadership open to including youth representation (as mandated) and facilitating child engagement
Output 1.2: Communities have increased understanding of climate change impacts and are supported to develop inclusive local adaptation plans	% target women, men, children and youth with increased understanding of the implications of climate change	Project reports Survey/questionnaire Gov't records	Approx. 15% nation-wide (<25% female)	60% targeted beneficiaries (49% female) (direct and indirect) (120,000 people)	95% total beneficiaries (49% female) (direct and indirect) (190,000 people)	Project effectively reaches all direct and indirect beneficiaries with IEC materials
	% target communities with adaptation plans in place	Project reports Survey/questionnaire	0	50% target communities	100% target communities	All target communities participate in developing and formalizing plans

		Gov't records				
Output 1.3: Communities have increased access to climate information services and early warning systems and the skills to utilise them as adaptation tools	% target CDCCCs with internet connectivity for CIS/EWS delivery	Project reports Survey/questionnaire Gov't records	Approx. 7% nation-wide	30% target CDCCCs	100% target CDCCCs	All CDCCCs are able to be connected and actively transfer information for CIS/EWS
	# target community members with increased understanding of application of CIS to agriculture/fisheries	Project reports Survey/questionnaire Gov't records	720-1,380 people nation-wide (<25% female)	17,500 people (30% female as fishers skew male)	29,210 people (30% female as fishers skew male)	60% of adults/youth reached with CIS training c apply it to livelihoods
Outcome 2						
Output 2.1: Local natural resources are more resilient to climate change impacts through implementation of nature-based solutions	# hectares of agricultural and fisheries sites under improved management using nature-based solutions	Project reports Survey/questionnaire Gov't records	0 hectares in target Area Councils	5,800 hectares (approx. 200ha per target Area Council)	11,600 hectares (approx. 400ha per target Area Council)	Targeted communities prioritize nature-based solutions ahead of possible quick but unsustainable gains from destructive farming and resource management habits The project's targeted area is not seriously disrupted by a major climate event affecting better managed sites, before the project interventions have been fully implemented
Output 2.2: Climate-resilient agriculture for food security and livelihood development	# target farmers with increased understanding of climate-resilient agriculture practices	Project reports Survey/questionnaire Training report Gov't records	720-1,380 people nation-wide (<25% female)	18,600 farmers (50% female)	31,200 farmers (50% female)	Farmers actively engage in climate-resilient agricultural training initiatives because they perceive benefits in mitigating climate risk and assume positive results in agricultural product pricing, yields and access to inputs
	# target farmers implementing climate resilient agriculture practices	Project reports Survey/questionnaire Gov't records	720-1,380 people nation-wide (<25% female)	14,000 farmers	23,400 farmers	Short term results are sufficiently promising to incentivize farmers to follow-through on training and apply principles on farm Market prices for key inputs or outputs in the value chain remain stable The project's targeted area is not seriously disrupted by a

						major climate event affecting agricultural production, before the project's full implementation of interventions
	% target households in moderate or severe food insecurity (This indicator will also be used to assess progress against Output 2.3)	Project reports Survey/questionnaire Gov't reports	30% of households involved in agriculture, fishing, aquaculture and/or livestock are reported to be food insecure ⁵⁵ (30% of 19556 HHs = 5867 HHs food insecure)	25% of targeted households in moderate or severe food insecurity. (25% of 19,556 HHs = 4,889 HHs food insecure)	15% of targeted households in moderate or severe food insecurity. (15% of 19556 HHs = 2933 HHs food insecure)	The project's targeted area is not seriously disrupted by a major climate event affecting agricultural or fisheries production, before the project's full implementation of interventions Target populations/household numbers and food supply logistics remain stable through project implementation
Output 2.3: Climate-resilient fisheries for food security and livelihood development	# target fishers with increased understanding of climate-resilient fisheries practices	Project reports Survey/questionnaire Training report Gov't records	720-1,380 people nation-wide (<10% female)	5,400 fishers (30% female as fishers skew male)	9,000 fishers (30% female as fishers skew male)	Fishers in targeted communities adopt an open-minded rather than sceptical outlook to actively engage in climate-resilient fisheries training opportunities
	# target fishers diversifying fisheries resources	Project reports Survey/questionnaire Gov't records	Approx. 2,000 people nation-wide (<5% female)	4,000 fishers	6,800 fishers	Fishers in targeted communities reached follow-through on training received by applying principles to diversify livelihoods Market prices for key inputs or outputs in the value chain remain stable The project's targeted area is not seriously disrupted by a major climate event affecting fisheries production, before the project's full implementation of interventions
Output 2.4: Women-led climate-resilient food processing and preservation established to support food security and diversification of livelihoods options	# communities using food preservation technologies	Project reports Survey/questionnaire Gov't records	<5 in target Area Councils	0 communities (distribution to occur in years 4 and 5)	261 communities	Targeted communities follow-through on food preservation training received, by adopting and utilizing adaptation technologies

⁵⁵ Vanuatu National Statistics Office (2021) *Food Security in Vanuatu: 2019-2020 NSDP Baseline Survey*, p.62. Available [here](#).

						Market prices for key inputs or outputs in the value chain remain stable
	# target women-led producer groups collaborating to access new markets	Project reports Survey/questionnaire Gov't records	Producers in 35 communities nationally (20% female)	Producer groups in 50 communities (100% female)	Producer groups in 90 communities (100% female)	Communities utilizing preservation techniques see the value of forming producer groups and mobilize accordingly No disinformation campaigns that work against the new formation of producer groups Markets remain intact and are not disrupted by economic downturns or shocks
	% target households participating in producer groups that report increased incomes	Project reports Survey/questionnaire Gov't reports	0%	30% producer group households report increased incomes	50% producer group households report increased incomes	Producer groups are established and functional and can effectively access markets Household income increases relate to the current median household income in rural areas is VTU 52,269 per month (USD 471)
	# partnerships facilitated between producer groups and private sector entities	Project reports Survey/questionnaire Partnership agreements/ MoUs Gov't records	0	4 partnerships	6 partnerships	National private sector entities realize the value of climate resilient food production and supply chain benefits secured through coordinated local food production and see value in engaging with remote/rural producer groups
Outcome 3						
Output 3.1: Adaptive local governance systems strengthened through sub-national planning	# Area Council staff with increased capacity to integrate climate change into planning and budgeting	Project reports Survey/questionnaire Training report Gov't records	0 No systematic Area Council capacity building initiatives	80 people	145 People	Obstacles, such as transport logistics, time availability or different expectations from other staff, are mitigated, so that at least 5 staff per targeted Area Council engage in training
	Shock-responsive social protection system developed and tested (via DFAT co-finance)	ANCP project reports Gov't records	0 No social protection system	Social protection system designed	Vulnerability criteria tested	DFAT co-financed project is sufficiently linked to VCCRP Social protection system designed in accordance with

						best practice and subnational context-specific needs
Output 3.2: Enhanced local-provincial-national linkages through knowledge management and creation of feedback loops	# knowledge products disseminated nationally, regionally and globally	Project reports Knowledge products	0	25 knowledge products	40 knowledge products	Agreement reached by key stakeholders on what knowledge products are required and how these need to be communicated to ensure uptake and application Knowledge products are available and accessible to all key stakeholders
	# local-provincial-national stakeholder forums convened	Project reports Survey/questionnaire Attendee list and meeting minutes Gov't records	0 No formalized process for adaptation knowledge management	2 forums	6 forums	Key stakeholders at national, subnational and local levels understand climate risk and the need for climate resilient practices to be amplified
Project/programme co-benefit indicators						
Note: a sub-set of core project indicators will be used to assess progress on achievement of co-benefits. Where required, additional questions will be added to surveys/questionnaires and other monitoring tools to increase data on co-benefits.						
Co-benefit 1 Increasing the household incomes of rural communities through livelihoods diversification and increasing access to markets.	% target households participating in producer groups that report increased incomes	Project reports Survey/questionnaire Gov't reports	0%	30% producer group households report increased incomes	50% producer group households report increased incomes	Producer groups are established and functional and can effectively access markets Household income increases relate to the current median household income in rural areas is VTU 52,269 per month (USD 471)
Co-benefit 2 Increasing access to education by ensuring fewer school days lost in the aftermath of extreme weather events through adaptation planning and enhanced DRR action.	% target communities with functioning CDCCCs	Project reports Survey/questionnaire Gov't records	Approx. 10% target communities	50% target communities	100% target communities	All targeted communities engage in CDCCC formation and formalization
	% target CDCCCs with internet connectivity for CIS/EWS delivery	Project reports Survey/questionnaire Gov't records	Approx. 7% nation-wide	30% target CDCCCs	100% target CDCCCs	All CDCCCs are able to be connected and actively transfer information for CIS/EWS
	% target communities with adaptation plans in place	Project reports Survey/questionnaire Gov't records	0	50% target communities	100% target communities	All target communities participate in developing and formalizing plans

Co-benefit 3 Increasing broad community health outcomes by ensuring communities have more secure access to locally-available nutritious foods.	% target households in moderate or severe food insecurity (This indicator will also be used to assess progress against Output 2.3)	Project reports Survey/questionnaire Gov't reports	30% of households involved in agriculture, fishing, aquaculture and/or livestock are reported to be food insecure (30% of 19556 HHs = 5867 HHs food insecure)	25% of targeted households in moderate or severe food insecurity. (25% of 19,556 HHs = 4,889 HHs food insecure)	15% of targeted households in moderate or severe food insecurity. (15% of 19556 HHs = 2933 HHs food insecure)	The project's targeted area is not seriously disrupted by a major climate event affecting agricultural or fisheries production, before the project's full implementation of interventions Target populations/household numbers and food supply logistics remain stable through project implementation
	# target farmers implementing climate resilient agriculture practices	Project reports Survey/questionnaire Gov't records	720-1,380 people nation-wide (<25% female)	14,000 farmers	23,400 farmers	Short term results are sufficiently promising to incentivize farmers to follow-through on training and apply principles on farm Market prices for key inputs or outputs in the value chain remain stable The project's targeted area is not seriously disrupted by a major climate event affecting agricultural production, before the project's full implementation of interventions
	# target fishers diversifying fisheries resources	Project reports Survey/questionnaire Gov't records	Approx. 2,000 people nation-wide (<5% female)	4,000 fishers	6,800 fishers	Fishers in targeted communities reached follow-through on training received by applying principles to diversify livelihoods Market prices for key inputs or outputs in the value chain remain stable The project's targeted area is not seriously disrupted by a major climate event affecting fisheries production, before the project's full implementation of interventions

Co-benefit 4 Increasing the sustainability of ecosystem services by reducing reliance on vulnerable resources (e.g. reef fish) as a primary food source in rural coastal communities.	# target fishers diversifying fisheries resources	Project reports Survey/questionnaire Gov't records	Approx. 2,000 people nation-wide (<5% female)	4,000 fishers	6,800 fishers	Fishers in targeted communities reached follow-through on training received by applying principles to diversify livelihoods Market prices for key inputs or outputs in the value chain remain stable The project's targeted area is not seriously disrupted by a major climate event affecting fisheries production, before the project's full implementation of interventions
	# hectares of agricultural and fisheries sites under improved management using nature-based solutions	Project reports Survey/questionnaire Gov't records	0 hectares in target Area Councils	5,800 hectares (approx. 200ha per target Area Council)	11,600 hectares (approx. 400ha per target Area Council)	Targeted communities prioritize nature-based solutions ahead of possible quick but unsustainable gains from destructive farming and resource management habits The project's targeted area is not seriously disrupted by a major climate event affecting better managed sites, before the project interventions have been fully implemented
Co-benefit 5 Increasing gender equality across all areas of community life – with a specific focus on ensuring women's voices are heard in climate-related decision-making forums and that the gendered nature of climate change impacts is a key component of all climate and development planning at community and province levels. * See GESI Action Plan for a comprehensive list of gender-	% target CDCCCs with gender balance	Project reports Survey/questionnaire Gov't records	0	30% target CDCCCs	90% target CDCCCs	CDCCCs leadership open to addressing gender issues
	% target communities with adaptation plans in place	Project reports Survey/questionnaire Gov't records	0	50% target communities	100% target communities	All target communities participate in developing and formalizing plans
	# local-provincial-national stakeholder forums convened	Project reports Survey/questionnaire Attendee list and meeting minutes Gov't records	0 No formalized process for adaptation knowledge management	2 forums	6 forums	Key stakeholders at national, subnational and local levels understand climate risk and the need for climate resilient practices to be amplified

related indicators the project will track						
Co-benefit 6 Increasing social inclusion across all areas of community life – with a specific focus on ensuring voices of traditionally underrepresented groups (e.g. youth, people with a disability) are heard in climate-related decision-making forums * See GESI Action Plan for a comprehensive list of social inclusion-related indicators the project will track	% target CDCCCs with child/youth engagement	Project reports Survey/questionnaire Gov't records	0	30% target CDCCCs	90% target CDCCCs	CDCCCs leadership open to including youth representation (as mandated) and facilitating child engagement
	% target communities with adaptation plans in place	Project reports Survey/questionnaire Gov't records	0	50% target communities	100% target communities	All target communities participate in developing and formalizing plans
	# local-provincial-national stakeholder forums convened	Project reports Survey/questionnaire Attendee list and meeting minutes Gov't records	0 No formalized process for adaptation knowledge management	2 forums	6 forums	Key stakeholders at national, subnational and local levels understand climate risk and the need for climate resilient practices to be amplified

E.6. Project/programme activities and deliverables

All project activities should be listed here with a description and sub-activities. Significant deliverables should be reflected in annex 5 implementation timetable. Add rows as needed.

Please number the activities as shown below to indicate association of activities to the related outputs provided above in section E.5. Similarly, please number sub-activities as shown below to associate to the related activity.

Activity	Description	Sub-activities	Deliverables
Component 1: Government, civil society and communities are strengthened to support local resilience to climate change impacts, including by providing access to climate information and early warnings			
Output 1.1: Community-based climate change adaptation and disaster risk reduction mechanisms are strengthened			
Activity 1.1.1 Establish CDCCCs (where necessary) and build their capacity, including strengthening social inclusion and gender-balance	Establish new, or strengthen existing, CDCCCs and build their capacity, including strengthening social inclusion and gender-balance.	1.1.1.1 DoCC develops and field-tests CDCCC status assessment tool in partnership with DLA and NDMO 1.1.1.2 Assess CDCCC status using field-tested tool (where CDCCC are established, evaluate gender-balance, engage children/youth and people with disabilities, and consult with community to identify opportunities to strengthen CDCCC) 1.1.1.3 Support the development of CDCCCs as necessary based on the findings of 1.1.1.2, including, where needed, CDCCC kits and community workspace	Assessments of CDCCC in all target communities 100% of target communities have new or strengthened CDCCCs Activities to strengthen CDCCCs including social inclusion and gender balance in at least 90% target communities Gender balance in CDCCCs in at least 90% target communities People with disability represented on CDCCC in at least 60% target communities Youth representatives on CDCCC in at least 80% target communities

			50% participants in education and training sessions are women
Activity 1.1.2 Increase CDCCC member capacity to identify climate change and disaster risks at the local level	Increase the capacity of CDCCC members in effectively identifying climate and disaster risk.	1.1.2.1 Conduct leadership and technical (DRR/CCA) training with CDCCCs, based on needs identified in 1.1.1.2 1.1.2.2 Conduct targeted training for women in leadership and children/youth engagement in CDCCCs and adaptation planning processes 1.1.2.3 Conduct follow-up refresher training 1 year after initial training with CDCCCs as well as regular monitoring/support visits 1.1.2.4 Establish communication channels through SMS or social media for CDCCCs to request information/support from NDMO/Provincial Disaster Officers in leading community education sessions	CDCCC digitized train-the-trainer sessions conducted in at least 90% of target communities At least 90% of target communities receive community-education sessions At least 80% of target CDCCCs receive refresher training (years 2 onwards) Scaled-up access to information for rural communities through newly established communication channels in 29 Area Councils
Output 1.2: Communities have increased understanding of climate change impacts and are supported to develop inclusive local adaptation plans			
Activity 1.2.1 Community awareness raising on climate change risks to food systems, livelihoods and disaster risk via targeted IEC materials and information sessions managed by Area Council Climate Change Officers and CDCCCs	Build awareness in target communities on climate change and disaster risks to food systems and livelihoods	1.2.1.1 Review existing climate change education and awareness raising materials available at the local level to identify gaps and opportunities for improvement 1.2.1.2 Building on existing efforts by MoET and MoCC to develop standardised participatory climate change education and awareness raising materials and key messages on climate change risks to food systems, role of habitats in supporting fisheries, livelihoods and disaster risk 1.2.1.3 Conduct best practice adult learning approaches to digitized train-the-trainer sessions with Area Council Climate Change Officers and CDCCCs using materials designed in 1.2.1.2 (delivered in tandem with 1.1.2.1 and 1.3.2.2) 1.2.1.4 Disseminate digital and paper-based awareness materials and extend training through local officers, CSOs and communication networks, as well as through participation in public events that provide outreach opportunities 1.2.1.5 Facilitate face-to-face knowledge exchange events with local community representatives, area council representatives and sub-national government officials and	Updated/new community awareness materials on climate change and disaster risks to food systems, livelihoods and disaster risk 5 local officers trained in each Area Council (145 total) on delivering awareness on climate change risks to food systems, livelihoods and disasters Extension of awareness materials and messages through local offices, CSOs, networks and related project activities to be undertaken in at least 95% of target communities and 29 Area Councils to scale-up further At least 95% of target communities receive community awareness sessions 144 community awareness media broadcasts/posts on climate change risks and impacts delivered to public via media sources

		representatives to help ensure local issues are considered in sub-national/national adaptation planning processes (linked to 3.2.2.3)	
Activity 1.2.2 Identify key local issues that drive climate vulnerability and use this to develop local adaptation plans and measure program impact	Support identification of key challenges and barriers that drive climate vulnerability to inform development of local adaptation plans.	1.2.2.1 Build capacity of Area Council climate change officers in community profiling and documenting local vulnerabilities (consistent with National Vulnerability Assessment Framework, GESI principles and child/youth inclusive approaches) 1.2.2.2 Conduct participatory community profiling and documenting of local vulnerabilities to record the key local issues that drive climate vulnerability to inform the development of Community Adaptation Plans 1.2.2.3 Conduct rapid baseline biophysical and ecological surveys of key natural resources (habitats and species) that support food security and livelihoods and help measure program impact (including technical assessments of threats to watersheds, erosion hotspots, mangrove and reef health checks, fish catch surveys, invasive species, agricultural pests and diseases) 1.2.2.4 Conduct household socioeconomic surveys to document resource dependence and important natural resources to inform local adaptation actions	At least 90% of target Area Councils participate in technical training on facilitating community profiling and documenting local vulnerabilities Baseline report for biophysical and ecological condition for at least 90% of target communities and 29 Area Councils to scale-up Baseline report for household-level socioeconomic status and resource dependence for at least 90% of target communities and 29 Area Councils to scale-up
Activity 1.2.3 Development of inclusive Community Adaptation Plans and identification of key resilience building actions (selected from adaptation package menu)	Facilitate development of Community Adaptation Plans and identification of key climate resilience building actions from the VCCRP 'adaptation package' of interventions.	1.2.3.1 Sub-national government/CDCCCs facilitate participatory stakeholder engagement processes to develop Community Adaptation Plans, based on the data collected via activity 1.2.2, which identify immediate and mid-term adaptation actions to address current and projected climate change risks 1.2.3.2 Sub-national government/CDCCCs and diverse community representatives to select the highest priority and locally appropriate adaptations from the VCCRP 'adaptation package' (Component 2) that are socially acceptable, avoid adverse environmental and social impacts, and address the main drivers of climate vulnerability 1.2.3.3 Finalise Community Adaptation Plan, including key priority activities for implementation by VCCRP and future activities.	100% of target communities develop Community Adaptation Plans and prioritize interventions from VCCRP adaptation package 100% of Area Councils participate in Community Adaptation Plan processes At least 60% of target communities update Community Adaptation Plans during project lifetime

		Validate with community members and Area Council officials and update on a 3 year cycle	
Output 1.3: Communities have increased access to climate information services and early warning systems and the skills to utilise them as adaptation tools			
Activity 1.3.1 Develop and distribute CIS IEC products to support community adaptation awareness raising and adaptation planning processes	Development and distribution of CIS IEC products to inform community-level climate change adaptation planning processes, including enhanced connectivity for CDCCCs. CIS products and knowledge management materials will be developed (including print, digital, audio, and mixed-media) for use in target communities in partnership with national authorities (including NDMO and VMGD), building on materials developed through Van-KIRAP (FP035).	1.3.1.1 Conduct best practice review and baseline study of existing access to EWS in high-risk communities (undertaken in conjunction with 1.2.2) 1.3.1.2 Enhance community EWS infrastructure where gaps exist (installation of small rooftop satellite dishes) and establish system for CDCCCs to on-sell data capacity to cover costs 1.3.1.3 Support CDCCCs to conduct participatory community meetings with an emphasis on the participation of elderly community members to identify, share and capture traditional knowledge for early warning of disaster or weather extremes related to agriculture or fisheries 1.3.1.4 Deliver CIS products and materials to communities from the Van-KIRAP and NDMO/VMGD projects identifying opportunities to further extend tailored materials for community-level use in target communities. In support of 1.2.1.2 1.3.1.5 Disseminate climate information to target communities through a range of media, including printed materials, social media, text messages and radio (e.g. radio drama). Linked to 1.2.1.4	At least 90% of CDCCCs undertake baseline assessment of existing access to EWS and CIS At least 90% of CDCCCs have solar PV systems and internet connectivity with system for on-selling data for financial sustainability At least 90% of target communities and 29 Area Councils (to scale-up) reached with delivery of CIS materials and resources 660 CIS communications through social media, text messages, radio and other media
Activity 1.3.2 Build capacity of Area Council Climate Change Officers and CDCCCs to effectively utilize CIS in community planning processes	Activity 1.3.2 will strengthen the capacity of Area Councils and CDCCCs in the use of CIS resources and information to inform community-level planning processes. Collaboration on delivery of CIS technical training with Van-KIRAP (FP035) and national authorities (VMGD and NDMO) will avoid duplication of efforts.	1.3.2.1 Optimise training materials that specifically address community needs and are tailored to community-level understanding of climate change, including integration of GESI considerations and child/youth inclusive approaches (extending CIS delivery from FP035) 1.3.2.2 Train local Area Council Climate Change Officers/CDCCCs to deliver community training on accessing and using climate and early warning information, in conjunction with 1.2.1.3 1.3.2.3 Conduct community trainings on accessing and using climate information relating to fisheries, agriculture and disaster preparedness through CDCCCs building on	Training materials and resources developed (including testing through VDPA) CIS/EWS training conducted in 100% of target communities and 29 Area Councils to scale-up Review of CIS-EWS use and future needs in at least 60% target communities in 29 Area Councils (from year 2)

		increased community understanding of climate change from 1.2.1	
Component 2: Scalable, locally appropriate actions are implemented to meet community adaptation needs to create climate-resilient, sustainable development pathways			
Output 2.1: Local natural resources are more resilient to climate change impacts through implementation of nature-based solutions			
Activity 2.1.1 Support adaptations that strengthen or rehabilitate coastal protection barriers, reduce risk of flood/landslides and improve water-security through nature-based solutions	Deliver community-based education on coastal and upland resource management; develop coastal and upland resource management plans; establish living barriers; support reforestation of damaged forests and water catchments; manage invasive vine species impacting watersheds; and establish new / strengthen existing community conservation areas.	2.1.1.1 Deliver community education and awareness raising on coastal and upland resource management 2.1.1.2 Conduct planning workshops with sector stakeholders for development of community-led coastal and upland resource management plans (including cooperation between communities for cross-boundary resources) – drawing in information from 1.2.2 and 2.1.1.1. Resulting plans will form a component of the Community Adaptation Plans under 1.2.3 2.1.1.3 Establish living barriers (vetiver and/or native trees) to storm winds, erosion or landslide zones to fortify slopes and reduce erosion 2.1.1.4 Support reforestation of damaged forests and water catchments using native species (including native coastal vegetation) and micro check dams for erosion control and groundwater recharge 2.1.1.5 Management of invasive vine species that impact on watersheds 2.1.1.6 Establish or enhance traditional tabu areas for conservation of forest resources, including biodiversity	Education sessions delivered in at least 90% of targeted communities Community-led coastal and upland resource management plans developed in at least 90% of target communities 29 tree nurseries established 11,600 hectares of agricultural and fisheries sites under better management using nature-based solutions
Activity 2.1.2 Introduce/scale up improved agriculture methods to minimise erosion and reduce impact of pests and diseases	Support agriculture technical officers at DARD to develop, produce, and deliver training and education materials on climate-resilient agricultural practices; develop and implement site-specific strategies to combat soil erosion; establish field demonstrations; distribution of trees and plants to prevent erosion and tools to support implementation.	2.1.2.1 Develop and provide training and education materials on climate-resilient agricultural methods to minimise erosion and facilitate groundwater recharge 2.1.2.2 Support communities to develop site-specific strategies to combat soil erosion and loss and facilitate groundwater recharge 2.1.2.3 Establish field demonstrations sites for soil erosion minimisation methods and facilitate groundwater recharge 2.1.2.4 Distribute preventive species for erosion control, including establishing Area Council agro-forestry nurseries, and tools to support implementation (coordinated with 2.2.2.3)	15,645 farmers attend training on climate-resilient agricultural methods and erosion management (at least 50% of attendees are women and ensuring inclusivity for people with a disability) Erosion management demonstration sites developed in at least 90% targeted communities 29 rehabilitated erosion hot spots to reduce soil erosion and sedimentation to coastal areas and scaled-up through Area Council extension

Activity 2.1.3 Support communities to protect and rehabilitate habitats that support fisheries, particularly degraded coral reefs, seagrass meadows and mangroves	Support provincial fisheries officers to develop, produce, and deliver training and education materials on mangrove and reef health, sustainable fisheries practices and coastal zone management; implement protections for local coastal habitats (including reduced mangrove clearing, limited reef gleaning); establish new / enhancing existing 'tabu' areas for environmental conservation (including freshwater resources, reef fisheries); rehabilitate key degraded coastal resources (including mangroves, seagrass meadows and coral reefs).	2.1.3.1 Develop and provide training and education materials on mangrove and reef health, sustainable fisheries practices and coastal zone management 2.1.3.2 Engage communities to establish priority areas and targets for action 2.1.3.3 Establish or enhance traditional tabu areas for conservation of coastal resources and freshwater resources (if applicable), building on 2.3.1.1 2.1.3.4 Where relevant, rehabilitate degraded mangroves, seagrass meadows and coral reefs 2.1.3.5 Management of climate-driven invasive species (i.e. crown of thorns starfish)	282 education sessions on mangrove and reef health, sustainable fisheries practices and coastal zone management 11,600 hectares of agricultural and fisheries sites under better management using nature-based solutions
Output 2.2: Climate-resilient agriculture for food security and livelihood development			
Activity 2.2.1 Support adaptations to traditional farming methods to increase climate-resilience and increase food security	Support DARD technical officers to develop and implement training materials on climate-resilient agriculture and water conservation techniques (including intercropping, seed selection, grafting techniques, and planting management); establish field demonstration sites to showcase climate-resilient agriculture methods using a participatory learning approach.	2.2.1.1 Confirm and document what existing and traditional practices exist in each target community and their seasonal calendar (in combination with 2.1.1.1) 2.2.1.2 Develop training materials on climate-resilient agriculture and water conservation techniques that will best suit changing conditions based on information gathered in 1.2.2 and combined with 2.1.3.1 – including intercropping, seed selection, grafting techniques and planting, management 2.2.1.3 Conduct training on climate-resilient agriculture techniques at community level 2.2.1.4 Establish field demonstrations of climate-resilient agriculture techniques (including traditional methods where appropriate)	1,410 print copies of climate resilient agriculture training manual and education materials developed and circulated Farmers in at least 90% of target communities receive and attend training on climate-resilient agriculture Field demonstration sites established in at least 90% targeted communities Farmers in at least 60% of target communities apply climate-resilient agricultural methods (including bio-controls), scaled-up through Area Council extension At least 80% of engagement includes separate women's, disability and youth focus groups
Activity 2.2.2 Introduce/scale up adoption of climate-resilient native food and cash crop varieties	Support the adoption (through increased supply and accessibility) of climate-resilient native food and cash crops, along with simple agricultural tools (including earth huger, rotavator) to increase productivity. Training will be provided to accompany distribution of new planting materials and tools.	2.2.2.1 Establish new or support existing nurseries at Area Council level for raising climate-resilient seed stocks, including native food and cash crops varieties, and germinating seedlings for food and cash crops 2.2.2.2 Distribute resilient native food and cash crops planting materials to communities, including identified climate-resilient varieties of: fruit and nut trees, coconut, vegetables, cacao, coffee and kava	29 nurseries established / supported At least 80% of targeted farmers receive seedlings of climate-resilient native and cash crop varieties At least 80% of targeted farmers receive agriculture tools At least 80% of engagement includes a separate women's, disability and youth groups

		2.2.2.3 Distribute simple agricultural tools to communities to increase production of resilient food and cash crops	
Activity 2.2.3 Establish/scale-up community-, school- and home-based kitchen gardens for enhanced nutrition utilizing climate-resilient crops	Support adoption (through increased understanding, supply and accessibility) of kitchen gardens to promote enhanced nutrition and climate-resilient crops.	2.2.3.1 Deliver family-based nutrition education based on local food and kitchen gardens with diversified, climate-resilient crops and training to promote nutrition and greater use of traditional foods 2.2.3.2 Distribute seeds, seedlings and plants to schools, communities and households to facilitate seed exchanges and seed saving to increase local independence and resilience 2.2.3.3 Establish demonstration training gardens in schools and/or communities to raise vegetable and tree seedlings for increased climate resilient nutrition	Community members in all 29 Area Councils receive training on kitchen gardens, agroforestry, climate-resilient farming and nutrition 29 vegetable nurseries established 29 kitchen gardens established in schools and/or communities across targeted Area Councils
Output 2.3: Climate-resilient fisheries for food security and livelihood development			
Activity 2.3.1 Build community capacity on coastal resource management and monitoring that supports sustainable fisheries	Build the capacity of target communities on coastal resource management; identify 'community champions'; undertake Coastal resource assessments; development and delivery of coastal resource management training program.	2.3.1.1 Engage communities to determine coastal habitat and resource conditions and threats (in combination with 2.1.1.1) 2.3.1.2 Develop a culturally appropriate and scalable coastal resource management training program that includes key capacity areas: the effects of fishing, habitat management tools, monitoring, and sustainable self-governance, including a youth-focused component 2.3.1.3 Deliver education and capacity development program developed in 2.3.1.2	Coastal habitat area, resource condition and threats determined for 202 target communities At least 80% of target coastal communities engaged to establish participation in coastal resource management activities Subsistence fish catch data collected in at least 90% of target coastal communities Fisheries food security and livelihood program developed and delivered in target coastal communities 404 community Champions (202 male and 202 female) in 202 target communities across 29 Area Councils trained in local monitoring and management At least 80% of engagement includes separate women's, disability and youth focus groups
Activity 2.3.2 Support communities to adopt primary community-based fisheries management to reduce climate change impacts	Support adoption of primary community-based fisheries management; collect local fisheries data using community-based monitoring methods; establish long-term mechanisms for sharing data between communities and government; support implementation of climate-resilient management techniques; distribution of off-shore fishing equipment	2.3.2.1 Develop community-level capacity in leadership, monitoring and effective governance, including management of tabu areas 2.3.2.2 Support community champions to collect local and relevant fishing data using established community-based monitoring methods to inform decision-making	At least 90% of target coastal communities empowered to implement effective coastal resource management At least 80% of target coastal communities establish community-led management of coastal resources At least 80% of target coastal communities establish community-led monitoring

		2.3.2.3 Support community-level implementation of climate-resilient fisheries management and development of locally appropriate governance mechanisms 2.3.2.4 Support diversification and sustainability of fisheries resources (alleviating pressures on inshore fisheries) by providing off-shore fishing equipment in targeted communities	At least 80% of target coastal communities implement sustainable governance mechanisms Off-shore fishing equipment distributed to 112 fishing communities (50% of targeted coastal communities)
Output 2.4: Women-led climate-resilient food processing and preservation established to support food security and diversification of livelihoods options			
Activity 2.4.1 Introduce or scale up women-led local solutions for food processing and preservation	Introduce new (or scale up existing) local solutions for food processing and preservation; provide information on relevant food processing and preservation techniques; provide adaptation technologies for food preservation and storage (solar dryers and solar freezers); support long-term use, operation and maintenance of food processing and preservation systems.	2.4.1.1 Local stakeholder engagement to select commodities that exist or can be introduced to communities that are most suitable for preservation and storage (based on existing traditional and cultural practices incorporating the latest best practice across the Pacific). 2.4.1.2 Purchase and install food preservation and storage systems in target communities 2.4.1.3 Support long-term use, operation and maintenance of food processing and preservation systems, including accessing spare parts and skilled labour as needed	90% of target communities assess food processing and preservation options 90% of targeted communities using local food preservation technologies 100% of technology owned and managed by women-led producer groups 30 youth entrepreneurs (100% women) supported to operate and/or maintain preservation technologies
Activity 2.4.2 Support women to diversify into new agricultural/food commodities and value-add products that deliver greater income generating opportunities	Support targeted communities to develop new women-led agriculture/food commodities and value-added products for income generation, including participatory and inclusive community engagement.	2.4.2.1 Participatory community engagement to select opportunities for diversification into and value-add food and non-food products for income generation 2.4.2.2 Support women to develop value-add products that generate income and access to new (distant) markets for emerging commodities utilizing food preservation systems under 2.4.1	Product processing and preservation options assessed for 141 target communities 60% of assessed target communities conduct feasibility assessment of suitable commodities for preservation and storage 5 new livelihood commodities requiring processing and preservation developed by women in 90 target communities At least 90 women-led income diversification initiatives implemented, with at least 30 led by young women
Activity 2.4.3 Support women-led enterprises to access private partnership options to access new (distant) markets for value-add products	Provide assistance for production and distribution of value-added products and agriculture/fisheries commodities, channeled through producer groups established at the community or Area Councils level. In collaboration with the VCCI, identify and facilitate private sector partnerships to further support community-level enterprise and enhance access to markets.	2.4.3.1 Support women to develop producer groups (at community or Area Council level) for production and distribution of value-added products and agriculture/fisheries commodities 2.4.3.2 Support the establishment of partnerships with private sector entities to facilitate community enterprise and enhanced access to markets in collaboration with VCCI	90 women-led producer groups established for production and distribution of value-added products and agriculture/fisheries commodities 6 partnerships established between producer groups and private sector entities to facilitate community enterprise and enhanced access to markets (in collaboration with VCCI)

Component 3: Institutional adaptive capacity is enhanced by building adaptive governance systems at the local level and enhancing local-provincial-national linkages			
Output 3.1: Adaptive local governance systems strengthened through sub-national planning			
Activity 3.1.1 Support Area Council and Province officials to incorporate climate risk analysis and financing strategies into Area Council development plans and budgets	Enable subnational officials to incorporate climate risk analysis into Area Council development planning and budgeting; develop tailored technical trainings for Area Council members, provincial government officials, and other relevant stakeholders; facilitate links between Area Council and Community Adaptation plans; technical support to enable assessment of gender gaps through gender-responsive climate change budgeting and planning.	3.1.1.1 Consolidate and synthesise community analyses (from 1.2.2) to develop Area Council level vulnerability mapping to inform planning and adaptation action 3.1.1.2 Identify and address gaps in the integration of climate risks and adaptation actions into Area Council planning and budgeting processes 3.1.1.3 Provide training and capacity building to Area Council representatives and technical advisory groups on the integration of climate change risks and adaptation actions into planning and budgeting processes (including gender-based risks of climate change) 3.1.1.4 Provide technical assistance/ resources to subnational officials to undertake new/ updated assessments of climate and disaster risk to inform Area Council development plans and budgets 3.1.1.5 Facilitate linkages between Area Council development plans and Community Adaptation Plans to avoid duplication or contradictions, and ensure consistent planning and budgeting 3.1.1.6 Provide technical assistance/resources to local and sub-national government (Area Councils, provincial government) to assess gender gaps through gender-responsive and inclusive climate change budgeting and planning	29 Area Council vulnerability maps developed Analysis of Area Council gaps undertaken Capacity building trainings on integration of climate risk analysis into planning and budgeting processes delivered in 29 Area Council 29 Area Council budget processes established to fund Area Council adaptation activities that consider climate and disaster risk At least 60% of Area Councils operationalize gender-responsive budgeting practices
Activity 3.1.2 Build the capacity of local authorities to support operations of the CDCCCs and ongoing inclusive local adaptation planning processes	Strengthen the capacity of local authorities (including Area Councils and CDCCCs) to carry out inclusive and effective adaptation planning at the local level; develop and implement technical training materials to address key competencies; ongoing support will be provided to local authorities for the inclusion of sustainable budgeting for CDCCCs as a component of Area Council Development Plans.	3.1.2.1 Undertake Area Council capacity reviews to support local adaptation action in order to identify resource constraints and needs 3.1.2.2 Building on 1.2.1 and 1.2.2, roll out further training to build capacity of Area Councils to support the ongoing operations of CDCCCs 3.1.2.3 Assess the status of formal links between Area Councils and CDCCCs and support increased two-way communication and engagement	At least 50% of Area Administrators/Liaison Officers/Area Secretaries in 29 Area Councils participate in capacity assessment At least 90% of Area Administrators/Liaison Officers/Area Secretaries in 29 Area Councils receive capacity building training At least 60% of CDCCCs in 29 Area Councils are allocated sustainable budgeting as part of Area Council Development Plan

		3.1.2.4 Support the inclusion of sustainable budgeting for CDCCCs in Area Council Development Plans	
Activity 3.1.3 Support NDMO to design and establish a shock-responsive social protection system designed for the needs of the most vulnerable households	Utilise co-finance from Australia's Department of Foreign Affairs and Trade to provide technical assistance to the National Disaster Management Office for the design of a government owned, shock-responsive social protection initiative. NDMO will be supported to develop and pilot locally appropriate targeting criteria (including inputs from Activity 1.2.2) to register the most vulnerable children and households in communities and to establish the framework for the system, linked to the strengthened sub-national CIS and EWS systems (including via output 1.3).	3.1.3.1 Provide technical assistance to the NDMO to design a government owned, shock-responsive social protection initiative aligned to strengthened sub-national CIS and EWS systems (linked to output 1.3). 3.1.3.2 Develop locally appropriate targeting criteria to register the most vulnerable children and households in communities (linked to 1.2.2). 3.1.3.3 Establish a framework for a cash transfer system.	social protection system designed criteria developed and tested cash transfer framework developed
Output 3.2: Enhanced local-provincial-national linkages through knowledge management and creation of feedback loops			
Activity 3.2.1 Capture lessons learned, emerging themes and best practices at the community level to ensure sub-national and national planning processes are informed by local needs and that local actions support national objectives	Promote national and sub-national planning processes that are informed by community level experiences and that community-level actions are in support of national public policy objectives. Bespoke knowledge management products and resources will be produced and disseminated. Participation of community champions in national and regional forums.	3.2.1.1 Produce knowledge management products that capture and emphasise local needs to national stakeholders directly involved in the production of high-level adaptation planning processes (Updated NDC, NAP development, UNFCCC reporting) 3.2.1.2 Facilitate participation of community champions and local community liaison officers in national and regional forums (Pacific Resilience Partnership, PIFS side events, national climate change conferences/events, other CBA/GCF project meetings) supported by governments and development partners. Facilitate visibility and engagement of senior officials through project site visits 3.2.1.3 Disseminate knowledge management products (participatory tools, videos, project reports, technical toolkits) that are translated in all three national languages to encourage meaningful consideration and usage at local level 3.2.1.4 Increase the global adaptation knowledge base by linking project outcomes to national, regional and global processes	30 annual knowledge management products produced 18 annual national, regional and/or international forums participated in to disseminate local CBA knowledge 80% of knowledge management products are translated into each national language Progress on gender equality, disability inclusion and youth participation included in annual knowledge management products
Activity 3.2.2 Support local authorities in monitoring and evaluation of national CCDRR policies at the	Support monitoring and evaluation of the national sector policy on climate change and disaster risk reduction. Strengthen linkages and	3.2.2.1 Establish a system to support sub-national authorities (provincial staff, Area Council, Area Administrators/Liaisons) with	80% of Area Councils capture, evaluate, and report CCDRRR sector policy implementation data to national authorities

local level and increasing dialogue between stakeholders at all levels	communication between local, provincial, and national stakeholders. Support sub-national government to establish systems to enhance reporting on implementation of the national CCDRR sector policy. Facilitate participatory events to increase emphasis on long-term, community-level priorities within national and sub-national planning and budgeting processes.	reporting on implementation of national sector policy in their respective local boundaries 3.2.2.2 Facilitate meetings between national and sub-national government stakeholders, including non-governmental actors, to discuss actions to increase emphasis on long-term community-level priorities within national and subnational planning and budgeting processes; coordinated with VCAN activities	7 annual dialogue meetings/forums held to increase communication vertically across government to increase inclusion of local needs in planning decisions 1 national and 29 sub-national planning documents (e.g. strategic plan, business plans, etc.) reflecting long-term community needs identified by local actors
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E.7. Monitoring, reporting and evaluation arrangements (max. 500 words, approximately 1 page)

207. The project has a monitoring, evaluation, accountability and learning (MEAL) framework, designed to measure two main areas:

- progress towards project objectives as articulated in the national climate change policy, updated NDC and the Resilience Framework, and
- contributions to key GCF Investment Criteria and the Adaptation Performance Measurement Framework.

208. Project-level monitoring and evaluation will be undertaken in compliance with Save the Children's MEL systems and processes as well as align to the GoV National Planning Framework (NPF) and National Monitoring and Evaluation Policy (MEP) to ensure complementarity with existing government systems and reporting processes.

209. The PMU's MEAL manager/adviser will be responsible for designing a study to established baseline, mid-line and final data for:

- Fund-level core indicators and outcomes
- Project level results and indicators

Monitoring

210. Setting up the monitoring system of the project will involve different steps. The primary responsibility for day-to-day project monitoring and implementation rests with the Project Manager. The Project Manager in consultation with key stakeholders will develop annual work plans to ensure the efficient implementation of the project. A project inception workshop, involving the Save the Children Australia, the co-Executing Entities (MoCC and SCV) and other key stakeholders will be held within the first six months of the project. The overarching objective of the inception workshop is to: a) assist the Project team and stakeholders to understand and take ownership of the project strategy, objectives and outcomes and discuss any changes in the overall context that influence project implementation; b) discuss the roles, support services and complementary responsibilities of the project team and the national government ministries including reporting and communication lines and conflict resolution mechanisms; c) review the results framework, re-assess baselines as needed, and discuss reporting, monitoring and evaluation roles and responsibilities and finalize the M&E plan.

211. The Project team will ensure that the indicators included in the project results framework are monitored and reported on annually and will objectively report progress. Project components will be monitored separately as well as in relation to the achievement of higher-level projects results and overall GCF goals. The Project M&E will each cover two levels of performance: GCF-level performance (expected performance against investment criteria) and project-level performance.

212. Details of MEAL implementation will be negotiated and included in the agreements between the AE, the Co-Executing Entities – the MoCC and Save the Children Vanuatu. Annual reviews will be led by the PMU with the participation of Area Councils and other government ministries involved in the project. With 29 Area Councils involved, the annual monitoring reviews may need to be organized at the provincial or sub-provincial levels.

Evaluation

213. The project's mid-term evaluation process will include an internal impact evaluation and an independent process evaluation. An independent final impact evaluation will take place no later than three months prior to operational closure of the project.

214. The evaluations will rely on key evaluation questions (to be developed during inception planning) to respond to the performance and impact of the project's completed activities, and will include assessment against OECD-DAC and GCF evaluation criteria. These may include the following: relevance; effectiveness of the project and processes; the efficiency of processes; sustained impact and coherence in climate finance delivery; gender equity and inclusiveness; innovation and potential for paradigm shift; country ownership; coherence of climate finance; and potential for building scale and unexpected results (positive and negative). Overall, the evaluation will contribute to accountability and learning by reviewing emerging evidence on the performance and the impact and/or likelihood of the project and disseminating that evidence to project implementors, beneficiaries and stakeholders (including donors) to support evidence-based decision-making. The mid-term evaluation will be instrumental in contributing – through operational and strategic recommendations – to improve implementation, setting out any necessary corrective measures for the remaining period of the project. The final evaluation will assess the relevance of the intervention, its overall performance, as well as sustainability and scalability of results, differential impacts and lessons learned. The evaluation should also assess the extent to which the intervention has contributed to the Fund's higher-level goal of achieving a paradigm shift in adaptation to climate change in Vanuatu.

215. The full MEAL plan is available in **Annex 11**.

F. RISK ASSESSMENT AND MANAGEMENT

F.1. Risk factors and mitigations measures (max. 3 pages)

* The top 5 risks for the project are provided below with further details on all potential risks (including low risks) in **Annex 2**

Selected Risk Factor 1: Financial Management

Category	Probability	Impact
<u>Technical and operational</u>	<u>Low</u>	<u>Medium</u>
Description		
Public financial management systems of the government's Executing Entity (MoCC) and government ministries implementing activities are unable to effectively absorb and distribute the increased volume of financing from this project on top of existing budget expenditure.		
Mitigation Measure(s)		
The fiduciary management procedures that will be utilized for the project under the Vanuatu Government decentralized model significantly reduces the overall risk and aligns with the intent of the Vanuatu PFEM Act (see Section G3 for further details). In addition, the AE has established and effective corporate policies regarding financial management that further mitigate this risk. While the Government does not have access to sufficient finance to meet current adaptation needs, Vanuatu has the Pacific region's only functional Government Financial Management Information System. The FMIS is linked to a Single Treasury Account (STA), a single reporting system and a single chart of accounts. This means that all government ministries currently access all of their funds via the one system for both spending, reporting and commitment purposes. It is this total level of transparency and control that has enabled Vanuatu to be the first and, in many cases, only recipient of direct budget support from a wide range of donors including DFAT, the European Union, the US MCA, NZMFAT, UNICEF and others. The Vanuatu Government runs a fully centralized financial management system that has sufficient decentralized coverage through Government agencies in the islands (including Department of Finance). This system is functional and can handle significant flows of funding. Project resources allocated to government ministries (including Department of Local Authorities and Provincial governments; Department of Agriculture, Department of Fisheries; Department of Climate Change; and National Disaster Management Office) will all flow through this centralized system and will be tracked and reported via MFEM.		

Selected Risk Factor 2: Long-term capacity building

Category	Probability	Impact
<u>Other</u>	<u>Medium</u>	<u>Medium</u>
Description		
Many international and regional donors are funding projects in Vanuatu that include site-specific activities and discrete government positions. Once this funding and the project ends, experience has shown that there isn't the financial capacity for government to continue the role and the staff and institutional knowledge is lost, and project activities cease.		
Mitigation Measure(s)		
The VCCRP project will mitigate this by embedding sustainable approaches to changing the governance framework and empowering government ministries to increasingly lead implementation of project activities. This will help ensure the knowledge, experience, skills and staff positions supported by the project remain after the project ends. A key focus of the project is in building local capacity to access and effectively utilize future flows of climate finance, including at the most local level (by supporting the development of		

prioritized and fundable local adaptation plans and building local capacity to harness CIS and increasing knowledge of appropriate adaptation actions implementable at the community level.

Selected Risk Factor 3: Prolonged period to establish the project

Category	Probability	Impact
<u>Technical and operational</u>	<u>High</u>	<u>Medium</u>

Description

A lack of technical capacity and slow government systems and processes can affect mobilization and implementation of projects, leading to significant delays in delivery of work plans and meeting funding agreement obligations, particularly in years 1 and 2.

Mitigation Measure(s)

The implementation schedule and budget allocations have specifically taken this risk into account, and the proposal includes a staggered approach to project mobilization and scheduling. Early project activities (particularly in years 1 and 2) will be significantly supported by `Save the Children Vanuatu who can mobilize quickly to support government activities while recruitment, training and other capacity building tasks are completed. This will ensure early implementation is not delayed while also not placing a sudden and over-whelming pressure on limited government resources.

The early establishment of the Project Management Unity (PMU) will enable the timely initiation of the procurement of goods and services which will happen in parallel to the mobilization of sub-national government offices and staff leading to faster project initiation timeframes.

Selected Risk Factor 4: Limited Government Capacity

Category	Probability	Impact
Technical and operational	High	Medium

Description

Current limitations in technical capacity and available resources within government, with multiple competing demands on personnel, can undermine robust governance structures for selecting new positions, project sites and administration of project work plans.

Mitigation Measure(s)

The project will be designed to avoid over burdening any one government delivery partner to minimize straining absorptive capacity and creating capacity constraints that delay project implementation. This is a key lesson from the implementation of a range of previous projects. Working with a range of relevant departments, including Department of Local Authorities and Provincial governments; Department of Agriculture, Department of Fisheries; Department of Climate Change; and National Disaster Management Office will ensure no one department creates implementation bottlenecks as has been the experience with some previous projects. The project will also provide direct technical assistance to Government departments and other delivery partners and supported through Save the Children's systems and national footprint. The breadth of the project will also help ensure community capacity is not overwhelmed. Working across all six provinces will enable the project to spread the investment across space and time. A slow and considered development of in-country, local and ongoing technical capacity and ownership supported by national and international expertise will help ensure sustainable engagement across government and the building of government skills and technical capacity throughout the life of the project.

Selected Risk Factor 5: FP035 (Van-KIRAP / Van CISRD) delays

Category	Probability	Impact
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Technical and operational	Medium	Medium
Description		
If FP035 CIS, IEC and demonstration site outputs are significantly delayed VCCRP will not be able to utilize them as inputs to project activities.		
Mitigation Measure(s)		
FP035 has, to our understanding, completed a range of soft outputs relevant to VCCRP. Should timely inputs to activities be unavailable, we will work closely with DoCC and VMGD to identify other sources of information as inputs to VCCRP IEC and training materials (including those developed under the VMGD/SPREP/SPC COSPPac project – supported by Australia’s Bureau of Meteorology).		

G. GCF POLICIES AND STANDARDS

G.1. Environmental and social risk assessment (max. 750 words, approximately 1.5 pages)

216. The proposal is a Category C in terms of environmental and social risks. ESS screening of the proposed project was undertaken against the GCF Guidelines for the Environmental and Social Screening of Activities Proposed under the Simplified Approval Process (SAP) during the design phase. The SAP ESS screening is substantially the same as the Program Environmental and Social Sustainability Management System (PESSMS) that Save the Children uses internally for similar projects. The objective of these guidelines is to apply best practice standards while reducing process times for micro and small-scale activities that promote and support certain scalable and transformational activities, typically activities qualifying as Category C. The project qualifies to use the SAP guidelines because the proposed actions are small-scale at the individual activity level, including: local community-based watershed and habitat management and rehabilitation; climate resilient agriculture (including soil and water conservation) and community forest management activities.
217. In undertaking this screening, the potential risks and impacts have been considered that include direct and indirect, induced, long-term and cumulative impacts and have taken into account the proposed activities area of influence. SEAH provisions have been included in the project risk screening and its Environmental and Social Assessment and Residual Risk Management Plan (RRMP) **Annex 6**, to prevent and respond effectively to SEAH in a survivor-centred and gender-responsive way in accordance with the Green Climate Funds (GCF) Revised Environmental and Social Policy (ESP) (B.BM-2021/18).
218. As per the SAP guidelines, the screening has been carried out at the pre-mitigation stage to enable the most serious potential impacts of the activities to be considered. While there are several categories of sub-projects proposed under VCCRP, as per GCF requirements, the risk category of the highest risk activity is applied to the entire project.
219. Part A of the SAP ESS Screening is against a set of exclusion criteria. The exclusion criteria describe activities that have specific risk factors that would (i) raise the overall environmental and social risks of the proposed activities and would (ii) require more detailed assessment. Outcomes of Part A screening are shown below and verify that the exclusion criteria are not triggered by the proposed activities and their associated tasks and therefore the SAP can be used for the VCCRP.

SAP Exclusion Criteria	Yes/No
Will the activities involve associated facilities or generate cumulative impacts that would require further detailed due diligence and management planning?	No There are no associated facilities ⁵⁶ on VCCRP
Will the activities involve transboundary impacts including those that require further due diligence and notification to affected states?	No There are no transboundary impacts ⁵⁷ associated with VCCRP
Will the activities adversely affect working conditions and health and safety of workers or potentially employ vulnerable categories of workers including women and children?	No There are no deemed risks to workers or to the employment of any vulnerable groups.
Will the activities potentially generate hazardous waste and pollutants including pesticides and contaminate lands that would require further studies on management, minimization and control and compliance to the country and applicable international environmental quality standards?	No

⁵⁶ Associated facilities are facilities that are not funded as part of the project, and that would not have been constructed or expanded if the project did not exist and without which the project would not be viable.

⁵⁷ Transboundary impacts are those outside the defined area and manifested in other neighbouring countries.

Will the activities involve the construction, maintenance, and rehabilitation of critical infrastructure (like dams, water impoundments, coastal and riverbank infrastructure) that would require further technical assessment and safety studies?	No
Will the proposed activities potentially involve resettlement and dispossession, land acquisition, and economic displacement of persons and communities?	No Any changes proposed to access of lands or resources through management measures will be voluntary and will be based on community decision-making
Will the activities be located in protected areas and areas of ecological significance including critical habitats, key biodiversity areas, and internationally recognized sites?	No Project activities are targeting degraded habitats and ecosystems for improvement
Will the activities affect indigenous peoples that would require further due diligence, free, prior and informed consent (FPIC) and development of inclusion and development plans?	No The target communities of VCCRP are ni-Vanuatu who make up 98% of the country's population and are therefore not considered to be indigenous under UNDRIP
Will the activities be located in areas that are considered to have archaeological (prehistoric), paleontological, historical, cultural, artistic or religious values or contains features considered as critical cultural heritage?	No

220. The SAP Part B requires that an ESS Screening Checklist (appendix of the Residual Risk Management Plan (RRMP)) be applied to the projects proposed activities. Screening was carried out using the screening template recommended as part of the Vanuatu GCF Accreditation Processes Report⁵⁸. The screening tool indicates a low degree of concern and confirms a Category C rating for the VCCRP.

G.2. Gender assessment and action plan (max. 500 words, approximately 1 page)

221. Existing inequality and disadvantage in Vanuatu are amplified by climate change. Access to resources, decision making, information and safety are all mediated through norms associated with gender, disability and age. In rural communities, agriculture and fisheries are family enterprises with different roles undertaken by men and women of different ages and abilities. However, men own the majority of resources and women's access is based on fathers, husbands and sons. Decision-making positions in "kastom" governance as well as national and provincial government are almost exclusively male. At family level there is greater evidence of shared decision-making. Community development, church and market committees are all places where space has been created for women's decision-making and is starting to shift social norms. People with disability and children remain excluded from these structures.
222. National agriculture and fisheries policies now recognize the value of and importance of engaging whole communities and families – women, men, children and youth of all ages and people with disabilities. However long-established practices of working with male heads of household, focusing on their roles in agriculture and fisheries are slow to change. Women's roles in ensuring food security and value adding through marketing, food and handicraft production have not been a focus of climate change adaptations. Yet women's ability to grow food, fish, collect marine resources, and access

⁵⁸ Vanuatu's GCF Accreditation Process: Environment and Social Safeguards Analysis and Recommendations, USAID Climate Ready Project, December 2019

fresh water are all directly impacted by drought, heavy rainfall, high seas and depleting marine resources. Work burdens are increasing, and women face risks of gender-based violence travelling further to gardens and to collect water. Vanuatu already has high rates of gender-based violence which serves to underpin women's exclusion from decision making, reinforces women's unpaid care roles and limit women's mobility.

223. The project will provide opportunities for women, men, girls and boys of all ages to build their resilience to the impacts of climate change in ways that are meaningful to them. Comprehensive community and stakeholder engagement is the foundation on which locally-led adaptation is built. Under the project, all stakeholder engagement will have issues of gender and social inclusion and equity at their heart. CDCCCs will aim for gender equity in representation and decision making, and Community Adaptation Plans will be inclusively developed and address climate risk and resilience building from all community perspectives. The project will ensure that women and men have equal voice in the determination of community adaptation priorities and equally benefit from project activities. Activities implemented via the adaptation packages (**Component 2**) will work to address the specific adaptation needs of all community members, within the project's scope, and (under Output 2.4) focus exclusively on increasing women's economic empowerment via supporting the establishment and operation of women-led enterprises which will help increase and diversify incomes. These needs and opportunities are further explored in the full GESI Assessment and Action Plan (at **Annex 8**).
224. The GESI Action Plan notes that the project benefits women, people with disability and children and youth, as well as men. Project interventions will be targeted in ways that support women, people with disability and children and youth to access climate information, and resources and skills to adapt their livelihoods. To support lasting change the project will also address underlying social norms and behaviours associated with work roles and workload, leadership and violence. This means going beyond individual self-improvement activities for women, people with disability and youth to also transforming power dynamics at household, community, area and province levels that serve to reinforce inequality.
225. A "twin track" approach to disability inclusion will be applied – working directly with people with disability, and also mainstreaming disability inclusion into the wider community and government systems. Vanuatu Society of Disabled People and Vanuatu Skills Partnership are key partners for building skills and training, while Vanuatu Disabled People's Association (Santo) and Rainbow Theatre are important advocacy organizations.
226. Youth will be engaged in project activities to ensure they benefit from adaptation actions and have a voice in adaptation planning and community-level decision making.
227. The full gender and social inclusion assessment and project-level gender and social inclusion action plan is available in **Annex 8**.

G.3. Financial management and procurement (max. 500 words, approximately 1 page)

228. Fiduciary arrangements will follow a decentralized model, that involves the Accredited Entity (AE), Save the Children Australia, providing direct funding tranches separately to both co-Executing Entities, the Ministry of Climate Change and Save the Children Vanuatu, following endorsement of work plans and budgets by the Project Steering Committee and the NAB. Once funding is received by the Vanuatu National Government from the AE via the Reserve Bank of Vanuatu, a decentralized financial management approach will be utilized, where each separate government agency will receive its own budget / appropriation following established work plans and will be responsible for reporting to the Project Management Unit at the Ministry of Climate Change for all expenditure. Existing administrative structures for reporting against funds received would be distributed across pre-existing line Ministry structures located in the Corporate Service Units of each Ministry (as opposed to being centralized in one unit only). This is the approach used by other programs such as the European Union Budget Support, as it significantly reduces the overall administration costs of the program and aligns with the intent of the Vanuatu PFEM Act. The EEs will follow the AE rules and policies. This requirement will be stipulated in the sub agreements.

229. Funding received by Save the Children Vanuatu would be used for implementation of its work plan and programming, including the engagement of procured parties, as approved by the Project Steering Committee and NAB.

Transparency Implications

230. A decentralized model allows for coding of project activities at a higher level in the chart of accounts and as a result the FMIS general reporting system would be able to produce the financial reports required without additional analysis and manipulation.

231. This model also provides a better representation of project spending as expenses are shown alongside other sector spending, which increases transparency and understanding of how these funds are being utilized compared to funds from other donors and the Government budget. The funds would also be more visible to the responsible line Ministries who can view and manage the budget used for the project activities they are expected to deliver.

Administrative burden

232. A decentralized approach can be more administratively cumbersome as it entails multiple spending units across the Government, however, these units already exist within the Corporate Service Units of each Ministry. Therefore, no new structures or work units need to be established in terms of funds administration and the workload would be distributed across pre-existing line Ministry structures. This is the approach already in use by other programs such as the European Union Budget Support as it significantly reduces the overall administration costs of the project.

Control

233. As mentioned above, a decentralized model allows more efficient coding of the project activities in terms of their alignment with the overall “funds control” of the Government system. By spreading the funds allocation across Ministries the project can use higher parts of the coding structure (program, activity, and cost centre) for which there are strong financial controls already in place that would prevent overspending or any one component of the program adversely affecting another.

Alignment with government and donor policies

234. A decentralized model is aligned with Government and donor policies and allows for an accurate representation of project resources by sector and such reports could be produced using the pre-existing government reporting tools and templates without the need to extract and manipulate data externally. It is also aligned with recent Government declarations to provide a greater alignment of donor and Government resources in terms of how they are operationalized and reported on by sector.

Performance management/auditing

235. A decentralized model enables the project to link seamlessly into the Vanuatu Government’s system of performance management and reporting. Under program budgeting, each agency of Government is required to publish a “narrative” that accompanies the budget report. This narrative forms part of the presentation of the budget to the Parliament, and importantly contains service delivery or output and outcome targets. Each agency is then obliged to report on these targets. Hence, the project will use a decentralized financial model to link into the performance management reporting of Government, thereby removing duplicate reporting.

236. Annual audit of the financials of the project will be completed by SCA’s independent external auditor, PriceWaterhouseCoopers. Two Internal audit reviews to be conducted by SCA’s in house Head of Internal audit in years 2 and 5 which will focus on reviewing compliance with SCA’s policies and procedures and GCF requirements. The Australian accounting standards which are aligned to IFRS will be used for project reporting.

G.4. Disclosure of funding proposal

☒ **No confidential information:** The accredited entity confirms that the funding proposal, including its annexes, may be disclosed in full by the GCF, as no information is being provided in confidence.

☐ **With confidential information:** The accredited entity declares that the funding proposal, including its annexes, may not be disclosed in full by the GCF, as certain information is being provided in confidence. Accordingly, the accredited entity is providing to the Secretariat the following two copies of the funding proposal, including all annexes:

- full copy for internal use of the GCF in which the confidential portions are marked accordingly, together with an explanatory note regarding the said portions and the corresponding reason for confidentiality under the accredited entity's disclosure policy, and
- redacted copy for disclosure on the GCF website.

The funding proposal can only be processed upon receipt of the two copies above, if containing confidential information.

H. ANNEXES

H.1. Mandatory annexes

- ☒ Annex 1 NDA no-objection letter(s) ([template provided](#))
- ☒ Annex 2 Feasibility study - and a market study, if applicable
- ☒ Annex 3 Economic and/or financial analyses in spreadsheet format
- ☒ Annex 4 Detailed budget plan ([template provided](#))
- ☒ Annex 5 Implementation timetable including key project/programme milestones ([template provided](#))
- ☒ Annex 6 E&S document corresponding to the E&S category (A, B or C; or I1, I2 or I3):
[\(ESS disclosure form provided\)](#)
 - ☐ Environmental and Social Impact Assessment (ESIA) or
 - ☐ Environmental and Social Management Plan (ESMP) or
 - ☐ Environmental and Social Management System (ESMS)
 - ☐ Others (please specify – e.g. Resettlement Action Plan, Resettlement Policy Framework, Indigenous People's Plan, Land Acquisition Plan, etc.)
- ☒ Annex 7 Summary of consultations and stakeholder engagement plan
- ☒ Annex 8 Gender assessment and project/programme-level action plan ([template provided](#))
- ☒ Annex 9 Legal due diligence (regulation, taxation and insurance)
- ☒ Annex 10 Procurement plan ([template provided](#))
- ☒ Annex 11 Monitoring and evaluation plan ([template provided](#))
- ☒ Annex 12 AE fee request ([template provided](#))
- ☒ Annex 13 Co-financing commitment letter, if applicable ([template provided](#))
- ☒ Annex 14 Term sheet including a detailed disbursement schedule and, if applicable, repayment schedule

H.2. Other annexes as applicable

- ☒ Annex 15 Evidence of internal approval ([template provided](#))
- ☒ Annex 16 Map(s) indicating the location of proposed interventions
- ☐ Annex 17 Multi-country project/programme information ([template provided](#))
- ☐ Annex 18 Appraisal, due diligence or evaluation report for proposals based on up-scaling or replicating a pilot project
- ☐ Annex 19 Procedures for controlling procurement by third parties or executing entities undertaking projects financed by the entity
- ☒ Annex 20 First level AML/CFT (KYC) assessment
- ☐ Annex 21 Operations manual (Operations and maintenance)
- ☐ Annex 22 Assessment of GHG emission reductions and their monitoring and reporting (for mitigation and cross cutting-projects)⁵⁹
- ☒ Annex 23 National Vulnerability Assessment and beneficiary selection

* Please note that a funding proposal will be considered complete only upon receipt of all the applicable supporting documents.

⁵⁹ Annex 22 is mandatory for mitigation and cross-cutting projects.

No-objection letter issued by the national designated authority(ies) or focal point(s)

GOVERNMENT OF THE
REPUBLIC OF VANUATU MINISTRY
OF CLIMATE CHANGE
ADAPTATION, METEOROLOGY,
GEO-HAZARDS, ENVIRONMENT &
ENERGY & NDMO
PMB 9074, PORT VILA
VANUATU



GOUVERNEMENT DE LA
RÉPUBLIQUE DE VANUATU
MINISTÈRE DE L'ADAPTATION AU
CHANGEMENT CLIMATIQUE, LA
MÉTÉOROLOGIE, LES RISQUES
GÉOLOGIQUES, ENVIRONNEMENT &
ENERGIE & NDMO
SPR 9074, PORT-VILA, VANUATU

TEL: (678) 22068

FAX: (678) 22068

Ref: *21/MCCA/PROJ/KRP/11.B.5*

To: The Green Climate Fund ("GCF")

Port-Vila, 10 August 2021

Re: Funding proposal for the GCF by Save the Children regarding the Vanuatu Community-based Climate Resilience Project

Dear Madam, Sir,

We refer to the project titled *Vanuatu Community-based Climate Resilience Project* in Vanuatu as included in the funding proposal submitted by Save the Children to us on 09 August 2021.

The undersigned is the duly authorized representative of the National Advisory Board on Climate Change and Disaster Risk Reduction (NAB), the National Designated Authority of Vanuatu.

Pursuant to GCF decision B.08/10, the content of which we acknowledge to have reviewed, we hereby communicate our no-objection to the project as included in the funding proposal.

By communicating our no-objection, it is implied that:

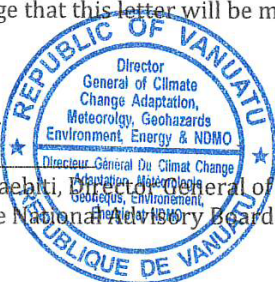
- (a) The government of Vanuatu has no-objection to the project as included in the funding proposal;
- (b) The project as included in the funding proposal is in conformity with the national priorities, strategies and plans of Vanuatu;
- (c) In accordance with the GCF's environmental and social safeguards, the project as included in the funding proposal is in conformity with relevant national laws and regulations.

We also confirm that our national process for ascertaining no-objection to the project as included in the funding proposal has been duly followed.

We acknowledge that this letter will be made publicly available on the GCF website.

Kind regards,

Mrs. Esma Garaebiti, Director General of the Ministry of Climate Change
Chairlady of the National Advisory Board on Climate Change and Disaster Risk Reduction (NAB)
Vanuatu



Secretariat's assessment of FP184

Proposal name:	Vanuatu community-based climate resilience project (VCCRP)
Accredited entity:	Save the Children Australia
Country:	Vanuatu
Project/programme size:	Small

I. Overall assessment of the Secretariat

1. The funding proposal is presented to the Board for consideration with the following remarks:

Strengths	Points of caution
The project offers an innovative approach to transforming local food systems and boosting resilience with long-term benefits	None
The project's adaptation packages provide a unique opportunity to tailor solutions and long-term opportunities to local landscapes and ecosystems and their individual key challenges	None

2. The Board may wish to consider approving this funding proposal with the terms and conditions listed in the respective term sheet and addendum VII, titled "List of proposed conditions and recommendations".

II. Summary of the Secretariat's assessment

2.1 Project background

3. Vanuatu is one of the most vulnerable countries in the world to extreme weather events induced by climate change. It was ranked eighth in the 2020 Global Climate Risk Index and received the highest disaster risk score of 49.7 in the World Risk Report in 2020. The country has been suffering from increasing frequency and intensity of extreme weather events, including heatwaves, flooding and tropical cyclones. Food systems and livelihoods in Vanuatu have been affected by these climate change impacts, as 80 per cent of the population depend on subsistence agriculture and are susceptible to rainfall variability and extreme rainfall. The food security of rural households who depend on coastal fisheries is also threatened by changes in the number, distribution and sizes of coral reef fish and invertebrate species brought about by climate change.

4. The Vanuatu Community-based Climate Resilience Project aims to fill the adaptation deficit in 282 remote and rural communities across six provinces. It will do so by supporting access to and utilization of local-level climate information, integrating climate risks into community planning processes and implementing priority adaptation actions. The project will directly benefit 90,157 people in 28 Area Councils. These are the most vulnerable and socially marginalized people in Vanuatu, who will benefit through the implementation of the project's

adaptation packages, including the adoption of climate-resilient agriculture and fisheries and the development of diversified or enhanced livelihoods resilient to flooding, storm surges, salinization, drought and heatwaves. The project will also indirectly benefit an additional 110,000 rural people.

5. The total project financing is USD 32,650,440, with a request for GCF grants of USD 26,182,878. Co-financing will be provided by the Government of Australia of USD 4,625,040 in grants, USD 1,541,230 in grants by the Government of Vanuatu and USD 301,292 in grants by Save the Children Australia (SCA). The project is submitted under environmental and social safeguards category C.

2.2 Component-by-component analysis

Component 1: Government, civil society and communities are strengthened to support local resilience to climate change impacts, including by providing access to climate information and early warning (total cost: USD 6.68 million; GCF cost: USD 6.02 million, or 90 per cent)

6. Component 1 aims to strengthen the resilience of 254 local communities (90 per cent of the total number of target communities) to climate change impacts through establishing Community Disaster and Climate Change Committees (CDCCCs) that will guide adaptation and disaster preparation and response for the local communities. Under this component Community Adaptation Plans will be developed with CDCCCs and awareness raised among communities of climate change risks through targeted information, education and communication materials. It will extend climate information services and early warning systems to target communities via various available technologies, which will increase the technical competency of the communities in utilizing climate information services and early warning systems.

7. Baseline assessment shows that CDCCCs are either non-existent or not fully functional in the target communities. However, as a result of the active engagement and strong determination of the Government of Vanuatu in its climate actions, their terms of reference, including their structure, roles and responsibilities, have already been defined within the National Disaster Management Office under the Ministry of Climate Change (MoCC). The proposed activity of strengthening CDCCCs is therefore deemed to be appropriate in filling the financial gap for operationalizing the committees, providing an opportunity to increase community-level ownership in managing disaster risks. Although the Government of Vanuatu's in-kind co-financing will support this activity, it will be important to secure resources to continue the committees' activities after project completion.

8. The activities related to climate information services and early warning systems have been extensively discussed between the Secretariat and the accredited entity (AE) in view of the potential overlap of proposed activities with those of approved GCF project FP035, "Climate Information Services for Resilient Development Planning in Vanuatu" (Van-CIS-RDP). Detailed mapping exercises have been conducted at the activity level by the AE in aligning the activities between the two projects. In essence, output 1.3 in the proposed project will enable wider dissemination of the climate information generated by the Van-CIS-RDP project at the community level. This includes utilizing outputs from the Van-CIS-RDP project as an input to the proposed project's community training and facilitating access to the Van-CIS-RDP project's climate information services on an ongoing basis.

9. The appropriateness and necessity of the proposed component has been justified in that the awareness-raising and climate information services provision under this component covers all types of beneficiaries, including government (Area Councils), civil society and communities. Activities under this component should be closely linked to the capacity-building under component 3, especially the knowledge generation and dissemination for the target communities.

Component 2: Scalable, locally appropriate actions are implemented to meet community adaptation needs to create climate-resilient, sustainable development pathways (total cost: USD 14.56 million; GCF cost: USD 13.89 million, or 95 per cent)

10. Component 2 will strengthen agriculture and fisheries systems through nature-based solutions and local value chain improvement. The first output includes the reforestation and restoration of upland forest areas and shoreline vegetation, as well as the protection of critical watershed areas and marine habitats, leading to a total of 11,600 ha sites under better management. This will be done through distributing 500,000 tree seedlings and building at least 254 erosion management demonstration sites. The second output will support 17,072 smallholder farmer households in carrying out climate-resilient agriculture techniques in household plots through training and the provision of seeds and seedlings.

11. This component is structured as an adaptation package, with a suite of adaptation activities in the agriculture and fisheries sectors. Target communities will be able to select the most appropriate and effective options within the package to meet their needs on the ground. Given the dispersed locations of the target communities in different Area Councils, the proposed approach is deemed adequate and the most feasible approach in delivering tailored adaptation solutions for the target livelihoods. While the exact adaptation interventions have not been determined for each community at the project appraisal stage, the proposal still manages to set overall output and outcome targets, as provided in the logical framework. The package has been designed based on wide stakeholder consultations and the targets may change depending on the needs of the communities.

12. Under this component, GCF grants will be used to generate tangible outcomes to address food insecurity in the agriculture and fisheries sectors. The component focuses on the supply side of agricultural inputs, tools and techniques; to maximize upscaling potential, mechanisms that would incentivize target beneficiaries to adopt such inputs and techniques are required. As the priority has been given to addressing food insecurity due to climate change, such incentive mechanisms and business models have not been incorporated into the design of the project. It would be advisable to discuss, design and develop them as part of the knowledge products in component 3.

13. The proposed agriculture and water conservation techniques are well-known and recognized agricultural practices that will produce 'no regrets' results. These techniques are based on a comprehensive stocktake of existing and traditional agricultural practices and crop calendars. As for the requested GCF grant funding, the proposal provides sound justification for the request of full concessionality, supported by the financial analysis, which shows marginal rate of return and net present value.

Component 3: Institutional adaptive capacity is enhanced by building adaptive governance systems at the local level and enhancing local-provincial-national linkages (total cost: USD 8.51 million; GCF cost: USD 3.67 million, or 43 per cent)

14. Component 3 aims to build the capacity of provincial and national actors, as well as local authorities, to integrate climate risks into their governance, planning and budgeting processes. Based on climate risk analysis and vulnerability mapping for each Area Council, a tailored social protection system will be established, including a cash transfer system, to protect the most vulnerable population against climate change. The second part of this component is to generate and disseminate knowledge management products based on lessons learned and best practices gleaned through this project.

15. A concrete financial exit strategy is provided only to a limited extent. The proposed component offers a good opportunity to design and mainstream a financial exit strategy that is viable in the local context and the context of projected climate impacts, supported by a cash transfer system and business plans.

16. The proposed component is assessed to be adequate and reasonable, given the importance of sharing knowledge and good practices across communities and provinces. Considering the remoteness of the islands from each other, expensive travel and high costs of goods and services production, the most cost-efficient way should be used to disseminate the knowledge and know-how through established mechanisms, including CDCCCs.

Project management (total cost: USD 1.47 million; GCF cost: USD 1.17 million, or 80 per cent)

17. The GCF portion of the project management cost is about 4.7 per cent of the total requested GCF funding and is compliant with the GCF policy on fees.

III. Assessment of performance against investment criteria

3.1 Impact potential

Scale: N/A

18. The project targets the most vulnerable and marginalized communities in Vanuatu covering a vast area of islands, including some of the most remote islands in the Vanuatu archipelago covering all six provinces. A total of 90,157 direct beneficiaries, or 33 per cent of the population, will become more resilient and achieve diversified livelihoods through the sustainable use of the adaptation packages and access to climate information services fostered by the project. The packages and the information services will enable the target communities to diversify their livelihoods and make them less vulnerable to shocks and hazards as well as less prone to future shocks caused by cyclones.

19. The project will further reduce food insecurity and malnutrition by diversifying the existing farming and food systems by promoting highly diversified local food products that will provide communities with a very varied, healthy, nutritious and sustainable diet.

20. The project offers a unique platform for scaling up the best practices fostered by the adaptation packages, the strengthened resilience and the enhanced capacity at both government and community level. This will be ensured by an innovative project design adapting the packages and support to the specific needs of the circumstances and challenges of each community group through government and national partners.

3.2 Paradigm shift potential

Scale: N/A

21. The Vanuatu community-based climate resilience project fosters innovative solutions to meet the current climate challenges faced by communities on a daily basis and empowers them to become less vulnerable and build a solid platform to further diversify their livelihoods and adapt to future challenges, including shocks and hazards from cyclones.

22. By combining the adaptation packages, well designed and adjusted to each of the provinces, islands and local circumstances, farming and food systems, with access to detailed and continuous climate information and built capacity across all levels of Vanuatuan society, the project will be able to improve the current situation for the poorest and most vulnerable population groups. Furthermore, it will offer a long-term solution to the continued empowerment of communities across the archipelago in adapting to future challenges and shocks and strengthen local food systems to provide healthy and nutritious diets as well as fostering rural entrepreneurship.

23. The adaptation packages offer a unique platform to cater to the demands, challenges, opportunities and investment options of each community and its local landscapes and food systems.

3.3 Sustainable development potential

Scale: N/A

24. The project empowers communities through capacity-building, ensuring better access to education services and the sustainable management of ecosystem services and enabling communities to diversify their food systems and create jobs and growth at the local level as well through the adaptation packages. This will allow communities to strengthen and diversify their household incomes and help to create robust productive landscapes.

25. The project will further boost health conditions for targeted communities through better access to healthy and diversified diets with locally produced and processed food, and this access and processing will continue to be expanded and take a new direction throughout implementation and beyond.

26. Furthermore, the project fosters strong gender mainstreaming across the activities, ensuring equal participation in decision-making across the community groups and at the provincial level.

3.4 Needs of the recipient

Scale: N/A

27. The project targets the most needy, vulnerable and poorest communities across the archipelago. The targeted communities are also the most marginalized.

28. Coronavirus disease 2019 has had devastating impacts on the local economies across the six provinces, with market access blocked to the local communities, not to mention the collapse of the tourism sector.

29. Vanuatu regularly experiences category 5 tropical cyclones, causing significant damage to local infrastructure and food systems and presenting a challenge to the government in financing the rebuilding of multiple damaged areas.

30. The project will build the capacity of government across all levels and in parallel with empowering communities to better withstand such shocks and hazards and boost local food systems to be more productive, resilient and long term oriented.

3.5 Country ownership

Scale: N/A

31. The project objectives and structure are fully aligned with all strategic frameworks of the country.

32. The first nationally determined contribution of Vanuatu underlined the key priority of adaptation solutions. The country's national adaptation programme of action also focuses on adaptation, pointing to five priority areas headed by agriculture and food security.

33. The updated nationally determined contribution zooms in on quantifiable adaptation targets seeking to further boost resilience in the agriculture and water sectors. Agriculture is targeted as a main strategy with the focus on household income and nutrition needs in a changing climate.

34. National policies and strategies such as the National Sustainable Development Plan also point directly to the key priority of building adaptation solutions that focus on food and nutrition. In addition, the Climate Change and Disaster Risk Reduction Policy 2016–2030 outlines the key importance of adaptation solutions.

3.6 Efficiency and effectiveness

Scale: N/A

35. The structure of the proposed adaptation packages supported by the information services and capacity-building provides a platform for transforming local livelihoods, boosting resilience and modifying food systems to generate a multitude of services and opportunities for rural entrepreneurship and value chain development focusing on local production and processing.

IV. Assessment of consistency with GCF safeguards and policies

4.1 Environmental and social safeguards

36. The project is classified as environmental and social safeguards category C. The project has developed an environmental and social assessment and residual risk management plan that provides for screening of proposed activities and management of potential minimal environmental and social residual risks and impacts. The environmental and social co-benefits include increased access to locally available food supplies; enhanced ecosystem services through reforestation, erosion control and shoreline protection; and increased access to education as a result of the enhanced capability to adapt to extreme climate events through better planning and implementation of disaster risk reduction strategies. The AE has requested minor revisions and clarifications of the plan, which will need to be addressed prior to Board circulation.

37. The revised GCF Environmental and Social Policy adopted by decision B.BM-2021/18 requires safeguarding from sexual exploitation, abuse and harassment (SEAH) in GCF-financed activities. As the Vanuatu Community-based Climate Resilience Project aims to support highly vulnerable remote and rural communities across all six provinces of Vanuatu, where custom laws and practices are predominately administrated by male chiefs in rural areas, the SEAH risks associated with the project need to be addressed.

38. The project has incorporated screening and management of SEAH-related potential risks and impacts in its relevant safeguards instruments, such as the Residual Risk Management Plan. As SEAH stems from unequal relations and power dynamics resulting in a culture of discrimination and privilege, the project examines such risks with regard to the project workforce and affected communities. The project considers that project staff and consultants spending time in communities, including occasionally overnight, will have influence or relative power over the distribution of project inputs where community members may not be aware of or able to identify and report any SEAH incident.

39. To resolve the SEAH risks associated with the unequal power dynamics, the project has identified relevant measures in the Residual Risk Management Plan to mitigate and manage the SEAH risks and impacts by providing awareness-raising and training to build capacities for both its workforce and affected communities on the SEAH policy and SEAH-related procedure for monitoring and reporting and the project grievance redress mechanism. The project also plans to identify and equip community child protection and SEAH focal points to monitor the conduct of project staff during project implementation and report concerns or incidents as they arise. To ensure that the project-specific grievance redress mechanism responds to SEAH incidents, the project will train staff to handle sensitive disclosures and make referrals to appropriate service providers.

40. The project identifies SEAH mitigation measures, including integrating SEAH into staff induction and training, reflecting SEAH prevention and response in the planning and initiation of community-based activities and monitoring SEAH risks and incidents throughout project implementation. The project considers that putting the SEAH prevention and response measures into place will not imply additional costs to the project as they are seen or costed as part of the project design.

41. The SEAH safeguarding undertaken by the AE is aligned with the SEAH provisions of the revised GCF Environmental and Social Policy. The AE is required to take all necessary measures to ensure such alignment to prevent and respond effectively to SEAH in a survivor-centred and gender-responsive way.

4.2 Gender policy

42. The AE provided a gender assessment and action plan with the funding proposal and therefore complies with the requirements of the GCF Gender Policy.

43. Vanuatu's constitution provides rights to live freely without discrimination on the basis of sex. The country prepared the second national gender equality policy to enhance women's economic status, mainstream gender equality into national sectoral policies, increase women's participation in leadership and decision-making and foster gender-responsive community-driven solutions to climate and disaster resilience. Vanuatu is a signatory to the Convention on the Elimination of All Forms of Discrimination Against Women. In addition, it has signed related regional commitments such as the Pacific Leaders Gender Equality Declaration. National institutional arrangements include the Department of Women's Affairs situated in the Ministry of Justice and Community Services. The department is responsible for policy and programme development and supporting mainstreaming of gender into other government departments; however, it has limited technical and financial capacity at the national and provincial level to deliver on its mandate adequately.

44. Social norms shape gender matters by giving men control over women's behaviour and privileges to make decisions in traditional settings. Women have limited access to resources such as land, which is mediated through husbands and sons. Caring for family members, managing food gardens, fishing and water collection, handicraft work and selling produce at markets are roles assigned to women. Men have greater mobility and can be engaged in employment outside the home, including in urban centres and other countries.

45. Women and men are active participants and producers in the fisheries and agriculture sectors. They grow different crops and use different levels of technology in agriculture. Women lead in weeding, planting and maintaining crops closer to home, while men take on clearing and ploughing land, including use of machinery. Women's gender roles restrict their access to training and extension initiatives. Extension services and enterprise development training usually target male heads of household, thereby valuing men's work over that of women. Deep water fishing with larger vessels for sale is a male-dominated activity, while women undertake coastal gleaning and fishing from canoes for food security, and aquaculture and fish processing to generate income. Although women participate in fishing their contributions are undervalued. The gender assessment also describes challenges faced by people with disabilities and the compounded issues of women with disabilities in Vanuatu. People with disabilities are targeted for stakeholder engagement, training and inclusion in committees.

46. Community meetings, key informant interviews and women's focus group discussions undertaken in the preparation phase of the project identified challenges associated with adapting to climate change and responding to natural disasters, the limited inclusion of women in community committees and the need for income generation. The following priorities were highlighted, especially by women: training on agricultural practices, value addition and financial literacy, food security and income diversification. Even though these priorities were identified, the gender assessment does not clearly describe the opportunities presented by the project to address them. Nonetheless, they are reflected in the gender action plan.

47. The gender action plan submitted with the proposal contains activities aligned with those of the project, performance indicators, baseline, sex-disaggregated targets, timelines and responsibilities. The project aims to address the limited inclusion of women in community

structures by targeting a gender balance in CDCCCs to improve women's participation in leadership and decision-making positions at the community level. Project benefits will be accessible to both women and men and sex-disaggregated targets are included for each activity. Although the funding proposal has outlined in detail the activities that will be supported by the project, the gender action plan describes them broadly as project-provided resources which will be accessible to women and men equitably. The gender action plan includes opportunities for women and men to participate in training on climate-resilient agriculture, canoe making and value addition skills. This responds to issues raised in stakeholder engagement during the project's preparation and the gender assessment. Furthermore, inputs will be provided in the form of seeds, seedlings, simple agricultural tools, food processing and preservation technologies and fishing equipment. Other project benefits include food processing and preservation equipment such as solar food dryers and freezers to support food security. Needs and priorities identified in the consultation process to deliver income-generating opportunities to enhance resilience to climate change are reflected in the gender action plan through the support to market access provided to women-led producer groups which will be established for bringing agricultural and fisheries goods and value addition.

48. Implementation arrangements include a gender equality and social inclusion adviser for the project who will be included in the project management unit to supervise and guide the execution of the action plan. The Department of Women's Affairs will be included in the project steering committee. Executing entities (EEs) will also participate in the implementation of all the activities in the action plan. In addition, costs allocated from the project's budget are included for each activity listed in the action plan.

49. The AE is required to collect sex-disaggregated data on all activities where communities will benefit from project-provided resources and report accordingly to GCF as per the action plan.

4.3 Risks

4.3.1. Overall programme assessment (medium risk)

50. This is an adaptation project that seeks to support vulnerable rural communities in Vanuatu by implementing targeted adaptation actions and facilitating decentralized governance structures that enable rural populations to adapt to changing climate trends and reduce disaster risk. GCF is requested to provide USD 26.3 million in grants. Additional co-financing will come from the Government of Australia (USD 4.6 million grant), the Government of Vanuatu (USD 1.5 million in-kind contribution) and the AE (USD 30,000 grant for project management costs).

51. Vanuatu is a small island developing State. Moreover, given the public nature of the proposed activities and the difficulty of access to finance for community-based adaptation, the AE deems it appropriate to request grant funding.

4.3.2. Accredited entity/executing entity's capability to execute the current programme (medium risk)

52. SCA is the AE of this project. It is a non-governmental organization based in Australia that operates internationally through its network. Globally, SCA is implementing a portfolio of over 100 resilience-related projects and programmes valued at more than USD 200 million, including those with explicit objectives to reduce climate and disaster risks, as well as to increase adaptive capacity and speed recovery from shocks and stresses. Specifically, SCA has implemented adaptation projects in countries including the Philippines, Bangladesh and Vanuatu.

53. The project will be co-executed by two entities, namely, the Government of Vanuatu, acting through MoCC, and Save the Children Vanuatu (SCV). MoCC will retain overall responsibility for the implementation of the project; it will be the lead EE for all outputs and activities. Both entities have experience in managing and delivering climate change programmes across Vanuatu at a range of scales and from a variety of funding sources; for example, MoCC is the co-EE for the Van-CIS-RDP project referred to in paragraph 8 above as well as the EE for a number of donor-funded projects, including via the Global Environment Facility. SCV is a separate legal entity that is managed by SCA and utilizes the SCA systems and processes. The AE has completed an initial partnership assessment for MoCC, which identified no red flag risks. However, an organizational review of SCV highlighted challenges in areas such as capacity and procedures. SCA expects remedial actions to address the identified shortcomings to be concluded in early 2022.

4.3.3. Project-specific execution risks (medium risk)

54. Long-term sustainability: two out of the three major components in this project will be dedicated to awareness-raising and/or capacity-building in order to foster understanding of climate change impacts and develop local adaptation plans, strengthen the capacity of government officials and incorporate climate risk analysis and financing strategies into the planning process. It may take time for such support to eventually translate into concrete actions within communities. The lag may affect the long-term sustainability of the project.

55. Financing risk: multiple aspects of the proposed exit strategy hinge on the fact that financial resources from the national government will be allocated to community-based adaptation activities. However, the national government does not currently have sufficient funding, given the political complexities with budget cycles and approvals. At the subnational level, little to no funding is invested in community-based adaptation as this is not featured in the planning process. Although this project is envisaged to raise awareness and influence the central allocation of funds, subsequent funding to ensure the sustainability of community resilience measures could become a challenge.

56. Economic analysis: a cost-benefit analysis returns a project-level economic internal rate of return of -1 per cent. The benefits are estimated by valuing the avoided damage, erosion and carbon emissions, as well as calculating production and income increase for agricultural activities. The negative internal rate of return indicates that the total costs outweigh the envisaged economic benefits, thus giving rise to questions about the viability and effectiveness of GCF investment in this project.

4.3.4. GCF portfolio concentration risk (low risk)

57. In the case of approval, the impact of this proposal on the GCF portfolio risk remains non-material and within the risk appetite in terms of concentration level, results area or single proposal.

4.3.5. Compliance risk (medium risk)

58. Vanuatu is not the subject of any current targeted United Nations Security Council resolutions or sanctions regimes.

59. SCA, as the AE, confirmed that no project activities will be undertaken in a jurisdiction which is subject to or affected by United Nations Security Council resolutions. Furthermore, no individual or entity that is listed on any United Nations Security Council sanctions list, including the United Nations Consolidated Sanctions List, will be involved in any manner with the project or its activities, either as a counterparty, implementer or beneficiary.

60. SCA completed partnership assessments in October 2021 for its EEs, namely SCV and the Government of Vanuatu represented by MoCC, as follows:
- (a) **SCV:** the data collected for the assessment included a review of policies and procedures, summary findings of an audit completed by the SCA Global Assurance team in 2021 and discussions with the SCV team. The assessment found that SCV overall has strong systems, capacity and experience to implement the scope of work outlined in the funding proposal. No red flag risks were identified per the Initial Partnership Assessment (IPA); and
 - (b) **MoCC:** the data collected for the assessment included a review of related policies, a 2020 Public Finance Management Assessment by the Australian Department of Foreign Affairs and Trade for the Department of Education and the Government of Vanuatu overall, and discussions with MoCC staff. The assessment found that MoCC has the experience and expertise to successfully carry out the scope of work outlined in the project. Owing to limited access to MoCC staff during the review period, the data compiled by SCA on key areas of the MoCC financial systems are not fully complete and will require additional information gathering in collaboration with MoCC partners to fill gaps relating to controls, reporting, planning and staffing. Similarly, while SCA reviewed the Ministry of Finance and Economic Management and MoCC procurement guidelines, which were deemed adequate as outlined in their procurement manuals, it was unable to confirm how these policies and procedures are followed on a day-to-day basis. While the review identified no red flag risks, SCA will continue to collaborate with MoCC and plans to update the Initial Partnership Assessment (IPA) on an ongoing basis throughout project delivery and support MoCC in addressing any weakness as identified.
61. SCA confirmed a broad array of control mechanisms established to address money-laundering and terrorism financing risks, including:
- (a) Anti-Money Laundering and Countering the Financing of Terrorism Policy;
 - (b) Regular vetting processes carried out for staff, partners and suppliers, in line with the SCA Staff and Partner/Supplier Vetting Guidelines;
 - (c) Whistle-Blower Policy and Procedure;
 - (d) Incident reporting mechanism for receiving and managing reports of suspected or alleged fraud, corruption or dishonesty, including anti-money-laundering and countering the financing of terrorism;
 - (e) Reference and background checks carried out for new staff;
 - (f) Partner assessment completed for all delivery partners and updated regularly;
 - (g) Participatory programme design and implementation, including by the Government of Vanuatu and SCV;
 - (h) Embedded Program Management Unit, which is jointly recruited by SCA;
 - (i) Active Technical Working Group and Project Steering Committee approving disbursements;
 - (j) Strengthened government financial management and procurement processes;
 - (k) Financial management and procurement assessment conducted during effectiveness/start-up and regularly thereafter;
 - (l) Audits and spot checks in relevant ministries;
 - (m) Monthly budget v actual expenditure reports;
 - (n) Rigorous background check on programme staff;

- (o) Electronic transfer of funds where applicable; and
 - (p) Regular publicity about the programme, its targets and achievements.
62. Similarly, SCA confirmed a broad array of control mechanisms established to address fraud and corruption risks, including:
- (a) Fraud, Bribery and Anti-Corruption Policy;
 - (b) Whistle-blower Policy and Procedure;
 - (c) Incident reporting mechanism for receiving and managing reports of suspected or alleged fraud, corruption or dishonesty;
 - (d) Fraud refresher training for all SCV staff, consultants, MoCC staff and other government department staff and community volunteers involved in the project;
 - (e) Strengthened government financial management and procurement processes and a programme operations manual for finance and procurement;
 - (f) Financial management and procurement assessment conducted during effectiveness/start-up and regularly thereafter;
 - (g) Regular audits;
 - (h) Monthly budget v actual expenditure reports – Global Movement of Children (GMC) reports;
 - (i) Rigorous background checks on programme staff (recruitment process);
 - (j) SCV working closely with the Ministry of Infrastructure & Public Utilities (MIPU) to strengthen the MIPU procurement system to ensure that no fraudulent activities occur;
 - (k) Robust internal financial guidelines and checks and whistleblowing policy; and
 - (l) Monthly project monitoring reports – GMC.
63. SCA confirmed that it does not to distribute or disburse to beneficiaries, either directly or indirectly, cash, vouchers or commodities. However, it advised that the project plans to distribute low-value, simple agricultural and offshore fishing equipment to targeted households. The project will also distribute food processing and preservation equipment (solar dryers and freezers) to a number of communities. This will be carried out as follows:
- (a) The agricultural and fishing equipment will be distributed direct to households via community-level agreements under the Community Adaptation Plan in each targeted community (which will be developed through a collaborative stakeholder engagement process, endorsed by community and approved by the EEs). Distribution will be undertaken by relevant government departments (Department of Agriculture and Rural Development [DARD], Vanuatu Fisheries Department [VFD] and Department of Local Authorities [DLA]); and
 - (b) The food processing and preservation equipment will be distributed to community-level producer groups identified via the Community Adaptation Plan process. Again, distribution will be via relevant government departments and approved by the EEs through the Community Adaptation Plans.
64. SCA advised that the project will provision limited materials and technology to CDCCCs, co-operatives and other established and government accredited institutions which will limit diversion or misuse. SCA confirmed that, for the materials and technology that are distributed, the project will proactively engage with CDCCCs to establish community buy-in, increase knowledge of proper use and regularly publicize accountability mechanisms such as the whistle-blower, complaint and grievance redress mechanisms. Project monitoring will include checking on the presence and use of any distributed materials distributed by the project.

65. SCA confirmed that its Whistle-blower policy was provided during accreditation and applies to all SCA staff, SCV staff and partner organizations. Supplemental to the whistle-blower policy, SCA maintains a complaints process that is accessible via phone, email and post.

66. **Recommended risk rating:** the Compliance Team of the Office of Risk Management and Compliance (ORMC) has conducted a review of the project in accordance with relevant GCF Board-approved policies and does not find any material issue or deviation with respect to compliance issues. Based on available information for this funding proposal, the ORMC Compliance Team has determined a risk rating of medium and has no objection to this request proceeding to the next steps.

67. The ORMC Compliance Team would like to remind SCA, as the AE, of its continuing obligations and responsibilities with regard to monitoring and reporting any risks with respect to money-laundering, terrorist financing or prohibited practices among the intended counterparties, EEs, beneficiaries, persons involved or any of the proposed activities.

4.3.6. Summary risk assessment and recommendation

Summary risk assessment		Risk assessment
Overall project/programme	Medium	Pending capacity issues with SCV need to be addressed The Vanuatu Government's continued willingness and ability to mobilize co-financing will be critical for the sustainability of enhanced community resilience
Accredited entity/executing entity capability to implement the project/programme	Medium	
Project-specific execution	Medium	
GCF portfolio concentration	Low	
Compliance	Medium	

4.4 Fiduciary

68. SCA is the AE for this project. The Government of Vanuatu acting through MoCC and SCV will co-execute the project.

69. SCV and MoCC will work with other government ministries and procured parties to deliver agreed national-level activities. The in-kind support to be received from the Government of Vanuatu is a 10.7 per cent allocation from their approved recurring ministry budgets. SCA will review monthly expense reports prepared by the ministries of recurring costs against the recurring budget and extrapolate and report on the cost in relation to this budget. The internal audit reviews will include the in-kind funding support from the Government of Vanuatu in their sample selections for review. The Programme Management Unit will monitor the in-kind contribution and report it as part of the Annual Progress Reports and audits.

70. The EEs will follow the AE rules and policies. This requirement will be stipulated in the sub-agreements.

71. Annual audit of the financial statements of the project will be completed by SCA's independent external auditor, PricewaterhouseCoopers. Two internal audit reviews are to be conducted by the SCA in-house Head of Internal Audit in years 2 and 5, which will focus on reviewing compliance with SCA policies and procedures and GCF requirements. The Australian accounting standards, which are aligned to International Financial Reporting Standards, will be used for project reporting.

4.5 Results monitoring and reporting

72. This is an adaptation project focusing on supporting highly vulnerable rural communities across Area Councils in Vanuatu to increase their resilience to climate variability and change by implementing targeted adaptation actions and facilitating decentralized governance structures that enable rural populations to adapt to changing climate trends and reduce disaster risk. The project's adaptation packages provide a menu of actions to support households and communities in addressing key drivers of climate change vulnerability, minimize exposure and sensitivity and build resilience to unavoidable impacts.

73. The project will reach and increase the adaptive capacity of 200,157 beneficiaries, out of which 90,157 are direct beneficiaries and 110,000 are indirect beneficiaries. It is the second GCF project supported in Vanuatu and will have strong synergies and build upon the work of the Van-CIS-RDP project.

74. This is the first GCF project developed under the new GCF Integrated Results Management Framework. It is fully aligned with the requirements of the framework in relation to results management and uses the latest GCF funding proposal template.

75. Annex 5 needs to add the key milestones and deliverables for each activity.

76. Annex 11 is still to be updated in line with the Integrated Results Management Framework.

4.6 Legal assessment

77. The Accreditation Master Agreement was signed with the Accredited Entity on 20 December 2019 (the “AMA”), and it became effective on 20 May 2020.

78. The Accredited Entity has provided a legal opinion of its General Counsel dated 12 August 2021 confirming that it has obtained all internal approvals and it has the capacity and authority to implement the project

79. The proposed project will be implemented in Vanuatu. The GCF has signed a bilateral agreement on privileges and immunities with Vanuatu; however, such agreement is still pending its entry into force. This means that the privileges and immunities are only effectively accorded to GCF upon the agreement entering into effect. Therefore, until such moment, amongst other things, GCF is not protected against litigation or expropriation in this country, which risks need to be further assessed.

80. The Heads of the Independent Redress Mechanism (IRM) and Independent Integrity Unit (IIU) have both expressed that it would not be legally feasible to undertake their redress activities and/or investigations, as appropriate, in countries where the GCF is not provided with relevant privileges and immunities. Therefore, it is recommended that disbursements by the GCF are made only after the GCF has obtained satisfactory protection against litigation and expropriation in the country, or has been provided with appropriate privileges and immunities.

4.7 List of proposed conditions (including legal)

81. In order to mitigate risk, it is recommended that any approval by the Board is made subject to the following conditions:

- (a) Signature of the funded activity agreement in a form and substance satisfactory to the GCF Secretariat within 180 days from the date of Board approval; and
- (b) Completion of the legal due diligence to the satisfaction of the GCF Secretariat.

Independent Technical Advisory Panel's assessment of FP184

Proposal name:	Vanuatu community-based climate resilience project (VCCRP)
Accredited entity:	Save the Children Australia
Country/(ies):	Vanuatu
Project/programme size:	Small

I. Assessment of the independent Technical Advisory Panel

1.1 Impact potential

Scale: N/A

1. This funding proposal for a small project in environmental and social safeguards category C is submitted by Vanuatu, a small island developing State¹ in the Pacific, with 65 inhabited islands and a population last recorded at 272,000. This is an adaptation project, with Save the Children Australia as the accredited entity (AE) and two co-executing entities – the Government of Vanuatu's Ministry of Climate Change and Save the Children Vanuatu. The total cost of the funding proposal is USD 32.65 million, as detailed in paragraph 29 below.

2. . Current available evidence, combining observed historical trends with future projections, indicates that a number of significant climate change challenges face communities in Vanuatu. Projected future trends in three key climate parameters are: 1) temperature: air and sea (increased minimum, mean and maximum daily temperatures and occurrence of events such as heatwaves); 2) rainfall patterns (increased duration of dry periods and changing frequency and intensity of extreme rainfall and rainfall associated with El Niño/Southern Oscillation); and 3) tropical cyclones (increased intensity, with extreme wind and waves, and intense rainfall and flooding). Category 5 cyclones in 2015 and 2020 caused loss of life and extensive damage to economic activities; the funding proposal shows that over the 42-year period to 2010, 101 tropical cyclones developed or crossed into the Vanuatu Exclusive Economic Zone, although the AE has not demonstrated a historical trend in relation to cyclone intensity.

3. With about 80 per cent of the population of this Pacific island nation dependent on subsistence agriculture, climate change poses a significant risk to Vanuatu's agriculture sector and food security. Agricultural activities in Vanuatu are particularly susceptible to climate change induced changes in rainfall patterns, extreme rainfall leading to flooding, droughts, heatwaves, salinization processes, increases in evapotranspiration, seasonal variations and reduction in freshwater availability. Under a Representative Concentration Pathway 4.5 scenario, soil moisture is expected to decrease significantly, with potential increased evapotranspiration, indicating significant stress on non-irrigated crops. These climate impacts are exacerbated by soil erosion and loss of soil fertility due to deforestation and environmental degradation. Prolonged and intense rainfall damages seedlings and encourages conditions that promote diseases and pests. Droughts create additional thermal stress on plants. Projected air temperature increases are likely to reach the maximum heat tolerance thresholds of some staple crops and induce heat stress and crop failure, especially in traditional crops such as

¹ Vanuatu graduated out of least developed country status in 2020.

cassava, taro and yam. Communities on Torres islands, South Santo, South Malekula, Central Pentecost, Epi, Erromango, Aniwa and Aneityum, in particular, have reported impacts from increased temperatures and droughts on declining crop yields and lowered livestock productivity during the 2015–2016 El Niño period. Coastal fisheries also contribute significantly to food security, with 60 per cent of rural households engaging in coastal fisheries activities, which, already at critical risk from non-climatic pressures such as overfishing and habitat degradation from pollution, are further threatened by climate change. Changes in ocean temperature and acidity are expected to impact on coral reef fish and invertebrate species in Vanuatu by altering their metabolic rates, growth, reproduction and survival, resulting in changes to species abundance, distribution and sizes that may reduce catches and food security.

4. Despite investments by the government and its technical and financial partners in the agriculture and fisheries sectors in response to these threats, more comprehensive, integrated adaptation measures are required, firmly rooted in communities' needs, including strengthening early warning to vulnerable communities of both slow and sudden onset disasters intensified by climate change. The project's goal statement is that IF vulnerable remote and rural communities in Vanuatu access and utilize locally relevant climate information, integrate climate risks into community planning processes and are supported in implementing priority adaptation actions, THEN they will be more resilient to the impacts of increasing climate variability, extremes and change on their food security and livelihoods, BECAUSE their exposure and vulnerability to hazards will be reduced and their adaptive capacity increased. The project will work to achieve this goal via activities under three interlinked components:

- (a) Component 1: Government, civil society and communities are strengthened to support local resilience to climate change impacts, including by providing access to climate information and early warning
- (b) Component 2: Scalable, locally appropriate actions are implemented to meet community adaptation needs to create climate-resilient, sustainable development pathways (adaptation packages)
- (c) Component 3: Institutional adaptive capacity is enhanced by building adaptive governance systems at the local level and enhancing local-provincial-national linkages.

5. **Adaptation impact.** The project is expected to have adaptation impact by contributing to increased climate-resilient sustainable development in a number of ways – strengthening adaptive capacity and reducing exposure of vulnerable communities to climate risks; increasing generation and use of climate information in decision-making; and strengthening institutional and regulatory systems for climate-responsive planning and disaster risk reduction. Component 2 involves implementing adaptation packages for climate-resilient agriculture, fisheries and diversified/enhanced livelihoods resilient to the conditions of flooding, storm surges, salinization, drought and heatwaves (marine and terrestrial). Activities under components 1 and 3 will reduce the vulnerability of farmers and fishers through the use of improved climate information services and early warning systems through Community Disaster and Climate Change Committees (CDCCCs) for disaster preparedness and response, as well as through the adoption of resilient food preservation and processing techniques and income diversification.

6. The project is designed to directly increase the climate resilience of 90,157 people in 19,556 households and 282 communities across all six provinces (33 per cent of the total population or 43 per cent of the rural population), with a focus on the most vulnerable and socially marginalized groups. Project interventions should result in substantial reductions in the risk of loss of lives and assets due to reduced exposure to extreme weather events, as well as a significant increase in the number of people adopting climate-resilient livelihoods options. They will also increase the number of households with year-round food security. A further 110,000

people will benefit indirectly from enhanced governance capacity, increasing the project's total reach to 95 per cent of the rural population.

1.2 Paradigm shift potential

Scale: N/A

7. The project aims to bring about a paradigm shift away from an agricultural system that is highly sensitive to climate change to climate-resilient food productive systems which ensure food and water security for farmers and fishers. Achieving reduced vulnerability and increased resilience requires a shift in agricultural and fisheries practices in Vanuatu. The project aims to achieve a transformation in the way adaptation actions are conceived and implemented, providing local communities with up-to-date climate information and projections; empowering them to make informed decisions about the nature, timing and type of adaptation actions they want to take; and resourcing them to follow through and feed results upward through governance structures to create a fundamental shift in the way adaptation is pursued. To date, a largely top-down approach to community-based adaptation has resulted in adaptation actions at the local level that are not community owned and, therefore, not consistently maintained or sustained after project funding concludes.

8. In order to promote longer-term sustainability of any adaptation technologies provided to communities, the project will ensure that adaptation package actions and implementation align with and support existing government systems and processes. Importantly, the project will ensure that government systems and processes are reflective of local needs and have the capacity to support them by strengthening the current vision of decentralization. This is seen as a key paradigm shift in a country that has largely been governed under a centralized approach despite the dispersed and isolated population. Output 2.4 activities under component 2 will help targeted communities to diversify their livelihood options via supporting access to markets for agriculture/food commodities, creating new avenues for remote and rural communities to engage with private sector entities and increase the sustainability of project activities.

9. The project also addresses scalability and replicability – it works with 29 of Vanuatu's 71 Area Councils and provides a model for village-level CDCCs to guide both adaptation and disaster preparedness and response. According to the funding proposal, this model, with concomitant investments in early warning systems and Area Council planning and budgeting, "could be applied in all remaining communities in Vanuatu via a combination of domestic resources and future climate finance". The independent TAP notes that the project does not itself establish a pathway to scaling up the approach across the whole country, and that such scaling up will in practice probably rely on follow-on official development assistance of one kind or another, given government's small revenue base. On the positive side, component 3 of the project invests in knowledge-sharing and learning engagement between national and subnational government and has a specific output 3.2 for "Enhanced local-provincial-national linkages through knowledge management and creation of feedback loops". This includes facilitating meetings between national and subnational government stakeholders, including non-governmental actors, to discuss actions to increase the emphasis on long-term community-level priorities within national and subnational planning and budgeting processes.

10. In terms of catalysing impact beyond a one-off investment, a project rooted in the agriculture and fisheries sectors would ideally seek to achieve market transformation that will ensure the maintenance and continued uptake of adaptation approaches and technologies at producers' own cost post-project. In this regard, the VCCRP seeks to provide incentives for longer-term uptake of climate-resilient practices through helping producers to achieve increased profit margins through support to cash crop production, preservation and processing. Support for crop varieties resilient to climate change impacts, combined with investment in renewable-powered solar food dryers and fish freezers, and capacity development for preservation processes like salting and pickling, should significantly enhance yields and prevent

food losses, improving food security even in the face of climate change. However, facilitating access to markets for surpluses remains a major challenge.

11. The funding proposal identifies as one of three major existing barriers to effective and sustainable locally led adaptation in Vanuatu “Low incentives for private sector entities to engage with remote rural communities to support increased market access and help diversify livelihoods”. The project aims to introduce new livelihoods commodities (dried fruits, dried nuts, smoked fish, shell crafting, copra, coffee) in least 140 of the 282 target communities, establishing 90 women-led producer groups to support communities in bringing agricultural and fisheries goods to market and facilitating at least six private sector partnerships to support access to distant markets for commodities (assumed at one per province). If these economic activities could be put on a sustainable business footing, with strengthened supply chains including buyer contracts in place by the end of the project, this would indicate that a significant paradigm shift has taken place whereby the agriculture and fisheries sectors have reached a point where investments in climate change adaptation have become self-sustaining.

12. This is noted in the project’s exit strategy with its six elements, one of which is to “Foster sustainable value chains in the local market. Food surpluses from agriculture and fisheries...are expected to be generated due to improvements in agricultural and fisheries practices, including through access to improved CIS, as well as significantly reduced losses from excess production and improved handling of produce. Establishing the value chains ensures a small but steady supply of income to the community with which the operation and maintenance of the installed processing technologies can be supported over the long term. Once communities have realized the potential of marketing food surpluses, this may lead to autonomous growth without the need for further external financial support, especially through fostering of twinning arrangements between local producers and private enterprises in the food sector”.

13. There are a number of structural constraints, however, to the engagement of downstream private sector actors to help to bring products to markets such as Port Vila and its tourism sector, or cross-continental export markets. Like other small Pacific island countries with limited natural resources and narrow-based economies, Vanuatu is physically detached from major markets, has a small population spread across many islands, with trade balance skewed towards imports. The funding proposal notes the “long distances and limited transportation options between the project sites and the main commercial and residential hubs of Vanuatu” and the “poor communication and transport networks within and between islands”, and expresses the view that the “combination of extreme remoteness from major markets, very small size, dispersion over vast tracts of the Pacific Ocean, and environmental fragility results in very high cost of production of goods and services by both the private and public sector, leading to an assessment that the public sector is likely to remain the main source of formal sector employment and driver of economic activity in most Pacific Island countries for the foreseeable future”.

14. The independent TAP asked the project proponents if it is realistic to attract private sector buyers or transport middlemen with small and unpredictable volumes of relatively low-value produce that must travel long distances to market. In response, the AE noted that, “against a challenging backdrop there are success stories of local producers reaching domestic and at times export markets. Many of these examples are in the tourism industry where tourism service providers, including cruise ships, will purchase and use locally produced goods to support the local economy as part of the experience...they are selling”. It also noted that “a number of organizations and donors have been undertaking research in private sector and value chain analysis in Vanuatu over the years” and “a commonality across all studies and past and present projects is that it is not easy to engage the private sector, for the reasons outlined in the Funding Proposal. This is why we have purposely kept the target of this activity low (6) in comparison to the scale of the project.” The modest scale of the project’s ambitions in this

regard make sense and are realistic but limit the extent to which a market-based paradigm shift to sustainable adaptation practices is possible.

15. An additional concern on the sustainability of project outcomes relates to the project's lack of a costed operation and maintenance (O&M) plan with a commitment by government implementing partners, at the various levels at which adaptation technology will be employed, to meeting these costs. The independent TAP is concerned about how equipment purchased through the project will be sustained in terms of operating costs, upkeep and eventual replacement; for example, smartphones, tablets, etc., in activity 1.1.1, satellite dishes and solar panels in activity 1.3.1, earth auger and rotavator in activity 2.2.2, solar food driers and solar-powered freezers in activity 2.4.1 and quad bikes in activity 3.1.2. The funding proposal acknowledges the importance of O&M, referring in the exit strategy to "inevitable on-going operation and maintenance (O&M) related expenses associated with introduced adaptation technologies (including solar PV freezers and solar air driers) to reduce the likelihood of negative externalities such as equipment falling into disrepair or breaking down" and noting that project activities include "training for target communities on installation, operation, maintenance and repair of all equipment, and budget to provide spare parts or training in using local materials for repairs and maintenance. This guidance on post-sale/installation O&M considerations will also be supplied to the [Department of Climate Change] DoCC on the selection and procurement of adaptation technology services for use in communities."

16. In response to a question from the independent TAP on ensuring that O&M needs will be adequately resourced, the AE stated that "Options for resourcing the O&M will depend on the needs and cost. The two principal options that will be used are: 1) government funding through development expenditure incorporated into government budgets along with the wider adaptation options as described in the project's sustainability plan (for example, for the maintenance of quad bikes); and 2) the collection of maintenance fees from users at the point of use of the equipment in the communities (such as for the rotavators and freezers)". In response to follow-up questions, the AE acknowledged the importance of formal O&M planning and committed itself to continuing to work with the co-executing entities on this to enhance project sustainability: "The approach chosen and used will be discussed and agreed with CDCCCs, Area Councils, Provinces and relevant line ministries to ensure the approach is consultative and participatory, as well as technically robust and reflects the needs and desires of the end users – the communities".

1.3 Sustainable development potential

Scale: N/A

17. **Environmental co-benefits.** In terms of the environment, the project is expected to have extensive co-benefits. On the marine side, the project seeks to increase the sustainability of ecosystem services by reducing reliance on vulnerable resources (e.g., reef fish) as a primary food source in rural coastal communities. Sustainable fisheries practices and coastal zone management will lead to the implementation of protections for local coastal habitats (including reduced mangrove clearing, limited reef gleaning); establishing new or enhancing existing "tabu" areas for environmental conservation (including freshwater resources, reef fisheries); and rehabilitating key degraded coastal resources (including mangroves, seagrass meadows and coral reefs). For terrestrial ecosystems, the project will develop coastal and upland resource management plans; establish living barriers; support reforestation of damaged forests and water catchments; manage invasive vine species impacting watersheds; and establish new or strengthen existing community conservation areas.

18. **Social co-benefits.** The project has a number of social co-benefits. Increasing social inclusion across all areas of community life – with a specific focus on ensuring that the voices of traditionally underrepresented groups (e.g., youth, people with a disability) are heard in climate-related decision-making forums. The project aims to increase broad community health

outcomes by ensuring that communities have more secure access to locally available nutritious foods. Community adaptation planning and enhanced disaster risk reduction and response will enable increasing access to education, by ensuring that fewer school days are lost in the aftermath of extreme weather events. The project is also transformative in its focus on promoting women's equitable representation in project activities and enabling greater economic empowerment and participation in decision-making by women, youth and people with a disability.

19. **Economic co-benefits.** The project works to increase the household incomes of rural communities through livelihoods diversification and increasing access to markets. Component 2 includes support to 261 communities on utilizing climate-resilient food preservation techniques to prevent food spoiling and wastage, and support to 140 communities on new livelihoods commodities (see para. 11 above). Communities will be supported in diversifying into new agricultural/food commodities and value added products that deliver greater income generating opportunities, including identifying local value added commodities with market potential and supporting processing. In collaboration with the Vanuatu Chamber of Commerce and Industry, private sector partnerships will be identified and established to further support community-level enterprise and enhance access to markets, and, where possible, support producer groups in transitioning into micro or small enterprises (including support in identifying longer-term sources of finance for business development).

20. **Gender-sensitive development impact.** The project promotes increasing gender equality across all areas of community life, with a specific focus on ensuring that women's voices are heard in climate-related decision-making forums and that the gendered nature of climate change impacts is a key component of all climate and development planning at the community and province level. This includes leadership training targeted at women, as part of capacity development for CDCCC members under component 1 to identify climate change and disaster risks at the local level and liaise on their needs with the National Disaster Management Office. In particular, the focus of output 2.4 on women is noted, including project interventions to i) introduce or scale up women-led local solutions for food processing and preservation, including identifying the foods most suitable for preservation and provision of processing equipment (solar dryers and freezers) to communities; ii) support women in diversifying into new agricultural/food commodities and value added products that deliver greater income-generating opportunities, including identifying local value added commodities with market potential and supporting processing; and iii) support women-led enterprises in accessing private partnership options to access new (distant) markets for value added products.

21. The independent TAP welcomes the inclusion in the gender action plan of childcare provision during project implementation to facilitate women's full participation in project activities and decision-making forums. In response to a question from the independent TAP about the budgetary implications, the AE explained that the project takes two approaches to address women's needs for support with childcare to enable them to engage in the project, neither of which will require GCF funds. The first approach is providing childcare for specific periods through existing Early Childhood Care and Development Centers that increasingly exist in communities (supported by government and organizations such as Save the Children) or through community groups and churches. The second approach is "to take the project to the women where they already regularly congregate. CDCCCs are mandated to include women (and the project will ensure gender balance) and they are increasingly represented in other decision-making forums. Women leaders engaged by the project will then consult and engage with other women in the community and church groups where they already congregate and socialize". This is welcomed as good practice in getting the details right to ensure women's full and effective participation in project activities.

22. Vanuatu has the highest score in the world on the global disaster risk index – a score of 49.74, indicating a high degree of physical exposure, relative vulnerability and resultant risk of loss of life from natural hazards. This is intensified by the predicted impacts of climate change discussed above, combined with adaptation deficits that need to be addressed to build community resilience to these impacts. Financing this adaptation gap has posed a significant challenge in Vanuatu, which, despite its graduation in 2020 from least developed country to lower middle-income country status, remains highly aid dependent. While steadily increasing economic and social indicators over recent decades are a positive sign for Vanuatu's climate resilience, gains remain unevenly distributed and the most vulnerable people and communities will require adaptation assistance for the foreseeable future, particularly given the country's significant exposure to extreme weather events and other hazards. The economic impact of the coronavirus disease 2019 pandemic, with the collapse of the tourism sector and reduced tax receipts, combined with the loss and damage suffered from level 5 Tropical Cyclone Harold that hit the country in April 2020, pushed the domestic budget into deficit in 2020/21, and is likely to have set Vanuatu back to gross domestic product levels typical of least developed countries.

23. Consultations in preparation for the project by the Ministry of Climate Change and Save the Children Vanuatu revealed significant climate-related impacts on agriculture and fisheries, and the ecosystems that support them. Domestic revenue remains insufficient to adequately fund essential services to a widely dispersed, largely rural population, and donor programmes are generally focused on immediate development priorities (e.g., economic growth, poverty reduction, health and education). Only a few initiatives focus on climate change or mainstreaming the management of climate change risks and the building of resilience building into production and governments sectors. While the Government of Vanuatu has access to strong technical climate change capacity, the capacity to deliver adaptation assistance to the local level – in ways that meet community needs and expectations – remains restricted. Communities in Vanuatu urgently need scaled up support to address immediate adaptation priorities and to support the integration of climate change into local planning processes.

1.5 Country ownership

Scale: N/A

24. The project is well aligned with Vanuatu's policy framework, including its first and subsequent nationally determined contributions (NDCs) under the Paris Agreement, which highlight adaptation to climate change as the country's overriding concern. The focus of the project is aligned with the national adaptation programme of action (NAPA) and focuses on three of the five identified adaptation priority areas, namely: agriculture and food security; community-based marine resource management; and integrated water resource management. The project is also aligned with the National Climate Change Adaptation Strategy for Land-Based Resources (2012–2022), the Disaster Risk Reduction and Disaster Management National Action Plan and the Climate Change and Disaster Risk Reduction Policy (2016–2030).

25. Vanuatu's NAPA, Climate Change and Disaster Risk Reduction Policy and GCF country programme are also fully aligned with the country's National Sustainable Development Plan, the highest public policy framework in Vanuatu, which explicitly includes climate change adaptation as a key sustainable development priority. Policy objectives include: "Enhance traditional agricultural practices, focusing on disaster risk reduction and climate change adaptation"; "Institutionalize climate change and disaster risk governance, and build institutional capacity and awareness"; "Improve monitoring and early warning systems"; "Strengthen post-disaster systems in planning, preparedness, response and recovery"; "Promote and ensure strengthened resilience and adaptive capacity to climate related, natural and man-made hazards"; and "Access available financing for climate change adaptation and disaster risk management".

26. Projected actions by the Government of Vanuatu on national priorities for climate change adaptation in 2021–2022 include efforts identified under its updated NDC (2020–2030)

to provide for quantifiable adaptation targets. The updated NDC includes specific targets and indicators aimed at enhancing the resilience of the agriculture and water sectors, developed with the objectives of maintaining food, income and water security. The overarching goal for the agriculture sector is: “Agriculture is able to support household income and food needs in a changing climate”. Two targets have been established to meet this goal, focused on small and medium-sized enterprises and private sector operators to generate sufficient income to cover essential household needs and services in normal and stressed (climate, disaster and environmentally) times; and implemented measures for enhancing the resilience of subsistence agriculture in a changing climate in the six provinces. The VCCRP aligns well with the NDC goal and targets.

27. Vanuatu has had five GCF readiness proposals approved from 2015 to date, with which the VCCRP is well aligned. In 2018, the Government prepared the GCF country programme for Vanuatu, complementing the NAPA and Climate Change and Disaster Risk Reduction Policy and assisting the government with the prioritization of adaptation investments. The VCCRP is highlighted as a priority in Vanuatu’s GCF country programme, including in the 2021 update. The funding proposal has been developed through close cooperation between the AE and the project’s two co-executing entities. The national designated authority and senior staff from key departments of the Ministry of Climate Change have been engaged in the design process, and the national designated authority will co-chair the Project Steering Committee, maintaining a role in the oversight of the project and direct lines of communication with the Project Management Unit throughout implementation.

28. Country ownership has been promoted through an extensive and comprehensive consultation process with the Ministry of Climate Change and line ministries via workshops and meetings, as well as wider engagement with civil society. Relevant stakeholders were identified through a mapping exercise and consultations built on stakeholder engagement between 2016 and 2019 with key partners, government and communities, to develop the concept note. Consultation was participatory and voluntary, working closely with primary stakeholders who will play a part in implementation. The continued consultation during the design phase with government at all levels, civil society and other relevant stakeholders further progressed the project development and ownership; it included discussions on the project concept and details of the design process, feasibility study results, focus of the adaptation package, validation of the target beneficiaries and approval of the full funding proposal at the meeting of the National Advisory Board on Climate Change and Disaster Risk Reduction in April 2021.

1.6 Efficiency and effectiveness

Scale: N/A

29. The total project cost is USD 32.65 million, 80 per cent of which is a USD 26.18 million GCF grant contribution. The remaining USD 6.47 million, or 20 per cent of the total project cost, is made up of grant and in-kind contributions from the Government of Vanuatu (USD 1.54 million), Save the Children Australia (USD 300,000) and the Australian Department of Foreign Affairs and Trade (USD 4.63 million). Government of Vanuatu contributions are in kind and are distributed across the three technical components of the project, but can be considered as significant given the country’s financial position as discussed above. The structure of the project as 100 per cent grant financed represents an appropriate level of concessionality in the country’s context, and the small profit margins expected on small-scale farming and fishing, combined with the public goods nature of ecosystem restoration, mean that the GCF project is not expected to crowd out potential private sector investments.

30. The economic and financial analysis conducted for the project examined four specific adaptation actions deemed to be representative of the actions in the adaptation package menu, and found that all four have solid economic internal rates of return (EIRR) and can be justified on economic grounds: early warning system communications equipment (EIRR of 111 per

cent); nature-based solutions – coastal management (EIRR of 12 per cent); climate-resilient agriculture, with taro and yam as examples (EIRR of 19 per cent for taro and 27 per cent for yam); and food processing and storage (EIRR of 81 per cent).

31. Looking at the project overall, however, the economic analysis showed the project has an EIRR of only 3 per cent, which, while positive, is below the discount rate used of 5 per cent. This is because of the high non-economically assessable costs (non-investment costs) required to enable and support the adaptation investments, and to create transformational change in remote and rural communities that are highly vulnerable to the impacts of climate change. The AE suggests that these costs are high because of the need to address significant capacity gaps and constraints at all levels (government at national, provincial and Area Council levels as well as at the community level) to ensure that the project leaves behind significantly increased institutional capacity to enhance the sustainability and replicability of the project's adaptation investments and catalyse transformation. Also significant is the high cost of delivering projects in Pacific small island developing States because of their remoteness from major markets, small size and dispersion over vast tracts of the Pacific Ocean, such that the technical assistance and travel costs of projects in these island nations are typically higher than those in other developing regions.

32. Application of best practice technologies is also important to ensure cost-effectiveness of the GCF and co-financing resources. In relation to the restoration of coastal ecosystems (mangrove swamps, seagrass beds and coral reefs), the project budget is fairly limited (USD 385,000) and has no detailed explanation of how it will be spent, or which of the wide variety of restoration techniques, some extremely costly (particularly those involving diving), may be utilized. There are also additional complexities involved where cyclones have damaged coastal ecosystems extensively, for example, cutting off mangroves from the freshwater supply providing optimal salinity levels for survival.² The feasibility report (Annex 2) also does not provide any reflection on various approaches, techniques and costings, and methods and which have proved effective and cost-effective in recent restoration initiatives, including in the Pacific.

33. In response to a question from the independent TAP on this, the AE said that the budget highlighted is only for actual restoration work, and that there is additional budget in other activities for the assessment of the most appropriate sites, methodology and associated risks and costs. The development of local community adaptation plans during project implementation will include a feasibility assessment of the most appropriate rehabilitation techniques specific to that community. The AE also stated that "the project will also draw on established techniques in Vanuatu (e.g., coral gardening), as well as elsewhere in the Pacific (e.g. mangrove restoration) and globally (e.g., seagrass restoration) when selecting methodologies for specific sites and communities to suit the site conditions and are cost-effective".

34. In follow-up discussions, the independent TAP reiterated its concern, indicating that many coral reef and seagrass restoration techniques may be beyond the reach of the project's budget, and that it was difficult to assess the potential of the proposed mangrove restoration when no information was provided about the current state of degradation of the mangroves, including whether engineering works might be needed to reconnect mangrove swamps to freshwater sources where such connections have been disturbed by cyclones or human activities, to avoid the scenario in which newly planted mangrove propagules die en masse. In response, the AE stated that many of the Vanuatu islands' coastal ecosystems are still in a relatively undamaged state and would need smaller investments to maintain their functionality as climate change buffers. A detailed assessment of the ecosystem condition and what is needed to restore functioning will thus need to be the starting point for assessments of potential

² See the recent report by The Nature Conservancy: *Hurricane Damages to Mangrove Forests and Post-Storm Restoration Techniques and Costs*; available at https://www.nature.org/content/dam/tnc/nature/en/documents/TNC_MangroveHurricaneDamages_Report.pdf.

approaches and techniques. Detailed monitoring mechanisms will need to be put in place to track progress of restoration efforts, including resultant changes in ecosystem functioning that buffer climate change impacts.

II. Overall remarks from the independent Technical Advisory Panel

35. The independent TAP recommends this funding proposal for approval, subject to one condition. In order to maximize sustainability of the project's investments in equipment and technologies for adaptation, the independent TAP requests that an O&M plan be developed as a condition to first disbursement, as described below. Therefore, this endorsement by the independent TAP is subject to the following condition:

Condition precedent to first disbursement by GCF under the funded activity agreement:

- (a) Prior to the first disbursement of GCF Proceeds for the Funded Activity, the accredited entity shall finalize and submit to the Fund a costed Operations and Maintenance (O&M) Plan for the project, in a form and substance satisfactory to the GCF Secretariat.

Response from the accredited entity to the independent Technical Advisory Panel's assessment (FP184)

Proposal name:	Vanuatu community-based climate resilience project (VCCRP)
Accredited entity:	Save the Children Australia
Country/(ies):	Vanuatu
Project/programme size:	Small

Impact potential

SCA welcomes ITAP's positive assessment of the project's impact potential. This reflects the project's focus on building the resilience of some of the most vulnerable people and communities in Vanuatu, a small island developing state only recently graduated from least developed country status (and whose economy has been substantially impacted by the COVID-19 pandemic). The project will directly reach over 40% of the rural population and set the foundations for a step change in the way community-based adaptation is undertaken in Vanuatu.

Paradigm shift potential

SCA notes ITAP's assessment of the project's paradigm shift potential. We note the concerns expressed on the private sector impact and need for an operations and maintenance plan. As ITAP notes, the project's modest aims for private sector engagement make sense and are realistic. The project will work within the constraints of a largely subsistence and widely dispersed economy to support enhanced market engagement among targeted communities to help diversify livelihoods strategies and increase their resilience to climate change impacts. Regarding the project's operation and maintenance, we note the need to develop a costed O&M plan for the project. We accept this condition and will ensure it is met prior to first disbursement of project resources.

Sustainable development potential

SCA welcomes ITAP's positive assessment of the project's sustainable development potential, particularly in relation to the focus on addressing gender equity issues and supporting women's economic empowerment through supporting women's decision-making roles in local climate governance mechanisms and promoting resilient livelihoods diversification activities as this is a key focus of the project.

Needs of the recipient

SCA welcomes ITAP's positive assessment of the needs of the recipients, reflecting the urgent need for scaled up adaptation assistance to highly vulnerable remote and rural communities.

Country ownership

SCA welcomes ITAP's positive assessment of the project's country ownership. The project has been developed via a highly collaborative and participatory process, ensuing high ownership by the participating government ministries and targeted communities.

Efficiency and effectiveness

SCA notes ITAP's assessment of the project's efficiency and effectiveness. Regarding the project's overall EIRR, as the ITAP assessment notes, the significant non-economically assessable costs and high cost of delivery context result in a low overall EIRR. This is offset by the economic and financial analysis findings that each of the assessable activities have strong EIRR. Furthermore, the project responds to the GCF's objective to build the climate resilience of the most vulnerable communities, which requires substantial investments in non-economically assessable activities to ensure the sustainability of project outcomes. We believe this investment in capacity building, its focus on highly climate vulnerable communities and its sustainability focus, along with the experience of the executing entities in delivering community-level projects will result in a highly efficient and effective project.

Regarding ITAP's concern around the ecosystems-based adaptation component, the community-level bio-physical assessments will be undertaken prior to any decisions being made on specific adaptation activities related to restoration of coastal ecosystems. These assessments will feed into the broader participatory community adaptation planning process to ensure high local ownership of resulting activities.

We note ITAP's assessment that 'application of best practice technologies is also important to ensure cost-effectiveness of the GCF and co-financing resources'. We agree, however we would highlight here that best practice must also include a focus on the local context. The technologies that will be utilized under this project will support communities to achieve their adaptation objectives in a way that sits well in the local context. The project is also promoting best practice in processes, for example, support for highly participatory local adaptation planning processes and putting the principles for locally-led adaptation into practice.

Overall remarks from the independent Technical Advisory Panel:

SCA welcomes ITAP's overall positive assessment of the funding proposal and notes with gratitude the recommendation that the Board approves the Project.

We note and accept the proposed condition on the development of a costed operations and maintenance plan for the project prior to first disbursement.

As outlined above, we believe this project will have a transformative impact on the climate resilience of highly vulnerable remote and rural communities in the small island developing state of Vanuatu, who, through no fault of their own, are facing a context of escalating climate extremes which, unaddressed, will likely undermine their sustainable development potential. Remote and rural communities in SIDS face substantial adaptation capacity and finance gaps. We believe this project will showcase how scaling up locally-led approaches to adaptation and building local capacity to access and effectively utilise future flows of climate finance can help close both these gaps and provide a model for other SIDS with similar challenges.

Vanuatu Community-based Climate Resilience Project (VCCRP)

Annex 8: Gender Assessment & Action Plan

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PART 1 VCCRP GENDER AND SOCIAL INCLUSION ANALYSIS/ASSESSMENT 2

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PART 2 VCCRP GENDER AND SOCIAL INCLUSION ACTION PLAN 18

Part 1 VCCRP Gender and Social Inclusion Analysis/Assessment

Introduction

1. The project aims to improve the adaptive capacities of rural communities and recognises that within communities' gender, age and disability influence adaptation capacities and that addressing structural disadvantages is a precondition to adaptation. This analysis considers the ways in which gender, age and disability intersect with climate change and disasters in Vanuatu with a focus on rural communities. The analysis sets out key data and analysis across six domains and includes recommendations for the Project. The core approach is to embed gender equality and social inclusion across the Project activities and operations. The Gender and Social Inclusion Action Plan highlights actions included in the Project wide logical framework.
2. The six domains of analysis are:
 - Law, policy and institutions.
 - Social norms and beliefs.
 - Roles, responsibilities and time use.
 - Decision making, leadership and participation.
 - Access to and control of resources; and
 - Safety, dignity and well-being.
3. The analysis and action plans are based on literature review, key informant interviews with national government officials, and community profiles in North Ambrym, Epi and North West Santo, undertaken through community meetings, surveys and women's focus group discussions.

Methodology

The assessment and action plan was prepared by the feasibility team located in Vanuatu and the GESI adviser based in Australia. The team used a combination of primary and secondary methods:

- Literature review of policy documents, project reports and published research
- Women's focus group discussions and community surveys in 8 communities across three provinces, using standard question guides and in local languages.
- Key informant interviews with national government staff including Ministry of Climate Change, Ministry of Agriculture, Livestock, Fisheries, Forests and Biosecurity; Department of Women's Affairs and Department of Local Authorities.
- Key informant interviews with disability NGOs.

4. Key Findings

- National policies on climate change, agriculture, fisheries and gender equality recognise the importance of gender equality and social inclusion in building community climate and disaster resilience
- Translating these policies into service delivery is hampered by limited expertise in gender mainstreaming at national, provincial and area levels of government. Support is needed for area and province level staff to undertake gender and social inclusion analysis with communities and integrate findings into annual planning, budgeting and reporting systems
- At family level women and men report a high level of shared decision making. Men are seen as heads of households and social norms privilege male decision making in traditional, formal and community settings. At community level NGO's have supported inclusive decision making in Community Disaster and Climate Change Committees (CDCCCs) which has created space and shifted norms around participation of women, people with disability and youth in decision making.
- Under customary law women's entitlement to land and natural resources are mediated through husbands and sons. This has significant implications for economic development, food security and gender-based violence.
- In rural communities while women and men are equally active producers in agriculture and fisheries, the majority of extension and training programs are tailored to the needs and interests of male producers.

- Women and girls work significantly more hours than men, with less time for leisure or rest. In rural Tanna women worked twice as many hours as men. Impacts of climate change such as drought, heavy rains, sea level rise and rough seas all increased women's workloads.
- Service providers need to shift approach to recognise that rural livelihoods are family enterprises, with women making up half of rural producers. Engaging families rather than just male heads of household using the family teams approach is an effective way of reaching women and men, recognising and building on the work of all family members
- Already high levels of gender-based violence are amplified in the aftermath of disasters, due to displacement, breakdowns in services and increased pressure on families with loss of food stores and access to water.

Key Data ¹

- The population of Vanuatu is 272,459 (Male 138, 265/Female 134,194)
- The annual population growth rate is 2.3%, one of the highest rates in the world.
- Vanuatu is one of only two countries in the world where there are no women in Parliament.²
- Vanuatu's HDI score is 0.609 (2019) which put the country in the medium human development category – positioning it at 140 out of 189 countries and territories. Between 2005 and 2019 Vanuatu's HDI increased by 6.1% (Vanuatu Human Development Report). The Gender Development Index which provides the sex-disaggregated data of the three dimensions measured in the HDI was not able to be calculated in 2019 due to a lack of data. Similarly, the Gender Inequality Index for Vanuatu has not been measured.³
- The country has a young population with 39% under 15 years of age, and 26 % aged 15-29. Life expectancy for women is 72.2 years and 69 years for men.
- Three quarters of ni-Vanuatu live in rural areas and rely on agriculture, marine and forest resources.
- 12.7% of the population live below the National Poverty line.⁴ 57% of people below the poverty line live in rural areas and poverty is concentrated amongst female headed households.
- The disability prevalence rate is estimated at 2.6%, with 22% of the population reporting some level of difficulty in functioning⁵. Rates of disability are higher in rural areas and increase with age. There is no difference in disability prevalence between women and men.
- The infant mortality (death < 1 year) is 28/1,000 births⁶ while 28.9% of children under 5 are stunted⁷.
- Early marriage is widespread, 22% of women aged 20 – 24 were first married before 18. 17% of girls in rural areas aged 15-19 have started childbearing.
- The maternal mortality rate is 72/100,000 live births, 8% of deaths of females of reproductive age are maternal deaths⁸.
- 60% of women have experienced sexual or physical violence
- The literacy rate is 88.3% for men, 86.7% for women. 80% of women in rural areas reported being literate compared with 98% of women in urban areas⁹. People with disability are less than half as likely to read or write Bislama or other language compared with people without disability. Women with disability less than half as likely to read or write compared men with disability.¹⁰
- The school enrolment rate of girls as a percentage of that of boys was 95.2 at the primary level and 101.5 at the secondary level (UNICEF 2013). The 2016 Mini Census reported 11% of children aged 6-13 years were not attending school and most of these children were in rural areas.

¹ Data is from the VNSO Mini Census 2016 (unless specified)

https://vnso.gov.vu/images/Public_Documents/Census_Surveys/Census/2016/2016_Mini_Census_Main_Report_Vol_1.pdf accessed 15 January 2021

² World Economic Profile, Global Gender Gap Report, 2021, Insight Report, March 2021, p15 (Accesses 8 November 2021: https://www3.weforum.org/docs/WEF_GGGR_2021.pdf)

³ <http://hdr.undp.org/sites/default/files/Country-Profiles/VUT.pdf>

⁴ VNSO, *Household Income and Expenditure Survey* 2010

⁵ International Centre for Evidence in Disability (ICED), *Water, Women and Disability Study Report*, London School of Hygiene & Tropical Medicine 2020

<https://www.lshtm.ac.uk/research/centres/international-centre-evidence-disability/research>. Accessed 20 Jan 2021. Disability prevalence data for Vanuatu is gradually evolving with different methodologies applied in the 2009 Census, 2013 Demographic Health Survey, 2015 Pilot Survey on Disability and the Vanuatu Education Information Management System. This data is drawn from the most recent research using the Washington Group short set across the population of SANMA and TORBA

⁶ VNSO, VMoH, *Vanuatu Demographic Health Survey* 2013

https://vnso.gov.vu/images/Special_Report/Vanuatu_Demographic_and_Health_Survey_Report/2013_VDHS_FINAL_Report.pdf accessed 15 January 2021

⁷ UNIFC, WHO and World Bank (2020). Joint Child Malnutrition Estimates Expanded Database: Stunting. July 2020 edition. New York.

<https://data.unicef.org/topic/nutrition/malnutrition/> Accessed 19 Jan 2021

⁸ WHO maternal health by country estimates https://www.who.int/gho/maternal_health/countries/vut.pdf?ua=1 Accessed 19 Jan 2021

⁹ 2009 census

¹⁰ ICED, *Water, Women and Disability Study Report* 2020

- Children with disability are up to 10 times less likely to attend school¹¹ with girls more disadvantaged than boys: In 2013 15% of girls and 28% of boys with disability had ever attended school.¹²
- The majority of people in Vanuatu rely on subsistence income, with little difference in participation rates between rural men 47% and women 44%.
- Women constitute 49.5% of agricultural producers and spend more time than rural men on agricultural production, income generation and household work. Women's incomes are on average lower than men's incomes.¹³
- 40% of women declared unpaid family work as their main employment compared with 20% of men.
- There were no women elected to the Vanuatu National Parliament in 2020, a situation that has persisted for three terms. Since independence in 1980 five women have been elected to Parliament.
- At subnational level a quota system introduced in 2013 has led to increased number of women elected or appointed to municipal and provincial councils.¹⁴
- The World Economic Forum Global Gender Gap Report, 2021 saw Vanuatu as the lowest performer in Asia Pacific region in closing gender gaps. Since 2006 (since WEF started reporting) no progress has been made in closing gender gaps.¹⁵

Laws, Policy and Institutional Arrangements

5. The Constitution of Vanuatu (1980) states that people have the right to live freely and without discrimination on the grounds of sex, race, place of origin, religious or traditional beliefs, political opinions or language. The Constitution also acknowledges special measures to benefit females, children, young persons and member of under privileged groups and inhabitants of less developed areas. Vanuatu is signatory to key international human rights treaties: Convention on the Elimination and Discrimination Against Women (ratified 1995); the Convention on the Rights of the Child (ratified 1993) and Convention on the Rights of People with Disability (ratified 2008). In 2011 Vanuatu signed the United Nations joint statement on ending acts of violence and related human rights violations based on sexual orientation and gender identity. Vanuatu is also signatory to regional commitments in the Pacific Leaders Gender Equality Declaration and the Pacific Platform for Action on Gender Equality and Women's Human rights (2018-2030).
6. The National Sustainable Development Plan (2016 – 2030) sets out specific policy objectives for gender equality and social inclusion in education (2.1), health (3.1), government planning and budgeting (4.1), protection from violence and discrimination (4.2), and empowering people with disabilities and improving accessibility (4.3, 4.5).¹⁶
7. The country is preparing to launch the second National Gender Equality Policy (NGEP 2020 - 2030). Implementation of the first National Gender Equality Policy (2015 – 2019) delivered gains against strategic objectives of enhancing women's economic status; mainstreaming gender equality into national sectoral policies (and planning to some extent); and advancing efforts to reduce gender-based violence and increase women's participation in leadership and decision making. The new NGEP includes an additional strategic area: Fostering gender-responsive and community-driven solutions to climate and disaster resilience. The addition of this strategic area reflects experience from TC Pam that addressing disaster preparedness and response at community and household level is an effective entry point for shifting social norms about gender and disability.¹⁷
8. Priority actions in the NGEP relevant to building climate and disaster resilience cover job creation and skills development for women in agriculture, fisheries, handicrafts and tourism, including women with disabilities (2.2.2); Enhancing rural women's access to markets, land, credit and financial literacy training (2.2.3); Increasing women's participation in decision making processes and leadership including in emergencies (3.1.3 and 5.3.1) Engaging women with disabilities in leadership and decision making roles (3.1.4); increasing capacity of climate change and disaster governance bodies (CDCCCs, area and

¹¹ ICED, *Water, Women and Disability Study Report 2020*

¹² VNSO, VMoH, VDHS 2013

¹³ FAO, *Country Gender Assessment of Agriculture and the Rural Sector in Vanuatu 2020*

¹⁴ Department of Women's Affairs, *National Gender Equality Policy 2020-2030* (draft)

¹⁵ World Economic Forum, *Global Gender Gap Report, 2021*, Insight Report, March 2021 (accessed 8 November 2021: https://www3.weforum.org/docs/WEF_GGGR_2021.pdf)

¹⁶ Government of Vanuatu *National Sustainable Development Plan 2016 to 2030. Vanuatu 2030: The People's Plan*, 2016

¹⁷ Webb J, Damon, C, Savua I, Marango J, Malliu E, Toto M, Charley JB, Silas M & Silas S, *Does Gender Responsive Disaster Risk Reduction Make a Difference? A comparative study of Category Five Tropical Cyclone Pam in Vanuatu*, CARE International in Vanuatu, Port Vila, 2017

provincial councils) to plan for and respond to needs of vulnerable groups (5.1.2); allocation of budgets for gender analysis and specific gender activities (5.1.3); Funding and supporting women led initiatives that contribute to adaptation (5.3.2); Embedding gender and social inclusion outcomes in tourism and productive sector recovery (5.3.3). Provincial gender action plans have been developed with specific priorities drawn from the NGEF.

9. Vanuatu's National Disability Inclusive Development policy (2018 – 2025) commits to mainstreaming the Rights of Persons with Disabilities to ensure that development efforts meet the particular needs and priorities of persons with disabilities and that targeted disability specific services are made available. The policy also commits to improving data collection, coordination between sectors, enhancing access, raising awareness of the rights of people with disabilities and providing support specifically to women and girls with disabilities.
10. To date the Ministry of Justice and Community Services¹⁸ has lead responsibility for women children and disability. The Ministry's Department for Women's Affairs (DWA), Child Desk and Disability Desk are responsible for policy and program development and supporting mainstreaming into other parts of government, however, are under resourced. Annual budgets only cover staff costs and not programming, and technical expertise to support mainstreaming across government is limited. DWA has 14 staff including one in each province. DWA plays a convening role across the desks including leading the Gender and Protection Cluster at national level, with subgroups on children, disability and leadership. The Cluster is active in both peacetime and response and with the establishment of DWA in provinces efforts to build provincial gender and protection capabilities are a priority.
11. Sectoral policies for climate change and disaster risk reduction (CCDRR Policy)¹⁹; agriculture, fisheries, livestock and forestry²⁰ all include language on gender equality and inclusion. The CCDRR policy specifies participation of women, youth and people with disability in Community Disaster and Climate Change Committees (CDCCCs). The other policies address extension and training services, representation in decision making, as well employment opportunities in departments. In 2017 the Council of Ministers identified five priority ministries for gender-based budgeting: agriculture/fisheries, climate change, lands, education and local authorities.
12. The legal and policy framework provides a solid basis and direction for mainstreaming gender equality and social inclusion in climate and disaster resilience action. The CCDRR, agriculture, fisheries, forestry and livestock policies do not specify *how* departments should go about gender and social inclusion work or set indicators or targets to generate action and accountability. A recent FAO assessment of the enabling environment for gender equality in the Ministry of Agriculture, Livestock, Fisheries, Forests and Biosecurity (MALFFB) found that there is substantial staff interest in understanding more about gender equality and social inclusion and how to translate this into their work. The gap is in financial and human resources to implement gender mainstreaming.²¹ MALFFB has extension officers in all six provinces and is supported by the Vanuatu Agricultural and Research and Technical Centre and the Vanuatu Agricultural College, neither of which have specific programmes targeting women/girls or people with disabilities.²²
13. Support is required for departments to translate policy into practice and accelerate gender-based planning and budgeting as per the Council of Ministers decision in 2017. Technical resources are needed to support departments to undertake gender and social inclusion analysis and integrate findings into annual planning, budgeting and reporting, at national and subnational levels.

Social Norms and Beliefs

14. Social norms and expectations shape the ways in which different groups can access information about climate change and disasters and how they can adapt and respond. In Vanuatu social norms give men control over women's behaviour and privilege male decision making in traditional, formal, community settings. Gender based violence is widespread and continues to be accepted as a way of enforcing expectations and exerting power.^{23, 24} People with disabilities face stigma and isolation underpinned by negative beliefs and shame about disability.

¹⁸ In late 2020 the Government moved to abolish the Ministry of Justice and Community Services and absorb functions into other Ministries, this change is currently being contested.

¹⁹ Vanuatu Government, *Vanuatu Climate Change and Disaster Risk Reduction Policy 2016-2030*, Government of the Republic of Vanuatu, Port Vila, 2015

²⁰ Vanuatu Government *Agriculture Sector Policy 2015 – 2030; National Livestock Policy 2015 -2030, National Fisheries Policy 2016 -2031, National Forest Policy 2013 – 2023*.

²¹ FAO, *Country Gender Assessment of Agriculture and the Rural Sector in Vanuatu 2020*

²² FAO *Country Gender Assessment of Agriculture and the Rural Sector in Vanuatu 2020*

²³ Vanuatu Women's & VNSO, *Vanuatu National Survey on Women's Health and Domestic Violence*, Port Vila, 2011

²⁴ FAO *Country Gender Assessment* pg 56

15. In rural areas, kastom governance is the main form of community organisation and social protection (Vanuatu has no non-contributory formal social welfare programs).²⁵ Kastom is usually patrilineal with male chiefs presiding. While women go to chiefs when facing abuse or family conflict, family and community are prioritised above individuals in decision making. Beliefs and practices vary widely between islands but are widely observed and co-exist with people's strong faith in Christianity. Kastom has changed over time with foreign contact, devaluing the role of women in decision making. According to the NGEF 2020, "Whilst kastom bestowed authority to men with chiefly titles, decisions were shared and agreed to by both spouses within the extended family unit. The role played by women in household decision-making no longer exist or constitute modern notions of kastom."²⁶ Community profiles undertake in the feasibility stage of this project indicate a more nuanced picture at household level with women reporting more shared decision making.
16. Social norms towards early marriage and childbearing are persistent especially in rural areas. 22% of women aged 20 to 24 years were first married or in union before age 18.²⁷ 17% of girls in rural areas (15-19) have started childbearing compared with 12% in urban areas.²⁸ Opportunities for education, employment, mobility are all the more restricted once childbearing starts. Unmarried women and girls live with their families and move to their husband's home on marriage, to a different community or island, away from social supports. A woman's entitlement to land and other natural resources is through her husband and sons, leaving women vulnerable if she is unmarried, the relationship breaks down or her husband dies, and she has no sons. Women with disability are three times as likely to be widowed or divorced as compared with men with disability and nine times more likely to have never married as compared with women without disability.²⁹ This has direct impact on access to land and resources for women with disability.
17. There are significant taboos associated with menstruation, internalised by women and girls including the belief that menstruating women and girls will kills crops if they touch them, they must not work in gardens, cook food or lift heavy objects. They must also collect their own water for bathing and washing their reusable menstrual products, wash their own menstrual products and use separate toilets and bathing shelters.³⁰
18. People with disability in Vanuatu face significant stigma and isolation due to negative social norms and beliefs. Parents can be ashamed of sending children with disability into public so do not send them to school³¹, particularly where children experience intellectual disability. People with disability are seen only as vulnerable and excluded from community decision making. Government and CSO programs on food security, water security and livelihoods are not targeted to people with disabilities and they are unable to access mainstream opportunities.³² Vanuatu has no non-contributory social welfare programs.

Roles, Responsibilities and Time Use

19. Social norms and expectation underpin roles and responsibilities for women and men and girls and boys. Rural families operate as a family unit to undertake productive work. Women are expected to care for all family members manage food gardens, fishing and water collections for family consumption, host guests, weave mats and handicrafts, sell produce at markets and also provide support to local community and church. Men have greater mobility and are engaged in outside employment and politics, as well as community and church activity. Both women and men are engaged in agriculture in almost equal numbers though they may grow different crops and use different levels of technology.³³ Generally women tend to have "lighter" agricultural roles of weeding, planting and maintaining crops closer to home, while men take on "heavier" roles of clearing and ploughing land including use of machinery. Fishing in deeper water with larger vessels for fish for sale is a predominantly male role, while women engage in coastal gleaning and fishing from canoes for food security. Women also participate in aquaculture and fish processing to generate income.³⁴ Social norms associated with who is a fisher tend to focus on male roles in deeper water, neglecting the role of women who harvest close to shore. This both underestimates the impact of

²⁵ Vanuatu has no non-contributory formal social protection pensions or payments. The Vanuatu National Provident Fund is a contributory fund open to formal and informal workers, however only 10 % of rural women and 18% of rural men have an account FA) pg41.

²⁶ NGEF 2020 – 2030 pg 5

²⁷ VNSO and SPC, *Vanuatu Demographic and Health Survey* 2013 p 85

²⁸ VNSO, VMoH VDHS 2013

²⁹ ICED, *Water, Women and Disability Study Report* 2020

³⁰ ICED, *Water, Women and Disability Study Report* 2020

³¹ VNSO, UNICEF Children, *Women and Men with Disabilities in Vanuatu: What do the data say?* 2014

³² ICED, *Water, Women and Disability Study Report* 2020

³³ FAO *Country Gender Assessment* p1

³⁴ FAO *Country Gender Assessment* p11

fishing pressure along the coast and undervalues the contributions of women.³⁵ Few fisheries programs benefit women or transformed gender relations, and inclusive approaches are hampered by limited knowledge and capacity of fisheries managers and institutional cultures.³⁶

20. People with disabilities are equally likely to take part in productive activities as people without disability but are less likely to be employed outside the home due to barriers to education, training and employment.³⁷ Information on specific roles of people with disability in agriculture or fisheries in Vanuatu is not available.
21. Overall women and girls work significantly more hours than men, with less time for leisure or rest. FAO rural case studies of time use in Tanna showed women worked twice as many hours as men.³⁸ When faced with this data men in the community were surprised and many indicated a willingness to take on more work so there is better balance in families. Climate changes including drought, heavy rains, rough seas and sea level rise increase women's workloads in a number of ways: reducing productivity of household gardens; reducing productivity of materials for handicraft production; increasing time and distance for water collection and reducing opportunity for gleaning and fishing. Communities in North Ambryn, Epi and West Santo all experience three or more months water shortages, requiring greater travel to collect drinking water and increasing incidence of water borne diseases. After disasters (and during the pandemic)³⁹ women's care burden increases substantially with closure of kindergartens and schools, loss of homes and gardens and water sources.
22. Labour migration is an increasingly important feature of rural livelihoods as the need for cash grows. Most labour migrants are men, moving to urban centres or Australia and New Zealand for seasonal agricultural or other low or semi-skilled work. Women from rural areas participate in migration to urban areas to work in domestic roles in extended family or kinship groups. Migration generates substantial remittances that are used for family and productive purposes such as school fees, health care, improving housing and water supply, purchasing boats and machinery. Migration also creates pressure on families with increased work burdens on women left to care for children, elderly and family members with disability. Women have greater autonomy and financial decision-making power while male partners are away, and relationship tensions increase both during separation and on return.
23. Women and girls' roles and workloads restrict access to training and extension initiatives that could assist with adaptation strategies such as livelihood diversification. When family incomes are under pressure the needs of girls and family members with disability are the first to be compromised with reduced spending on rehabilitation and healthcare, withdrawal of girls from school and early marriage. While primary and secondary school participation rates have improved, on marriage girls and women's ability to participate in further education and training is restricted.
24. Agricultural extension services and enterprise development training at local level tends to be targeted to male heads of household, with men's work valued over women's work. Service providers need to shift approach to recognise that rural livelihoods are family enterprises, with women making up half of rural producers. Engaging families rather than just male heads of household is an effective way of reaching women and men, recognising and building on the work of all family members.⁴⁰ The family farm teams approach combines technical extension/training with modules to identify family goals, roles, how work burdens can be shared, and improving decision making and communication.⁴¹ The approach has been pioneered by CARE Australia in PNG and is being used with success across Melanesia. The family farm teams approach can also address the increased risks of gender-based violence that women can face when they increase their incomes.⁴² Building on women's existing roles including targeting capacity support to women in markets and in women's church groups are also entry points.

³⁵ Thomas et al, *Why they must be counted: Significant contributions of Fijian women fishers to food and security and livelihoods* Ocean and Coastal Management 205 (2021) 105571

³⁶ Mangubhai, S., Lawless, S., 2021. *Exploring gender inclusion in small-scale fisheries management in Melanesia*. Marine Policy 123, 104287. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.marpol.2020.104287>.

³⁷ VNSO, UNICEF *Children, Women and Men with Disabilities in Vanuatu* 2014

³⁸ FAO *Country Gender Assessment* p 47

³⁹ Care International in Vanuatu, *Rapid Gender Analysis COVID-19 Vanuatu* 2019

⁴⁰ FAO, *Country Gender Assessment*

⁴¹ Pamphilon B., Mikhailovich K., "Bringing together learnings from two worlds: Lessons from a gender-inclusive community education approach with smallholder farmers in Papua New Guinea", *Australian Journal of Adult Education* 57/2 July 2017; Family Farm Teams, Transformative Agriculture and Enterprise Development Program <https://tadep-png.com/project/family-farm-teams/>

⁴² Eaves R. Kouro G., Steven S. and Subalik I. "Do No Harm Research: PNG" 2018 ANU; Eaves R. Lusby S., Araia T., Maeni M., Martin R. "Do No Harm Research: Solomon Islands" 2018 ANU.

Decision Making, leadership and participation

25. Decision making is male dominated in Vanuatu. Since independence in 1980 only five women have been elected to Vanuatu's national parliament, and there are no women in Parliament in 2021. While women have competed in election none have been successful in the last three elections. At subnational level a quota system introduced in 2013 has led to increases in the number of women elected or appointed to Municipal and Provincial councils where women now make up about one third of members. While there are no women mayors there are some women in deputy mayor roles. In the public sector women are better represented in leadership. Two of seven director generals are women (notably in the MCC and MJCS) and 8/43 directors were women in 2019.⁴³ At the international level women have led Vanuatu delegations to the UNFCCC COP (2017 and 2019) and women's representation in delegations has been 30-50% since 2017.
26. Social norms about masculinity and leadership are slowly changing. At community level while male chiefs head the kastom governance structure, community committees for climate and disasters, water and village development provide a framework for women, people with disability and youth to participate and take on leadership roles particularly when supported by NGOs. Activities to build confidence and skills of women, people with disability and youth have increased community acceptance of their leadership capabilities.
27. The Vanuatu Gender and protection cluster was established in 2014 and has built a strong network of government, international and national NGO partners focused on disaster management, as well as disaster risk reduction and climate action. The national cluster is chaired by DWA with NGO support, and includes subcommittees on children, leadership and disability. The cluster has been an important venue for building skills, awareness and systematic tools for more inclusive disaster preparedness and response. Challenges faced by the Cluster include securing financing from government for program implementation, influencing mainstreaming in other clusters and building provincial cluster mechanisms. There is a risk that action on gender and protection is left only to the gender and protection cluster or DWA, rather than embedded into the operations of all clusters, provincial and municipal emergency operations.
28. Women have low levels of representation in the formal private sector but are active in small and medium enterprises based on agriculture, handicrafts and food production. Market associations and loans and savings cooperatives have large numbers of women members including in leadership roles. These provide an important entry point for business skills development (eg UN Women Markets for Change, VANWODs financial literacy and savings and loans groups) but have not yet been targeted for climate adaptation and resilience building. While women in most communities are excluded from kastom leadership roles they do play an active part in church communities including leadership of women's groups and youth groups.
29. At the household level men are seen as the head of household. In the FAO Tanna case study women reported many decisions are made by women and men together, but that men are the final decision makers. In Women's Focus Groups in North Ambrym and Epi, North West Santo women reported that most decision making was shared between women and men. Project interventions using a family approach are important to reinforce existing shared decision making, instead of privileging male decision making.
30. People with disability report isolation and stigma, as well lack of accessibility as barriers that prevent participation in community events and committees. Examples include CDCCC meetings being held in "open" settings that people with disabilities cannot access, or fear shame and ridicule.⁴⁴ In some cases teachers take on the role of representing people with disability instead of communities supporting people with disability themselves to have voice. NGO and CSO activism by Vanuatu Disability Promotion and Advocacy Association, Vanuatu Society for People with Disability and Rainbow Theatre (Won Smal Bag) and the Vanuatu Civil Society Disability Network is challenging this exclusion. After TC Harold there was recognition by government and donors that data systems needed to improve to better support people with disabilities in disasters.⁴⁵ The Vanuatu Skills Partnership is also demonstrating change employing seven people with disability as trainers, and 42% of industry trainers in the productive sectors are women.⁴⁶

⁴³ Vanuatu Government, *NGEP 2020 – 2030 (draft)*

⁴⁴ UNDP, USAID *Building the Resilience of Persons with Disabilities to Cope with Climate Change in the Asia Pacific Region, Vanuatu Country Report 2019*

⁴⁵ A new program to improve province and area level disability data through the Ministry of health information management system is being designed with support from SPC.

⁴⁶ Pacific Women Shaping Pacific Development, *Vanuatu Snapshot 2020*

Access to and Control of Resources

31. 97% of land in Vanuatu is under customary ownership which is largely patrilineal. Men have control over land, marine and forest resources, while women have access or use rights to natural resources in line with existing divisions of labour. There can be restrictions on women's access when menstruating or during pregnancy.⁴⁷ On marriage women move to their husband's community or island and access to resources is through him. Women with disability are less likely to marry and so face double exclusion to resources. Widows and female headed households also face exclusion or marginal access to natural resources.
32. Women in rural areas earn income through marketing crops and fish, processing copra, cooking food and handicrafts. Fewer than one in five women have a bank account, though village loans and savings schemes are widespread and an important way for women to increase access to finance. Without land as collateral women struggle to access larger loans.⁴⁸ Women's focus group discussions identified a priority for financial literacy training.
33. Small and medium enterprise development provides an opportunity to diversify livelihoods and also integrate climate and disaster resilience into existing enterprises such as handicrafts. It is important that enterprise development is linked to markets with sound value chain analysis. This requires climate change and DRR delivery partners to work with market development programs.⁴⁹
34. People with disability have low access to assistive devices and rehabilitation services, less than 20% have ever heard of assistive devices or rehabilitation services. Of those just over half of the people who needed services had received them.⁵⁰
35. Access to and control of agricultural and marine machinery is gendered in many countries, including Vanuatu, with women having less access than men to tools, machinery such as grass cutters, food processing (dryers and grinders) motorbikes, trucks or generators. Technology such as solar energy systems, fridges, lighting, drying and processing machines, improved cookstoves contribute to adaptive capacity. It will be important to ensure these technologies are available to women as well as men, and that women and people with disability have opportunities to train in maintenance and management of new technologies.
36. Women's role in household food production is an area to target. Childhood nutrition data in Vanuatu shows a quarter of children are stunted and Women's Focus Groups identified changing rainfall as impacting on the variety of foods they can grow and families can eat, with a drop in leafy greens and vegetables. There is increased reliance on imported, less nutritious food which has negative health implications however this food is also attractive as it reduces women's time burden. Similarly traditional food preservation techniques can be important disaster preparedness measures, however there is a cost in women's work burden. Adaptive technology that also reduces women's unpaid care workloads is more likely to be taken up.
37. Access to mobile phones is a significant asset in Vanuatu with mobile networks improving communications and putting communication into the hands of individuals. Most households have a mobile phone, though data on who owns and uses the phone within the household is not available. A recent initiative – Women Wetem Weta – has established a mobile SMS network translating weather and health warnings from VMGD and MoH in Port Vila and sending to women network leaders in rural areas using low bandwidth SMS and social media to maximise reach. These women are then responsible for sharing information with their community through meetings, forwarding SMS and visits including to people with disabilities in their community. To start the initiative rural women leaders were given phones and data credit as they did not have these resources themselves. The initiative effectively uses technology and builds on women's social roles, while empowering them with critical information. This initiative is not operational in all project areas.

Gender-Based Violence

38. Vanuatu has a high prevalence of gender-based violence (GBV), in particular violence against women and girls. In 2011, research showed that 60% of women have experienced some form of physical and/or

⁴⁷ ICED Water, *Women and Disability Study Report 2020*; and Braaf, *Initial Gender and Social Inclusion Assessment for Vanuatu GCF Consortium*, 2017

⁴⁸ Bowman, Cutura, Ellis and Manuel *Women in Vanuatu Analyzing Challenges to Economic Participation*, 2009 World Bank

⁴⁹ Talanoa Consulting, *Women's Resilience to disaster and climate change in the Pacific: Needs and Gaps Analysis 2019*

⁵⁰ ICED, *Water, Women and Disability Study Report 2020*.

sexual violence.⁵¹ Violence is seen as an acceptable way of controlling behaviour and enforcing expectations on women and children. In rural settings, social norms and kastom decision making by village chiefs can place community harmony above the safety of individual women and children. While the Family Protection Act was passed by parliament in 2008 services for victims of gender-based violence are limited with little available in rural areas and low usage of protection orders. In a 2015 study 74% of women in Malekula had never heard of a domestic violence protection order, compared with 38% of chiefs, and only 6% of had used one.⁵² In 2020, a free telephone hotline service was established to provide assistance to victims to domestic violence and counselling for women and girls.⁵³

39. Sexual and physical violence is also high against women and girls with disabilities, both physical and mental. Family members are often afraid to leave women and girls with disabilities alone in the home for fear of sexual abuse by male community members.⁵⁴
40. In the aftermath of disasters GBV is amplified. Where families lose homes and are displaced, lack of safe housing, lighting, water and sanitation facilities increases risk of gender-based violence. Breakdowns in health and GBV support services, transport routes and policing prevent women and girls from seeking assistance. Loss of food crops and stores have been identified as contributing to increased gender-based violence when women are unable to feed their families or earn income. Climate change and disaster impacts on water sources and agriculture mean women and girls need to travel further to farm and collect water, creating increased risks to women and girls of sexual assault and harassment. Flooding and storm surges block transport routes preventing pregnant and lactating women from accessing essential health services, high risk home births were reported after TC Harold as women were unable to reach health facilities.⁵⁵ There is ever-growing evidence that climate-induced disasters exacerbate early child marriages and forced unions. Although there are many factors that contribute to child marriage, such as poverty and social norms that value community cohesion over the best interests of girls, there is growing evidence that families also resort to marrying off their daughters as a direct response to the effects of shocks to household income, property and livestock as a result of floods, cyclones and droughts etc.⁵⁶ Additionally, disasters often lead to the closures of schools, and girls not in school is a major risk factor for child marriage. As child marriage increases, poverty deepens and hence the vulnerability of communities to climate change increases.
41. Child protection concerns have also been reported following TC Harold and with COVID19.⁵⁷ Both girls and boys are not able to attend school and families are not able to home school. They have been required to work including carrying water loads beyond their capacity, and there are reports of verbal and physical abuse.
42. Gender and protection assessments following TC Harold (and with COVID19)⁵⁸ identified common priorities for action including:
- Increasing GBV support services and policing,
 - ensuring chiefs and service providers have an understanding of GBV risks after disasters
 - improving access to child, maternal and sexual and reproductive health services
 - putting child protection measures in place
 - psychological first aid
 - improving women's leadership role in CDCCC, provincial emergency operations, women, church and youth groups.
43. Research following TC Pam⁵⁹ showed the effects of the disaster are amplified for people with disability – they were 2.5 times more likely to have been injured (men twice as much as women), few had assistive devices and some were lost in TC Pam. Adults with disability also had less access to DRR efforts, with women more excluded than men. Women with disability also had less access to response and recovery

⁵¹ Vanuatu Women's Centre, 2011 *The Vanuatu National Survey on Women's Lives and Family Relationships* Port Vila, Vanuatu.

⁵² Policing and Justice Sector Support Program Vanuatu, 2016, *Conflict Management and Access to Justice in Rural Vanuatu*

⁵³ VBTC <https://www.vbtc.vu/en/domestic-violence-victims-to-access-new-free-phone-help-line> accessed 19 January 2020

⁵⁴ Braaf, 2017

⁵⁵ Vanuatu National Disaster Management Office, *TC Harold Detailed Sectoral Assessment* June 2020

⁵⁶ McLeod, C; Barr, H; and Rall, K (n.d.) "Does climate change increase the risk of child marriage? A look at what we know – and what we don't – with lessons from Bangladesh and Mozambique," *Columbia Journal of Gender and Law* (accessed online 5 Nov 2021)

⁵⁷ Vanuatu National Disaster Management Office, *TC Harold Detailed Sectoral Assessment* June 2020

⁵⁸ Vanuatu National Disaster Management Office, *TC Harold Detailed Sectoral Assessment* June 2020

⁵⁹ CBM-Nossal Institute *Disability Inclusion in Disaster Risk Reduction: Experiences of people with disabilities in Vanuatu during and after TC Pam* 2017

efforts compared with men with disability. While access to services was poor for entire communities, access to disability services was worst, and both adults and children with disability reported lower wellbeing than people without disability. Gender and protection assessments after TC Harold⁶⁰ found that people with disabilities lost access to already limited services and were solely reliant on family support. Family resources and time were under pressure and basic needs of people with disabilities were not met.

44. Throughout Vanuatu few facilities are accessible. Evacuation centres, particularly in rural areas are not accessible (e.g. buildings have stairs) and do not have water and sanitation facilities. Even if some evacuation centres are accessible (as is the case in Port Vila) people with disabilities prefer to avoid these as they risk facing discrimination and abuse.⁶¹ While awareness of disaster risks faced by people with disabilities is increasing action has failed to adequately consult with people with disabilities. During the Ambae volcano eruption people with disabilities were prioritised for relocation but were moved to the evacuation centre but without assistive devices and carers. Inclusion of people with disabilities in planning decisions is critical - at community level there has been some progress with NGO engagement to support participation of people with disabilities in CDCCCs. This has helped to build confidence of people with disability and shifted community attitudes and behaviour.

Community Profiles: Gender and Social Inclusion Focus

45. Profiles of eight communities are presented here, based on community meetings and women's focus group discussions which identify gender-based differences. Data on people with disabilities, children and the elderly was not specifically addressed in the consultations and so profiles are limited in considering intersecting issues.

North Ambrym Area Council, Malampa

46. There are slightly more women (55%) than men in each community of 250 – 350 people and an estimated 55% are aged 0-25 years. 3-5% have a lot of difficulties in functioning across one or more of six areas. All communities have active chiefs who organise community work. All have village development councils and plans, CDCCCs, as well as women's groups, church and youth groups. One community has a water committee, and some have a health committee, market committee and savings group. All have CDCCCs, with women in varying numbers, there are no people with disabilities on CDCCCs. Women are members of some committees but do not chair committees. The main income sources are kava, livestock, fish and local produce sales. Women also earn money through baking. For all communities the Area council and administrator was seen as working well with them, but they had little contact with provincial or national departments.

Ranon community

47. This community has a market house but limited access to banking. Women do not have access to microloans, but have, with men attended financial literacy training. The community has poor access to the health clinic, high seas can prevent access to the area health centre, a priority concern for women. The community has good access to water close to homes with supply managed by a water committee with 4 women and 4 men members. There is a high level of concern about increasing drought events, cyclones and volcanic ashfalls. Women identified contamination of water, water borne illness, food crop productivity and road access to health care as key challenges associated with climate change and disasters. The community faces food security challenges due to cyclones, overuse and degradation of land. There is good connection to the Digicel network and handheld radios, and most but not all households have a mobile phone. The CDCCC has 1 female/9 male members and has had some training on DRR and climate change where women and youth participated however awareness of risks and adaption opportunities is low. The main DRR action taken has been to build stronger homes. Some people have access to safe shelter during cyclones, though these do not have private washroom facilities or emergency supplies. The main external assistance has been food relief and to the school, the community has no funding for CCDRR work. Women in the community are active in the VDC in roles of secretary and treasurer, school and youth organisations and some are confident to participate actively in community meetings. They generally feel respected by men. Additional to family agriculture/fishing they earn money

⁶⁰ Vanuatu National Disaster Management Office, *TC Harold Detailed Sectoral Assessment* June 2020

⁶¹ UNDP, USAID *Building the Resilience of Persons with Disabilities to Cope with Climate Change in the Asia Pacific Region, Vanuatu Country Report* 2019

from kava and baking. Women have mobile phones and direct access to information about weather and disaster warning from VMGD. Following disasters women noted an increase in overall conflict in the community but were unsure about family violence. Women go to the chief's council for support if they face problems. Decision making about large household purchases and women visiting the health centre are shared by men and women while women are able to decide themselves about small purchases. They are also able to decide themselves about visiting relatives or friends outside the community.

48. Priorities identified in Women's Focus Group: training on food security and sewing to diversify incomes.

Magam Community

49. Cyclones, drought, and volcanic ash are key concerns identified in this community. Cyclones have damaged buildings and cut road access preventing them from transporting goods to market. There are water shortages for 3-4 months a year and water has to be collected from 1km away, there is no water committee. Women are on the village council (3 women, 5 men), kindergarten committee and CDCCC, where they are active according to the community consultation. However in the women's focus group women noted feeling afraid to share ideas and speak freely in community meetings with men discouraging women when they return to their families. There are no people with disabilities on the CDCCC. One woman has unsuccessfully stood for election at provincial or national level.

50. There are 7 concrete buildings used as cyclone shelters, but do not have private toilet facilities for women and men. After disaster events women noted the level of conflict and family violence is about the same, and for support women report being able to go to the chief, police and church leaders. About half the women have access to microloans and have attended financial literacy training. There are no community funds for CCDRR action. Most women have access to a mobile phone, there is good access to the Vodafone network and they get warnings and weather information from VMGD through social media. Women are able to decide themselves to visit the health centre (there is no health facility in the community) and make small household purchases, while large purchases and visits to family outside the community are decided by women and men together. Women earn money through baking bread and donuts.

51. Priorities identified in Women's Focus Group: assistance with food security and financial literacy.

Fonmur/Nazareth Community

52. Cyclones, drought, and volcanic ash are key concerns identified by women, damaging gardens and water systems and creating food and water shortages. Water borne diseases and flu are challenges associated with cyclones. Drought damages gardens and causes a shortage of drinking water for 4 months of the year with water springs 1km away. There is no water committee in the community. Heavy rain erodes soil and volcanic ash affects gardens and water sources. Damage to roads and buildings from cyclones are also significant challenges. Levels of conflict and family violence are about the same before and after disasters, and women go to the Chief to seek support for abuse. Most women in the community are able to speak at public meetings and women are office bearers in the CDCCC, there are no people with disabilities on the CDCCC. The community does have a disaster/evacuation and CC/DRR plan with support from Care. The school is used as shelter for some people though these were damaged in TCH. The community does not have funds for CCDRR activities. A small number of women have mobile phones and receive information from Facebook or the internet about weather and disasters. There is good access to the Vodafone network. Decisions about visiting the health centre, small and large household purchases, visiting outside the community are made by women and men together. Less than half of the women have access to microloans

53. Priorities identified in Women's Focus Group: agriculture training

Varsu Area Council, Epi Island, Shefa Province

54. In this area council the three communities consulted range from 280 – 333 people, with 55% women, and 55% aged 0-25 years. 3-5.7% have a lot of difficulties in functioning across one or more of six areas. All communities have active chiefs who organise community work. All have village development councils and 2 have development plans. All communities have women's groups, church groups, youth groups and water, health and market committees. Two communities have micro-finance or savings groups, and women have access to loans in one community. The main income sources are kava, handicrafts, peanut and copra sales. There are no functional CDCCCs, evacuation or climate adaptation plans or access to

funds for CCDRR activities. One community rated their relationship with provincial authorities to be very good, the other two rated the relationship as OK. They had little or no interaction with national ministries.

Nikaura community

55. This community has been affected cyclones, heavy rains and flooding and associated landslides as well as drought. Women identified fear of sea level rise preventing pregnant women from road travel to hospital, as well as impacts on income generation. In heavy rains older women cannot go to gardens, and it is also hard for children to travel. Women have observed an increase in pests and diseases in vegetable gardens and changes in seasons for planting. There are water shortages throughout the year, and water collection is insufficient for both village supply and upland gardens. Sediment affects water which is collected by container 2km from homes. Bush toilets are close to houses which creates hygiene problems during floods.
56. Some women are able to speak and share ideas in community meetings, and there are some women in leadership roles such as the Treasurer of the village council. Women feel men show them respect. Women earn money from selling agricultural produce, cooked food, weaving and handicrafts, fishing, and sale of livestock. There is a women's building where meetings, activities and marketing takes place, however the market house is small and lacks shelter during rain.
57. There have been projects in the last five years on violence against women. After cyclones and floods women noted violence in home and conflict in the community goes down. Women can go to the nassara and chief for support regarding abuse and domestic problems. Women are able to make their own decision to seek health care and make small purchased, while decisions about expensive items varies between households.
58. Priorities identified in Women's Focus Group: Financial management, income generating activities, value adding opportunities for export of products , improving health access for women (cancer and other women's health checks), food preservation for disaster, food security training, DRR training to cope with all disasters.

Mate Wan Community

59. This community is affected by cyclones, flooding, drought and volcanic activity. There are extremely rough seas and storm surges make roads impassable. Heavy rains damage food gardens and make it difficult for children to go to school. Food gardens are also affected with women reporting a lack of vegetables and fruits. Women also identified illness, income security, food security, water security as risks associated with climate change with water shortages 3months/year. They also noted a lack of facilities, training and poor infrastructure (roads and wharf) as challenges. Some women are able to speak and share ideas at community meetings and there is a women's church group. There are no women in the village council or other committees. Women earn money from weaving/handicrafts and sale of agricultural produce and cooked food. Women go to the chief, church and family for support regarding abuse or domestic conflict and note that both domestic violence and community conflict reduce after disasters. While some women have mobile phones none receive climate, weather or disaster information. Women are able to decide themselves about visiting people outside the community and men and women decide together about household purchases.
60. Priorities identified in Women's Focus Group: Training in DRR, personal finance, Climate Change Adaptation & mitigation, Food Security and nutrition.

Ngala(lopevi) community

61. This community is affected by cyclone, drought, rough seas and volcanic ash fall. Roads and schools have been destroyed and during flooding roads and paths are impassable. Women identify population growth straining resources, inadequate access to health facilities and water as major problems. Water collection is by bucket 300m away, with sediment affecting water sources. Bush toilets are close to houses which creates hygiene problems during floods. Lack of water storage is leading to low vegetable production and impact on nutrition and food security. Women are also concerned about loss of housing during disaster events.
62. Some women are able to speak and share ideas at community meetings, and there is a women and girls church group and handicrafts group. The village council has 3 men and 3 women and a woman chairs the school committee. Women earn money through weaving and handicrafts, sale of cooked food,

agricultural produce and livestock. Challenges include lack of health services, poor water storage and low greens and vegetable consumption. Women are able to go chiefs regarding abuse or domestic problems, and they report less domestic violence and community conflict after disasters. Women are able to decide on large household purchases themselves, while decisions about a woman going to a health centre, small purchases and visiting family outside the community are shared between women and men. Some women have mobile phones but face communication problems due to limited access to phone networks. Women have not received information about climate and weather forecasts or disaster warnings.

63. Priorities identified in Women's Focus Group: DRR training, food safety training, value-added production training, first aid training, financial literacy training, health and nutritional training, improve communication phone networks.

64. North West Santo Area Council, Santo Island, Sanma Province

65. The two communities consulted in this area council varied significantly: Olpoe is a large community of 410 people (55% male), while Penaoru has 74 people (55% female). 55% of the population in both communities is aged 0-25years. In Olpoe 1% of the community have a lot of difficulties in functioning across one or more of six areas, while the rate in Penaoru is over 5%. Both communities have active chiefly leadership, but no community disaster or climate change committee, plans or funding. Copra is the main source of income, followed by cacao.

Olpoe community

66. Drought is the main risk faced in this community, affecting kava and food crops. Women report feeling afraid to speak and share views in community meetings. Women are involved in a range of committees including church, cooperative (2 women/3 men), boat committee (2 women, 3 men) and violence against women committee, but are not represented in the village council. Women earn income from sale of agricultural products, handicrafts, fishing and livestock, as well as copra and cacao.
67. There are water shortages for 5 months a year, with a 4km walk for water and few improved toilets. Women identify flooding and heavy rain as harming crops and contaminating water supply. They are concerned about river and coastal erosion and sea level rise. Rough seas also prevent travel to access services. Most women have mobile phones and have received information about climate and weather forecasts and disaster warning. The community has a good relationship with the area administrator and the Director of Department of Women's Affairs recently visited the community. Women decide themselves about small and large household purchases and visiting outside the community, while men and women decide together about visiting health care.
68. Priorities identified in Women's Focus Group: Food security training & activities, personal finance trainings on how to manage income

Penaoru community

69. This community faces drought, fire and storms causing river flooding which has destroyed houses, fruit and cash crops. They experience water shortages throughout the year and have few improved toilets. Illnesses such as red eye, malaria and dengue are a concern. Poor weather and rough seas blocks access to markets and services. Children are cut off from school due to storm surges and women are unable to access food gardens during heavy rains. Women have to travel to Luganville to give birth if they have already had 5 children, however transport is difficult.
70. Some women are able to speak freely at community meetings, and women are active in aid (health)post, water, environment and church committees. They earn money from weaving/handicrafts, livestock as well as sale of copra, cocoa and agricultural products in Luganville. They have received small business management training. While a small number of women have mobiles phones there is no network access in the community and radio Vanuatu is available at night only. Women are concerned that they cannot receive cyclone and tsunami warnings because of the lack of a phone network. Women decide themselves about small and large household purchases and visiting outside the community, while men and women decide together about visiting health care. The community rates the relationship with area administration as poor.
71. Priorities identified in Women's Focus Group: Weaving, savings & loan programs, first aid training, DRR training, Income generating activities, training to women selling produce at markets:

value-adding production training. Nutritional training. Leadership training. Cervical cancer awareness & other health and hygiene training.

Project specific conclusions and recommendations

72. It is important that the project benefits women, people with disability and youth, as well as men, and that power dynamics currently undermining community resilience are transformed. Project interventions should support women, people with disability and youth to access climate information, and resources and skills to adapt livelihoods. To support lasting change the project must also address underlying social norms and behaviours associated with work roles and workload, leadership and violence, including child marriage and forced unions. This means going beyond equitable participation and individual self-improvement activities for women, people with disability and youth to also lift women's voice and agency and transform power dynamics at household, community, area and province levels that serve to reinforce inequality.
73. A "twin track" approach to disability inclusion is needed – working directly with people with disability and DPOs, and also mainstreaming disability inclusion into the wider community and government systems. Vanuatu Society of Disabled People and Vanuatu Skills Partnership are key partners for building skills and training; while Vanuatu Disabled People's Association (Santo) and Rainbow Theatre are important advocacy organisations.

Household and Community level

74. At the household and community level the following approaches should be prioritised:

- Family teams – work at household level and engage male and female heads of household in planning and implementation of adaption actions to ensure that women's and men's roles in agriculture and fisheries are accounted for. This approach also creates opportunities to address social norms about unpaid work and sharing workloads more equally. Modules address family goal setting and finances; planning family farm (or other enterprise); feeding the family and nutrition; and communication and decision making in the family. Working at this level will also enable identification of family members with disability, to link with disability inclusive skills/training, as well as participation in CDCCCs.
- Ensure project supported infrastructure is accessible and reduces risks of gender-based violence. Emergency shelters should be prioritised for accessibility and wash facilities. Infrastructure projects should include women in management and leadership positions, and create opportunities for skills training of women, youth and people with disability and opportunities for work at equal pay with men. Codes of conduct, awareness raising, complaints mechanisms and survivor-centred response should be available on any GBV issues raised through building processes.
- CDCCC
 - Train all CDCCC on disability inclusive DRR
 - Identify and support people with disability in the community to be represented on the CDCCC and participate in activities run through the CDCCC.
 - Ensure women and youth are represented on the CDCCC, including 50% target for women's representation.
 - Provide targeted training and coaching support to women and people with disability to build confidence to engage actively in CDCCs.
 - Provide training to CDCCC members on women's empowerment and GBV (e.g. roles, norms and values that determine what men and women do, how men and women prepare for, react to and recover from disasters and the impacts of gender inequality, discrimination, GBV and child marriage and forced unions) and disability.
 - Emergency planning at community level should clearly identify people at highest risk and target support to ensuring their safety.
 - CDCCC should be able to undertake rapid needs assessments clearly identifying needs of women, children, elderly and people with disabilities.
- Work with chiefs, church and other male champions to raise awareness on the impacts of societal inequality on poverty and climate change and change attitudes and beliefs around gender roles and responsibilities and negative attitudes about the capabilities of women, youth and people with disability in the community.

- Support the participation of women and girls and persons with disabilities by subsidising transport costs and providing childcare arrangements at meetings, workshops and other project-related activities.
- Create extension and training programmes are tailored to the needs of women (as well as men) to address the current gap and bias towards men's needs.
- Include anti-child marriage efforts into awareness raising activities and adaptation planning processes.
- Target adaptation activities to women through existing women's groups eg market groups and church groups, and support women led adaptation initiatives eg in aquaculture, agriculture, value adding/diversification and ecotourism.
- Provide climate and weather information in multiple formats (written, graphic, audio – visual) and mediums (eg mobile phone sms, social media, radio, community meeting, home visits)

Area level

75. Area administration and area councils are critical for service delivery and accountability to communities. Recommendations at this level:

- Train area administration staff on how to collect and assess gender and disability-disaggregated data and integrate gender equality, disability inclusion and child protection into adaptation plans, budgets, and monitoring. This should include ongoing mentoring to support area staff to implement commitments.
- Build facilitation skills in the family teams approach for MALFFB extension staff and NGO partners.
- Support MALFFB to improve gender balance in field/extension staff, to improve engagement with women in communities. Priorities identified by women include food security, diversification and value adding and financial literacy. Training should include provision for childcare and catering; and be timed when women are most likely to be available. Technology training will need to have specific approaches to engaging women and girls and people with disabilities.
- Support MALFFB to partner with disabled people's organisations and Vanuatu Skills Partnership to design and deliver trainings so people with disability can participate. This should include providing transport, accessible venues, interpreter and caregiver support.
- Maintain up to date data on people with disability in the area council, and their specific needs so these can be rapidly addressed in disasters.
- Support two-way communications systems between area administration and CDCCCs, for early warning of disaster events and seasonal climate forecasts, and also for communities to submit rapid assessments after a disaster. Systems need to be established to ensure assessments are transmitted from area to provincial or national operations centres to trigger timely responses, including with information on people with disabilities.
- Area councils:
 - Support capacity building for women, people with disability and youth to participate in area councils as active, confident members.
 - Provide transport, accessible venues and accommodation; interpreter and caregiver support; childcare and catering; and time meetings when women are most likely to be available.

Province level

76. Improving linkages and coordination between the provincial and area levels are important for gender and social inclusion particularly as government staff from the Department for Women's Affairs (DWA) and NGOs and disabled people's organisations are at provincial level. Priorities here would be:

- Support implementation of provincial gender action plans for training Provincial disaster committees in gender and protection; establishing women led adaptation initiatives; and supporting representation and leadership by women; and providing livelihoods training to people with disabilities.
- Building DWA staff capacity at province level to coordinate across government and NGOs, including the gender and protection cluster, as well as support mainstreaming of gender and social inclusion into province and area operations for MALFFB and MoCC.

- Allocate funding to enable provincial Department for Women staff to travel to, and work with, area administration on gender focused adaptation activities including GESI training for CDCCCs, women's leadership development and women led adaptation initiatives
- Improve two way communication links and protocols to ensure that Early Warning Systems (EWS) reach area and community level, and information (including rapid needs assessment) from communities goes up to province and national level for timely response.
- Maintain accurate data about people with disability to enable service delivery and disaster preparedness and response is a priority.
- Many NGOs and other organisations eg VSDP, VDPA, VSP/TVETs and VANWODS have provincial operations, with established relationships with provincial, area and community leaders. VCCRPP should engage these organisations as project partners as they have a track record and critical relationships in each province.

Project operations

77. It is important to promote the value that gender equality and social inclusion is core to project effectiveness – if we care about community resilience then everyone's needs are important, and everyone's contributions need to be recognised. This should be articulated by project leadership and through project communications.
78. Mainstreaming targets should be set across the project operations to drive accountability:
- 50% female staff
 - targets for women in leadership positions
 - targets for recruitment, training and promotion of people with disability.
 - All project staff should be trained in gender equality and social inclusion
 - Findings from this report should be disseminated to SC staff and partners
 - Position descriptions for technical staff should include their ability to understand and address the needs of diverse groups
 - Employ at least one full time GESI technical adviser and additional technical support on disability inclusion, with experience in analysis, planning and monitoring. The advisers must be able to mentor and train government counterparts at MoCC, MALFFB and province DWA staff and have budget to travel to province and area level.
 - Project communications should be designed to challenge social norms. For example, by using appropriate language; and showing women of all ages and people with disability in active leadership roles.
 - MEAL activities should track changes in knowledge, attitudes, perceptions and behaviours related to gender equality, preferably at outcome level.
 - Regular review of GESI Action Plan, and adaptations made to Action Plan and project implementation as needed.
79. Implementation arrangements should engage partners with a track record of working with communities in each particular province. Expertise in gender equality and disability inclusion may need to be centralised through organisations such as VDPA (disability inclusion) and Care (family teams); Vanuatu Women's Centre for support on gender-based violence, working with men and boys, relationship building; Save the Children and World Vision on school based DRR.
80. Referral pathways and relationships should be established with other organisations to deal with specific issues eg VANWODS access to finance, savings and loans groups and enterprise skills development; Vanuatu Women's Centre for GBV services; Area and provincial health services, especially for access to reproductive and sexual health services.

Part 2 VCCRP Gender and Social Inclusion Action Plan

Component 1: Government, civil society and communities are strengthened to support local resilience to climate change impacts, including by providing access to climate information and early warnings				
Project Activities	Indicator & Targets	Timeline	Responsibilities	Cost
Output 1.1: Community-based climate change adaptation and disaster risk reduction mechanisms are strengthened				
Activity 1.1.1 Establish CDCCCs (where necessary) and build their capacity, including strengthening social inclusion and gender-balance	- Gender balance in CDCCCs in target communities (50% F, 50% M) (Baseline 0%) - Gender balance in leadership of CDCCCs (50% F, 50% M) (Baseline: 0%) - At least one person with disability is on CDCCC in target communities (Baseline: 0) - At least two youth on CDCCCs in target communities (1 F, 1 M on each CDCCC totalling 282 F and 282 M) (Baseline: 0) - Women, people with disability and youth on CDCCC report being confident to share their views and be respected	Year 1-4	DoCC DLA PMU Team Leader GESI Advisor	\$101,614 (Activity 1.1.1.2, budget assumptions A2, A5 & A6)
Activity 1.1.2 Increase CDCCC member capacity to identify climate change and disaster risks at the local level	100% of men, women and youth trained in leadership, including targeted training for women in leadership and children/youth engagement, ensuring that all CDCCC members respect women's decision-making roles (282 workshops total) (Baseline: 0%) 100% CDCCC members trained in gender-based risks of climate-induced hazards; gender-sensitive data collection and analysis (disaggregated by sex, age and ability) (Baseline: 0%)	Year 1-6	DoCC DLA SC Vanuatu PMU Team Leader GESI Advisor	\$38,566 (Activities 1.1.2.1-1.1.2.2, budget assumptions A12-14)

	95% targeted CDCCC members with increased understanding of the implications of climate change (Baseline: Approx. 15% nation-wide [<25% female])			
Output 1.2: Communities have increased understanding of climate change impacts and are supported to develop inclusive local adaptation plans				
Activity 1.2.1 Community awareness raising on climate change risks to food systems, livelihoods and disaster risk via targeted IEC materials and information sessions managed by Area Council Climate Change Officers and CDCCCs	- Equal participation in community awareness raising sessions (50% F, 50% M) (32 workshops total) (Baseline: 0%) 50% Area Council Climate Change Officers engaged under the project are women (Baseline: 0%) - IEC materials highlight key concerns as identified by women, men, girls and boys 5% of participants are people with disability (Baseline: 0%) 95% targeted women, men, children and youth with increased understanding of the implications of climate change (Baseline: Approx. 15% nation-wide [<25% female])	Year 1-6	DoCC DLA SC Vanuatu PMU Team Leader GESI Advisor	\$197,080 (Activities 1.2.1.1-1.2.1.5, budget assumptions A22-27)
Activity 1.2.2 Identify key local issues that drive climate vulnerability and use this to develop local adaptation plans and measure program impact	- Equal number of male and female participants in community consultations, including separate women and youth consultations (50% F; 50% M) (Baseline: 0%) 5% of participants in community consultations are people with a disability (Baseline: 0%) - All consultation reports identify distinct issues for women, men, young people and people with disabilities	Year 1-6	DLA PMU Team Leader GESI Advisor	\$189,383 (Activities 1.2.2.1-1.2.2.4, budget assumptions A33-38)
Activity 1.2.3 Development of inclusive Community Adaptation Plans and	100% Community Adaptation Plans include the perspectives, needs and capacities of women, men, girls and boys and people with disability	Year 1-6	DLA DoCC PMU Team Leader	\$211,925 (Activities 1.2.3.1-1.2.3.3, budget assumptions A44-48)

identification of key resilience building actions (selected from adaptation package menu)	(Baseline: 0%) 100% of community adaptation packages respond to all of the needs identified in the Adaptation Plans and includes activities specifically focused on the needs of women, children, youth and persons with disabilities (Baseline: 0%)		GESI Advisor	
Output 1.3: Communities have increased access to climate information services and early warning systems and the skills to utilise them as adaptation tools				
Activity 1.3.1 Develop and distribute CIS IEC products to support community adaptation awareness raising and adaptation planning processes	- All CIS communications (660 messages) are delivered in formats accessible to people with disability (Baseline: 0) 50% CIS communications (330 messages) are targeted at women (Baseline: 0) 50% CIS communications (330 messages) are targeted at women (Baseline: 0) 29,210 people target community members with increased understanding of application of CIS to agriculture/fisheries (8,763 F, 20,447 M – 30% female as fishers skew male) (Baseline: 720-1,380 people nation-wide [<25% female])	Year 1-6	DoCC NDMO PMU Team Leader GESI Advisor	\$44,442 (Activity 1.3.1.3-1.3.1.5, budget assumptions A54, A60,)
Activity 1.3.2 Build capacity of Area Council Climate Change Officers and CDCCCs to effectively utilize CIS in community planning processes	- Training materials include a strong focus on gender and disability - Equal numbers of men and women in Area Councils and CDCCCs trained in the use of CIS resources (50% F, 50% M) (44 workshops) (Baseline: 0) - Equal number of male and female participants in community consultations, including separate women and youth consultations (50% F; 50% M) (Baseline: 0%)	Year 1-4	DoCC PMU Team Leader GESI Advisor	\$172,532 (Activities 1.3.2.1-1.3.2.3, budget assumptions A67-A72)

Component 2: Scalable, locally appropriate actions are implemented to meet community adaptation needs to create climate-resilient, sustainable development pathways				
Project Activities	Indicator & Targets	Timeline	Who is responsible	cost
Output 2.1: Local natural resources are more resilient to climate change impacts through implementation of nature-based solutions				
Activity 2.1.1 Support adaptations that strengthen or rehabilitate coastal protection barriers, reduce risk of flood/landslides and improve water-security through nature-based solutions	- Assessment of men's and women's roles in natural resource management and findings incorporated into adaptation plans and activities, including efforts to address the skewed division of labour towards women 50% of participants in activities are women (Baseline: 0%) 5% of participants in activities are people with disability (Baseline: 0%) - Women and men have equitable access to project-provided resources to implement nature-based solutions (Baseline: 0)	Year 1-6	DoA DoWR DLA PMU Team Leader GESI Advisor	\$1,43,461 (Activities 2.1.1.1-2.1.1.6, budget assumptions B1-7)
Activity 2.1.2 Introduce/scale up improved agriculture methods to minimize erosion and reduce impact of pests and diseases	50% participants in education and training sessions are women (7,822 F) (130 workshops per year) (Baseline: 0) 50% of scaled-up/introduced methods support women's agricultural roles and support ways of addressing skewed division of labour (Baseline: 0) - At least 5% of participants in education and training are people with disability (Baseline: 0) - Women and men have equitable access to project-provided resources to implement nature-based solutions (Baseline: 0) - Women are 50% of participants in development of demonstration sites (Baseline: 0)	Year 1-6	DoA DoWR DLA PMU Team Leader GESI Advisor	\$369,536 (Activities 2.1.2.1-2.1.2.4, budget assumptions B14-19)

Activity 2.1.3 Support communities to protect and rehabilitate habitats that support fisheries, particularly degraded coral reefs, seagrass meadows and mangroves	50% participants in education and training sessions are women (43 workshops per year) (Baseline: 0%) - Women and men have equal voice in decisions on priority areas and targets for action 50% participants in rehabilitation action and invasive species management and women (Baseline: 0)	Year 1-6	DoA DoWR DLA PMU Team Leader GESI Advisor	\$175,304 (Activities 2.1.3.1-2.1.3.5, budget assumptions B26-32)
Output 2.2: Climate-resilient agriculture for food security and livelihood development				
Activity 2.2.1 Support adaptations to traditional farming methods to increase climate-resilience and increase food security	- Stocktake of existing and traditional agricultural practices outlines women and men's roles, needs and challenges and identifies strategies to address the skewed division of labour 50% participants in education and training sessions are women (15,600 F) (28 workshops per year) (Baseline: 0%) - Women are 50% of participants in development of demonstration sites (Baseline: 0)	Year 1-6	DoA DoWA DLA PMU Team Leader GESI Advisor	\$744,679 (Activities 2.2.1.1-2.2.1.4, budget assumptions B38-43)
Activity 2.2.2 Introduce/scale up adoption of climate-resilient native food and cash crop varieties	- Women and men have equitable access to project-provided resources to implement climate-resilient agriculture initiatives 50% farmers implementing climate resilient agriculture techniques are women (11,700 F) (Baseline: 0) - Women and men benefit equally from increased household food security	Year 2-6	DoA DoWA PMU Team Leader GESI Advisor	\$635,887 (Activities 2.2.2.1-2.2.2.3, budget assumptions B50-53)
Activity 2.2.3 Establish/scale-up community-, school- and home-based kitchen gardens for enhanced nutrition utilising climate-resilient crops	- At least 50% participants in education and training sessions are women (141 workshops per year) (Baseline: 0%) 5% of participants in education and training sessions are people with disability (Baseline: 0%) - Women and men have equitable access to project-provided resources to implement climate-resilient food security initiatives	Year 1-4	DoA DoWA PMU Team Leader GESI Advisor	\$439,090 (Activities 2.2.3.1-2.2.3.3, budget assumptions B60-65)

	50% participants in development of kitchen gardens in schools and communities are women (87 plots per year in years 3-5, total 261 plots) (Baseline: 0%)			
Output 2.3: Climate-resilient fisheries for food security and livelihood development				
Activity 2.3.1 Build community capacity on coastal resource management and monitoring that supports sustainable fisheries	50% of participants in training are women (Baseline: 0%) (28 workshops per year) 5% of participants in training are people with disability (Baseline: 0%) 50% of community 'champions' are women (202 F) (Baseline: 0%)	Year 1-6	DoF DoWA PMU Team Leader GESI Advisor	\$255,726 (Activities 2.3.1.1-2.3.1.3, budget assumptions B72-77)
Activity 2.3.2 Support communities to adopt primary community-based fisheries management to reduce climate change impacts	30% of participants in leadership training are women (2,700 F) (fishers in Vanuatu are predominately men) (28 workshops per year) (Baseline: 0%) 30% of targeted fishers diversifying resources are women (2,040 F) fishers in Vanuatu are predominately men) (Baseline: 0%)	Year 1-6	DoF DoWA PMU Team Leader GESI Advisor	\$242,985 (Activities 2.3.2.1-2.3.2.4, budget assumptions B78-82)
Output 2.4: Women-led climate-resilient food processing and preservation established to support food security and diversification of livelihoods options				
Activity 2.4.1 Introduce or scale up women-led local solutions for food processing and preservation	100% of technology owned and managed by women-led producer groups (Baseline: 0%) - Support 30 youth entrepreneurs (100% women) to operate and/or maintain perseveration technologies	Year 2-6	DLA DoWA PMU Team Leader GESI Advisor	\$2,578,623 (Activities 2.4.1.1-2.4.1.3, budget assumptions B89-94)
Activity 2.4.2 Support women to diversify into new agricultural/food commodities and value-add products that deliver greater income generating opportunities	- At least 90 women-led income diversification initiatives implemented, with at least 30 led by young women, including skills development for value-add products (28 workshops per year) (Baseline: 0) - Women and men benefit equally from increased household incomes generated from project support	Year 2-6	DLA DoWA PMU Team Leader GESI Advisor	\$1,850,130 (Activities 2.4.2.1-2.4.2.2, budget assumptions B101-105)

Activity 2.4.3 Support women-led enterprises to access private partnership options to access new (distant) markets for value-add products	90 women-led producer groups established and operational (Baseline: 0) 6 women-led partnerships with private sector entities established (assumes 1 per province) (Baseline: 0)	Year 1-6	DLA DoWA PMU Team Leader GESI Advisor	\$325,420 (Activities 2.4.3.1-2.4.3.2, budget assumptions B1127-117)
Component 3: Institutional adaptive capacity is enhanced by building adaptive governance systems at the local level and enhancing local-provincial-national linkages				
Output 3.1: Adaptive local governance systems strengthened through sub-national planning				
Project Activities	Project tasks	Deliverables		
Activity 3.1.1 Support Area Council and Province officials to incorporate climate risk analysis and financing strategies into Area Council development plans and budgets	- Consolidation of community analysis provides gender and disability disaggregated information (Baseline: not currently disaggregated) - Area Council training on the integration of climate change risks and adaptation actions into planning and budgeting processes includes tools on how to analyse plans from a gender and disability perspective and are gender balanced - At least 60% of targeted Area Councils operationalise gender-responsive budgeting practices (Baseline: 0%) 100% of Area Council and Province officials receive training in gender-based risks of climate-induced hazards; gender-sensitive data collection and analysis (disaggregated by sex, age and ability) (6 workshops per year) (Baseline: 0)	Year 1-6	DLA DwoA PMU Team Leader GESI Advisor	\$123,914 (Activities 3.1.1.3/3.1.1.6, budget assumptions C3/4)
Activity 3.1.2 Build the capacity of local authorities to support operations of the CDCCCs and ongoing inclusive local adaptation planning processes	Training to build capacity of Area Councils to support the ongoing operations of CDCCCs to include both women and men and seek gender balance (6 workshops per year)	Year 1-6	DoCC DLA PMU Team Leader GESI Advisor	\$522,330 (Activity 3.1.2.2, budget assumptions C11)
Activity 3.1.3 Support NDMO to design and establish a gender and shock-	Design of the shock responsive social protection system responds to the needs of women and people with disability	Year 1-4	NDMO PMU Team Leader GESI Advisor	Match funding Australian DFAT

responsive social protection system designed for the needs of the most vulnerable households.	(Baseline: no social protection system)			
Output 3.2: Enhanced local-provincial-national linkages				
Activity 3.2.1 Capture lessons learned, emerging themes and best practices at the community level to ensure sub-national and national planning processes are informed by local needs and that local actions support national objectives	• 10 (of 30) annual knowledge management products focus specifically on progress on gender equality, disability inclusion and youth participation and GESI issues mainstreamed into all other knowledge products (Baseline: 0 products) • At least 50% of participants in annual national, regional and/or international forums are women (Baseline: 0%) (4 workshops per year) • At least 30% of participants in annual national, regional and/or international forums are youth (Baseline: 0%) • At least 5% of participants in annual national, regional and/or international forums are people with disability (Baseline: 0%) • At least 30% of annual national, regional and/or international forums focus specifically on climate change and GESI-related issues (5 forums) (Baseline: 0%)	Year 1-6	DLA PMU M&E Specialist GESI Advisor	\$230,173, (Activities 3.2.1.1-3.2.1.3, budget assumptions C26-C31)
Activity 3.2.2 Support local authorities in monitoring and evaluation of national CCDRR policies at the local level and increasing dialogue between stakeholders at all levels	• Community level data includes indicators to report on Provincial Gender Action Plans, including: • Participation of Women, youth and people with disability • Leadership by women, youth and people with disability • Women led adaptation initiatives • Youth led adaptation initiatives • Skills development for people with disabilities (Baseline: data not captured)	Year 1-6	DLA PMU M&E Specialist GESI Advisor	\$57,401 (Activities 3.2.2.1-3.2.2.2, budget assumptions C36-C39)

	- At least 50% of participants in annual dialogues are women (1 workshop per year) (Baseline: 0%) - At least 30% of participants in annual dialogues are youth (Baseline: 0%) - At least 5% of participants in annual dialogues are people with disability (Baseline: 0%)			
Project Operations: Mainstream gender and social inclusion across project operations				
Project Staff demographics	50% of project staff are women 5% of project staff are people with disability 50% of project leadership positions are held by women	Throughout project	PMU Team Leader Recruitment officer	No additional cost
Project staff capacity	- All staff receive training in gender equality and social inclusion within year 1 - Position descriptions for Technical Staff include their ability to understand and address the needs of women, people with disability and youth - Full time GESI Advisor in Project	Year 1	PMU Team Leader GESI Adviser	Training time and budget
Support to Government	- GESI Advisor to train and coach staff in MoCC, Department of Women's Affairs (province level), and other key partners on mainstreaming GESI into plans, budgets and monitoring - Funding to enable province DWA and MALFFB staff to travel to communities for adaptation activity implementation and monitoring	Throughout project	PMU Team Leader GESI Adviser	Training time and budget

Project Communications	- Findings of this GESI assessment be disseminated to project staff, government and partners in Year 1 of implementation - Project communications represent women, youth and people with disability in positive, empowered roles and use appropriate language and deliver in accessible formats. - The project will publicise the grievance redress mechanism through means that ensure the process is accessible to both women and men. When making decisions about the locations and modalities to receive grievances the project will ensure accessibility to all affected stakeholders, in particular girls and women and that it responds effectively to SEAH in a survivor-centred and gender-responsive manner		Communication Manager GESI Adviser	PMU time
Community level considerations	- Women's time and care work will be considered in decisions on timing and location for all community level activities. Childcare facilities will be provided where required during project activities (i.e. at workshops) and will be communicated to participants prior to commencement of activities - Shifting gender norms is a key component of Save the Children's approach to programming. Behaviour change communications (utilizing resources from other SC projects in Vanuatu) will be utilized in community engagement and training	Year 1	PMU Team Leader GESI Adviser	